

Imaginal Transformation Fieldbook

Imaginal Concepts, Tools and Methods

Master's Academy & College Edition v2



by Thomas Rudmik

Imaginal Transformation

Imaginal Concepts, Tools and Methods

Fieldbook

by Thomas Rudmik

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Preface

Four Imaginal Capacities

During my life I have experienced a number of epiphanies; those inexplicable moments when something is deposited into your spirit that ignites a passion and a vision. Most of these moments have led to the unfolding of events that have proven to be significant. One such moment occurred in June 1999. I was flying from London to Nairobi to conduct an educational symposium in the country of Uganda. It was two o'clock in the morning, and the airplane was quiet as most people were sleeping. Suddenly, I was awakened with a steady stream of ideas as if someone had pressed the download button for a large file over the internet. I grabbed a notepad and pen, and began writing and illustrating the four capacities of an Imaginal leader, which I called at that time the iCubed (I^3) Model.

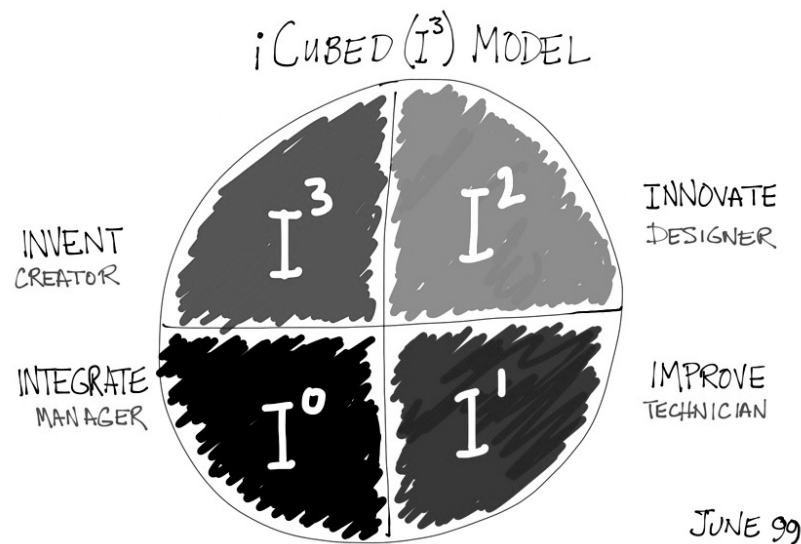


Fig. 1: The Inception of the iCubed Model- June 1999

The most common capacity is I^0 , which is the capacity to INTEGRATE —when we take on the role of a manager or system integrator. In mathematics any number to the power of 0 is equal to 1. Also any number multiplied by 1 remains unchanged. The manager identity is defined by researching what is already known, as well as finding best practices. This manager role maintains the status quo, keeps things in balance, and helps ensure that things run smoothly. As an integrator identity, managing the system needs to be performed well, but not to the exclusion of experiencing and developing the other three capacities.

I^1 is the capacity to IMPROVE, and is represented by the role of the engineer and technician. This is when we take on the role of improving our situation or the system we are a part of. Improvement is always a good thing, but seldom leads to profound change or breakthroughs.

The top two quadrants are where life begins to get interesting and exciting. I² is the capacity to INNOVATE; the ability to push the boundaries of your life and organization, or “the box” as some people like to call it. The capacity to innovate is truly an earmark of some of the more successful companies, such as Apple, and the reason why, for instance, it was able to stage a remarkable comeback after near certain death in the late 1990s.

Finally, the fourth capacity is the rarest of all: I³ is the capacity to INVENT—to be a visionary and entrepreneur. The visionary is someone who is willing to risk, go where no one has gone before, and explore the boundaries of what is possible.

These two capacities—to innovate and invent—introduce one to the role of being a creator, designer, futurist, and entrepreneur; one who can see the future and bring it into the HERE through the creation process.

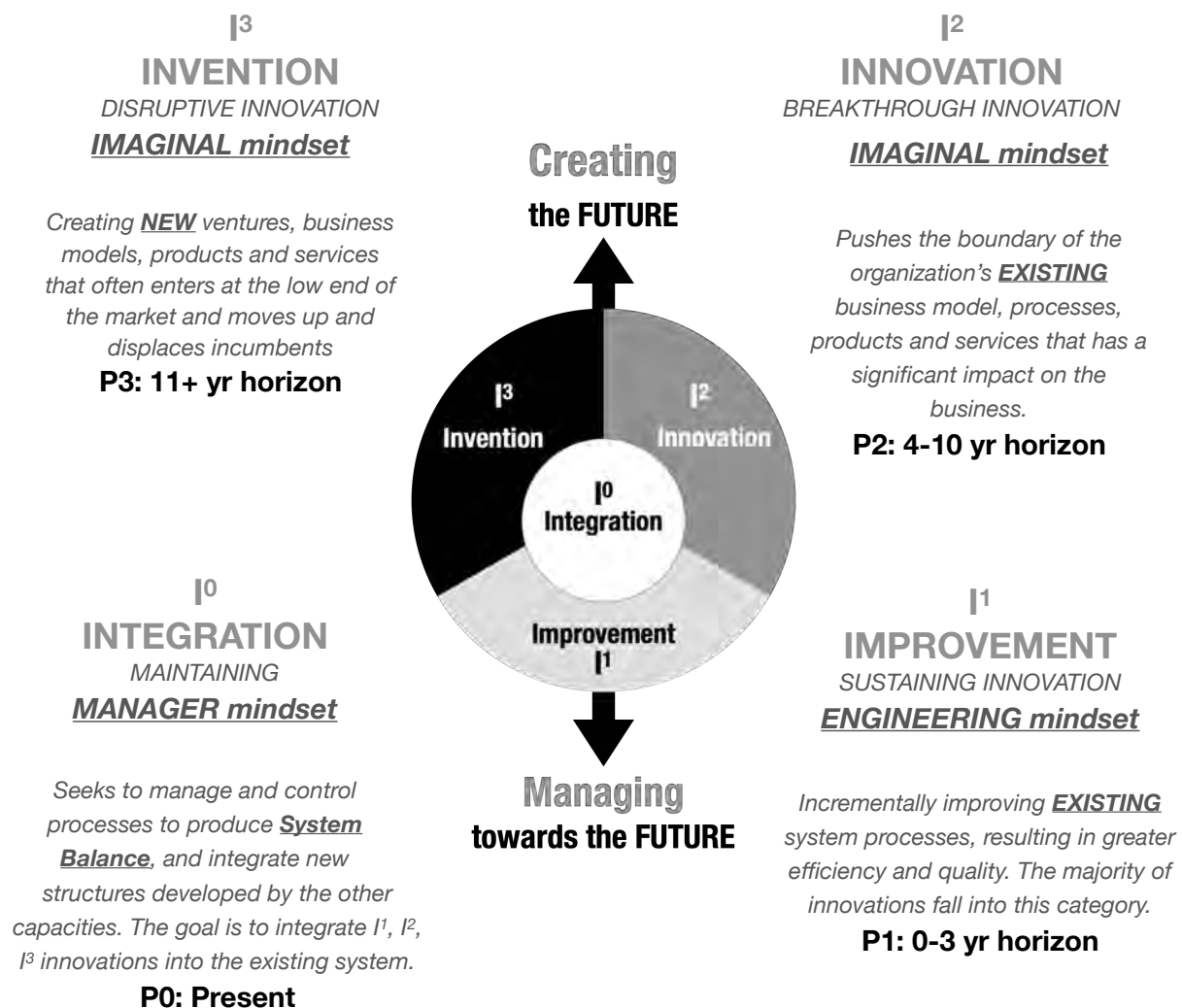


Fig. 2: Four Capacities of an Imaginal Leader and Organization

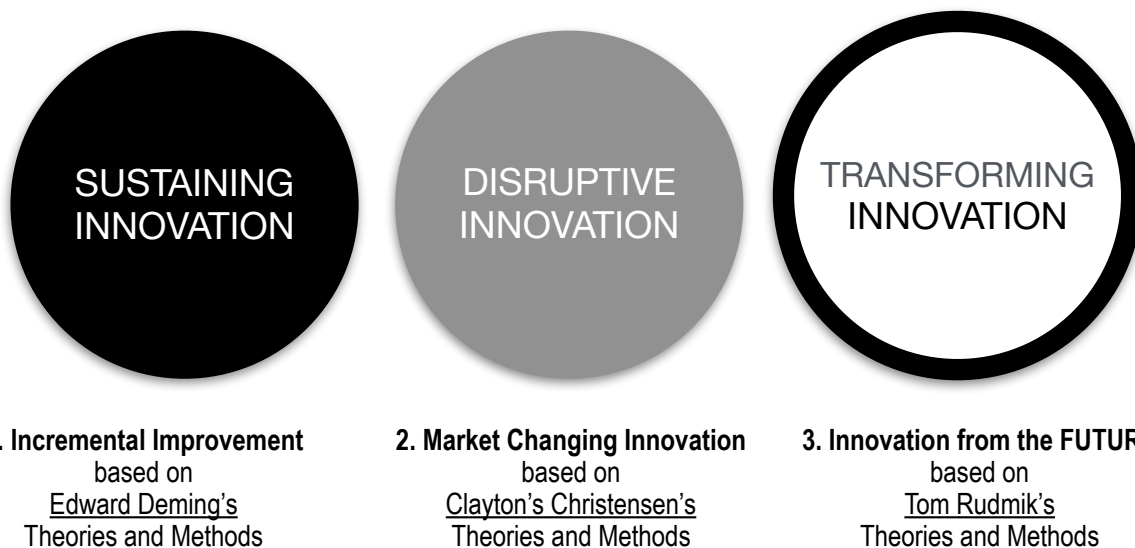


Fig. 3: Innovation Types

Your Imaginal Capacities

The capacity to innovate and invent, innately present in all of us, often goes untrained, causing it to whither over time. The capacity to imagine, to create, becomes stifled quite early in a person's life due to prolonged exposure to the industrial-age education system. This system, with its stringent demand for conformity, compliance, and the 'correct' answer, conditions people to become adept managers. They fit into the system, administer towards the future using goal setting and similar linear processes. Existing in the realms of management and improvement, these individuals perceive the future passively, and are tutored to deal with it as best as they can.

The two topmost quadrants in the Imaginal Capacities model signify the capacity to envision and manifest the future. Individuals inhabiting these quadrants have mastered the art of transcending their present reality to craft the future they desire and require. The Improvement capacity is about managing towards the future by creating an enhanced tomorrow, informed by historical data. This capacity is most prevalent since it doesn't necessitate a vision of the future, but is driven by creating something marginally better than what currently exists. Organizations that have developed their capacities to innovate and invent are able to create the future they want versus the one that is created for them by others.

Central to the Imaginal Leader's skillset is the proficiency to incorporate improvement, innovation, and invention into the existing system. Systems, inherently, are resistant to novelty, making the integration ability crucial for organizational stability. Imaginal Leaders can discern when a process or system requires management, improvement, or creation—be it through innovation or invention. This understanding renders an Imaginal Leader genuinely prepared for the future.

Reason for the Fieldbook

The tools and systems for integration and improvement have been well established over many decades of practice by organizations around the world. The improvement capacity finds its roots in Total Quality Management (TQM) and Edward Deming's philosophy of continuous improvement. There is a plethora of books and systems built around TQM.

The Imaginal Transformation Fieldbook was created as a manual to support the implementation of various Imaginal processes such as Imaginal Thinking and Imaginal Workshop. The concepts, tools and methods found in the Fieldbook will help those leaders aspiring to unleash the Imaginal and Innovative spirit in their organization using the Imaginal Thinking process.

Clayton Christensen's Innovation Types

Clayton Christensen, in his seminal work, delineated two distinct forms of innovation: sustaining and disruptive. Many companies, he observed, are engaged in a continuous cycle of sustaining innovation — incremental enhancements that primarily serve to improve their existing products and services. At times, these companies manage to engineer disruptive innovations that dramatically reshape markets and consumer behavior. Both of these types of innovation hinge primarily on engineering design thinking processes that harness historical data and insights from existing customers or collaborations within their open innovation ecosystem to craft superior solutions for the future.

Transforming Innovation

Transforming Innovation, as envisioned by Tom Rudmik, is a proactive and strategic approach to innovation, which focuses on pulling the future into the present. Instead of being reactive and trying to catch up with the evolving market trends, organizations proactively shape their future by envisioning it and creating new practices, products, or services that don't just improve upon the existing, but transform the marketplace. This innovation approach not only disrupts the current business landscape but also redefines it by reimagining what's possible, thus keeping the organization perpetually ahead in its competitive sphere.

Transforming Innovation stands in a category of its own, representing a radical departure from conventional innovation approaches. These innovations are not merely iterations or advancements of what already exists, but are groundbreaking ideas conceived from visions of the future. These are innovations that, when manifested, have the capacity to entirely transform not just the company that birthed them, but the industry at large.

At the core of Transforming Innovation is a visionary perspective that is distinctly future-focused. Its methodology hinges on the principle of seeing and learning from the future, then retrospectively charting the pathways that will actualize that vision. This approach demands a certain degree of imaginative foresight, coupled with the ability to discern strong and weak signals in the present that can guide an organization in crafting potent future scenarios.

These scenarios, in turn, serve as immersive platforms for the organization. Having generated robust future scenarios, we can "futurecast"—immerse ourselves in these scenarios and extract insights by responding to questions like: What needs to change for this future to materialize? How would you align with this future? If you were an enterprise, would your present self be competitive in this future scenario, and so forth?

The responses to these questions provide invaluable insights, lessons gleaned from the future. These insights, in essence, set the stage for constructing a backcasting scenario, a reverse-engineered roadmap detailing how that particular future was brought to fruition. This process facilitates not just the envisioning of the future but also the strategic planning and actions necessary for an organization to transform itself in alignment with that future.

As such, Imaginal Transforming Innovation calls for a different kind of leadership - leaders who can intuit the future, decipher these signals, and harness them to build strategies and make decisions today that will prepare their organizations for that envisioned future. It's about learning from the future as it emerges. In the process, these innovations have the potential to catalyze widespread transformation, propelling an organization, and indeed an entire industry, into a new era of growth and relevance.

Unleashing Innovative Spirit

At the heart of Transforming Innovation lies the domain of futurism and the realm of future studies. It's a process that allows us to visualize, learn from, and shape the future. The fact that we can anticipate the future is premised on the existence of strong and weak signals present today.

Strong signals often materialize as trends, backed by comprehensive research and data. A case in point is the growing inclination towards autonomous vehicles; it's an inevitability that self-driving cars and trucks will become the norm. We are surrounded by myriad trends across all societal sectors that will interplay and shape the future. S-curves help us map the adoption stage of each trend based on expert opinions.

Thorough future impact analysis allows Imaginal leaders to construct probable, plausible, and possible future scenarios, founded on their trend exploration. In the world of foresight or future studies, the objective isn't to foretell the future—an endeavor often laden with inaccuracies—but to craft various alternative futures, be they plausible, possible, probable, preferred, or preposterous.

Fieldbook Parts

Imaginal Transformation Fieldbook, delves deep into the journey of personal and organizational transformation through the lens of Imaginal Thinking and Leadership. This book is structured into four distinct parts, each building upon the concepts introduced in the preceding sections to guide readers through a comprehensive transformational journey.

Part I: Imaginal Leadership

This section lays the foundational principles of Imaginal Leadership found in Thomas Rudmik's first book, *"Becoming Imaginal, Seeing and Creating the Future of Education"*. It begins by introducing the Big WHY model, the first of five keys of becoming Imaginal. It establishes a framework called "Imaginal Capacities," identifying key qualities and abilities vital for navigating and propelling breakthroughs in various aspects of life and work. Additionally, the narrative unfolds the "Seven Breakthrough Drivers," articulating core principles that instigate significant shifts in thinking and action. Themes such as courage, the embrace of the path of least resistance, and the exploration of "Levels of Creation" are examined, offering insights into overcoming challenges and enhancing creative prowess. The discourse also subtly introduces the spiritual dimension of transformation, suggesting a deeper, divine underpinning essential to the Imaginal approach.

Part II: Imaginal Thinking

This second section ventures into the forward-thinking methodologies of Imaginal Thinking. It systematically introduces the reader to essential concepts such as foresight, knowledge creation levels, and the interpretation of environmental signals for predicting and influencing future outcomes. A comprehensive seven-step framework for Imaginal Thinking is outlined, supplemented by a variety of tools and probing questions designed to support this reflective process. Furthermore, this part of the book investigates design thinking, scenario planning, and additional strategies that promote innovative and anticipatory thinking. With the integration of universal plot lines, futurecasting, backcasting, and trend analysis techniques, the text significantly expands the reader's capabilities to envision and steer through potential future landscapes.

Part III: Imaginal System Tools

This portion of the book is highly practical, focusing on tools and methods that help you to better understand your current reality and how a system works. This section covers a range of analytical and planning tools, such as force field analysis, consensograms, and flow charts, which are essential for understanding and mapping out the dynamics within systems. The deployment of diagrams like fish bone and inter-relationship diagrams, alongside methodologies like PDSA (Plan-Do-Study-Act) and systems thinking principles, are aimed at fostering a deeper understanding of complex systems and how to initiate improvements within them.

Part IV: Imaginal Organization and Innovation

Imaginal Organization and Innovation - The final section synthesizes the insights and methodologies discussed previously to outline the blueprint for building "Imaginal Organizations." These organizations are designed to embody the principles of imaginal leadership and thinking at their core, enabling them to innovate and transform continuously. This book presents the importance of aligning the organization's Big WHY with innovation strategies, the characteristics of Kingdom Companies, and how to cultivate an organizational culture that embraces change and fosters innovation. This part serves as both a culmination of the book's themes and a practical guide to implementing the imaginal transformation in real-world contexts.

Throughout the Imaginal Transformation Fieldbook, you will be introduced to a forward-thinking and integrative approach to innovation, termed "Transforming Innovation," which emphasizes the creation and application of future-derived insights for impactful change. By providing a rich array of concepts, tools, and methods, the book aims to equip individuals and organizations with the capability to shape the future proactively, fostering a new era of innovation grounded in deep foresight and transformative action.

Part V: Master's Big WHY

At Master's Academy and College, our "Big WHY" encapsulates our deep, God-inspired commitment to advancing His Kingdom through education. We believe that our Mission, Vision, and Kingdom Assignment are divinely guided, and that teaching here is more than a profession—it is a spiritual calling. This Kingdom Assignment drives us to co-design and co-create with God a new model of Christian education, aligned with Kingdom principles, which we are dedicated to sharing with the world. Our mission extends beyond the classroom, aiming to instill Christian faith, values, and worldview in our students, act as marketplace influencers and redemptive agents within the educational system, and make a transformative impact on education globally. This profound purpose shapes our culture of respect, empowerment, and integrity, and is reflected in the behaviors and values that govern our community. In all we do, we strive to honor God and prepare our students to be Future Ready, fulfilling our calling to make a significant difference in our community, region, country, and beyond.

Appendix A: Profound Learning Overview

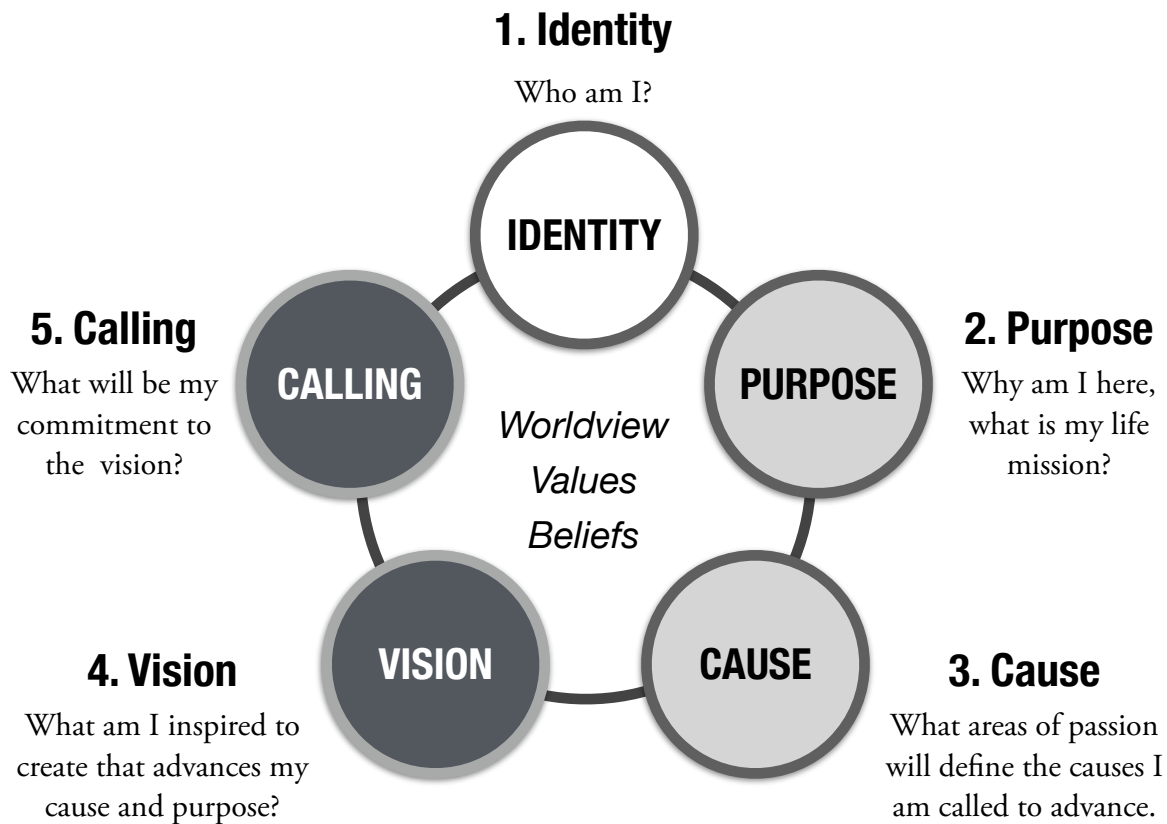
Appendix A presents a detailed overview of Profound Learning developed at Master's Academy and College.

Part I

Imaginal Leadership

*“People don’t buy what you do; they buy why you do it. And what you do simply proves what you believe.”—Simon Sinek, Start with Why:
How Great Leaders Inspire Everyone to Take Action*

5 Dimensions of your Big WHY



**There is no greater joy or fulfillment
than living out your Big WHY in
alignment with God's will for your life!**

—Tom Rudmik 2024

My Personal Big WHY



Imaginal Leaders are driven by a ‘higher’ calling and at their centre is something that is bigger than themselves, it is their Big WHY. The Big WHY is an emergent property of all of the five dimensions below working together to give you a deep sense of purpose and destiny. Imaginal Leaders display incredible courage as they advance their Big WHY of life.

Three men were working on building a wall and were asked what they were doing, the first responded, ‘I am building a wall’, the second responded, “I working so that I can provide for my family” and the third responded, “I am building a cathedral” The Big WHY is all about being a cathedral builder!

Identity

My identity is all about how I view myself, and how I interpret others’ view of me. My sense of identity is the sum total of all my experiences interpreted through a filter of my worldview—the beliefs, values, and assumptions I hold about life and myself. It includes my unique set of talents and passion areas that guide my life.

Purpose

Purpose answers life’s biggest question: Why am I here? Purpose defines in general terms my life’s mission—what I want to accomplish with my life.

Purpose provides a general framework for my life’s mission or aim. However, being purpose-driven is not the same as being vision-driven. Vision-driven people are those Imaginal leaders who go out and change the world and become history-makers. You can be purpose-driven and not have a compelling vision, but you cannot be vision driven without a clear understanding of purpose.

Cause

Cause moves our focus away from ourselves to some endeavor that has a greater good attached to it and is generally much bigger than any one individual. Discovering the cause or causes that will elevate our lives is at the core of helping us define our Big WHY.

It is cause that elevates the human experience, for it is what compels us to escape the world of self absorption, to flee the entrapment of materialism and consumerism. Victor Frankl observed that survivors of the holocaust often were those who had a strong sense that they still had something significant to contribute to their world, which thus enabled them to endure unthinkable suffering.

Vision

Dream can be defined very loosely as a picture one carries of an ideal future. Dream is the early stage development of a vision, and tends to be big and lacking in details. Dreams are designed to inspire and ignite the passion within people; and truly compelling dreams are those tied to a cause that is bigger than the dreamer.

Dreams over time become more specific and ultimately mature into a vision. For an Imaginal leader, and for the purposes of this book, vision is defined as the specific expression of what I am inspired to create that advances my cause and purpose. A true and authentic vision can be one of the most powerful forces in our life. It keeps pulling us forward to live an extraordinary life. Visionary people seldom, if ever, lose focus or quit.

Calling

Calling defines my role within a vision, as well as my commitment. Everyone can have a vision for their life, which often means being a part of a larger vision-community. Calling is applying my gifts and talents appropriately to the vision. Not everyone is called to lead a vision, but everyone can be a contributor to the advancement of a vision. This is when personal vision melds with community vision—they become one and the same.

Calling is a very important step that helps to solidify your Big WHY. Many people can carry dreams and aspirations for a number of things, but calling takes it beyond a wish list item to something far more tangible and observable.

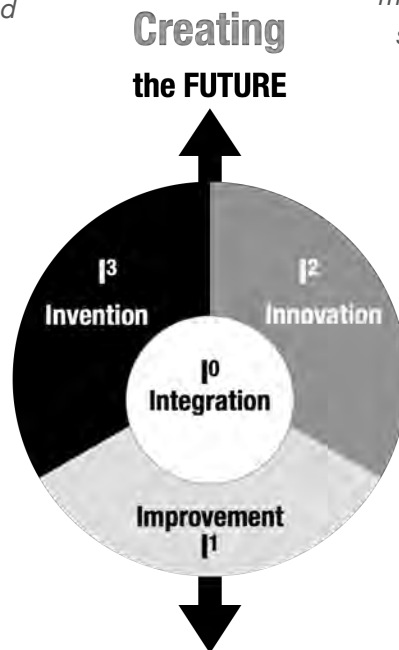
Four Imaginal Capacities

I³
INVENTION
 TRANSFORMING INNOVATION
IMAGINAL mindset

Creating **NEW** ventures, business models, products and services that often enters at the low end of the market and moves up and displaces incumbents
P3: 11+ yr horizon

I²
INNOVATION
 DISRUPTIVE INNOVATION
IMAGINAL mindset

Pushes the boundary of the organization's **EXISTING** business model, processes, products and services that has a significant impact on the business.
P2: 4-10 yr horizon



I⁰
INTEGRATION
 MAINTAINING
MANAGER mindset

Seeks to manage and control processes to produce **System Balance**, and integrate new structures developed by the other capacities. The goal is to integrate I¹, I², I³ innovations into the existing system.
P0: Present

I¹
IMPROVEMENT
 SUSTAINING INNOVATION
ENGINEERING mindset

Incrementally improving **EXISTING** system processes, resulting in greater efficiency and quality. The majority of innovations fall into this category.
P1: 0-3 yr horizon

Imaginal Capacities



Your Imaginal Capacities

The capacity to innovate and invent, innately present in all of us, often goes untrained, causing it to wither over time. The capacity to imagine, to create, becomes stifled quite early in a person's life due to prolonged exposure to the industrial-age education system. This system, with its stringent demand for conformity, compliance, and the 'correct' answer, conditions people to become adept managers. They fit into the system, administer towards the future using goal setting and similar linear processes. Existing in the realms of management and improvement, these individuals perceive the future passively, and are tutored to deal with it as best as they can.

The two topmost quadrants in the Imaginal Capacities model signify the capacity to envision and manifest the future. Individuals inhabiting these quadrants have mastered the art of transcending their present reality to craft the future they desire and require. The Improvement capacity is about managing towards the future by creating an enhanced tomorrow, informed by historical data. This capacity is most prevalent since it doesn't necessitate a vision of the future, but is driven by creating something marginally better than what currently exists. Organizations that have developed their capacities to innovate and invent are able to create the future they want versus the one that is created for them by others.

Central to the Imaginal Leader's skillset is the proficiency to incorporate improvement, innovation, and invention into the existing system. Systems, inherently, are resistant to novelty, making the integration ability crucial for organizational stability. Imaginal Leaders can discern when a process or system requires management, improvement, or creation—be it through innovation or invention. This understanding renders an Imaginal leader genuinely prepared for the future.

Integration

The capacity for INTEGRATION taps into the mindset of a MANAGER, one who aspires to administer and regulate processes to yield consistent results and achieve targeted business objectives. All managerial systems collectively strive to uphold the health and equilibrium of the enterprise.

Management systems

- Business Performance System
- Human Capital Development System
- Imaginal Knowledge Management System

Improvement

The capacity for Improvement naturally fits the mindset of an ENGINEER to identify and rectify issues. The emphasis lies on step-by-step enhancement of current system processes, leading to amplified efficiency and quality.

The ethos of constant improvement is deeply ingrained in the organization, necessitating the accumulation and evaluation of data on system performance. The ultimate aim is to dominate the market with superior products and services.

Innovation

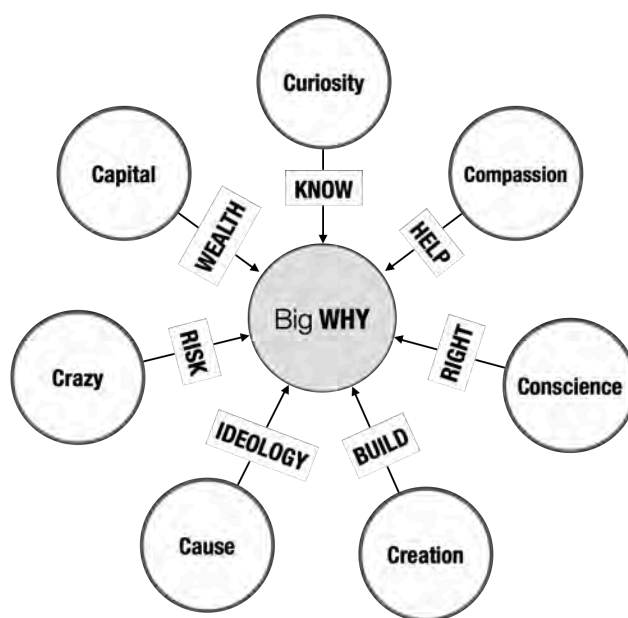
The capacity for INNOVATION leverages the IMAGINAL aptitude for envisioning, architecting, and bringing the future to life. Innovation challenges the confines of the organization's CURRENT business model, processes, products, and services. Innovation materializes through the amalgamation of groundbreaking technological advancements that markedly enhance customer value.

The methodologies for innovation diverge from those for improvement. Improvement centers on existing processes, whereas innovation necessitates broad scanning and establishing fresh connections with up-and-coming technologies and trends.

Invention

The capacity for INVENTION, too, harnesses the IMAGINAL prowess for visualizing, sculpting, and actualizing the future, focusing on the genesis of NEW enterprises, business models, products, and services that lead to sustainable competitive dominance. Invention, being the engine propelling the long-term growth of the enterprise, is a superior form of innovation demanding a higher threshold for risk absorption. Generally, invention necessitates the infusion of expert knowledge that lies beyond the organization's existing reservoir of competence.

Seven Breakthrough Drivers



Use the following rating scale to score the following drivers. There is no right or wrong score, this is simply an exercise to **help** you reflect on what drives you to do what you do. Shade in your score starting from zero and ending on the number you choose.

- 0 - Not at all
- 1 - Seldom- only if I have to
- 2 - Occasionally when I think of it

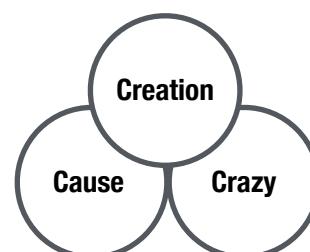
- 3 - Occasionally without having think of it
- 4 - Consistently by intentional effort
- 5 - Consistently without thinking

Your Driver	Score					
Curiosity - the drive to know something (Einstein)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Compassion - the drive to help others less fortunate (Mother Theresa)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Conscience- the drive to right a wrong (Martin Luther King Jr.)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Creation – the drive to build and create (Steve Jobs)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Cause – the drive to advance a noble cause or ideology (Martin Luther)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Crazy – the drive to be the first - to take extraordinary risks (Shackleton)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Capital- the drive to create wealth and to give it away (Bill Gates)	0	1	2	3	4	5

Reflection: Draw your driver cluster made up of your dominant driver plus your recessive drivers. How does your driver profile influence how you would function working in a team?

Dominant Driver:
Creation

Recessive Drivers:
Cause, Crazy



Seven Breakthrough Drivers

.....

Breakthrough Drivers

Reflecting on what inspires people to achieve extraordinary feats led me to consider influential figures who have shaped our world. My contemplations brought forth seven primary drivers behind groundbreaking achievements.

These drivers, much like personality types, tend to cluster together. One might have a primary driver, such as the pursuit of capital, but also possess a strong creation instinct and willingness to take risks—falling under the "crazy" driver.

Curiosity

Curiosity is the motivating force driving the pursuit of knowledge. Numerous notable scientific advancements throughout history owe their existence to individuals fuelled by a potent desire to learn. Those who are governed by curiosity have cultivated a heightened urge to seek answers to the unknown. It's this very human curiosity that propels the majority of today's scientific discoveries.

Eg. Nicolaus Copernicus, Galileo, Albert Einstein

Compassion

Compassion is the driving force that compels individuals to extend their hand towards those less fortunate. A significant number of global aid organizations were born out of the deep-rooted desire of some individuals to alleviate human suffering. Likewise, a lot of scientists and doctors have charted breakthroughs inspired by their profound wish to help others.

Eg. Dr. Alfred Blalock, Louis Pasteur, Mother Teresa

Conscience

Conscience is fundamentally about fairness, about doing what's right and rectifying wrongs. Our history is punctuated by individuals who have significantly influenced our world through their acts of social activism, even to the extent of altering the course of entire nations.

Eg. Martin Luther King, Mahatma Gandhi, Oscar Schindler

Creation

Creation is the driving force behind building and innovating. Those governed by this drive visualize their goals with their imagination before actualizing them in the real world. The creation drive stokes the fire of entrepreneurship and fuels the pursuit of solutions to seemingly impossible problems.

Eg. Filippo Brunelleschi, Steve Jobs, Leonardo DaVinci

Cause

Cause is usually associated with an ideology, or a large scale reform of our society or its institutions. Some are motivated to instigate meaningful changes in education, becoming part of the larger movement for educational reformation. Freedom fighters, in particular, tend to be driven by a cause so strongly that they are prepared to lay down their lives for it. Causes often have religious undertones as well.

Eg. Jesus Christ, Che Guevara, Eric Liddell

Crazy

History is littered with instances of individuals taking extraordinary risks, be it to discover new territories or to scale the highest peaks. What compels them? It's what I term as the 'crazy' driver. They are motivated by the thrill of adventure, by the aspiration of being the first, and are prepared to undertake extraordinary risks to fulfill their dreams.

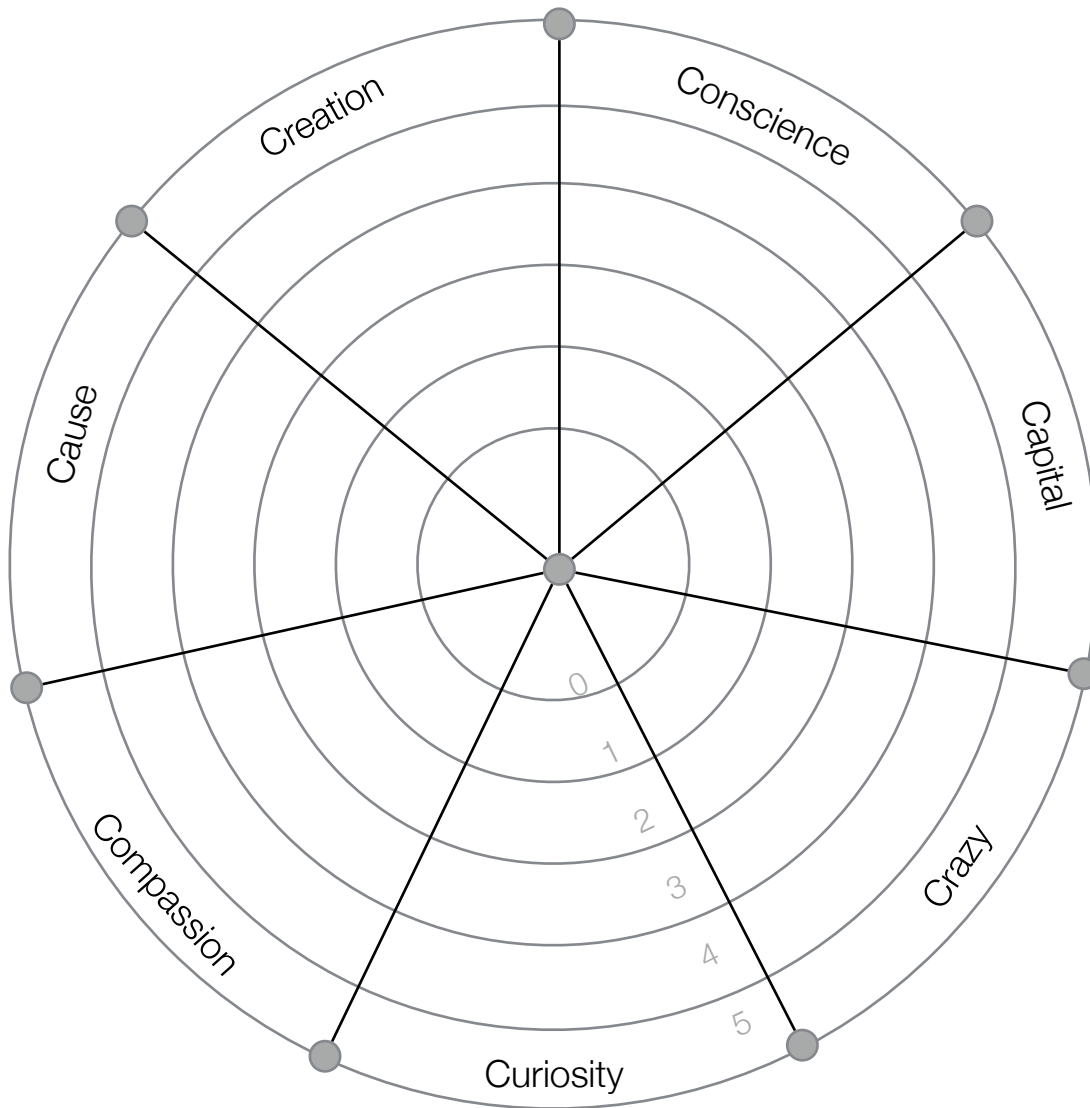
Eg. Ernest Shackleton, Christopher Columbus, Sir Edmund Hillary

Capital

The capital driver represents individuals who are motivated to amass wealth. The process of generating vast wealth typically entails the willingness to push boundaries, take risks on uncharted ideas, and persist until the dream has been realized. Wealth creation is primarily rooted in business, and over time, the most significant wealth creators have often been pioneers of new technologies or solutions. Towards the twilight of their lives, many such wealth creators shift their focus towards philanthropy.

Eg. Bill Gates, Warren Buffet, Oprah Winfrey

Seven Breakthrough Drivers Visualization



Rose Diagram Shade in the rose diagram rose diagram above to reflect your dominant and recessive drivers. You should aim to identify one dominant driver and at least two recessive drivers that occasionally are evident in your life. You need to be very objective with your assessment, your response should not reflect your values and desires, rather your behaviours. You may have the ability to function in all 7 drivers, but generally only one will be your dominant driver with a couple of recessive drivers.

Seven Breakthrough Drivers

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Your Driver Self-Assessment

Use the following rating scale to score the following drivers. There is no right or wrong score, this is simply an exercise to help you reflect on what drives you to do what you do. Shade in your score starting from zero and ending on the number you choose.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| 0 Not at all | 3. Occasionally without having think of it |
| 1. Seldom- only if I have to | 4. Consistently by intentional effort |
| 2. Occasionally when I think of it | 5. Consistently without thinking |

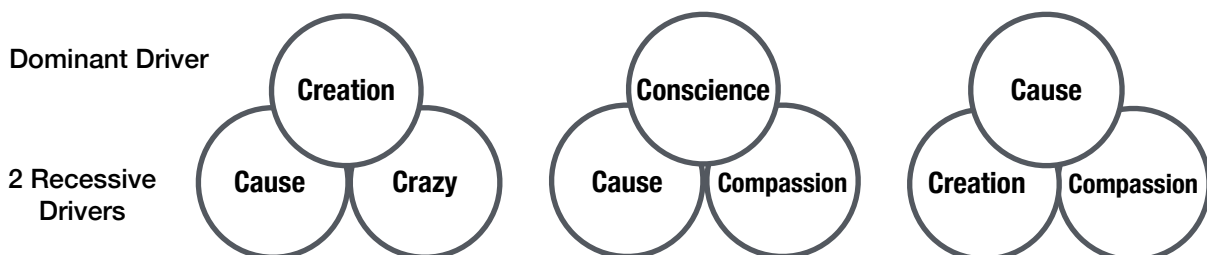
Your Driver	Score					
Curiosity - the drive to know something (Einstein)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Compassion - the drive to help others less fortunate (Mother Theresa)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Conscience- the drive to right a wrong (Martin Luther King Jr.)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Creation – the drive to build and create (Steve Jobs)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Cause – the drive to advance a noble cause or ideology (Martin Luther)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Crazy – the drive to be the first - to take extraordinary risks (Shackleton)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Capital- the drive to create wealth and to give it away (Bill Gates)	0	1	2	3	4	5

Dominant Driver: your default driver, this is your sweet spot when you feel most joyful and fulfilled. You express this driver without thinking about it.

Recessive Driver(s): I am comfortable operating with these drivers, but only when needed, I do not default to these drivers

Reflection: Draw your driver cluster made up of your dominant driver plus your recessive drivers. How does your driver profile influence how you would function working in a team?

Sample Driver Clusters



Courage and Imaginal Leadership



Fig. 1 Courage and Commitment

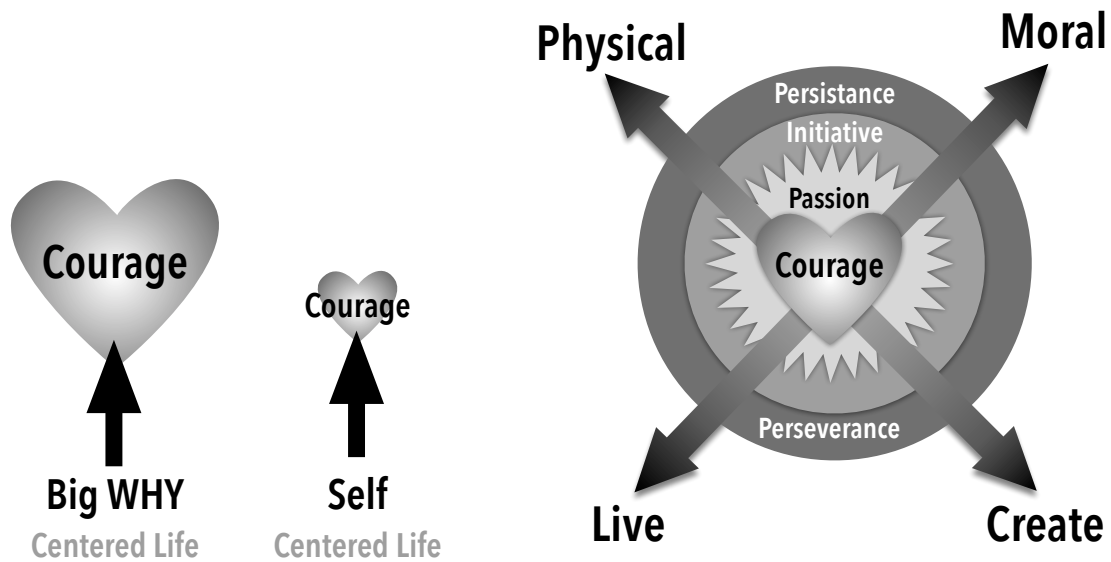


Fig. 2 Big WHY and Courage

Fig. 3 Four Realms of Courage

Courage



Courage Drives Commitment

Why do some individuals display immense bravery in the pursuit of their dreams, whilst others falter when faced with adversity? What causes some to flourish immensely in their divine gifts, while others stagnate, living a life devoid of fulfillment?

The activation of personal motivation is the second among the Five Keys to Becoming an Imaginal Leader, a pivotal determinant that differentiates dream achievers from the rest. Drive is akin to the spiritual fuel derived from the burning bush that Moses encountered— it propels you towards the realization of your God-given purpose. Just as that divine flame, drive comprises several potent core elements:

At the core of personal drive lies **Courage**, reminiscent of David's bravery in confronting Goliath. It is an embodiment of our human spirit, the capacity to make decisions even when facing formidable challenges.

Passion mirrors the fervor of Apostle Paul in spreading the teachings of Christ, defining the fervor, intensity, and depth of our commitment, often exhibited through deep-seated emotions.

Initiative is the act of stepping forward, fueled by courage and passion. It is akin to Noah beginning the construction of the Ark, driven by divine instruction.

Persistence and Perseverance, related directly to the intensity and depth of courage and passion, mirror Job's unwavering faith amidst trials.

Courage and Your Big WHY

In my exploration, I have discovered that courage is anchored in your Big WHY and calling. People who are self-centered, akin to the Rich Young Ruler in the Bible, do not embark on risks, as they are consumed with their own preservation, protection, and elevation.

Studying the annals of history, you will discern that the bravest were those centered around a Big WHY or a cause bigger than who they are. Such individuals, like the disciples, were often prepared to surrender their lives for the cause as it took precedence over self and comfort. As your personal vision is a distinctive manifestation of your

divine calling and purpose, the growth of vision fuels courage. Individuals centered on a cause have a grander vision fostering the growth of courage.

Someone once expressed, "Disturb the comfortable rather than comfort the disturbed; convert zones of comfort into zones of discomfort." This encapsulates the essence of becoming a visionary driven by a divine cause.

Four Realms of Courage

Courage manifests in four realms. Firstly, **physical courage**, which mirrors the traditional perception of courage held by Socrates, Plato, Aristotle, and other great thinkers. This involves placing your life at physical risk, just as Christ did for mankind.

Moral courage, as displayed by biblical prophets, involves standing firm for righteousness and the preservation of virtues. Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr. exemplified this through their quest for social justice.

The **courage to create**, reminiscent of God's creation of the universe, often involves the transformation of the imagined into reality. It may be met with rejection and could involve initial destruction before something new can be built.

Lastly, the **courage to live** and pursue your God-given dream, akin to Abraham journeying to the Promised Land, to become all that you are destined to be, to live an authentic life and exercise the divine gifts of entrepreneurship, innovation, and invention.

Courage is the impetus to step beyond traditional constraints and comfort zones, echoing Peter's step out onto the water towards Christ, to take risks, to lead, to stand firm, and to embrace errors as opportunities to learn and grow.

Red Sea and Commitment

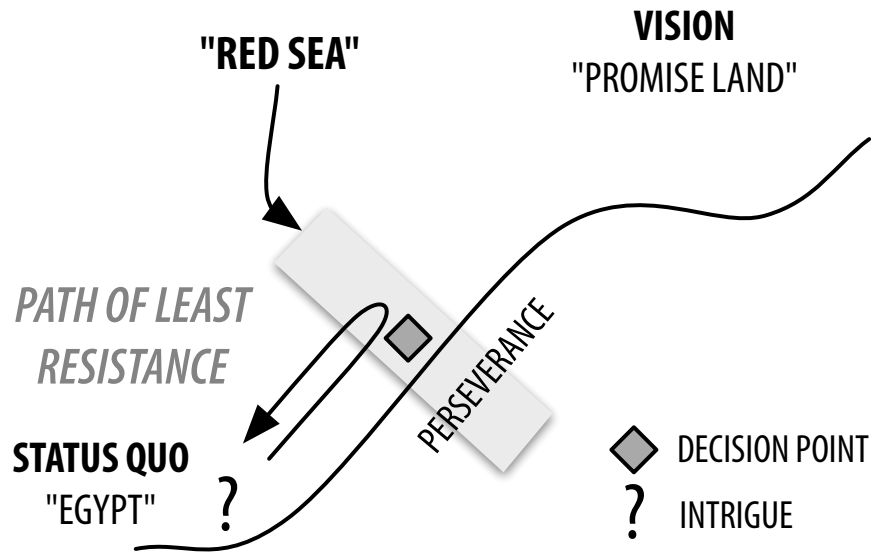


Fig. 1 Path of Least Resistance—Back to Egypt

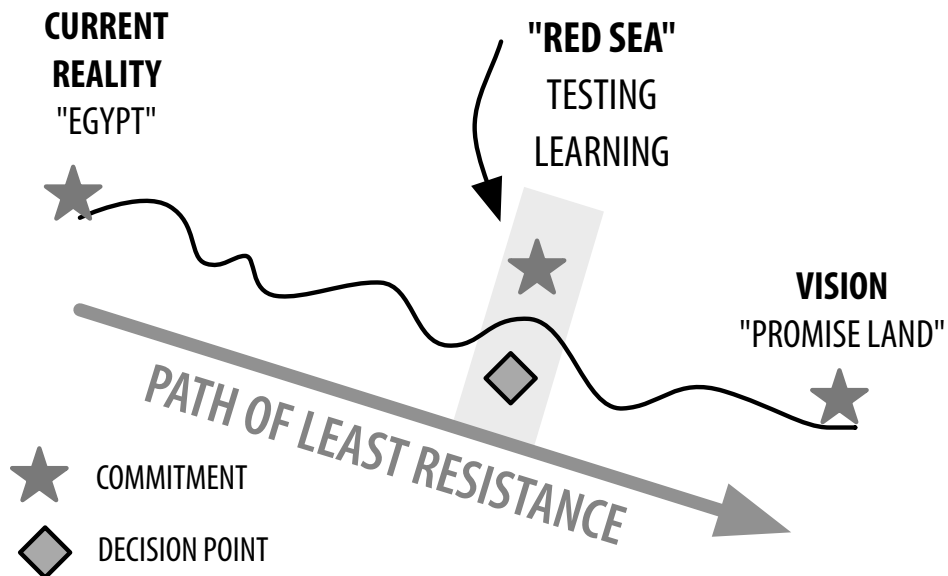


Fig. 2 Imaginal Leader's Path of Least Resistance is Towards Vision

Path of Least Resistance



Back to Egypt Syndrome

The Back to Egypt Syndrome serves as a metaphor taken from the Biblical Exodus narrative led by Moses. Egypt stands as a symbol for the status quo, representing a place of bondage where you are shackled by your past and held captive by the urge to maintain the status quo. In the Exodus narrative, the Israelites, with joy akin to King David's when he brought the Ark of the Covenant to Jerusalem, leave Egypt with high hopes of beholding the Promised Land. However, they soon face the Red Sea with Pharaoh's army breathing down their necks.

Red Sea Moments

Each of us confronts these Red Sea moments, analogous to enrolling in a program that promotes a better life. Up until this point, you have enrolled in the program due to a captivating vision of a better life. But now you face a decisive moment: do you revert and go back to Egypt, or do you forge a path through the Red Sea?

The Red Sea serves as the revelation point, where you uncover what truly motivates you to chase the vision of the Promise Land.

You may have shown a degree of commitment and put in some effort to get this far, but now your resolve faces a stern test, much like Job's faith during his trials.

In life, when you encounter your Red Sea moments, you quickly realize where your genuine commitment lies. Just as the Israelites initially pursued the promise of a land flowing with milk and honey, it's easy to pursue a vision that offers the prospect of something better. However, your true commitment is unveiled when the journey becomes strenuous. Being discontent with your current "Egypt" may prompt you to engage with a vision or program that promises an improved life, but seldom will this dissatisfaction fuel the energy required to realize the vision itself. Anyone who has started diet would understand how all this works.

The Path of Least Resistance

Imaginal leaders create not merely to attain satisfaction or escape dissatisfaction, but because they want to—they have been called to create, akin to God's divine calling to Jeremiah before his birth. They hold a deep love for the cause and vision they serve, and they harbor a divine calling that becomes their guiding star.

For an Imaginal leader, the tension that arises between the vision and the current reality creates a powerful dynamic in which ***the path of least resistance is towards the fulfillment of the vision and not a retreat back to Egypt***, just as the Israelites pressed forward to Canaan despite their initial struggles. For those merely engaged with a vision, their path of least resistance will often lead them back to Egypt. The Red Sea moment for an Imaginal leader serves as not just a time of testing, akin to Christ's temptation in the wilderness, but also a moment of learning to comprehend the dynamics at play within the system they inhabit.

The Imaginal leader envisions a future rooted in love, the most powerful motivating force in the universe, as professed in 1 Corinthians 13. The unshakeable commitment of a true Imaginal leader mirrors that of Ruth to Naomi - love and commitment are inseparable. The profound love between spouses or the parental love for their children inherently involves commitment to each other's well-being and success.

When I was 11 years old, my parents thought it prudent that I learn to play the piano. Early into my lessons, I was struck with a vision to become a concert pianist. Despite not being a child prodigy, under the guidance of a remarkable piano teacher, Hilda Capp, I swiftly advanced in my piano playing.

In 1997, Gary McPherson, a leading researcher in children's musical development from Melbourne, Australia, conducted a study with 157 randomly chosen children to discern why some progressed swiftly at music lessons while others did not. The surprising result? The vision the child brought to the first lesson, coupled with a commitment to learning an instrument, were far more crucial factors than any external influence, whether the teacher's input or the amount of practice.

For these young children, the path of least resistance was towards their vision to become musicians, evidenced by their long-term commitment, similar to the unwavering faith of the Apostle Paul in his long-term mission to spread the Gospel. Individuals with a genuine vision for the future create a structural tension that directs life towards its fulfillment, similar to how God's divine plan steadily unfolds throughout the Biblical narrative.

Levels of Creation

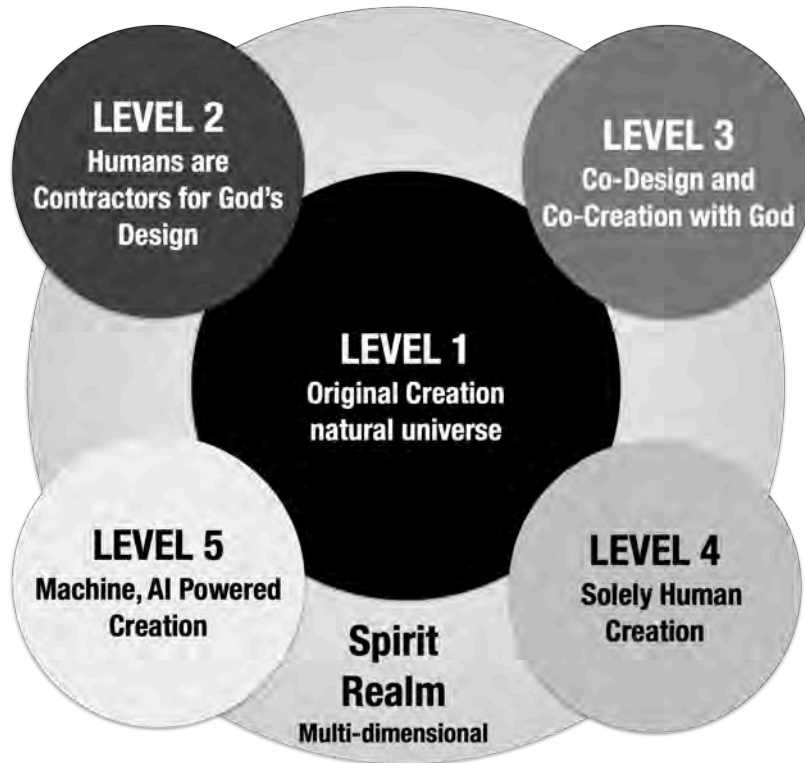


Fig. 1 Levels of Creation Model

Levels of Creation

Level 1: The creation of everything in the known universe by God

Level 2: Humans are involved in creation in accordance to precise plans given by God

Level 3: Intentional co-design and co-creation between God and humans

Level 4: Human creation with no intentional co-design

Level 5: Machine, AI powered creation

Levels of Creation

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Level 1: God as Creator

The first level of creation dives into the birth of the natural universe. From the dawn of intellectual curiosity, philosophers, theologians, and cosmologists have grappled with theories concerning the inception of the universe.

In Biblical teaching, the genesis of the universe is anchored in an eternal Creator - a divine being with neither a beginning nor an end, responsible for fashioning everything in existence.

*"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."
– Genesis 1:1*

"For his invisible attributes, namely, his eternal power and divine nature, have been clearly perceived, ever since the creation of the world, in the things that have been made. So they are without excuse."– Romans 1:20

The view of God as the creator suggests His capacity to shape our physical universe from the multi-dimensional expanse of His own existence, that is, the spiritual realm. Essentially, the natural world is encapsulated within or forms part of the spiritual world. This provides insight into how Jesus could break the constraints of the physical world to perform miracles, such as healing the sick or raising the dead. The laws that govern our physical universe yield to the superior laws of the spiritual domain.

Level 2: God as Designer

The second tier of creation expands upon the first, positing the existence of the universe, our world with its bountiful natural resources, all forms of life, and human beings. This level engages human agency, with God crafting what He desires using His own creations. God assumes the role of a designer or architect, while we humans function as His builders, contractors, or scribes. The builder erects exactly what the architect or designer has prescribed, and the scribe records precisely what they are directed to document. An intriguing feature of this level of creation is the Creator's use of His own creation to actualize His desires. The Bible contains numerous instances of this.

God furnished Moses with exhaustive instructions for the construction of the tabernacle in the wilderness. Each aspect of the blueprint, from the overall dimensions of the complex to the most minute detail of the fabric to be employed, was conveyed by God to the artisans that built the tabernacle.

Level 3: Co-Design/Creation

The third tier of creation employs a paradigm of collaborative design and creation. God imparts a grand idea or blueprint, which necessitates considerable design and engineering efforts for its realization. Those involved in this process assume roles of 'engineers' and 'designers', partaking in a journey of co-design with God. This progression can be conceptualized as unfolding revelation, wherein the Creator slowly and steadily infuses ideas and thoughts into the human co-designers over time.

Unfolding revelation mirrors the organic progression of design, where the human designer persistently grapples with design challenges and hones creative solutions, all while soliciting guidance from God. This process reflects a surge of creativity that's stimulated by God's input and reflections. Those who have mastered the practice of walking in the Spirit daily have also cultivated the ability to perceive God's voice.

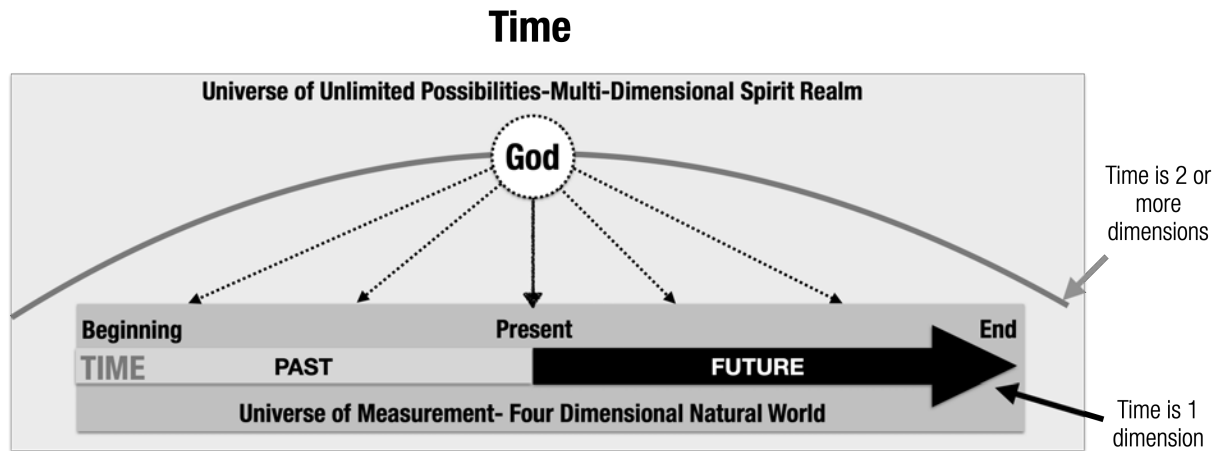
Level 4: Human Creation

The fourth layer of creation, primarily originates from human initiative without a purposeful incorporation of God from the human viewpoint. This suggests that the human creator is not actively soliciting God's involvement in their design and creation processes. It remains unclear whether God and the Holy Spirit infuse creative thoughts into human spirits and minds, regardless of whether they are believers or not. I'm not casting doubt on an individual's inherent creative potential, as we are all sculpted in God's likeness and hence possess the ability to demonstrate creative traits. Instead, I'm emphasizing a level of creation that doesn't consciously or actively engage God.

Level 5: Machine Creation

The fifth tier of creation reflects an unprecedented development where the creations of humanity have themselves begun to exhibit creative capabilities. With the rise of 'smart' machinery powered by Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology, these machines are capable of not just learning, diagnosing, and detecting concealed patterns in voluminous data sets, but also creating. AI offers myriad solutions that can streamline and enrich various facets of businesses and, by extension, our lives. Self-driving vehicles employ AI to safely navigate roads. AI is poised to optimize manufacturing and numerous other industries.

Co-Design and Co-Creation with God



"For by him all things were created, in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities—all things were created through him and for him."—Colossians 1:16

"I am the Alpha and the Omega," says the Lord God, "who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty."—Revelation 1:8

"So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen, since what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal."—2 Corinthians 4:18

God's Will is Knowable

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is—his good, pleasing and perfect will."—Romans 12:2

Bringing Heaven's Will to Earth

"Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven." —Matthew 6:9-10

Level 3: Co-Design and Co-Creation with God



Co-Design and Co-Creation with God

The third level of creation employs a co-design and co-creation framework. God communicates a grand idea or concept, which requires substantial design and engineering before its manifestation. People involved in this process take on 'engineer' and 'designer' roles, engaging with God in a co-design capacity. This process could be perceived as progressive revelation, where the Creator gradually imparts ideas and thoughts to the human co-designers over time.

Progressive revelation mimics the natural flow of design, where the human designer consistently wrestles with the design challenges and refines creative solutions, while seeking God's guidance. This process mirrors an outpouring of creativity that's instigated by God's input and thoughts. Those who have learned to walk in the Spirit daily have also learned to hear God's voice.

However, often, our experience entails a fusion of the Holy Spirit's thoughts with our own, making it difficult to distinguish between the two. I frequently pray before a meeting for God to share His thoughts, and by faith, I know He does. The Bible encourages us to ask for wisdom, with the expectation that it will be granted.

If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to you. —James 1:5

We encounter two main challenges in this process. First, there's usually no distinct sign or signal indicating when God shares His thoughts with us. Secondly, His thoughts are interpreted through the filter of our own mind, often making it hard to distinguish between His thoughts and our own. This is why the renewal of our minds is so crucial. Instead of interpreting God's thoughts through worldly patterns, they need to be perceived through a renewed mind (Romans 12:2).

A notable instance of co-design and co-creation can be found early in Genesis, when God instructs Noah to construct an ark:

So make yourself an ark of cypress wood; make rooms in it and coat it with pitch inside and out. 15 This is how you are to build it: The ark is to be three hundred cubits long, fifty cubits wide and thirty cubits high. 16 Make a roof for it, leaving below the roof an opening one cubit high all around. Put a door in the side of the ark and make lower, middle and upper decks. —Genesis 6: 14-16

God provided Noah with broad guidelines for the building project, but it took Noah 120 years to complete it. Some Biblical scholars estimate the construction period may have been closer to 75 years. Regardless of the exact duration, the key point is that Noah was handed a conceptual idea of

a "massive boat," and he had to perform substantial design and engineering work on his own to successfully construct the ark. One can speculate that throughout the 75-120 years of construction, Noah invented new tools and methodologies that were previously nonexistent. This is not to suggest that Noah was solely reliant on progressive revelation for direction; he was likely deeply involved in co-designing with God.

The third level of creation is the primary modality used in the Imaginal Transformation Centre and the Imaginal approach to transforming nations and manifesting heaven on earth. We will delve deeper into this methodology in subsequent chapters.

Bringing Heaven's will to Earth

When we embark on the journey of Imaginal Thinking, we aim to discern the future from the perspective of God's will - a divine plan for our world in any given temporal context. But it's crucial to remember that God's perception of time does not conform to our human understanding. Unlike our linear view, God's relationship with time is all-encompassing; He perceives the beginning and the end simultaneously. **Thus, what appears as the future to us is in actuality God's present.**

In this context, our task of unveiling God's will for the future and grounding it in our present reality aligns with Jesus's prayer in the Lord's Prayer, "*Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.*" We are essentially striving to align our earthly timeline with God's eternal timeline, to ensure that our actions and decisions mirror the divine will.

As we venture further into the future, we are merely uncovering what is already known and present to God. This aspect of Imaginal Thinking presents an intriguing spiritual paradox; we are navigating towards the 'future' while simultaneously journeying into God's 'present'. The closer we get to actualizing God's will on Earth, the closer we get to realizing heaven on Earth, thus fulfilling Jesus' profound prayer.

Our engagement with Imaginal Thinking, therefore, is not only about innovation and foresight. It's a spiritual exercise in aligning our actions, thoughts, and innovations with the divine will, guided by the enduring prayer Jesus taught us. As we envision and create the future, we remain committed to ensuring that our innovations and developments reflect God's heavenly design, contributing to the unfolding of His kingdom here on Earth.

God's Planned Obsolescence

	OLD	NEW
Atonement	Animal Sacrifice Annual Day of Atonement (Yom Kippur-Lev. 16)	Christ's Death Once for all (Heb. 10:10)
The Law	Stone Tablets Moses - 10 Commandments	Hearts not on tablets of stone but on tablets of human hearts. (2 Cor. 3:3)
Temple	Physical Building Tabernacle and the Temple in Jerusalem	Believers Temple of the HS, Living stones
Covenantal Symbols	Circumcision God and Abraham (Gen. 17:10-11)	Baptism Identification with Christ (Rom. 6:3-4)
Food	Manna During the exodus	Bread of Life Jesus is the bread of life
Kingdom	Literal Kingdom (Israel)	Spiritual Kingdom My Kingdom is not of this world (John 18:36)
Identity	Old Self Who we were in Adam	New Creation Who we are in Christ

Fulfillment of God's Perfect Law

Jesus, during His ministry, clarified that His purpose was not to abolish the Law, but to fulfill it. As He proclaimed in Matthew 5:17-18, "Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have not come to abolish them but to fulfill them. For truly, I say to you, until heaven and earth pass away, not an iota, not a dot, will pass from the Law until all is accomplished." While many rituals and ceremonies of the Old Covenant became obsolete in light of the New Covenant, God's perfect law remained. Through Christ, believers are imparted with His righteousness, fully satisfying the Law's requirements. This divine exchange ensures that, as Romans 8:1 affirms, "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

Examples of Planned Obsolescence

Planned obsolescence is a controversial strategy, and many examples are often based on consumer perception and accusations rather than transparent admissions by companies. That said, several instances and allegations suggest the use of planned obsolescence by businesses:

Apple: Apple faced accusations of planned obsolescence when it acknowledged slowing down older iPhones with aging batteries. The company claimed it was to prevent unexpected shutdowns due to battery health degradation. However, many viewed it as a tactic to push users towards upgrading to newer iPhone models. Apple later provided options for battery replacements at reduced prices and added battery health monitoring features to address the controversy.

Printer Manufacturers: Many inkjet printer manufacturers, like Epson and HP, have been criticized for creating printers that show "out of ink" warnings and stop functioning even when there is still usable ink left in cartridges. Some printers also refuse to print if even one ink cartridge is depleted, regardless of the content's color.

Fast Fashion Brands: Companies like H&M, Zara, and Forever 21, representing the fast fashion industry, introduce new styles at rapid intervals, leading to style obsolescence. The quick turnaround of designs can make clothing items seem "out of style" shortly after they're purchased. Additionally, the quality of fast fashion items is often lower, leading to a shorter lifespan and quicker wear-and-tear.

Consumer Electronics: Many modern electronics, from smartphones to laptops, are designed in ways that make repairs challenging. Brands like Samsung, Apple, and others have devices with non-removable batteries, proprietary screws, or designs that make independent repairs difficult. This can lead to consumers choosing to buy new devices rather than repairing existing ones.

God's Planned Obsolescence

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Planned Obsolescence

Planned obsolescence refers to the intentional design or strategy of manufacturers to limit a product's useful life or functionality, compelling consumers to replace or upgrade products more frequently. This can manifest in the form of limited durability, style changes, or unavailability of replacement parts. In contrast, obsolescence created by outside forces or competition is not a deliberate act by the product's manufacturer. Instead, it results from external factors such as technological advancements, innovations by competitors, or changing consumer preferences. In this case, a product becomes outdated or less desirable because newer, better options or standards have emerged in the market.

Planning your own obsolescence, often referred to as "self-disruption," can be preferable to having it thrust upon you by the marketplace for several reasons:

Control over Transition: By planning your own obsolescence, you maintain control over the transition process. This allows a company to set its own pace, allocate resources efficiently, and strategically introduce new products or services.

Financial Stability: Self-disruption can help a company capture new revenue streams, ensuring continued profitability. In contrast, waiting for market forces to make a product obsolete can lead to sudden revenue drops and financial instability.

Brand Image and Loyalty: A company that consistently innovates and updates its products is perceived as forward-thinking and customer-centric. Customers are more likely to stay loyal to brands that prioritize their evolving needs.

Staying Competitive: Self-disruption allows companies to remain at the forefront of industry developments. By continuously evolving and adapting, they can fend off competitors and maintain their market leadership.

Leveraging Existing Resources: When a company plans its own obsolescence, it can utilize its existing infrastructure, talent, and customer base to support new ventures, giving it a significant advantage over new entrants in the market.

Risk Management: Predicting and preparing for change allows companies to manage potential risks proactively. This contrasts with reactive approaches, where companies are often caught off guard, leading to rushed decisions and greater uncertainty.

Long-term Vision: Companies that plan their own obsolescence are often driven by a long-term vision. They're not just focused on quarterly results but are investing in sustainable growth and future market dominance.

God's Planned Obsolescence

God's planned obsolescence is clearly evident when we compare the Old Covenant with the New Covenant, here are some examples:

Sacrificial System to Jesus' Sacrifice: In the Old Testament, the sacrificial system was the primary means by which sins were atoned for. Animals were regularly sacrificed as a symbolic act of repentance. However, this system was replaced by a more profound, once-for-all sacrifice when Jesus Christ died on the cross. His sacrifice rendered the old system obsolete, ushering in a new covenant where direct reconciliation with God was made possible through Jesus.

Stone Tablets to Hearts of Flesh: The Ten Commandments were initially written on stone tablets, symbolizing the rigidity of the law. However, in the New Covenant, God promised to write His law on the hearts of His people (Jeremiah 31:33). This represents a shift from external regulations to an internal transformation—a more innovative way to foster genuine relationship and obedience.

Physical Temples to Living Temples: Solomon's temple in Jerusalem was the epicenter of Jewish worship. It was where God's presence resided. However, after Jesus' resurrection, believers in Christ are now referred to as the "temple of the Holy Spirit" (1 Corinthians 6:19). The physical building became obsolete as the divine presence came to reside within individuals.

Circumcision to Baptism: In the Old Testament, circumcision was a sign of God's covenant with His people. However, in the New Testament, especially after Jesus' resurrection, baptism became the symbolic act of entering into a relationship with God. The physical act of circumcision was no longer a requisite, having been replaced by the spiritual act of baptism and inner transformation.

Manna to the Bread of Life: During their wilderness wanderings, God provided the Israelites with manna—a physical bread from heaven. This was replaced in the New Testament when Jesus referred to Himself as the "bread of life" (John 6:35). No longer was sustenance merely physical; Jesus offered spiritual nourishment that leads to eternal life.

Literal Kingdom to Spiritual Kingdom: The Israelites often envisioned a physical kingdom where they would be free from oppression. While there were periods of physical freedom and monarchy, Jesus introduced the concept of a spiritual kingdom—the Kingdom of God. This kingdom wasn't about territorial dominance but about God's rule and reign in the hearts of people.

Old Self to New Creation: The apostle Paul in the New Testament expounds on the profound transformation that takes place in an individual when they accept Christ. "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come" (2 Corinthians 5:17). This transformation isn't just metaphorical. It signifies the obsolescence of our old nature—our predispositions, our sin-driven inclinations—and the birth of a new nature aligned with God's spirit. The person we once were becomes obsolete as we're spiritually renewed. Just as the caterpillar undergoes metamorphosis to become a butterfly, so does the believer undergo a spiritual rebirth, shedding the constraints of the old self and emerging as a new being in Christ.

Open Principle

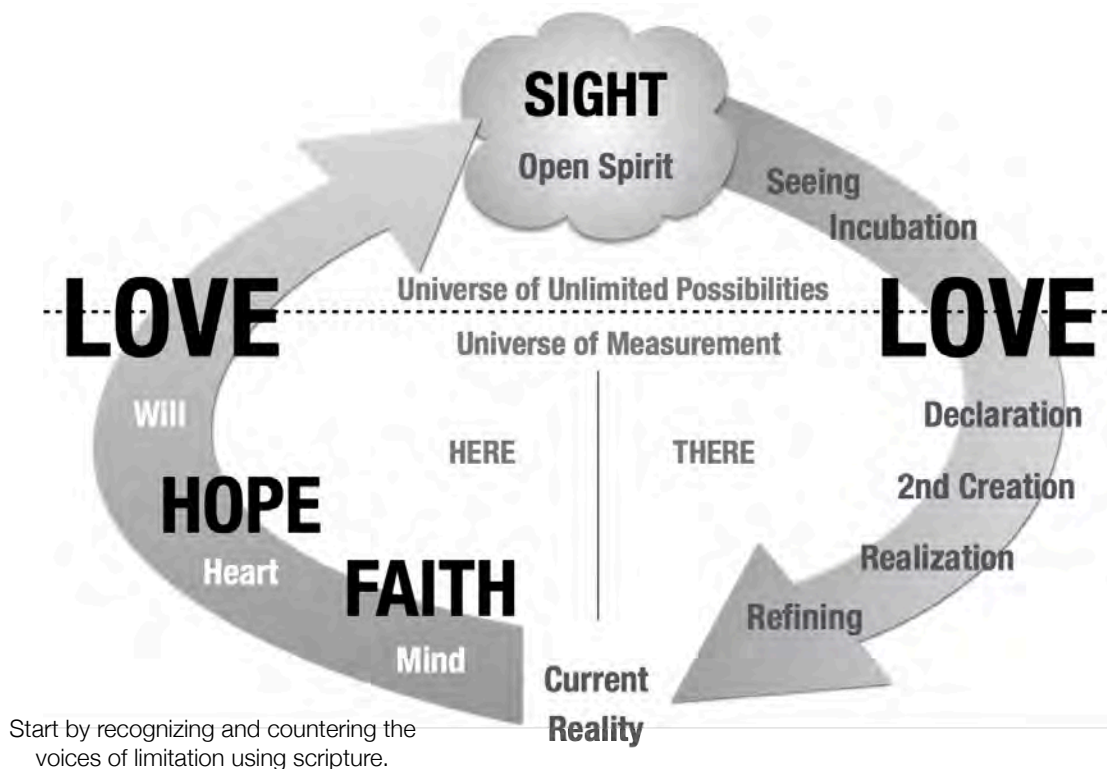


Fig. 1 Open Principle

Examples of Open Principle in Use

Entrepreneurship

Traditional Barrier: Entrepreneurs often stick to existing market segments or proven business models, fearing risk.

Open Principle in Action: A budding entrepreneur envisions a completely new market space or a business model that hasn't been explored, overriding the voice of limitation and paving the way for an industry-shifting idea.

Technological Innovations

Traditional Barrier: Engineers and developers sticking to established tech stacks—front and back end software tools and framework, and known methodologies.

Open Principle in Action: A team imagines a solution employing an existing technology in an unconventional manner. Their innovation changes the trajectory of tech applications.

Educational Reforms

Traditional Barrier: An adherence to age-old educational models and resistance to change.

Open Principle in Action: An educator, refusing to bow to the voice of fear, imagines an educational model where students drive their learning journey. This vision, when implemented, revolutionizes classroom dynamics.

Personal Growth

Traditional Barrier: Individuals get tied down by their past, seeing only linear paths for growth.

Open Principle in Action: Someone envisions a radical shift in their career or personal journey. Despite voices of doubt, they venture into unfamiliar territories, discovering new passions and potentials.

In all these scenarios, the Open Principle, rooted in the power of unfettered imagination, allows for a breach from the confines of conventional thinking. The individuals dare to dream beyond limitations, cynicism, and fear, tapping into the Universe of Unlimited Possibilities.

Open Principle



The Open Principle isn't merely a model. It's a transformative journey, a bridge between the power of our imagination and the remarkable realities we can create. This guiding beacon is developed with the intent to not just spark but to sustain extended periods of envisioning what could be. What you're about to explore is a synthesis from *Becoming Imaginal, Seeing and Creating the Future of Education*, focusing on three dominant voices that can inhibit our imaginings and the strategies to rise above them.

Voice of Limitation: Rising Above with Faith

Every mindset, no matter how evolved, has its boundaries. They are deep-seated patterns carved over time, occasionally entrapping us in 'paradigm paralysis', a confinement where our present thinking is all we believe exists. But remember, these mental constructs are our own creations and, therefore, malleable. The antidote? Faith. An ingredient so potent, it defies these self-set confines, urging you to entertain the possibility that perhaps, there's more than meets the mind's eye. This transcendence, driven by faith, is our escape from the chains screaming impossibilities at us.

Matthew 17:20 echoes this sentiment, "... if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, 'Move from here to there' and it will move. Nothing will be impossible for you."

Voice of Cynicism: Moving Forward with Trust and Hope

Doubt is a natural human response, often manifesting when our internal belief systems grapple with the unfamiliar. This cognitive dissonance, though unsettling, is natural. But cynicism? That's a different battle. It's an emotional judgement, a scar from past events that shadows our present, urging us into a defensive, negative spiral. It's soul-consuming. The way out? Choosing trust, letting hope paint the canvas of tomorrow.

Romans 15:13 encapsulates this sentiment, "May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you trust in him, so that you may overflow with hope."

Voice of Fear: Confronting with the Power of Love

Fear, an emotion so commanding, often stalls us in our tracks. But even in its overpowering presence, there exists a force that can mute its cry - LOVE. This emotion, in its true essence, drives creation, propels parents, artists, visionary Imaginal leaders, and every soul with a burning passion. It's the emotion that fuels unparalleled feats. The antidote to fear is the love for your grand purpose, your 'Big WHY'.

1 John 4:18 beautifully encapsulates this, "There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear."

Navigating with the Open Principle

It's fascinating, isn't it? How sometimes we find ourselves running on autopilot, confined by patterns and rules set ages

ago? These structures, or what some folks call institutional lock-in, are like the hand-me-down roadmaps we get from past generations. They dictate the terms, defining what's possible and what's not. And because they've been around for so long, we rarely question them. We're caught in a dance choreographed by decisions made long before our time.

But, let me share a little secret with you - a perspective shift I had during my explorations. Imagine you're out hiking. You're on a well-trodden path, safe and predictable. Now, what if, just for a moment, you stray off that path, driven by the beckoning of a strange bird, or the rustling of leaves hinting at a hidden waterfall? That's the essence of the Open Principle. It doesn't negate the value of the old path; it merely highlights the possibility of creating new ones.

Especially in the realm of education, the old ways seem unyielding. It's like a grand old oak tree, its roots deep, its branches wide - majestic, yet overshadowing new growth underneath. But with the Open Principle, we're equipped with tools - not to chop the tree down, but to harness its strength, to climb its branches, to get a new vantage point. To see where we might plant new seeds, where fresh meadows might flourish.

What we must truly grasp is this: Our history, our past, is a treasure trove. It lends us wisdom, experience, and cautionary tales. It whispers stories of where we've been, offering guidance. Yet, it shouldn't become a chain that binds us. We ought to dance with our past, not be led by it. And that's where the Open Principle shines its light, illuminating spaces and possibilities we'd overlooked.

Consider this passage, which I've always found deeply resonant:

"We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ." -2 Corinthians 10:5

This, in many ways, encapsulates our journey. It's about challenging preset notions, breaking free from mental molds, and aligning our thoughts with a higher vision. A vision that sees potential, growth, and transformation.

Another one that often stirs my soul is this:

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is—his good, pleasing and perfect will." -Romans 12:2

Isn't it a clarion call for us all? To renew, to reimagine, to redefine our paths using the Open Principle. Let's journey together, crafting new trails, reshaping the landscape, and making tomorrow's maps richer, broader, and ever-evolving.

Vision Formation

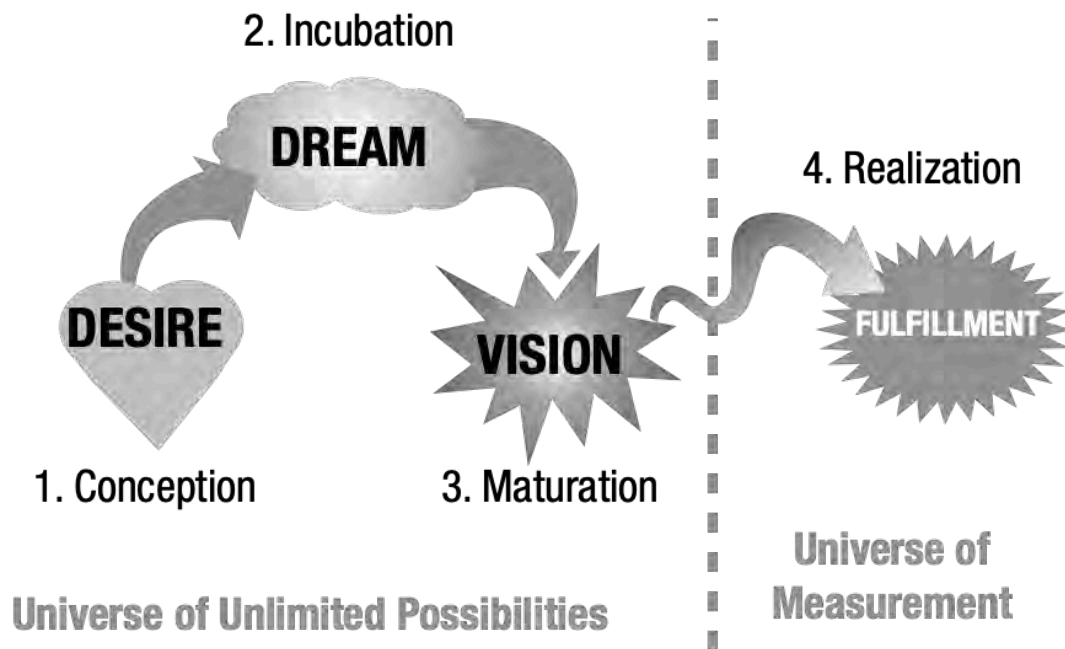


Fig. 1 Vision Formation Stages

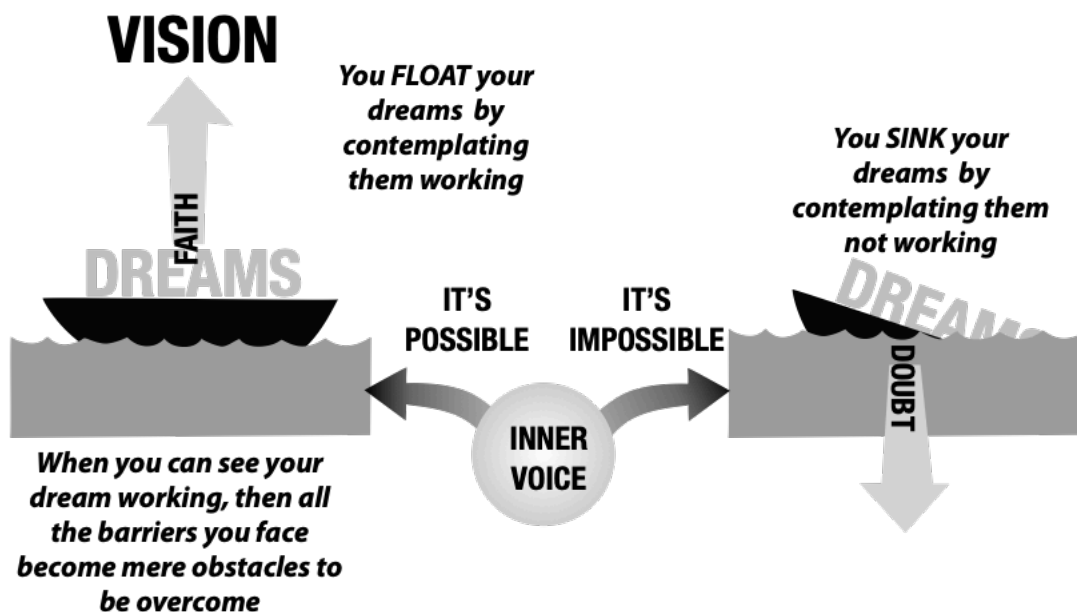


Fig. 2 Floating your Dreams

Vision Formation



Introduction:

Every revolutionary idea or project begins not as a detailed blueprint but as a glimmer, an intuition, or a deep-seated yearning. This process, the journey from a mere inkling to full fruition, can be understood in four distinct stages. Reflecting on my personal journey with education transformation, I will unfold each of these stages for you.

Vision Formation Stages

1. Conception or BURNING DESIRE stage:

At the heart of every transformation is a need, a burning desire for change or innovation. For me, this spark was ignited when I felt a growing dissonance with the traditional way education was being imparted. Yet, in the throes of this desire, the endgame wasn't clear. What was clear, though, was that change was imperative. It's like seeing the first few brush strokes on a blank canvas - the bigger picture is still a mystery.

2. Incubation or Dream stage:

With this burning desire kindled, dreams begin to take form. It's a broad, utopian vision of the future, shaped in the playground of our imagination. Here, in the realm of unlimited possibilities, dreams inspire not just the dreamer but everyone they touch. But remember, being ensnared by this dream and not acting upon it simply renders one a dreamer. Aspiring for a change is essential, but aspirations without actions remain just that - aspirations.

3. Maturation or Vision Stage:

For dreams to materialize, they need to transform into visions—more tangible, anchored in reality, and bound by time and space. My dream of reshaping education matured into launching the Master's Academy and College in 1997. This wasn't a vague idea anymore; it was a solid vision, characterized by a commitment to Profound Learning. Profound Learning wasn't just a fancy term; it represented a break away from the old, bringing forth a model marked by innovation, creativity, and individual-centric learning. This concrete vision began to magnetize others towards it, laying the foundation for a shared dream or a vision community.

4. Realization or Fulfillment stage:

The most gratifying phase is witnessing the realization of this vision. It's no longer about dreaming or planning; it's about execution and manifestation. This doesn't happen by chance; it's a deliberate journey from envisioning to achieving. Our vision at Master's Academy and College stands testament to this, as it emerged as a beacon of excellence in education, not just in Canada but internationally. The establishment of Imaginal Education, aimed at global outreach, further amplifies the potential of a vision realized.

In essence, every great achievement starts with a whisper in the heart, amplifies into dreams, solidifies into a vision, and finally blossoms into reality. The journey from the "what if" to the "we did it" is what makes the tapestry of Vision Formation so exhilarating and rewarding

Incubating Dreams in a World of Doubt

Alright, let's dive into this. Every early dream feels a bit like walking a tightrope. It's fragile, often swaying under the slightest gust of doubt. The world never runs out of skeptics, and some might cloak their skepticism as 'realistic feedback' or 'grounded perspective'. But sometimes, the most challenging voices to tune out are our own—those that replay past disappointments, urging us to tread lightly. It's like past setbacks have these invisible strings attached, pulling us back just when we're about to take flight. The trick? Always visualize your dreams as working. If you can picture it thriving, it soars. If doubt creeps in, it plummets. The choice is yours.

Let Your Dreams Take Flight

Now, imagine the transformation if we shifted our perspective! The key to translating dreams into reality lies in fully immersing in their potential. It's about seeing their success not as a distant possibility but through a lens of steadfast faith. When armed with this belief, what once seemed like insurmountable challenges turn into mere stepping stones on your journey. It's vital, during this odyssey, to tune into the voices that cheer you on and filter out the naysayers. Remember, a dream can only morph into a vision if you can visualize its success. Letting self-doubt creep in ensures it remains intangible and elusive.

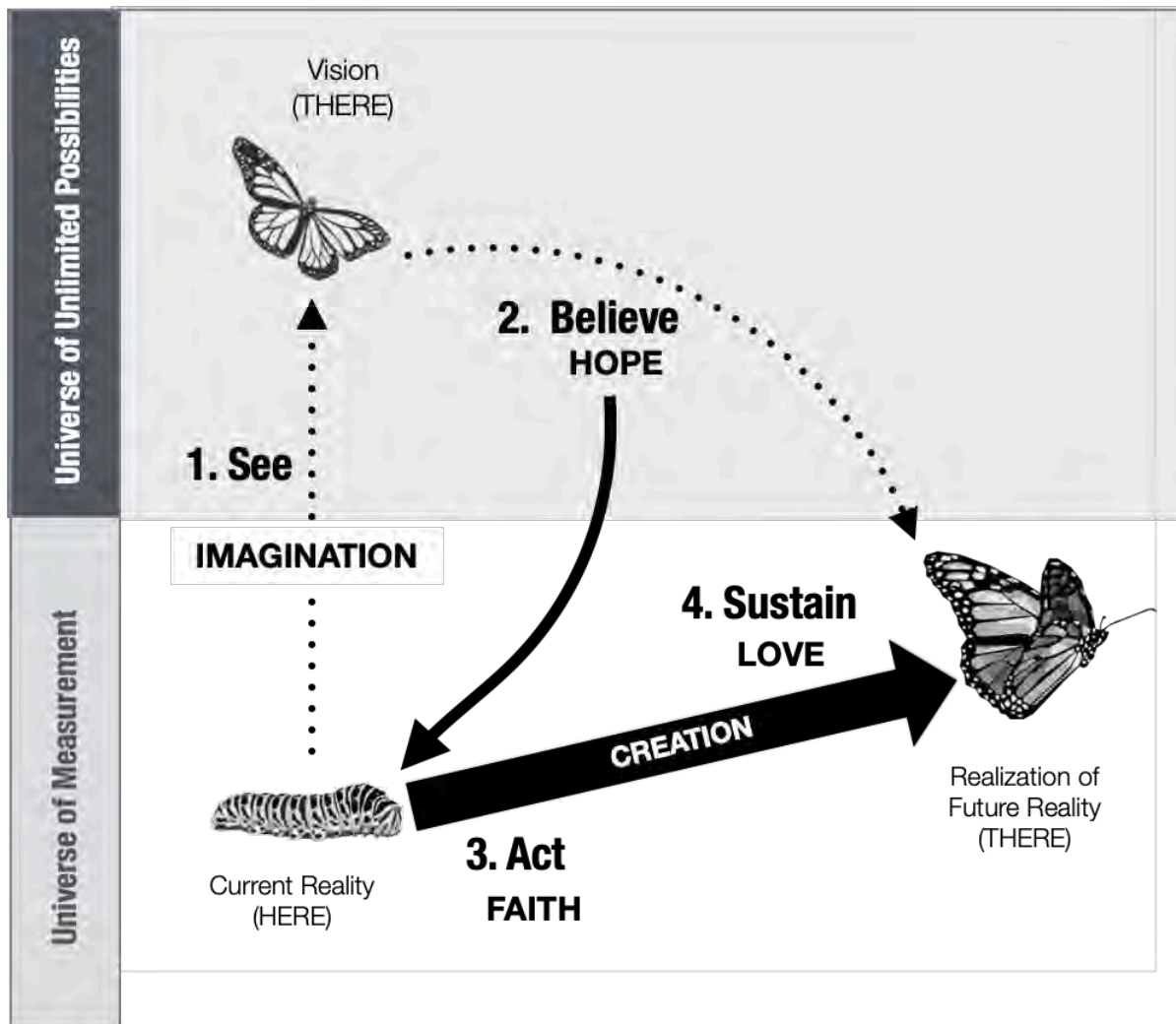
Drawing Inspiration from Legends

Think of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Here was a man whose dream wasn't just personal; it echoed the collective aspirations of countless souls. He envisioned an America that judged individuals by their character and not skin color. His dream touched hearts, inspiring many to join this noble cause. Together, they achieved what once seemed a fantasy: an America with its first African-American president, Barak Obama.

Unleashing the Imaginal Within

Every single one of us has that spark – that Imaginal visionary spirit, just waiting to break free. It's not about merely being extraordinary; it's about pioneering a legacy so impactful that it reshapes the world. It whispers, challenging us: "Dare to astonish. Build something so immense, it becomes immortal." The question is, will you heed its call?

Imaginal Spiritual Elements



IMAGINATION + HOPE = FAITH

Fig. 1 Spiritual Dimensions of Imaginal

"Now faith is confidence in what we **hope** for and assurance about what we do not see (**imagination**).” - Hebrews 11:1

Imaginal Spiritual Elements

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Key Imaginal Spiritual Elements

1. See: Childlike Vision and the Realm of Future Possibilities

"Truly I tell you, unless you change and become like little children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven." - Matthew 18:3

At the foundation of Imaginal leadership lies the essence of the ability to envision the 'butterfly' metamorphosis desired for the future. This vision requires us to transcend the limitations of our adult minds, often burdened by the weight of reality, and revert to the uninhibited imagination of a child. Just as Jesus highlighted the significance of childlike innocence in perceiving God's Kingdom, the true essence of this teaching might very well underscore a child's boundless imagination. It's this capacity to visualize beyond the immediate, beyond the confines of what's deemed 'possible', that sets the stage for the future's creation.

2. Believe: When Hope Affirms the Vision

"For in this hope we were saved. But hope that is seen is no hope at all. Who hopes for what they already have?" - Romans 8:24

After igniting the imaginal spark, hope steps in, serving as the divine affirmation whispering, "Yes, it can be done." Hope breathes life into the ephemeral images painted by our imagination, transforming them into conceivable realities.

3. Act: Faith, the Catalyst for Creation

"Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see." - Hebrews 11:1

It's one thing to imagine and another to believe, but true creation demands action. This is where faith, defined beautifully in Hebrews, becomes pivotal. When hope confirms the possibilities that imagination sketches, a surge of faith ensues, pushing one towards realizing that vision.

Consider Jesus's challenge to His disciples to feed the 5,000. Entrapped by the tangible limitations, they couldn't envision a solution. Yet, a young boy with a mere five loaves and two fishes steps forward. What did this child perceive that eluded the disciples? Could it be that his childlike imagination saw possibilities beyond the evident? It reminds us that sometimes, it takes the unbridled imagination of a child to break through the barriers that adults often face.

4. Sustain: Unwavering Dedication Rooted in Love

"And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love." - 1 Corinthians 13:13

The journey from vision to realization isn't always smooth. While imagination sketches the dream and hope and faith catalyze action, it's love that ensures sustainability. A true creator's journey is driven by an unwavering love for their creation, reinforcing their commitment to the creation of their vision of the future.

Let's break this down a bit. All creation – everything around us – is fueled and sustained by a creator's deep, profound love for their handiwork. Take parents, for instance. Their unwavering love for their kids helps them push past the messiness, the tantrums, and the sleepless nights. It's not about ignoring the hardships; it's about seeing a bigger picture. They're driven by a vision – a dream of their children's bright futures. They don't just wish for it; they see it, believe it, and rise above any present challenges for it.

Now, think bigger. Consider the ultimate Creator. God's love for humanity is so boundless that He made the ultimate sacrifice for us. It's that same unyielding, unimaginable love that empowers and inspires. It's a love that sees beyond the now, believes in the promise of tomorrow, and is willing to do whatever it takes to turn that vision into a reality.

In summation, true leadership, inspired by the Holy Spirit, emerges from the dance between imagination, hope, and faith. While the world might often challenge our visions, embracing our inner child's imaginative prowess, fortified by hope and faith, can pave the way to remarkable creations.

Creation Orientation



Creation Orientation Evaluation

Reactive/Response Leader	Where are you on this continuum?	Imaginal Leader
Reacting and responding to circumstances as the primary orientation	Reactive Imaginal 100% 50% 100%	Circumstances do not limit or control what can be created
Limited possibilities, trapped by circumstances	100% 50% 100%	Creator of the future, sees unlimited possibilities
Happiness is the avoidance of negative circumstances	100% 50% 100%	Happiness is in creating the future regardless of the circumstances
Living in the Universe of Measurement	100% 50% 100%	Living in the Universe of Unlimited Possibilities and Measurement
Despair for the future, because of powerlessness	100% 50% 100%	Hope for the future, because it can be created
Motivated by trying to think positively	100% 50% 100%	Motivated by one's calling and strong desire for the vision to exist
Motivated by obligation of doing the right thing	100% 50% 100%	Motivated by love not obligation
Uses emotions as a gauge whether you are in the "right" circumstance	100% 50% 100%	Engages in the creation process regardless of emotions, feeling good is not a prerequisite for action
Victim of circumstances	100% 50% 100%	Living above your circumstances
Identity is defined by external circumstances	100% 50% 100%	The creator separates their identity from their creation

Place an 'X' on the continuum between being Reactive and Imaginal Leader that represents generally your orientation.

Creation Orientation



Understanding Reactive/Responsive Behavior

At its core, the reactive/responsive orientation reminds us of the children of Israel, who, even after witnessing God's power through signs and wonders in Egypt, constantly grumbled and adjusted their faith based on their circumstances (Exodus 16:2-3). This mindset prompts us to mold our actions based on what's immediately visible or expected, much like Peter walking on water but sinking when he saw the winds and became afraid (Matthew 14:29-31).

Rebellion and Cynicism: Much like Jonah who ran from God's command, going against the grain can sometimes signify more than just a challenge to the status quo; it can evolve into deep-seated cynicism (Jonah 1:3).

The Subtle Conformist: While some react overtly, others suppress their natural inclinations to fit in, morphing into responsive conformists. This adaptive behavior may seem harmonious, but it often masks underlying discontent. Think of Aaron, who under pressure from the people, made a golden calf, conforming to their desires even though he knew God's commandments (Exodus 32:2-4).

Powerlessness and Blame:

The peril of the reactive/responsive mindset is the illusion of powerlessness. It paints a picture where external circumstances dominate, and you're merely a player responding to them. This can spiral into a victim mentality, offloading responsibility and blaming the world for personal situations. The danger? A life that drifts without intention, waiting for external forces to dictate the next move. The frequent oscillation between reactive and responsive behaviors only accentuates this sense of being adrift.

Imaginal Leader Orientation

Imaginal leaders are future-focused visionaries. They're not just dreamers; they're doers, actively striving to make their visions a reality. However, this often puts them at odds with those who don't share their fervor. Their defining trait? Unyielding courage. Even in the face of skepticism or apathy, they're uncompromising in their mission.

Imaginal leaders resonate with the spirit of Joshua and Caleb, who, despite the majority report, saw the Promised Land not as an insurmountable challenge, but as a promise waiting to be claimed (Numbers 14:6-9). They're visionaries, much like Joseph, who foresaw a future and actively worked towards it, even amidst adversities (Genesis 37:5-11).

Identity vs. Creation:

As they forge ahead, it's paramount for Imaginal leaders to differentiate their self-worth from their creations. While it's easy to equate personal value with success or failure, this can be a precarious path. Solomon, in all his wisdom, knew the perils of intertwining one's worth with worldly achievements, as reflected in Ecclesiastes when he calls such pursuits "vanity" (Ecclesiastes 1:14).

When identity intertwines with creation, every flaw or criticism becomes a direct hit to one's self-worth. Fear of rejection, or even the mere possibility of failure, can stifle innovation and courage. For example, David, a man after God's own heart, understood the weight of personal failures, but he also knew to seek repentance and not to equate his mistakes with his identity in God (Psalms 51:1-12).

Benefits of Separation:

Freedom to Err: Accepting that mistakes are a part of the journey, not a reflection of your worth, fosters resilience and growth. Proverbs 24:16 tells us, "For a righteous man may fall seven times and rise again."

Persistence in Design: Knowing that oppositions and setbacks in a project doesn't equate to personal failure ensures sustained commitment to the end goal. Like Nehemiah, who was determined to rebuild Jerusalem's walls despite opposition, separating our failures from our identity ensures continued dedication (Nehemiah 6:3).

Emotionally Liberated Action: Freed from the need for constant validation, you can act without the shackles of emotional volatility. It's not about feeling good; it's about being driven by a deep-seated passion for your vision. Paul, in his letters, often emphasizes acting out of love and purpose, rather than seeking the fleeting validation of men (Galatians 1:10). It's about being deeply rooted in God-given purpose.

Innovation Adoption Curve

Innovation Adoption Curve and Imaginal Organization

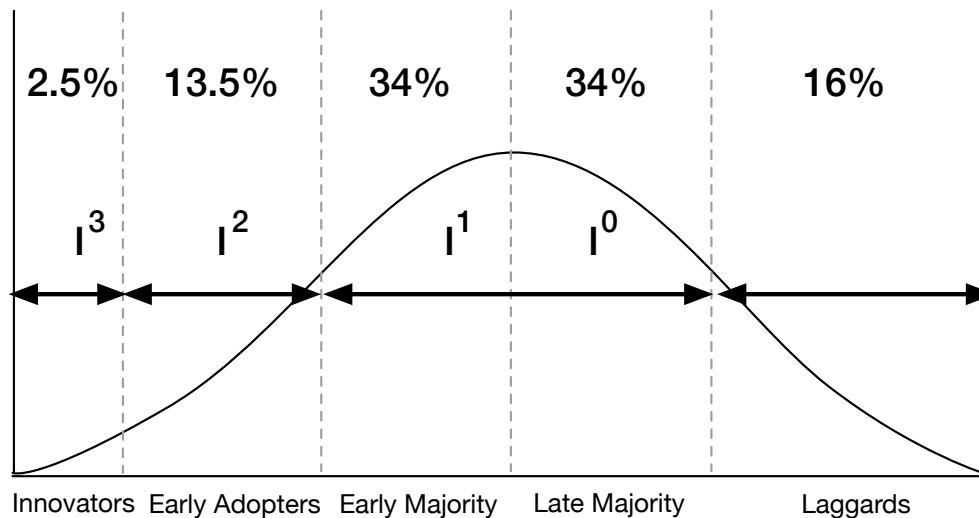


Fig. 1 Adoption Curve

Innovation Adoption Curve Applications In Imaginal Workshops

Innovation Prioritization: In an Imaginal workshop, participants are typically challenged to generate a host of innovative ideas. The Innovation Adoption Curve can help prioritize these ideas based on their potential to be adopted by the target market. Innovations that are expected to be adopted quickly by innovators and early adopters might be prioritized.

Developing Marketing and Adoption Strategies: The Innovation Adoption Curve can assist participants in creating effective strategies to market their innovations. For instance, early stages of the curve would suggest focusing on the unique advantages and cutting-edge features of the innovation to appeal to innovators and early adopters. In later stages, emphasizing the reliability, efficiency, and wide acceptance of the innovation can attract the early

Predicting and Managing Resistance to Change: Understanding the Innovation Adoption Curve can prepare participants for potential resistance or challenges that might arise when

implementing new ideas. Recognizing that some segments of their target market (late majority, laggards) are naturally more resistant to change allows them to devise strategies to address these concerns proactively.

Understanding Market Segmentation: By understanding where their target users lie on the Adoption Curve, participants in the Imaginal workshop can customize their innovation to better suit these user groups. This understanding allows the participants to better meet the needs of their intended users, improving the likelihood of adoption.

Fostering Empathy with User Groups: The Innovation Adoption Curve helps participants to empathize with different user groups (innovators, early adopters, early majority, late majority, laggards) by understanding their unique perspectives and potential hesitations regarding the adoption of new innovations. This empathy can lead to better, more user-focused innovations.

Innovation Adoption Curve



Innovation Adoption Curve

Everett Rogers' Innovation Adoption Curve, a model originating from his seminal work, "Diffusion of Innovations", offers profound insights into how new ideas, trends, and technologies gain traction and ultimately become normalized within society. Central to his model is the recognition of certain key groups of individuals who play pivotal roles in the diffusion process.

At the vanguard of any innovation are the "Innovators," a unique subset of the population that embraces new ideas and concepts before the majority. These pioneers are the trailblazers who perceive the potential of the uncharted and venture bravely into the unknown. Remarkably, these individuals often perceive themselves as ordinary, unaware of their transformative capacity in reshaping societal norms and practices.

Education Example

Rogers' model also aligns with the four iCubed capacities, which represent different types of abilities among individuals when it comes to innovation and change. Based on Roger's research then one would expect that in the realm of education, only a small subset of teachers, about 15%-20%, embody the I² and I³ capacities - those who can effectively pioneer and enact new educational practices.

These "Imaginal" teachers are instrumental during the early stages of system transformation. Comparable to the Innovators in Rogers' model, they serve as the catalysts of change, driving the metamorphosis of the existing "caterpillar" education system into a future-oriented "butterfly" model.

Yet, it's important to note that not all teachers need to, or indeed can, function as pioneers. The vast majority are more comfortable operating within the I⁰ and I¹ capacities, implementing and refining new practices once they have been established and proven successful. It isn't a measure of a teacher's effectiveness, but an acknowledgment of their comfort level with uncertainty and their inclination towards innovation.

This stratification underscores the vital lesson inherent in Rogers' model: innovations are adopted in stages, with different groups playing distinct roles at varying points in the journey. The Innovators and Imaginal educators blaze the trail, while the majority follow in their wake, adapting and consolidating the new practices into mainstream use.

It is crucial to respect these distinct roles in driving innovation, nurturing the Innovators in their pioneering endeavors, while patiently supporting the majority in their adoption process. Recognizing that the pace of change may differ among individuals is essential in fostering a smooth and effective transition towards a more innovative future.

Transformation Focus on Early Adopters

Kickstarting a transformation process in an organization, it's advisable to begin with the Innovators and Early Adopters. These individuals are open to change and resilient in facing uncertainties associated with the process. Their role at the onset is pivotal, as it sets the rhythm and tone for the rest of the organization.

Trying to involve a large group into a transformative process before they're ready can be detrimental. It's crucial to remember that not everyone is equally prepared or inclined towards change. Forcing the unprepared could invite resistance, misunderstanding, or even opposition to the transformation efforts.

Conversely, by channeling the initial efforts towards the Innovators and Early Adopters, organizations can cultivate a cadre of change leaders. They serve to trial, experiment with, and embody the changes, paving the way for wider implementation. Their success sets a tangible precedent for others, validating the transformation and illustrating its potential benefits.

Once the Innovators and Early Adopters have adopted the change, it's time to engage the Early Majority. By now, the process is more polished and understandable, making it simpler for this group to adopt the changes. The presence of their pioneering peers offers reassurance and a path to follow.

Subsequently, the Late Majority will start to engage with the transformation. By this stage, the changes are well-integrated within the organization, and the benefits should be apparent.

Typically, I advise minimal time spent on the Laggards, the last group on Rogers' Innovation Adoption Curve. This group is usually resistant to change, potentially demanding substantial resources to persuade. However, as the transformation becomes the new norm, many Laggards may adapt on their own initiative or decide to leave.

In summary, leading an organizational transformation demands a thoughtful approach that respects varying attitudes towards change within the organization. By focusing on the Innovators and Early Adopters first, then the Early and Late Majority, the process can be effectively orchestrated. This sequential approach allows the transformation to be introduced, tested, and refined before wider implementation, culminating in a successful and enduring change.

Imaginal Transformation

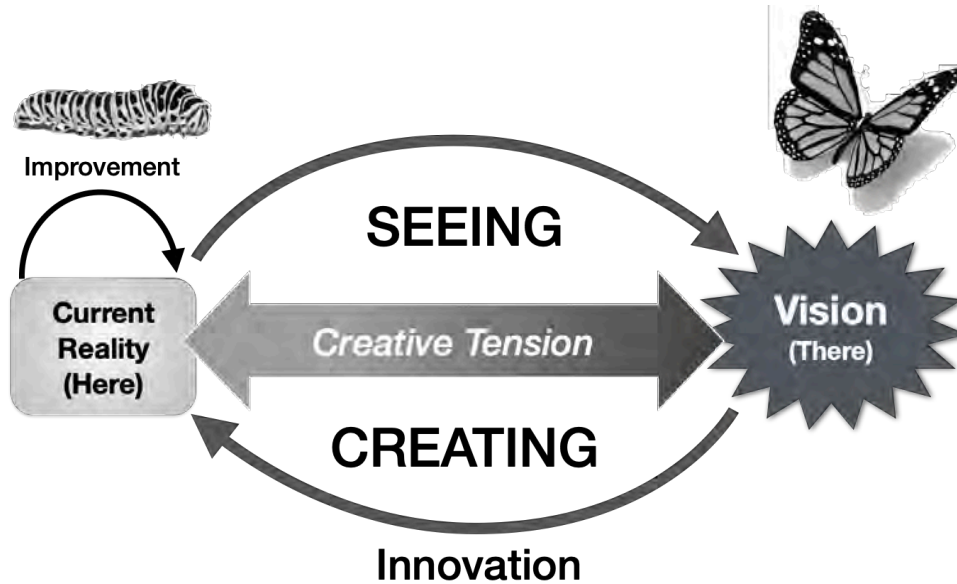


Fig. 1 Basic Elements of Transformation

Imaginal Transformation Defined

Transformation can be understood as a significant metamorphosis in both form and function, a process so profound and sweeping that it fundamentally alters the very essence of its subject. The term elicits the image of a caterpillar undergoing a dramatic change to emerge as a butterfly, a classic and vivid illustration of transformation from the natural world.

This transformation, while visually stunning, is not just about a change in physical appearance. The metamorphosis involves a complete overhaul of the creature's biological structure and functions. From the body and wings to the digestive system and lifestyle habits, every aspect of the butterfly is dramatically different from its previous caterpillar form.

In a similar vein, when we speak of transformation in other contexts, whether it be personal growth, business restructuring, or societal change, we refer to a profound shift that alters the foundational aspects of the subject. The change is not merely cosmetic or superficial; it is a deep, systemic shift that changes how the entity functions and interacts with its environment, just as significantly as a caterpillar transforms into a butterfly.

Imaginal Transformation Defined

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Metamorphosis

The process of metamorphosis, wherein a caterpillar undergoes an extraordinary transformation into a butterfly, stands as one of nature's most awe-inspiring phenomena. The caterpillar is characterized by its sluggish movement, insatiable consumption, and extreme susceptibility to threats from external predators. The skin of the caterpillar, known as the exoskeleton, does not expand by stretching, but instead, it grows by the process of molting, which involves shedding the outgrown skin multiple times. Drawing a metaphorical parallel, certain consultants possess expertise in guiding organizations through this molting process. However, it's important to clarify that this, despite some claiming otherwise, is not transformational. It merely enables the organization to increase in size, while its fundamental nature remains unchanged. The entity remains a caterpillar.

The true marvel, the profound transformation of a caterpillar into a butterfly, unfolds within the pupa or chrysalis. The caterpillar starts secreting enzymes that dissolve the caterpillar structure. However, within the caterpillar exist these exceptional imaginal cells that carry the "vision" and technical "know-how" to morph into a butterfly. At this critical juncture of "rebirth," these imaginal cells activate to construct the various parts of the butterfly.

Over the course of time, a fully-grown butterfly is developed and stands ready to break free from the confines of the chrysalis. Observing the butterfly making its exit, one witnesses a considerable struggle as the butterfly endeavours to squeeze itself out of the protective casing that served as its shelter throughout the transformation process. This struggle, although arduous, is crucial to the survival of the butterfly as it results in the necessary fluid being pushed to the extremities of the wings, enabling their inflation. Analogously, organizations will undergo similar experiences as the "butterfly" starts to surface. There will be bouts of struggle, but they will not be perpetual. In the third part of this book, you will be equipped with strategies to navigate through such periods of stretching and growth.

Transformation Defined

To establish a clear understanding, let's define transformation as a significant alteration in form, nature, and function, mirroring the metamorphosis of a caterpillar into a butterfly. One could alter the color of their hair, but it wouldn't qualify as transformational as the essence of the individual remains unchanged.

In the contemporary world, the term "transformation" is rather liberally used to denote "change." You'll notice the word "transformation" splashed across numerous websites offering consulting services to organizations. Recently, I came across a website asserting to transform education by enhancing teachers' professional practices, aligning with the latest US government's reform initiative, Race to the Top. This is hardly transformational.

Education transformation is a monumental challenge; the system is intricately complex and highly resistant to change. The mental models that underpin the existing education system are deeply ingrained and have been accepted for an extended duration, rendering it difficult for most educators to conceptualize a different future. Many school reform initiatives, such as No Child Left Behind or Race to the Top in the USA, emphasize on improving test scores or teacher performance. These initiatives inevitably fail as they merely address symptoms of an outdated system. If we could improve all students' test scores, would that system prepare students for the future or the past?

If the education system is antiquated, then enhancing teacher training within that system won't alter the overarching state of obsolescence. What we require is a novel education system; and teacher training needs to concentrate on cultivating skills needed to support the new system's structures. We need teachers, administrators, students, parents, and politicians to become Imaginal leaders—those who envision and actualize the future they perceive, require, and desire. We need Imaginal leaders to guide the transformation process from the caterpillar to the butterfly stage.

System Transformation Basics

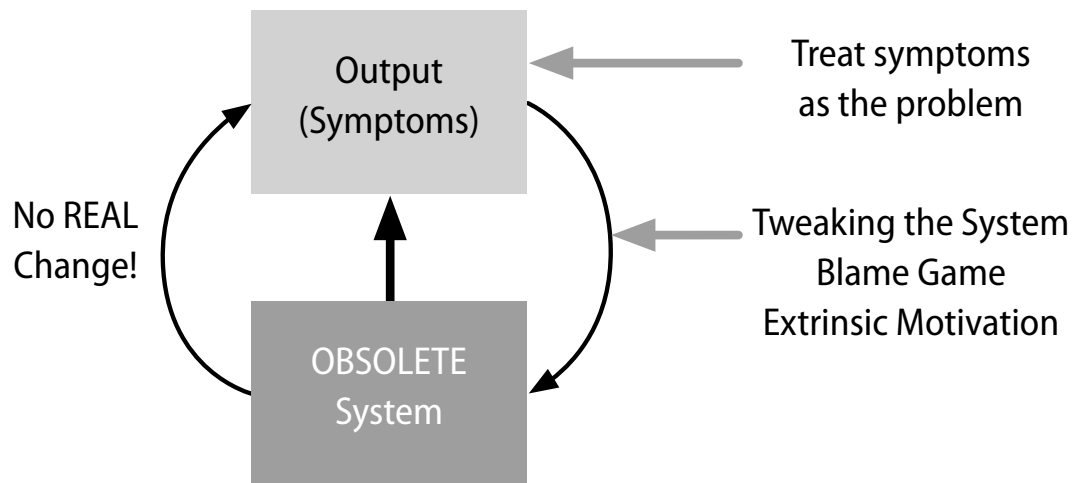


Fig. 1 Futility of Improving an Obsolete System

Tweaking an “obsolete” system using continuous improvement methodologies will not yield the desired results, since even in its most efficient state it fall short of producing what the future needs!

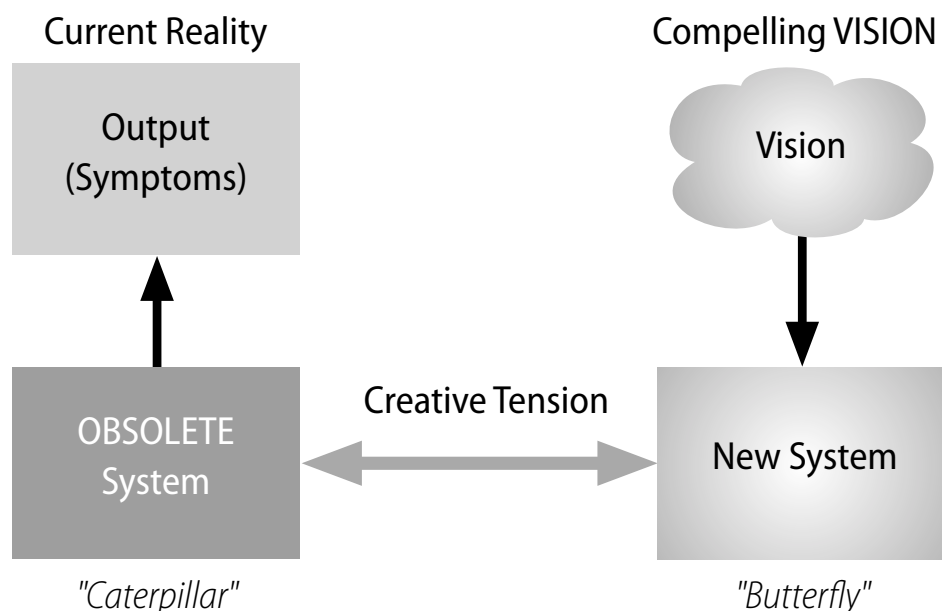


Fig. 2 System Transformation

How to transform the OLD system into the NEW is the REAL problem, it is about closing the gap between your Vision and your Current Reality.

System Transformation Basics



Education Dilemma

A widespread dissatisfaction echoes through many regarding the output of our existing education systems. Yet, this dissatisfaction often mistakenly identifies these outputs as the problem, overlooking that they're merely symptoms of a flawed system. The Imaginal perspective encourages us to adopt a systems viewpoint, revealing that most reform efforts merely adjust an antiquated system, rarely leading to the desired results.

Reflect on initiatives like No Child Left Behind, which, despite the billions of dollars invested over the years, yielded little improvement and often, paradoxically, exacerbated the issues. The tragedy lies not only in the financial waste but also in the squandered opportunity to effect real change.

For instance, consider the Gates Foundation's school initiatives, which, despite billions of dollars invested over the past decade, led to minimal improvement. This raises the question: why? The answer: these programs, and many others like them, fail to address the real problem with education. Continuing to fund an outdated system and expecting different results aligns with what some might describe as insanity.

This resistance to change from the familiar factory model of education has been dubbed "The Fallacy of the Familiar," proposing that our current educational approach mirrors that of previous generations. According to this fallacy, the thought of transforming education is unimaginable, and accepting the current methodology is more manageable since it's what we've always done.

A decade ago, the Gates Foundation embarked on a journey to make a difference. Bill Gates reflected on the experience, labeling it as "sobering" and admitting the difficulty of improving public education. He also acknowledged some key learnings:

More funding isn't the answer: Various foundations have amplified investments in certain regions, but this didn't significantly narrow the achievement gap.

Smaller schools aren't the solution: While there was a slight improvement with smaller schools, the progress didn't match the investment.

Despite the U.S. being the wealthiest and most powerful nation in history, its education system ranks poorly among developed nations.

Consider the car and driver analogy to describe the current education woes. The 'car' represents the system, and the 'driver' symbolizes the teacher. If the 'car' is broken, no amount of 'driver' training or incentives can fix it. Unfortunately, if the system is both broken and obsolete, no degree of rewarding or punishing the 'drivers' will yield the desired results.

So, what is the REAL problem?

It's not the education system per se, but rather the incongruity between the system's design, which caters to producing industrial age workers, and the needs of our modern society. The real problem or 'problemtunity' arises from the creative tension between your vision for a new system and your current reality, demanding a system transformation.

This tension can be resolved in two ways: by moving your current reality toward your vision or by adjusting your vision to fit your current reality. For many educators, the ingrained feelings of powerlessness and hopelessness breed cynicism and judgment towards the notion of an improved educational system. But understanding and overcoming these forces, while harnessing the power of your 'Big WHY' and love for your vision, are key components of Imaginal leadership.

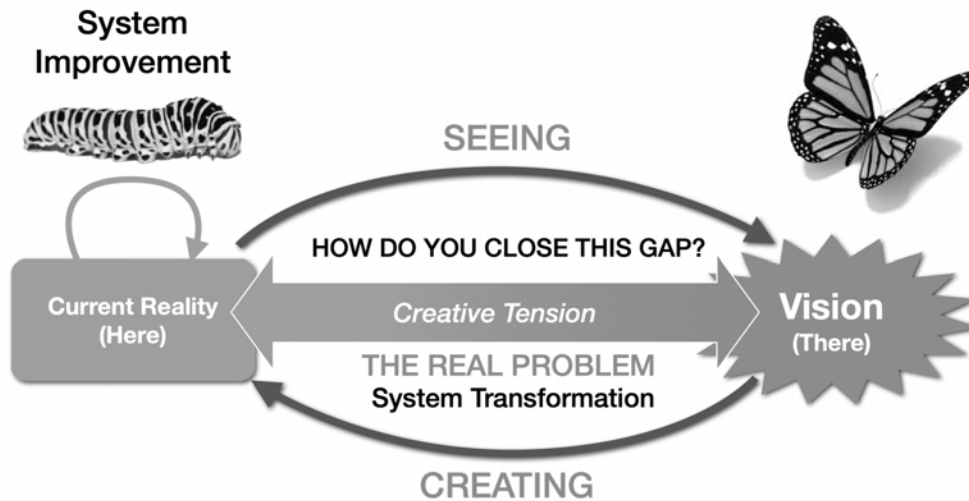
For profound transformation, we need Imaginal leaders in every sector of our society – from politicians, educators, administrators, and school board members to parents, business leaders, and students, all guided by a Kingdom perspective.

Imaginal Leaders

We have discovered that it is possible to transform education from a voracious "caterpillar" into an elegant beautiful "butterfly" symbolic of students being able to pursue their destiny without limitation. My first book, "Becoming Imaginal" is intended to inspire and create hope for the millions of parents, educators, students, politicians, and business owners who may feel powerlessness and hopelessness regarding the future state of education.

An Imaginal Leader is one who has the passion, courage, and vision to engage in the creation process of seeing the invisible and doing the impossible. Steve Jobs was an Imaginal Leader; he was able to live in the tension of his "reality distortion field" to create one of the greatest technology companies against insurmountable odds.

System Transformation in Education



There can be no transformation without a compelling vision of the future and a strategy by which that future can be realized. – Tom Rudmik 2020

Fig. 1 What is the REAL Problem?

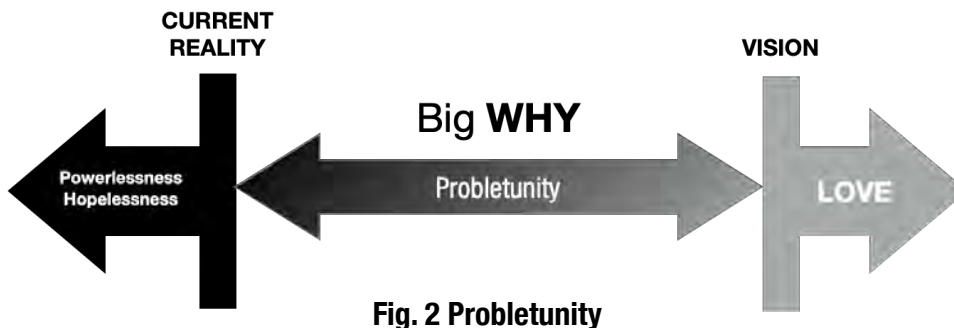


Fig. 2 Probletnuity

CONDITIONS describe the current reality before you begin the creative process. Conditions are descriptive statements of reality and are not the problem. Conditions are in constant flux and will change as the creative process advances.

VISION is a picture of your preferred future – this is what you wish to create and become.

A “**PROBLETNUTY**” is created when you discover a gap between reality and your vision for a new reality. The “probletnuity” is neither current conditions nor the vision, rather, it is the discrepancy between them. The “probletnuity” represents the REAL problem that needs to be solved which requires system transformation.

CREATIVE TENSION is generated, when you decide to resolve the probletnuity, which is the interplay between your vision and current reality.

System Transformation in Education



Probletnunity" Exploration in Education

"Probletnunity" is an innovative term that fuses "problem" and "opportunity," suggesting that a circumstance can embody both these elements. The term challenges conventional mental models, which often perceive problems as something to be avoided or solved in traditional ways. "Probletnunity," on the other hand, prompts a proactive design approach to creatively resolve the situation.

Vision emergence invariably results in a gap between your present reality and your envisioned future, and this gap is the birthplace of a "probletnunity." It's essential to differentiate between conditions – the facts of your current reality – and a probletnunity, which emerges when your vision diverges from these conditions. This divergence creates a gap, and the tension arising from this gap fuels the energy to address the probletnunity.

Consider this: In my current reality, I do not own a rocket – this is not a probletnunity, merely a fact of my present state. However, if I envisage a future where I travel to space, the absence of a rocket becomes a significant issue. This gap between my vision (space travel) and my current reality (no rocket) births a probletnunity, requiring me to create conditions where space travel is feasible. This probletnunity generates structural tension that drives actions to reshape my conditions, inching me closer to my vision.

Your vision and your "Big WHY" have a natural pull, driving you forward, answering the question, "Why do this?" Simultaneously, there are restraining forces striving to pull you back, seeking the comfort of the status quo. These forces, real or imagined, act as balancing loops, continually gravitating you back to the comfort zone. Our innate tendency to seek comfort often enables these forces, and recognizing these forces and strategies that maintain comfort can help lessen their influence, allowing the driving forces to pull us toward our vision.

Remember, it isn't necessary to eliminate all restraining forces before progressing towards your "Big WHY." Instead, the love and passion for your vision and "Big WHY" can inspire you to start creating your future now, in spite of these forces.

Through my extensive work with educators around the world, I've observed a consistent difficulty in envisioning the future of education. The conventional educational mindset is so deeply ingrained in educators that visualizing an alternate system seems nearly impossible. While integrating advanced technology, better resources, and modernizing school infrastructures are steps forward, the

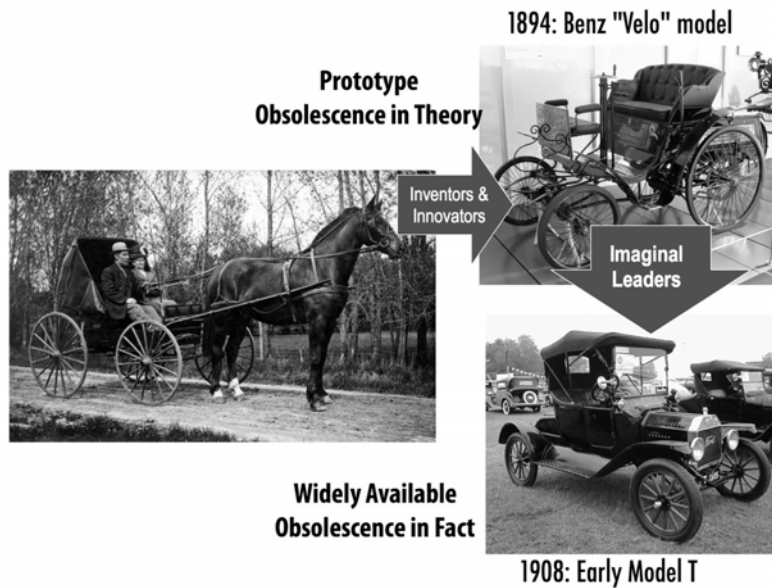
fundamental nature of education hasn't seen any revolutionary changes in the last century. A few outlier institutions do exist that have ventured into the future, but these are sadly the exception rather than the norm.

A crucial theme of this book is the difficulty educators face in actualizing a future-oriented vision, primarily because they're not trained as designers of intricate systems. Instead, their expertise lies in crafting educational programs for students. Renowned Canadian educational reformer, Michael Fullan, asserts that the battle we've been waging to incorporate more innovations or reforms into the education system is largely futile. The challenge isn't about scaling the hill of innovation but rather finding a different hill, a different mindset about educational change. The paradox is that while education should teach people to deal with change fundamentally, it often does the opposite. To break this deadlock, Fullan argues, educators need to transform themselves into change agents, experts in the dynamics of change. Fullan's point underscores the need for educators to evolve into change agents or more appropriately, Imaginal Leaders. But the question remains: how do we achieve this transformation?

Seeing and Creating the Future at Master's

While shaping Master's culture and vision for Future Ready Education, we recognized the challenges teachers faced balancing the present with the future. We promoted a culture that supported risk-taking, but many struggled to comprehend the concept of stepping into the future guided by faith rather than sight alone. The ingrained thinking patterns that dictated educators' behaviors were so deeply rooted in the traditional paradigm that gaining momentum for systemic transformation was arduous. We needed a shift in our fundamental orientation towards becoming Imaginal — someone capable of visualizing and creating the future they desire. This transformation was no simple task given our diverse individualities. We questioned if there were universal laws or keys that could help decode the process of becoming Imaginal.

Creating Obsolescence



Obsolescence to Horse and Bugging

The establishment of obsolescence necessitates a functioning prototype that demonstrates success, coupled with a strategy to scale it affordably to the wider public.

Fig. 1 Creating Obsolescence

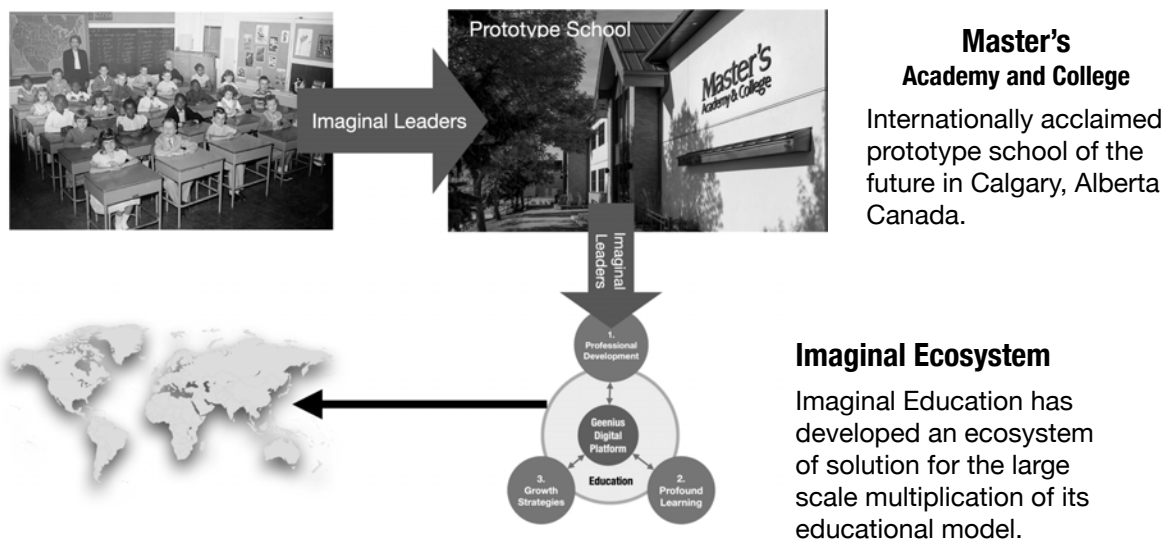


Fig. 2 Creating Obsolescence in Education

Creating Obsolescence



In our fast-paced world, obsolescence is a constant presence. It manifests when a product, service, or process is supplanted by something deemed more useful or valuable. Consider the music industry: cassette tapes in the 70s were superseded by CDs, which then gave way to online digital music stores. Similarly, VHS tapes evolved to DVDs, BlueRay DVDs, and now, online video streaming. The ability to induce obsolescence, that is, to envision and shape the future, is a unique trait of Imaginal leaders.

Consider the fall of Blockbuster Video stores, made redundant by cable and internet streaming services like Netflix. As consumers, we didn't perceive Blockbuster as obsolete while we frequented it. Little did we know, Imaginal individuals and corporations were reimagining the future of video content delivery. Blockbuster's success impeded its ability to anticipate and engineer its obsolescence before competitors could. Similarly, the public was blindsided. Although there were complaints about late rental fees, the system was largely accepted as it was. Today, the thought of physically renting a video seems archaic.

Obsolescence in Theory vs Fact

I've long maintained that the educational system, not being adequately primed for future needs, is essentially obsolete. This argument was theoretical, fueled by the desire for something better. Genuine obsolescence only occurs when a superior alternative is crafted and widely accessible. Simply labeling something as obsolete doesn't make it so.

Obsolescence Example

In 1894, Karl Benz invented the Velo, a rudimentary automobile. The concept required substantial Imaginal vision, but the Velo alone couldn't displace the horse and buggy. It was only when another Imaginal pioneer, Henry Ford, mass-produced affordable cars, that the horse and buggy truly became obsolete.

This principle applies to education as well. A prototype 'school of the future' may be intriguing, but it doesn't induce obsolescence. However, if we can scale up that model to cater to the masses, obsolescence becomes a possibility. At Imaginal Education, our goal is not just to establish a working prototype of Profound Learning at Master's Academy and College in Calgary, Alberta, Canada, but also to create a supportive ecosystem for its global adoption. We are at a stage where this vision is feasible. To actualize it, we need educators to morph into transformation agents within their school systems. We need Imaginal Leaders.

Creating Your Own Obsolescence

Embracing and crafting your own obsolescence is essential in this era of profound change, where the ultimate competitive edge lies in outlearning and out innovating your rivals. The most beneficial obsolescence is self-induced, reflecting a future designed purposefully rather than accepted passively. If Blockbuster had successfully self-orchestrated its obsolescence, perhaps we wouldn't have witnessed the rise of Netflix. Incumbent industry leaders often struggle to envision and shape the future, primarily because they are heavily invested in their current success. That's why startups frequently out-innovate market leaders, and why successful corporations acquire startups.

Not all instances of obsolescence mirror the radical shift from horse-drawn carriages to automobiles that occurred in the early 20th century. Presently, Elon Musk's enterprise, Tesla Motors, is spearheading a new era of obsolescence with its electric vehicles and unique, cost-effective manufacturing methods. At first glance, Tesla's cars might appear ordinary, but they conceal groundbreaking technology under their hoods that holds the potential to reshape the transportation sector anew. With the further expansion of requisite infrastructure, the prevalence of fully electric vehicles is only set to surge.

Similar to Musk's electric cars, the obsolescence we aim to induce in education may not be immediately apparent. The exterior might appear similar, but beneath lies a completely revamped education system.

Imaginal leaders, those who envision and create the future, are the architects of obsolescence. Our world is moulded by these Imaginal leaders, but where do these visionaries originate from?

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Tipping Point

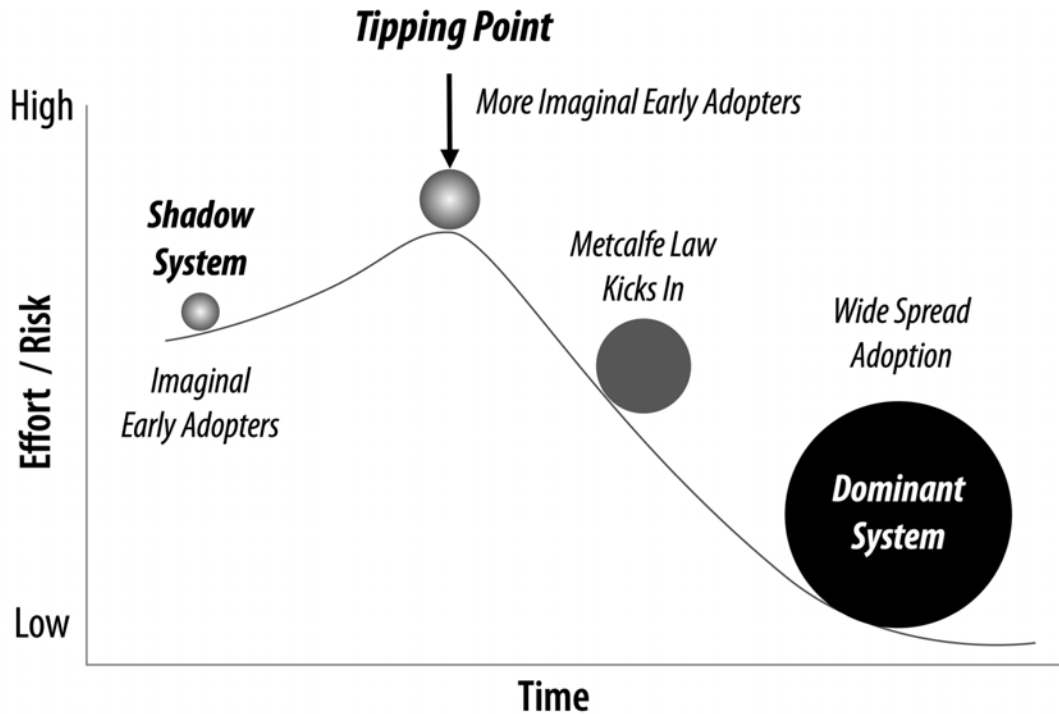


Fig. 1 Transformation Tipping Point

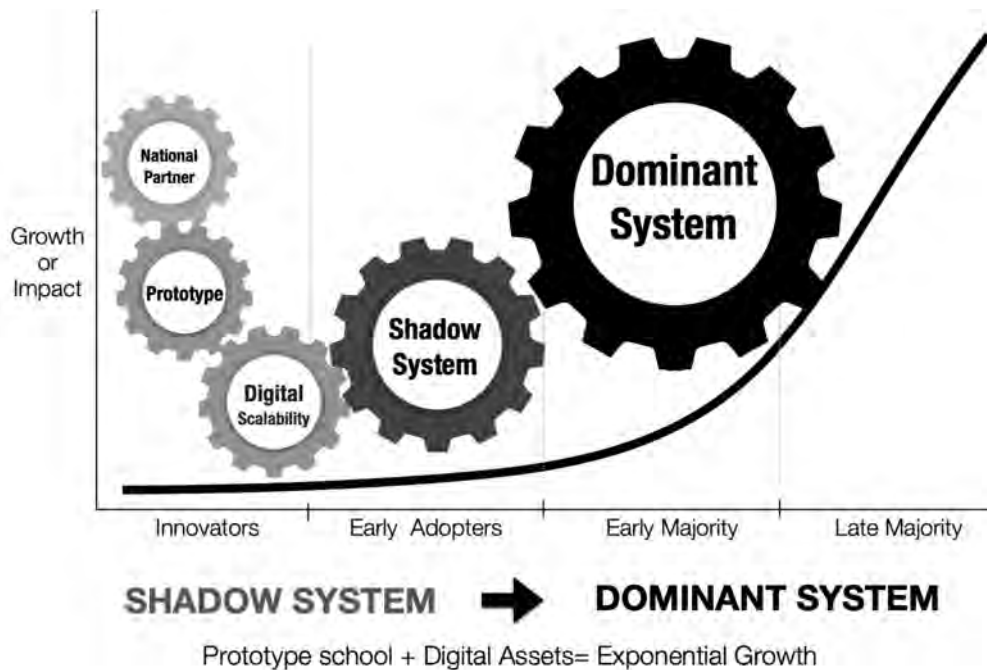


Fig. 2 Creating a Shadow System

Creating a Shadow System



Shadow System

In today's educational landscape, the majority of nations align with a model that hinges on institutions accredited by the government, both public and private. This prevalent educational mold adheres rigidly to a state-endorsed curriculum, reminiscent of the dated, factory-style approach to teaching.

Yet, there's a rumble in the horizon. Imaginal Education (Imaginal) envisions an "alternate", an emergent "shadow" educational paradigm. Grounding itself on a regional or state foundation, this blueprint collaborates closely with vanguard institutions that operate outside the typical confines. The intent? Not to merely exist alongside but to challenge the dominant system's status quo. To provoke it to a form of "jealousy" - not in the traditional sense but in a desire to elevate, to match, to grow. And how? By highlighting a refined, more effective, and financially prudent model of education that makes the current look obsolete in comparison. To solidify this transformative shift, the allure of the digital frontier, offered by Imaginal's digital platform, amplifies the change.

But why a shadow system? It's more than a whim; it's strategic. Drawing parallels to biblical teachings where believers are instructed to "provoke the world to jealousy" (Romans 11:11), Imaginal seeks to create a ripple effect. The idea isn't just to introduce something marginally better, but to bring about a transformative wave that can't be ignored.

Tipping Point

A tipping point is when a series of small changes or incidents becomes significant enough to cause a larger, more important change. Historical patterns suggests a tipping point in social systems emerges around the 10% adoption mark, but we believe that number is closer to 2-5% adoption. Consider a country like the USA, boasting approximately 50 million students from K-12. The goal? A robust shadow system encompassing close to 1 million users. While boutique private or charter schools might spark interest, they're often just a drop in the ocean. To truly challenge the colossal dominant paradigm, we need a shadow system of significant magnitude. Only then can we hope to transition from gentle nudges to monumental shifts in the educational sphere.

Creating a National Shadow System

The following are four broad steps needed to establish a national shadow system.

National Collaborators: Imaginal's pioneering step is to lay the foundation for an Imaginal Transformation Center in tandem with a national collaborator. Such collaborators already radiate a transformative aura at the regional level, with a visionary approach towards national evolution. Many have the infrastructure in the form of an established school or network, primed for prototyping.

Creating Prototype: Every transformative journey with Imaginal in a new region commences with the blueprint of a prototype school. Despite Imaginal's acclaimed success in places like Canada, it's pivotal to showcase the efficacy of this model within the target nation. Rooted in neuroscience, the universality of Imaginal's approach is evident. Any cultural nuances that arise are seamlessly addressed from branding, creating local learning experiences and educator development standpoints.

Digital Leverage: Imaginal's forward-thinking paradigm perceives a future dominated by a blended educational model, harmonizing online and in-person experiences. A holistic digital curriculum is paramount, complemented by a streamlined system to assimilate online mentors and facilitators. This digital infrastructure, capable of accommodating and nurturing thousands of learners, is the cornerstone of Imaginal's rapid, exponential growth vision.

Cultivating the Shadow Paradigm:

Initially, nurturing this shadow system might feel like an uphill task, akin to pushing a hefty boulder up a steep incline. However, as the network of early adopters grows, Metcalfe's Law—stating that the value and power of a network is proportional to the square of the number of its users—begins to kick in. This network effect amplifies the system's intrinsic value and strength exponentially with each new participant. Once the inflection point is achieved, the challenge transitions from mere initiation to managing explosive, downhill growth. This is where the focus shifts crucially to ensure that the rapid expansion fortifies rather than overwhelms the blossoming system. Effective management of this growth phase is critical to harnessing the full potential of the network effect, turning burgeoning potential into a self-sustaining transformational force across the educational landscape.

Part II

Imaginal Thinking

“There can be no transformation without a compelling vision of the future; Imaginal Thinking is the process by which we can see and create the future we need.”—Tom Rudmik, Becoming Imaginal –2013

Tenets of Imaginal Foresight

- 1. The future remains unwritten.**
- 2. Multiple futures await our choice.**
- 3. Tomorrow's certainty is today's decision.**
- 4. Futures range from wild to desired.**
- 5. Our actions shape future outcomes.**
- 6. We're guardians of future generations.**
- 7. Align futures with God's design.**
- 8. God's will can be known.**

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www.futures.hawaii.edu

Foresight Basics



Unraveling Foresight: Imaginal Leaders Envisioning the Future

Foresight isn't mere prediction; it's the craft of shaping potential futures. Forget the crystal balls – it's about strategizing with foresight, positioning yourself to harness the waves of tomorrow. As Einstein said, "The intuitive mind is a sacred gift and the rational mind is a faithful servant. We've built a society that adores the servant, sidelining the gift."

An Imaginal Leader dances between the now and the next. It's a captivating tango – feeling the rhythm of today while sketching the melodies of tomorrow. Remember, the future's knocking; will you design its blueprint or let someone draft yours? Your move, leader.

Core Tenets of Foresight:

1. **The future remains unwritten.** The future is like an untouched canvas, waiting for us to define its landscape. Our choices and actions today lay the foundation for this new horizon, hinting at the myriad possibilities that lie ahead.
2. **Multiple futures await our choice.** Our destiny is not just one path, but an intricate web of possibilities. Every decision we make branches out, revealing alternative futures that diverge and converge based on our interventions.
3. **Tomorrow's certainty is today's decision.** The unpredictability of tomorrow is rooted in the choices we make today. With each decision, we pivot towards a particular future, highlighting the powerful agency we hold in our hands.
4. **Futures range from wild to desired.** The concept of the future is multifaceted, encompassing everything from the wildest, most eccentric imaginings to the deeply rooted aspirations we hold dear. Understanding this spectrum allows us to chart a course that aligns with our core values and desires.
5. **Our actions shape future outcomes.** Every step, every decision, every moment of inertia plays a part in shaping what comes next. Whether we act or refrain, our influence on the eventual outcome is undeniable.

6. **We're guardians of future generations.** Our responsibility goes beyond just the present moment; we're custodians of the legacies we leave behind. The world we shape today will be the home for generations to come, urging us to act with foresight and compassion.
7. **Align futures with God's design.** To navigate towards an impactful future, we need alignment with God's master plan. This ensures our efforts mirror what's divinely intended for us on earth.
8. **God's will can be known (Rom. 12:2).** While the future might seem uncertain, the divine path God has intended for us is accessible. Through faith, introspection, and guidance, we can uncover and resonate with God's aspirations for us, shaping a future that serves a greater good.

Diving into Foresight Techniques:

- Scan & Soak: Immerse in diverse knowledge pools.
- Leap Beyond: Venture outside your niche. New industries, regions, horizons await.
- Visualize: Graphics, models – they simplify the intertwined, intricate webs.
- Dig Deep with 'WHY': Interrogate assumptions, connections, origins.
- Embrace 'What if': Anticipate not just the probable, but the possible.
- Engaging in the Imaginal Spectrum:
- Foresight isn't about bull's-eye accuracy.
- Numbers? Vital for history, less so for sketching the unborn future.
- Gather generously: Signals from yesteryears, whispers of emerging shifts, contrasting future portraits.
- Challenge assumptions. At every "That's unlikely," retort with a "Why not?"
- Every viewpoint, a piece of the puzzle. Embrace the myriad hues. Remember the Taylor axiom: debating perspectives? Futile.
- Stay alert. Keep recalibrating. Set standards.
- Dive into the Imaginal; chart the uncharted. The future's yours to craft

The Four Keys to Hearing God's Voice

1. Being Still

Find a quiet place to still your thoughts and emotions, as Habakkuk did (Hab. 2:1), and practice biblical meditation to silence distractions, enabling a deep inner knowing (Psalm 46:10, 37:7).

Worship, especially gentle songs expressing love for God, aids in achieving stillness and focusing on His presence.

2. Focus on Jesus

Focus your heart on Jesus to ensure the intuitive flow comes from Him, not personal desires (Heb. 12:2), and look for vision while praying, supported by God's promise of dreams and visions to believers (Acts 2:1-4, 17).

Seeing with the eyes of your heart involves actively looking for Jesus and expecting Him to speak and act.

4. Two-Way Journaling

Write down your prayers and God's responses, as Habakkuk did (Hab. 2:2), allowing you to record in faith and later test and examine what you believe you received from God.

Sharing your journaling with a trusted friend or spouse can provide confirmation and strengthen your faith in hearing God's voice.

3. Recognizing God's Voice

Hearing God's voice often flows as spontaneous thoughts in our hearts. When I seek Him, I tune into these moments that seem to arise out of nowhere.

God's command to Habakkuk to "write the vision" (Hab. 2:2) shows a pattern. Recording what I receive has strengthened my confidence in hearing Him, making alignment with His will a daily journey.

The Three Ways of Discerning the Voice of God

From "Imaginal Transformation, A Dance of Co-Design and Co-Creation with God"—Thomas Rudmik 2024

My Thoughts

Personal thoughts are conscious and deliberate, originating from our own introspections, and are distinguishable by their familiar, self-directed nature.

Enemy's Thought

Thoughts that provoke unease, fear, or confusion are likely from Satan, aiming to disturb and mislead, contrasting with the peace and clarity of God's voice.

God's Thought

God's voice often comes as spontaneous, unexpected thoughts or impressions that surprise us and inherently nurture and elevate our spirit, even when they contain cautions.

Key to Discernment:

Discerning God's voice involves transforming our minds (Romans 12:2), replacing worldly thought patterns with those rooted in God's Word, and practicing co-creation with God to tune into His voice more accurately over time.

—Summarized from: <https://www.cwgministries.org>

Co-Creation with God Basics

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Key Principles for Co-Creation with God

Believers are called to be active participants in God's grand design, working alongside Him to manifest His will on earth. This partnership is emphasized in Scripture, such as in 1 Corinthians 3:9 and 1 Peter 4:10, which describe believers as God's fellow workers and stewards of His grace.

1. Communion with God:

- Engaging in deep, two-way communication with God through prayer.
- Dr. Mark Virkler's teachings on prayer emphasize interactive dialogue and journaling, which helps believers capture divine thoughts and guidance.
- This practice leads to a clearer understanding of God's will and a closer relationship with Him.

2. Seeking Divine Wisdom:

- Pursuing God's wisdom, which goes beyond human knowledge, to guide decisions and actions.
- James 1:5 promises that God will generously provide wisdom to those who ask.
- This divine wisdom shapes our perspectives and aligns our actions with God's plans.

3. Stewardship:

- Faithfully managing the resources, talents, and opportunities God has entrusted to us.
- This involves integrity, accountability, and using God's gifts for His glory, as highlighted in 1 Corinthians 4:2.
- Stewardship requires ongoing evaluation and adjustment to ensure alignment with God's will.

4. Humility:

- Recognizing God as the ultimate creator and submitting our plans to His will.
- Humility involves being teachable, valuing others' perspectives, and giving God credit for successes.
- James 4:10 underscores that humility brings divine favor and blessing.

5. Active Listening:

- Discerning God's voice through Scripture, prayer, prophecy, and circumstances.
- Dr. Virkler's framework helps differentiate between our thoughts, Satan's deception, and God's guidance.
- John 10:27 assures us that as God's sheep, we can hear His voice.

6. Obedience:

- Taking faithful action based on God's directives, demonstrating our love and trust in Him.
- Biblical heroes like Noah, Abraham, and Moses exemplify obedience that significantly influenced God's plans.
- Obedience often requires stepping out in faith, assured of God's presence and guidance (Deuteronomy 31:6).

7. Trust and Faith:

- Embracing God's plans with unwavering trust, even when the future is unclear.
- Trust and faith are personal, lived experiences that grow through life's trials.
- Hebrews 11:1 defines faith as believing in God's promises, igniting our imagination and hope to co-create with Him.

8. Growth and Iteration:

- Continuously refining our understanding and designs in collaboration with God.
- Imaginal Thinking helps explore potential futures and adjust our actions based on divine insights.
- 1 Corinthians 13:12 and 2 Peter 3:18 highlight the importance of ongoing spiritual growth and iteration.

9. Collaboration and Unity:

- Co-creating with fellow believers, valuing collective wisdom and diverse perspectives.
- Imaginal Transformation Workshops foster a culture of collaborative exploration, where every voice contributes to discerning God's will.
- Unity enhances our ability to perceive God's plans, as emphasized in Matthew 18:20 and Romans 12:4-5.

10. Bringing Heaven's Will to Earth:

- Aligning our actions with Kingdom principles like love, justice, mercy, and righteousness.
- Jesus' teachings in Matthew 6:10 and 6:33 encourage seeking God's Kingdom and His righteousness in all we do.
- Imaginal Thinking helps conceptualize and apply these principles in practical ways, aiming to manifest God's will on earth.

This co-creative process is an ongoing journey of faith, trust, and obedience, transforming our lives and the world as we align with God's divine purposes.

Knowledge Creation Levels

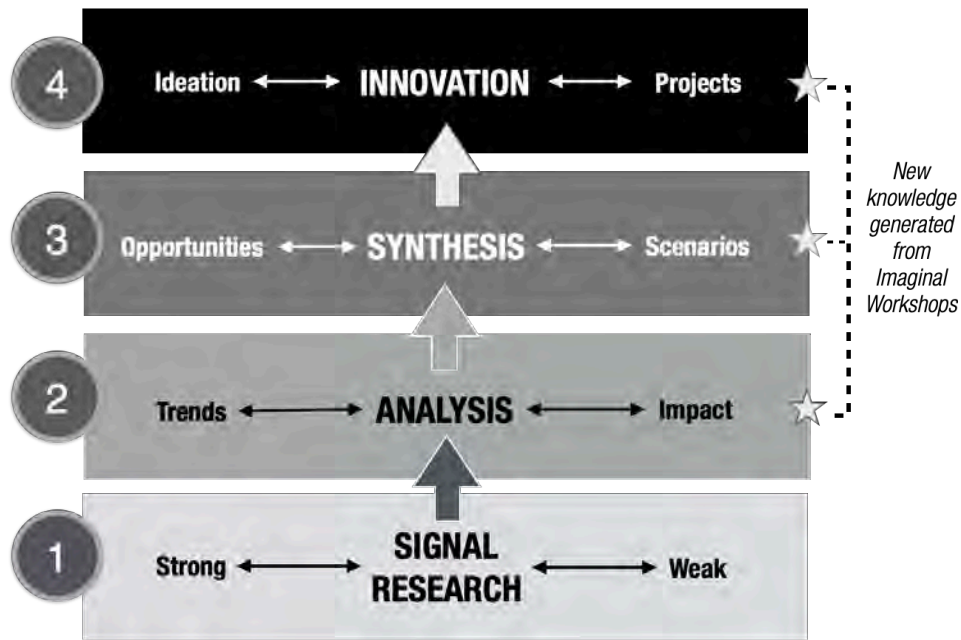


Fig. 1 Knowledge Creation Levels

“Imagination is more important than **knowledge**. For while **knowledge** defines all we currently know and understand, **imagination** points to all we might yet **discover** and **create**.”

–Albert Einstein

New Knowledge Creation



An Imaginal Organization functions by employing the Imaginal Thinking process to invigorate its "innovation engine". This is achieved by pioneering a next-generation knowledge management system that doesn't just archive knowledge from the past, but anticipates and captures foresight from the future. This innovative approach revolutionizes the way organizations traditionally use and manage knowledge.

Conventional organizations predominantly rely on knowledge and experience from the past to inform their decisions and future planning. They forecast the future based on trends and patterns observed in historical data, and while this can provide useful insights, it fundamentally roots their strategic thinking in the past. When the time comes to make pivotal strategic decisions about the future, these organizations essentially lean on what they have learned and experienced previously, thereby maintaining a backward-looking perspective.

Creating New Knowledge

An Imaginal Organization, on the other hand, represents a significant shift from this norm. It doesn't just theorize or speculate about potential future developments; it proactively generates knowledge from envisaged future scenarios. This is not a passive process, but an active engagement with the future that involves vividly imagining various future possibilities and extracting insights from these scenarios to inform present decisions and strategies.

The methodology used in Imaginal Organizations is robust and dynamic. It focuses on creating new knowledge inspired by future possibilities, and it demands a willingness to explore, experiment, and adapt. This process not only provides a comprehensive understanding of potential future landscapes but also equips the organization with the knowledge and foresight needed to shape those futures.

In essence, an Imaginal Organization is not merely a reactive entity that responds to the future as it unfolds. Instead, it is an active participant in the creation of the future. It utilizes Imaginal Thinking as a bridge that connects the present with the future, enabling it to not just adapt to, but actively shape the unfolding reality.

The innovative knowledge generated through Imaginal Thinking provides fuel for the organization's innovation engine, empowering it to drive forward with a clear vision, strategic foresight, and a commitment to creating a future aligned with its purpose and values. This approach paves the way for a transformative shift in organizational strategy and culture, empowering businesses to navigate the complexities of the future with confidence and agility.

Innovation projects once approved will generate a vast amount of new learning and knowledge that needs to be captured in such a way that can easily be shared with other innovation project teams.

Level 1: SIGNAL RESEARCH

The Imaginal Knowledge Creation model starts with the capture of SIGNALS from the future through research. This research includes, white papers, published research papers, articles from thought leaders, etc. An organization would setup research teams that would focus on domains that are relevant to the organization. Included in the research will be articles on strong signals or trends that are currently observable and trackable. Weak signals from the fringe are also captured, these would come from various publications that are deemed to be futuristic.

Level 2: ANALYSIS

Level 2 knowledge is primarily created by analysts, those that are able to perform trend and impact ANALYSIS. The work of an analyst is to gain a deeper understanding of existing knowledge and the implications it might have on the future. An Imaginal Organizations may purchase high-valued analysts reports from reputable sources, but it still requires its own team of analysts to create NEW knowledge that is specific to the future needs of the organization.

Level 3: SYNTHESIS

SYNTHESIS of new knowledge about the future builds usually takes place in Imaginal Workshops. Using the level 2 knowledge, workshop participants are able to create scenarios of the future, and by placing themselves into these scenarios are able to learn from the future. The learning from the future reveals opportunities for innovation.

Level 4: INNOVATION

The purpose of levels 1-3 knowledge is to create the fuel that generate ideas for INNOVATION projects. Innovation projects once approved will generate a vast amount of new learning and knowledge that needs to be captured in such a way that can easily be shared with other innovation project teams.

Imaginal Thinking: Signals

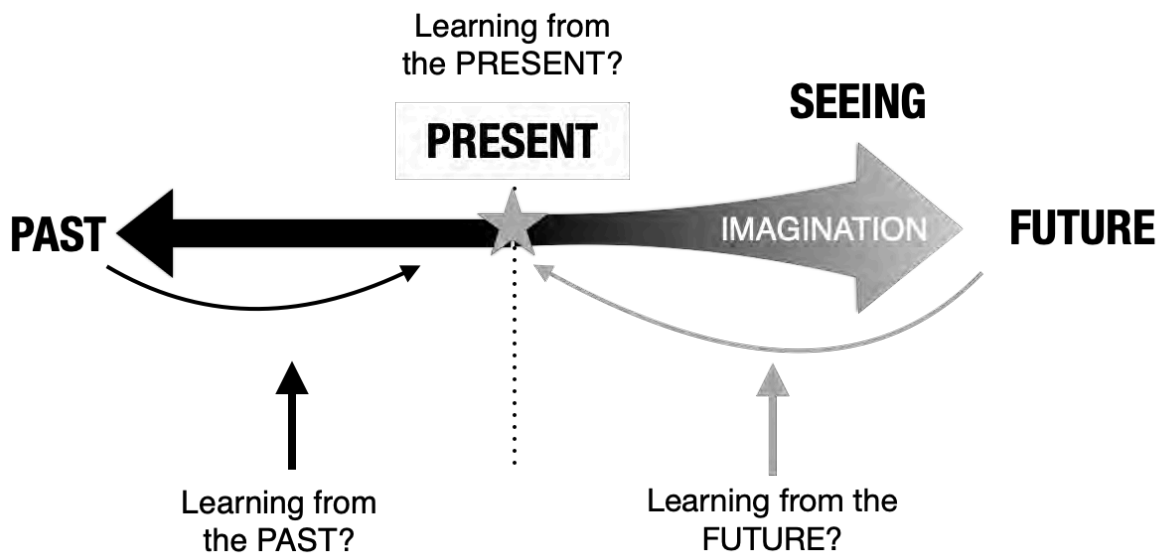


Fig. 1 Imaginal Thinking, Seeing and Creating the Future

Our ability to envision, learn from, and create the future is based on the fundamental idea that signals from the future exist in the present. By identifying these strong and weak signals, we can build compelling future scenarios, allowing us to enter, learn from, and actively create the future.

—Thomas Rudmik, 2015

Imaginal Thinking: Signals



Unveiling the Future through Signal Research

Signal research is a key facet in the journey of strategic foresight and Imaginal Thinking. It involves identifying and interpreting signals from both the past and the present, each of which could have meaningful bearings on the future. These signals, characterized as strong or weak, play an indispensable role in molding our comprehension of prospective future scenarios, thereby serving as an essential guide in decision-making processes.

This method can be analogized with the approach of astronomers who, in their quest to learn more about the universe, seek out signals from distant galaxies. Similarly, we, as practitioners of foresight and future studies, scout for signals that could enlighten us about the potential trajectory of our societal, economic, and technological future. However, these signals from the 'future' are not detached from our current reality. Instead, they are embedded within it, appearing as strong or weak signals.

Decoding Strong Signals and Trends

Strong signals can be identified as trends substantiated through rigorous research and empirical data. They embody the visible patterns and current developments in our time that demonstrate a strong probability of endurance and future influence. One such trend that paints an illustrative picture is the consistent movement towards autonomous vehicles. As self-driving technology continues its rapid advancement and achieves widespread adoption, it seems almost irrefutable that most, if not all, vehicles will eventually transition to autonomy. However, the implications of this trend extend beyond technological transformation. The influence of autonomous vehicles on the job market and all intersecting sectors, such as insurance companies, must also be factored into future projections.

These strong signals, or trends, traverse different stages of maturity and adoption, often visualized by an S Curve.

This progression is typically predicated on the assessments and forecasts of experts within the relevant field. By scrutinizing these trends and their potential future impact, Imaginal leaders can embark on the process of constructing future scenarios. These scenarios are shaped within one or more frameworks of the Seven "P" Futures Model. The objective is not to cast unerring predictions about the future—a pursuit often found to be in vain and erroneous. Rather, the goal is to conceive a multitude of diverse future scenarios from which you can learn.

Interpreting Weak Signals and Fringe Possibilities

On the other hand, weak signals are less tangible and lie on the fringe of what we currently perceive as feasible. They might seem improbable or far-fetched at present but harbor the potential for monumental disruption should they materialize. For instance, quantum computing was once considered a weak signal, a remote idea on the outskirts of technology. Today, however, it is an emerging field with the promise to revolutionize computing.

The Art of Seeing and Creating the Future

The art of learning from the future mandates the utilization of our imagination. The imagination is the lens of the human spirit, an astounding capacity that allows us to envisage a realm of boundless possibilities. Every creation initiates within the mind's eye of its creator, molded and imagined.

In the subsequent phase, the creator endeavors to manifest this vision into reality, igniting the creation process. This two-step journey, from the conception in the imagination to tangible creation, encapsulates the essence of Imaginal Thinking. As we sift through the horizon for signals, strong or weak, we harness our imagination to perceive, comprehend, and shape the future. In doing so, we engage in co-creating our collective destiny, standing shoulder to shoulder with God.

Imaginal Thinking Seven Steps



Fig. 1 Imaginal Thinking Seven Step Process

IMAGINAL THINKING is TRANSFORMATIONAL

In the grand journey of Imaginal Thinking, one must always remember that our envisioned future scenarios are not the end, but rather the means. They are the catalysts that spark new perspectives and challenge the status quo.

If the procedure itself eclipses the goal of altering people's mindset and questioning their presuppositions, then the outcome will have little strategic value. Scenarios that simply echo existing paradigms and fail to lead people into new realms of thought will not yield success.

At the heart of Imaginal Thinking lies its ability to disrupt conventional thinking patterns and guide individuals towards unexplored territories of the mind. It's not just about envisioning the future, but about pioneering it with a spirit of innovation and daring.

Imaginal Thinking: Seven Steps

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At its essence, Imaginal Thinking is a practice of visualizing, learning from, and actively participating in shaping the future. It is firmly rooted in futurism and the field of future studies, which involves systematic, interdisciplinary exploration of potential and probable futures. However, Imaginal Thinking extends beyond mere analysis and prediction, embracing a creative, co-designing role in the creation of the future.

Signals from the future are essentially present-day indicators or trends that hint at potential developments or changes that might occur in the future. These signals could be emerging technologies, social shifts, new policies, environmental changes, or any significant event or trend that has the potential to shape the future landscape. Recognizing and interpreting these signals is a crucial aspect of future studies and strategic foresight, aiding in proactive decision-making and planning.

Analyzing these signals allows us to anticipate possible future scenarios and develop effective strategies to navigate potential challenges and leverage opportunities. It also facilitates a proactive approach to change, enabling individuals, organizations, and societies to shape their future rather than merely reacting to it. This forward-thinking mindset is key to thriving in a rapidly evolving world, and signals from the future play a critical role in fostering this mindset.

In essence, signals from the future present today are the clues that help us understand what tomorrow might bring, and act as the foundation for imaginal thinking and strategic foresight.

Imaginal Thinking Seven Step Process:

1. Setting Conditions

Environment: Specialized environment for collaboration and release of the Imaginal spirit

Culture: Imaginal Organization culture embraces the contradictory nature of the innovation and business performance ‘engines’.

2. Learning from the Past

Drivers: looking at historical drivers that led to profound changes in our world

Stabilities: what forces historically were keeping change from happening

3. Learning from the Present

Signal Research: capture of strong and weak signals research

Trend Analysis: creating S Curve analysis derived from the strong and weak signals research

Impact Analysis: projection of trends and their impacts on the future across various sectors

4. Seeing the Futures

Forecast: using the Manoa method and other tools; future impacts from multiple trends across many sectors are formulated

Seven “P” Model: is used to create probable, plausible and possible futures

Scenarios: are robust narratives of the Four “P” futures for your organization. Each future may have multiple scenarios such as best case, worst case etc.

5. Learning from the Futures

Futurecasting: Placing your organization into the future scenarios—will you survive

Backcasting: Create a narrative by working backwards in time from your future scenario, how did you get to the future, what were the key milestones and how did you overcome obstacles, etc?

6. Redefining Strategic Focus:

Revisiting Big WHY: an organization’s vision and Big WHY are dynamic and are constantly adjusting to conditions that are unfolding

Focus: deciding on your focus helps to define what you are trying to accomplish

Goals: are the articulation of what you are hoping to achieve in a measurable way

Strategies: are how you will accomplish your goals

Who are we Becoming: defines who you are becoming as an organization

7. Creating the Future:

Opportunities: identifying opportunities zones for further exploration

Ideation: ideation workshops are conducted by taking opportunities from the future and with the right people in the workshop begin create ideas that align to your strategic focus. There may also emerge some outlier ideas for further development.

Design Thinking: is applied to the development of ideas into bonafide innovation projects

Innovation Projects: are submit first as proposals, and once accepted will go through phases of research, prototype development, testing etc. It is critical to capture the learning from all phases of the innovation project.

Imaginal Thinking Seven Steps

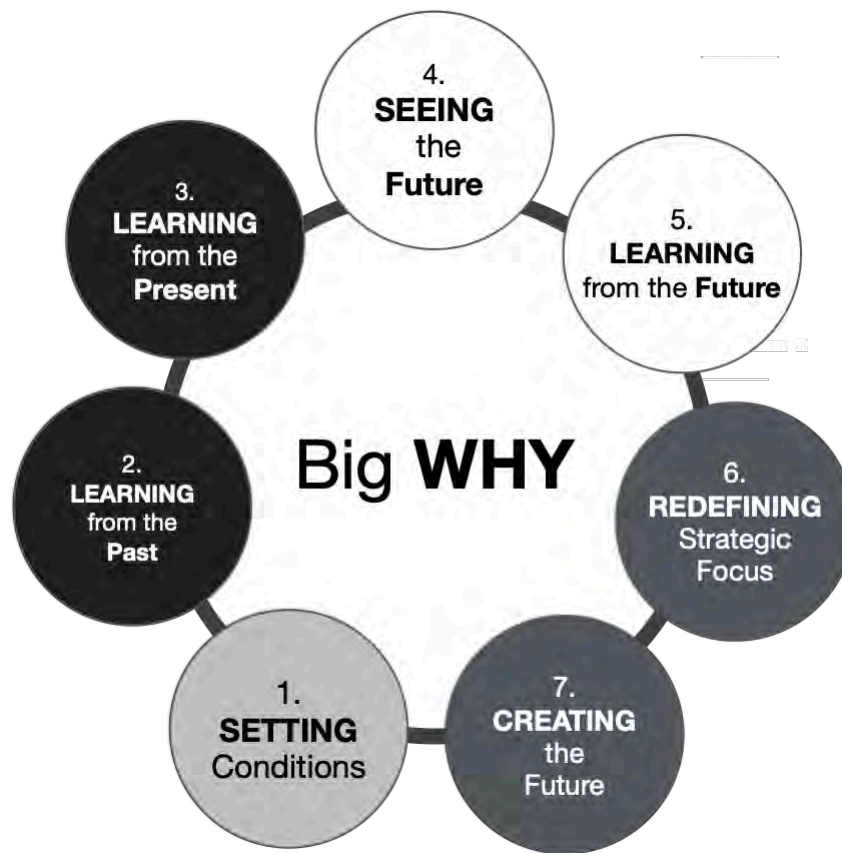


Fig. 1 Imaginal Thinking Seven Step Process

Imaginal Thinking is a mindset that enables members of an organization **to envision, evaluate, and forge their own future.**

This transformative process goes beyond merely reacting to daily challenges or long-term opportunities. It's not just about adjusting to new realities; **it's about envisioning and shaping the future.**

It is not reactive, but proactive... **Imaginal thinking is all about transformation,** which often leads to profound personal change. —Tom Rudmik, 2020

Imaginal Thinking: Questions and Tools

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Imaginal Framework	Questions	Tools/Methods/Systems
Setting Conditions	Are we ready to face the future? Do we have intent? Why is intent present? What conditions physically, mentally and spiritually need to be set so as to enable us to explore our future? Is there a Big WHY?	Physical space–Imaginal Lab Establishing intent - Reason for action Finding your Big WHY
Learning from the Past	How did we get here? Who are some of the winners and losers from the past, why? What can we learn from their experiences. How has our past influenced our present?	Mapping historical drivers and stabilities Time machine: were these changes anticipated, why or why not etc.
Learning from the Present	What emerging trends are shaping our organisation's future? What are some weak signals of today that could disrupt the future?	Trend Analysis- Develop a trends knowledge repository related to your business Weak Signal Analysis–the future in the present
Seeing the Futures	What are our possible/probable/ plausible futures? What would we do in each of those possible futures?	Forecasting the future using trends Developing multiple futures scenarios
Learning from the Futures	How would we survive or thrive in the futures? What needs to change, what needs to stay the same? How did we get to the futures we described	Futurecasting: how would you survive or thrive Backcasting- key milestones/decisions/ events that caused this future to emerge
Strategic Focus	How does our Big WHY inform our focus? What are we really good at? To thrive what should we focus on?	Big WHY helps to provide focus Identity, Purpose, Cause, Vision, Calling
Creating the Future	Where are the opportunities between the THERE and the HERE? How can we translate those opportunities into Innovation projects?	Mining opportunities Ideation, Design, and Creation Process Innovation Project proposal

Design Thinking

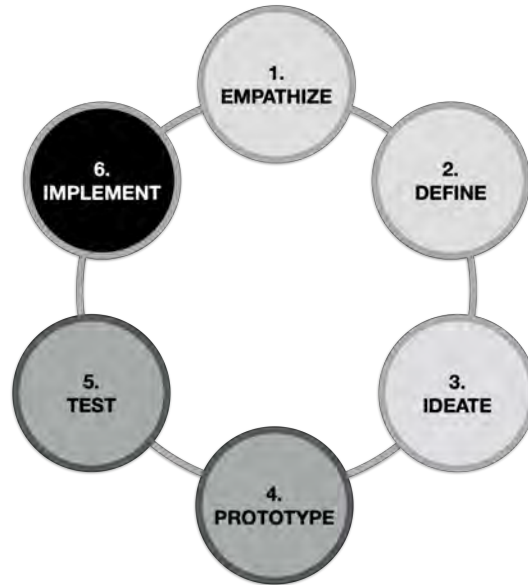


Fig. 1 Design Thinking Seven Step Process

Comparison of Design Thinking to Imaginal Thinking		
	Design Thinking	Imaginal Thinking
Purpose	Primarily focused on solving specific problems and creating user-centric solutions. It emphasizes human-centered design.	Goes beyond problem-solving; it's a holistic approach that visualizes, learns from, and actively participates in shaping the future. It's deeply rooted in futurism.
Process	Six distinct phases - empathize, define, ideate, prototype, test, and implement. It emphasizes understanding, exploring, and materializing ideas.	Employs a more comprehensive seven-step process that includes setting conditions, learning from the past and present, seeing and learning from the future, redefining strategic focus, and actively creating the future
Scope	Focuses on tangible problems and solutions, often in product or service design.	Addresses broader future scenarios, signals from the future, and larger systemic challenges. It involves a co-designing role in the creation of the future.
Iteration	Encourages cyclic iteration, revisiting phases as needed. The process is adaptable, and teams often return to earlier stages like empathize and define based on new insights.	While its process is iterative in nature, it places a stronger emphasis on adaptability and reshaping based on changing future signals and trends.
Application	Applied when crafting solutions tailored to specific user needs and challenges.	Used in strategic foresight, futurism, and for organizations and leaders aiming to navigate and shape the future.
Mindset	Encourages a user-centric mindset, promoting empathy and iteration.	Encourages a forward-thinking mindset, embracing a creative role in understanding and crafting future scenarios

Design Thinking



Design Thinking: Engineering Approach

1. Data Acquisition (Empathize):

Sensor Calibration and Input Collection: In this initial phase, it's akin to setting up sensors to gather raw data. The focus is on understanding the user's requirements by analyzing their feedback, behaviors, and needs. It involves engaging in field studies, employing diagnostic tools, and leveraging analytics to capture accurate user data.

Example: Imagine designing a new wearable device to monitor heart rates. The initial phase would involve studying potential users as they exercise, work, and rest. You'd gather data by interviewing athletes, office workers, and elderly people about their experiences with current heart rate monitors and understand their pain points.

2. Problem Definition (Define):

System Specification and Parameter Setting: After gathering raw data, the next step is to clearly define the problem. This is similar to setting parameters for an engineering project. It involves converting qualitative data into quantifiable metrics, identifying constraints, and laying out the specific objectives the solution needs to achieve.

Example: After gathering data, you find out that many users are frustrated with the inaccurate readings of current devices during high-intensity workouts. The defined problem might be: "Design a heart rate monitor that provides accurate readings during varying levels of physical exertion."

3. Solution Ideation (Ideate):

Conceptual Design and Modelling: Armed with a clear problem definition, brainstorm potential solutions. This is where theoretical models, simulations, and conceptual designs come into play. Brainstorming sessions can be thought of as creating multiple model iterations, exploring various approaches before zeroing in on the most promising ones.

Example: Your team could brainstorm solutions like incorporating multi-point sensors, developing advanced algorithms to filter out noise, or integrating temperature and humidity metrics to increase accuracy. You might draft early blueprints or use simulation software to visualize how each idea might work.

4. Prototyping (Prototype):

Preliminary Design and Testing Rig Setup: This phase involves creating initial versions of the solution, much like building a prototype in engineering. Using CAD tools, 3D printing, or even simpler mock-ups, this is about bringing theoretical designs to life in a tangible form. These prototypes might not be fully functional but serve as a visual and tactile representation of the solution's direction.

Example: Based on the ideation phase, a prototype is built with enhanced multi-point sensors. This could be a 3D-printed version of the wearable or even a more rudimentary mock-up made of basic materials just to understand its fit and feel.

5. Validation (Test):

Performance Testing and Iteration: Now, it's time to test the prototypes in real-world conditions, akin to stress-testing in engineering. Metrics are compared against design specifications. Feedback loops are established. The results will dictate modifications, improvements, or complete re-designs based on the performance of the prototype against the defined objectives.

Example: The prototype is then given to a group of athletes who test it during their high-intensity workouts. After collecting data, you notice that while accuracy has improved, the device gets uncomfortable after 30 minutes. This feedback then guides the next design iteration.

6. Deployment (Implement):

Final Assembly and Roll-out: With the tested and refined solution in hand, it's now time to deploy it at scale. In engineering terms, this means mass production, quality assurance, and rolling out the final product to the end-users, ensuring that it meets all specifications and achieves the desired impact.

Example: Once the design has been finalized and thoroughly tested, mass production begins. The final wearable is produced with materials chosen for both function and comfort, ensuring that the device meets all the specifications defined earlier. It's then rolled out to the market with confidence that it will fulfill user needs and desires.

In this engineering-inspired rendition, the Design Thinking process mirrors the rigorous, methodical, and data-driven approach engineers take when moving from problem definition to solution deployment.

Design Thinking Examples

Apple's iPod: In a world filled with complex gadgets, came a device that understood the human soul's desire for simplicity, music, and elegance. Design Thinking didn't just create a product; it revolutionized the way we experience music.

Airbnb: A platform born out of empathy for travellers seeking authentic experiences. Rather than just a place to stay, it offers a chance to 'live' somewhere, even if just for a night.

Tesla's Electric Cars: Beyond just transportation, Tesla tapped into the collective desire for sustainability, style, and innovation. A vehicle of change, quite literally!

Imaginal Seven “P” Futures

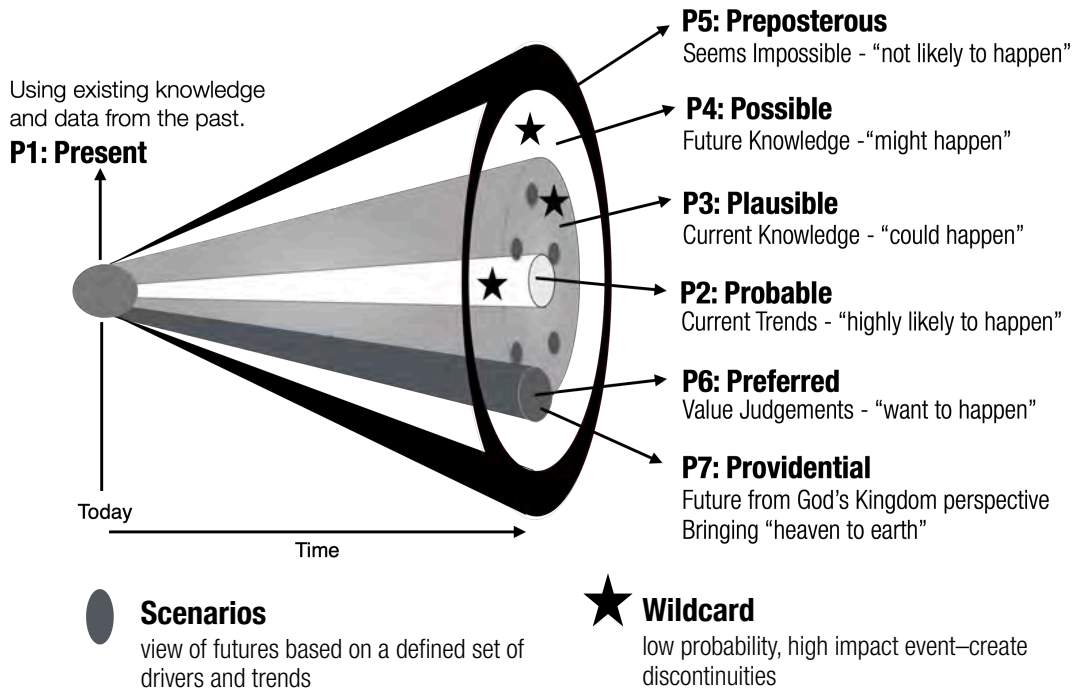


Fig. 1 Seven “P” Futures Types

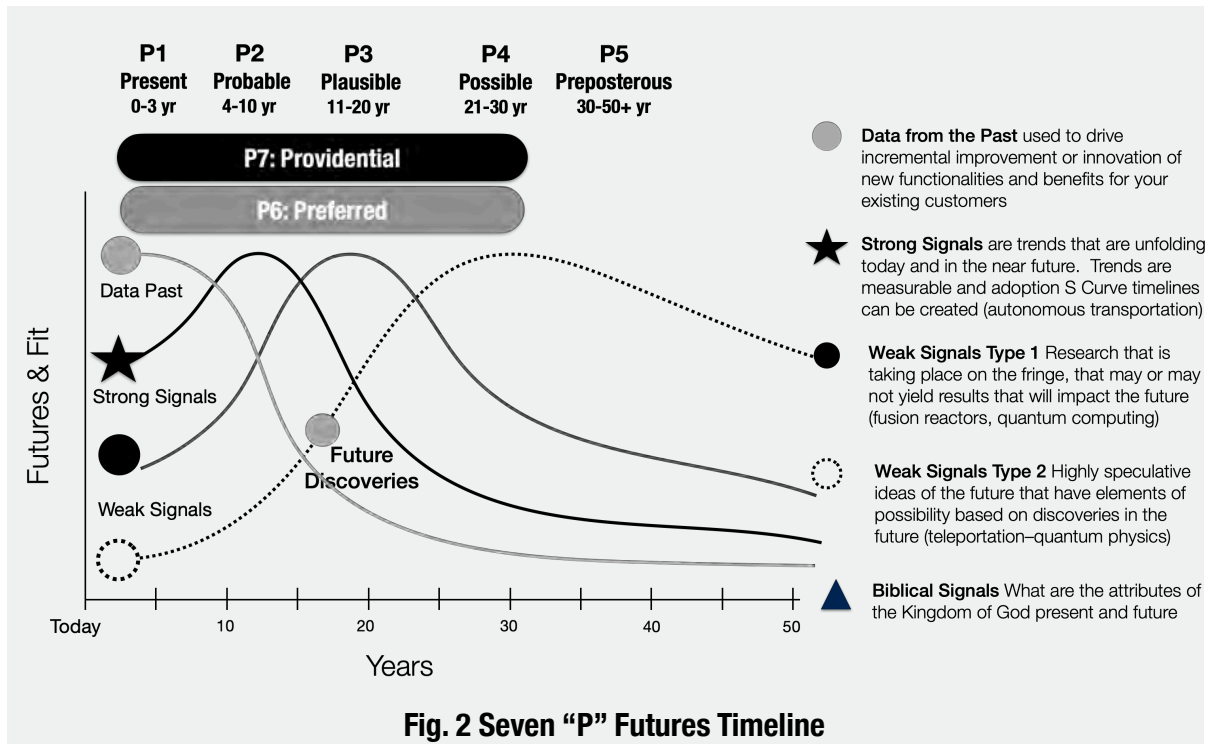


Fig. 2 Seven “P” Futures Timeline

Imaginal Seven “P” Futures Model

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The Seven "P" Futures Model, is an innovative framework that provides a structured approach to envisioning and preparing for the future. As the name suggests, it's built around seven different perspectives, each denoted by a word beginning with the letter "P". These perspectives range from the immediate present to distant, almost unimaginable futures, offering a comprehensive overview of the different time horizons and potential scenarios that an individual, organization, or society may encounter.

In a world characterized by accelerating change and increasing complexity, the Seven "P" Futures Model serves as a vital navigational tool. It facilitates the process of understanding, anticipating, and planning for the different eventualities that may arise. At its heart, the model underscores the importance of not just passively predicting the future based on past and present trends, but actively shaping it through informed decision-making, innovative thinking, and strategic planning.

From addressing the immediate needs of the present (P1) to envisioning and influencing preferred (P6) and providential futures (P7), the model encapsulates a broad spectrum of possibilities. It allows us to consider everything from probable, plausible, and possible scenarios, to those that may seem preposterous today. By systematically contemplating these diverse futures, we can cultivate foresight, prepare for various contingencies, and work towards the creation of desirable outcomes.

The Seven "P" Futures Model is not merely a theoretical construct; it's a practical, actionable tool. It invites us to actively participate in shaping our future, instilling a sense of agency and responsibility in navigating the course of our shared destiny. Through its use, we can transition from being mere spectators of change to becoming architects of our desired future.

P1: Present (0-3 years)

The present horizon is primarily focused on meeting current customer needs, utilizing existing knowledge and data derived from the past. It's a realm effectively managed using established design thinking tools and methodologies. It necessitates a short-term lens, addressing immediate requirements and ongoing operations.

P2: Probable Futures (4-10 years)

Probable futures delve into the more distant horizon of up to a decade. These futures are crafted based on strong signals apparent in our present day, which are projected to continue influencing the future. It's essential for every organization to envisage a multitude of P2 future scenarios, offering a solid foundation for strategic planning and decision making.

P3: Plausible Futures (11-20 years)

Stretching further into the future, plausible futures encompass a timespan of 15-20 years. With a higher degree of uncertainty, it's an exploration of what could possibly transpire given current trends and developments. Despite the uncertainty, charting out diverse plausible futures can offer valuable insights for major strategic decisions, such as capital investments in infrastructure.

P4: Possible Futures (21-30+ years)

Possible futures venture into a realm that's predicated on novel knowledge and ground-breaking discoveries. With a horizon of about two to three decades, this timeframe allows consideration for monumental changes, like the potential advent of fusion reactors altering the energy landscape entirely.

P5: Preposterous Futures (50+ years)

Preposterous futures offer a sandbox for unbounded imagination. Here, we can toy with far-reaching ideas about the future without the constraint of immediate practicality or feasibility. It's a realm where science fiction writers thrive, crafting narratives of future scenarios that, while seemingly implausible, could nevertheless exert influence on the long-term trajectory of our society.

P6: Preferred Futures (any of the above timelines)

Preferred futures denote the future state that you or your organization would ideally desire to materialize. It's a reflection of your core values and strategic objectives, embodying the idealized vision of what you want to achieve or contribute to the world.

P7: Providential Futures (any of the above timelines)

Providential futures pose the ultimate question, "What would God want?" This perspective can be overlaid on each of the previous six futures, lending a divine aspect to the exploration of possible futures. It underlines the spiritual alignment of our endeavors, be they personal, organizational, or societal.

Scenario Planning



Descriptor:

Scenario writing is a critical component of futures studies. It allows us to visualize and understand various possible futures in a tangible, narrative way. These narratives can range from worst-case to best-case scenarios, and everything in between, allowing us to prepare, plan, and create strategies for multiple eventualities. Here's a closer look at the process.

Types of Scenarios

There are numerous types of scenarios, each designed to serve a different purpose:

Exploratory Scenarios: These scenarios explore various future possibilities based on current trends and emerging issues. They are used when the future is unpredictable and when there are several plausible futures.

Normative Scenarios: These are created based on a desired future outcome. They are used to map out the steps needed to achieve a specific goal or vision of the future.

Contingency Scenarios: These scenarios are used to plan for potential crises or unexpected events. They often outline worst-case scenarios.

Plausible vs. Probable Scenarios: Plausible scenarios are about what could happen, while probable scenarios focus on what is most likely to happen given current trends and information.

Purpose of Scenarios

Scenarios serve a variety of purposes:

- They can challenge prevailing mindsets and assumptions, prompting individuals and organizations to consider unfamiliar or unexpected possibilities.
- Scenarios can provide a framework for understanding complex interactions and dynamics.
- They offer a means of testing potential strategies and policies, examining how they might perform under different conditions.
- Scenarios enable organizations to prepare for various futures, reducing uncertainty and improving resilience.

Steps in Writing Scenarios

Identify Key Factors and Drivers: Begin by identifying the key factors and drivers that will shape the future of the area under study. These could be trends, emerging issues, or uncertainties.

Explore Interactions: Consider how these factors might interact with one another. Look for potential synergies, conflicts, and ripple effects.

Creating Scenario Logics refers to the development of the foundational reasoning or guiding principles that underpin each future scenario in a foresight or futures study. Each scenario is typically based on a unique set of assumptions about how the future might evolve. These assumptions can be influenced by critical uncertainties (unknown factors that could significantly impact the outcome), key trends (observable patterns of change), or specific goals (desired future states).

For example, consider a company in the technology sector developing future scenarios to guide its strategic planning.

One scenario might be based on the logic that rapid technological innovation continues unabated (key trend), leading to significant disruptions in the industry.

Another scenario might be based on the logic that regulatory constraints become much more stringent (critical uncertainty), slowing the pace of technological advancements.

A third scenario could be based on the company's goal of becoming a leader in sustainable technology, and thus, the logic assumes a successful implementation of green initiatives.

By basing each scenario on a distinct and coherent logic, the company ensures that each scenario is both internally consistent (the events within the scenario fit together logically) and distinct from the other scenarios. This approach allows the company to explore a wide range of potential futures and develop robust strategies that can accommodate different possibilities.

In other words, scenario logics are the core assumptions or rationales that drive the events and outcomes in each scenario, giving them credibility and making them useful tools for strategic planning.

Write the Scenarios: Craft a narrative for each scenario. The narrative should be detailed and rich, offering a vivid depiction of what the future could look like. Include both the broader context (e.g., societal, technological, economic conditions) and more specific elements relevant to the area under study.

Review and Refine: Review the scenarios for coherence, plausibility, and internal consistency. Refine as necessary, and validate with subject matter experts if possible.

Consider Implications: Consider the implications of each scenario. What would they mean for your organization, community, or area of focus? What actions would be warranted in each case?

Remember, scenarios are not predictions. They are tools for thinking about, preparing for, and shaping the future.

Universal Plot Lines



- 1. Overcoming the Monster**
- 2. Rags to Riches**
- 3. The Quest**
- 4. Voyage and Return**
- 5. Comedy**
- 6. Tragedy**
- 7. Rebirth**

Universal Plot Lines



Scenario writing in strategic foresight and futures studies can benefit from the application of narrative structures used in storytelling, including the seven universal plot lines. These plots can be utilized to craft compelling and relatable narratives for each future scenario, making them more accessible and impactful. Here's how these universal plots could be integrated into scenario writing:

1. Overcoming the Monster:

This plot involves a heroic struggle against a formidable adversary or challenge. In a future scenario, this might involve an organization overcoming a major industry disruption or a societal challenge such as inequality or disease.

Example: An innovative tech company is faced with a formidable challenge: tackling cybersecurity threats posed by malicious hackers. The scenario follows the organization as it invests heavily in advanced security measures, hires top cybersecurity talent, and eventually builds an unbreachable system, safeguarding the integrity of their services and customers' trust.

2. Rags to Riches:

Here, the protagonist experiences a dramatic rise from poor circumstances to success. A scenario using this plot might depict a startup's journey to industry dominance or a developing nation's path to prosperity.

Example: A small family-owned business operating out of a garage creates a unique, eco-friendly product. Despite early struggles and market scepticism, their product catches the eye of a major retailer. This leads to a nationwide distribution deal, transforming their humble venture into a leading brand in the sustainability market.

3. The Quest:

The protagonist embarks on a journey to achieve a significant goal. This could be used in a scenario where an organization, a nation, or humanity itself is on a quest to achieve a major scientific breakthrough or societal transformation.

Example: A pharmaceutical company embarks on a mission to find a cure for a rare, but deadly disease. The scenario follows the company's ten-year journey, filled with trials, errors, breakthroughs, and setbacks, culminating in the successful development of a life-saving drug.

4. Voyage and Return:

The protagonist ventures to an unfamiliar environment and returns transformed. This plot could frame a scenario in which an organization expands to new markets or technologies and then returns to its core business, enriched by the experience.

Example: A traditional manufacturing company, seeing the rise of AI, decides to explore the potential of integrating AI into its operations. They invest in AI technology, encountering numerous challenges, but learn from them and eventually return to their core manufacturing process, now significantly optimized with AI.

5. Comedy:

This plot often involves complex and humorous situations that are eventually resolved, leading to a happy outcome. This plot could frame a scenario that highlights the lighter side of future possibilities, such as technological innovations leading to amusing societal changes.

Example: A pet supply company develops a "smart collar" for dogs that translates barks into human speech. The scenario could depict the unexpected, humorous consequences this innovation brings to pet-human interactions, ultimately leading to increased sales and the company's recognition as a fun, forward-thinking brand.

6. Tragedy:

This plot involves the downfall of the protagonist due to their own flaws or circumstances beyond their control. In the context of scenarios, it could depict futures where negligence, poor decisions, or uncontrollable factors lead to undesirable outcomes.

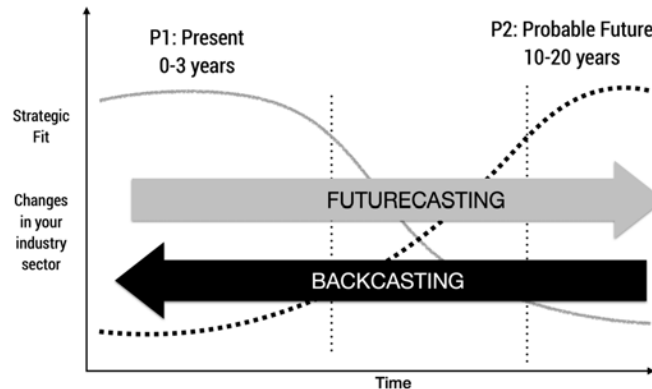
Example: A highly successful automobile company overlooks the gradual shift towards electric vehicles. Sticking to their traditional petroleum-based models, they see a drastic decline in sales and market share, leading to the eventual downfall of a once prosperous company.

7. Rebirth:

The protagonist undergoes a period of darkness before emerging into the light. A scenario using this plot might depict an organization or society going through a crisis before reinventing itself and achieving a better state.

Example: A once-popular retail chain that had lost customers due to outdated business practices decides to revamp its strategy. It goes through a period of intense transformation, digitizing its operations, rebranding its stores, and training staff in customer-centric service. The company makes a successful comeback, emerging as a competitive player in the modern retail market.

Modules: Futurecasting and Backcasting



Module 1A: Futurecasting

Futurecasting is an essential tool used in Imaginal Thinking where we learn from the future by projecting our organization into that envisioned reality. It is a strategic exercise that allows us to assess how well our current organizational structure, operations, and culture would fit and adapt in our projected future scenario.

STEPS:

1. Visualize Your Organization's P2 Future:
 - Utilize a large flip chart or whiteboard to outline a visual representation of your organization situated in the P2 future. Be as detailed and comprehensive as possible - include elements like market dynamics, key competencies, customer base, technological usage, and any other relevant aspects.
2. Analyze Your Organization's Current Fit:
 - Assess the congruity of your organization's present form with the P2 future. Would your organization seamlessly blend into this future as it is today? Examine and explain any gaps or misalignments.
3. Identify Required New Competencies:
 - Considering the future landscape, what new skills, knowledge, or abilities would your organization require to thrive? These could range from technological advancements, process improvements, shifts in leadership style, and more.
4. Evaluate the Changes:
 - Scrutinize what has transformed in your organization's environment. What components of your current organization would become obsolete in the P2 future?

This exercise will shed light on how ready your organization is for the projected future and reveal the areas that require attention and transformation. Remember, the goal of Futurecasting isn't just to fit into the future but to mold it actively, shaping our organization's destiny in alignment with our envisioned success.

Module 1B: Backcasting

Backcasting is a valuable learning tool from the perspective of Imaginal Thinking. It allows us to draw from the future, weaving it into our present reality. This process doesn't just present an idealized end-point but rather meticulously unravels the transformation journey that led us there, providing a detailed roadmap for our path to the envisioned future.

STEPS:

1. Construct Your Timeline:
 - Using a large flip chart or whiteboard, draft a timeline that commences with your current state (P1) and concludes with your desired future state (P2). This visual representation serves as a chronological guide, assisting in outlining the transformation process.
2. Identify Key Transitions and Milestones:
 - Working backwards from P2 to P1 on this timeline, map out the significant steps, shifts, and milestones that contributed to the emergence of P2. These may include changes in operational processes, management strategies, market disruptions, technological advancements, and more.
3. Highlight Innovations:
 - Reflect on the innovations that were essential for your P2 to materialize. This could span across product or service innovations, strategic and cultural shifts, or technological breakthroughs.
4. Understand System Pushbacks:
 - Systems tend to resist change in order to maintain the status quo. So, identify the possible pushbacks your organization might face on this journey. What were the barriers that emerged, and how were they surmounted? These could be organizational resistance, regulatory hurdles, technological constraints, or market competition.

The objective here is to dive deep and be as detailed as possible. This exercise brings clarity to your transformation roadmap, helping to highlight the challenges and opportunities that lie ahead. Remember, Backcasting is about harnessing the future to shape your actions today.

Futurecasting and Backcasting



Learning from the Future:

When we talk about the future, it's not just about forecasting what's to come; it's about creating it. Imaginal Thinking is about unlocking our innate capacity to visualize, comprehend and craft the future. At its core, Imaginal Thinking involves futurecasting and backcasting – two incredibly potent methodologies that help us to learn from and create the future.

Futurecasting

Futurecasting, as the name suggests, is a forward-looking process where we position ourselves within a future we've envisioned. This isn't mere daydreaming; it's a conscious act of imagining ourselves thriving in this prospective reality. How does our organization fit into this landscape? What challenges do we face, and more importantly, what opportunities can we seize? By stepping into this possible future, we can start to draw a clear and tangible image of what our success or failure might look like.

Take, for instance, the rise of Tesla Inc. Elon Musk, the visionary behind Tesla, didn't merely envision the advent of electric vehicles; he placed his company at the forefront of this revolution, futurecasting Tesla as the trailblazer in a world increasingly gravitating towards sustainable transportation.

Backcasting

Yet, the journey of Imaginal Thinking doesn't merely end with futurecasting. Once we've visualized ourselves thriving in this novel reality, we engage in an intriguing process we term as 'backcasting'. Traditional planning strategies often construct a pathway towards the future, commencing from the present. Conversely, backcasting takes a radically different approach; it begins with a clear vision of the end and works its way backwards.

We start from our envisioned future state and painstakingly decipher the route that led us there. We delve into the transformations that unfolded, the decisions we undertook, and the actions we executed to convert our imagined future into our present reality. The systemic dynamics must not be overlooked; systems are inherently designed to sustain the status quo. Therefore, a substantial amount of innovative thinking is essential to identify the resistance emanating from the system and strategize ways to overcome these barriers.

A Dance with the Future

It's a fascinating dance between time and possibility - a dance that challenges us, pushes our boundaries, and ultimately transforms us. In this way, both futurecasting and backcasting serve as pivotal tools in our quest to actualize the future. Together, they equip us with the foresight and the roadmap to pioneer transformation, staying one step ahead of the curve. It's this blend of strategic imagination and analytical rigor that positions a Kingdom Company to not just foresee the future, but to seize it and shape it according to God's will on Earth.

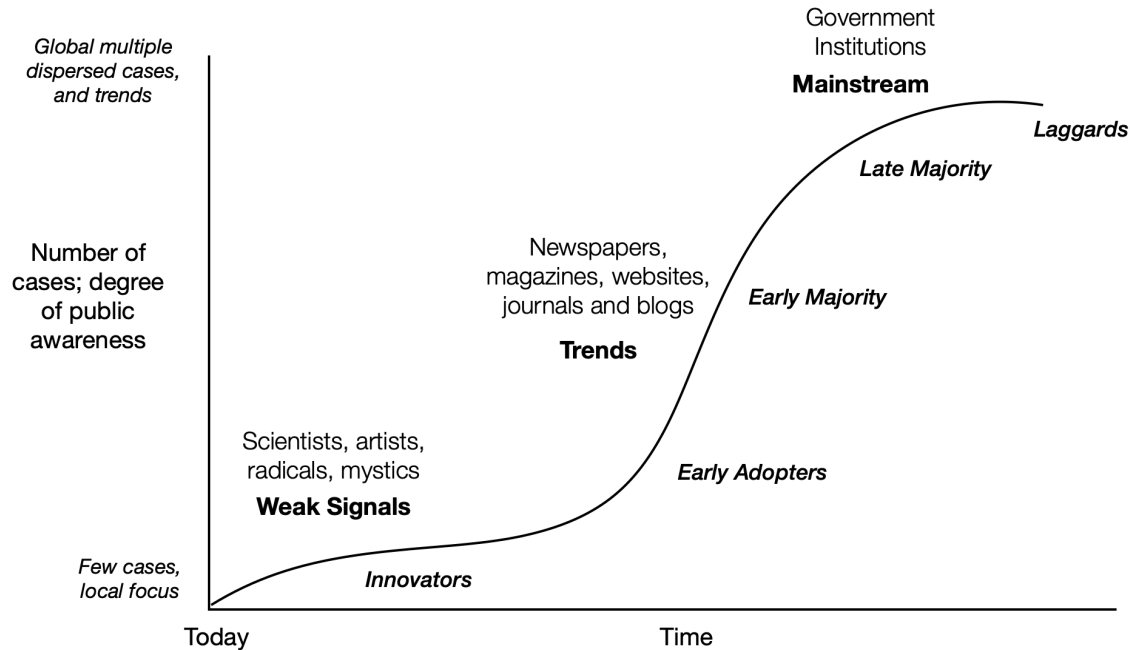
Consider the journey of TOMS Shoes. Founder Blake Mycoskie started with a vision – a future where every child had shoes. He then backcasted from this future, identifying key steps like the "One for One" business model, which made his vision achievable. Today, TOMS Shoes has given millions of pairs of shoes to children in need, making Mycoskie's envisioned future a reality.

Both futurecasting and backcasting are integral to Imaginal Thinking. They give us not only the foresight to see where we want to go but also the insight to chart the best course there. They break us free from the confines of linear thinking and open us up to a world of infinite possibilities. And more than that, they empower us to not just react to the future, but to actively shape it.

In a world that's rapidly and relentlessly changing, the ability to imagine, learn from, and create our future isn't just a competitive advantage; it's a necessity. Futurecasting and backcasting are tools in our Imaginal Thinking arsenal that empower us to do just that. Through these methodologies, we become the architects of our destiny, crafting a future that aligns with our deepest visions and highest aspirations. This is the true power and promise of Imaginal Thinking.

As an Imaginal Organization, let us not merely gaze into the future, but grasp it. Let us not just imagine the possibilities, but ignite them. In the dance of futurecasting and backcasting, let us choreograph our path towards the future we desire. The future is ours to create. Let's make it count.

S Curve Analysis



Adapted for the work of Graham Molitor, Wendy Schultz and Everett Rogers

“Men” of Issachar- Understanding the Times

Drawing inspiration from the biblical men (women) of Issachar (1 Chronicles 12:32), Imaginal Leaders practice the diligent scanning of knowledge landscapes. This is not a quest for information for its own sake, but rather a meticulous discernment process, interpreting signs of the times, and grasping the essence of our times.

Just as the men of Issachar understood their times and knew the way forward, Imaginal Leaders analyze vast data, trends, and emerging issues to chart the course ahead. This isn't haphazard reading; it's to spotlight novel policy matters, cutting-edge technologies, and budding concepts that could evolve into significant trends or change-drivers.

The power lies not just in the information quantity, but also its source. Where these sources sit on the information curve influences their relevance and innovation.

This knowledge quest equips Imaginal Leaders with the ability to bring foresighted ideas into conversations, meetings, or workshops. It's not about being the conversation's star, but about staying ahead of the curve, foreseeing change, and steering a course through future uncertainties.

S Curve Trend Analysis



Trends: The Chronicles of Change

A trend is essentially a measurable and consistent change that unfolds over a period of time. Think of it as a historical narrative that describes a particular progression or evolution. It's a story written in data points and discernible patterns, painting a picture of how things have transformed.

Trends provide a lens through which we can examine the changes that have been occurring in our environment. Owing to their measurable nature, trends are often plotted on graphs, offering a visual representation of the course of change. These trend lines are our timelines of transformation, speaking volumes about past shifts and current states.

In a way, we listen to what trends have to say about the future. We use them to extrapolate potential continuations of the current trajectory. Though it's crucial to note that while trends can hint at future possibilities, they are essentially recounting the past and present.

S Curve Trend Analysis: Mapping Change

When it comes to trend analysis, it's about charting the ecosystem of change. Given their quantitative nature, trends often form the bedrock of future forecasting.

Trends are commonly depicted as S curves, a graphical representation that illustrates various stages of a trend's maturity. This curve encompasses the life cycle of a trend, from its inception to its eventual decline.

Trends usually initiate as weak signals, which are embryonic ideas or developments that haven't yet permeated mainstream consciousness. These weak signals are often the spark of innovation, attracting forward-thinking individuals who see potential where others don't.

These innovators serve as the pioneers of trend adoption. They understand the significance of the weak signal and become early adopters, creating the initial data that sets the trend in motion.

Following the early adopters are the early majority. By this stage, the trend is no longer a whisper, but a conversation. It's being discussed in the media and is starting to influence broader societal, economic, or technological landscapes.

The late majority joins next, usually playing catch-up with the changes that have taken hold. Finally, we have the laggards, who are typically resistant to change and hold on to the "old ways". It's important to differentiate between laggards and traditionalists. While the former resist change of any kind, the latter uphold enduring values and worldviews, which can often be a valuable trait.

Creating an S Curve Trends Map:

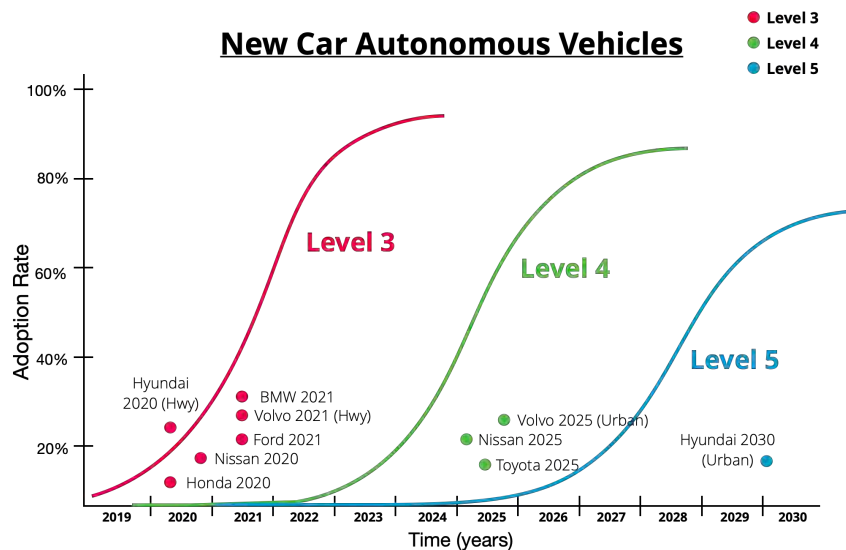
1. **Define the Trend or Technology:** Start by clearly identifying the trend or technology you want to analyze. It could be a new product, service, or a cultural shift in your field of interest.
2. **Research Expert Predictions:** Conduct thorough research to understand what experts in the field are predicting about this trend or technology. This could involve reading scientific papers, industry reports, blogs, and even social media posts from thought leaders. Be sure to get a broad range of perspectives to gain a comprehensive understanding.
3. **Identify the Stages of Adoption:** Based on your research, identify where the trend or technology currently sits within the adoption lifecycle. This is usually divided into five stages: innovators, early adopters, early majority, late majority, and laggards.
4. **Plot the Adoption Stages on the S Curve:** Draw a horizontal timeline on a graph, typically spanning from the present to the predicted saturation point of the trend or technology. Then, create a vertical line representing the adoption rate. Begin plotting the stages of adoption on the S curve starting with innovators at the bottom, early adopters as the curve starts to rise, early majority at the steepest point of the curve, late majority as the curve starts to flatten, and laggards at the top where the curve completely flattens.
5. **Extrapolate the Future:** Based on the current position of the trend or technology on the S curve and expert predictions, project its future trajectory along the curve. This is where your expert predictions come into play, as they help forecast how fast the adoption will grow and when it might reach saturation.
6. **Revise as Necessary:** As time progresses and the trend or technology continues to evolve, revisit your S Curve Trends Map. You may need to adjust your predictions based on new information, shifts in the market, or changes in the trend or technology itself. Always keep in mind that the S Curve is a model and while it can provide valuable insights, it's based on predictions and assumptions that may not fully materialize.

S Curve Poster

Overview

Autonomous vehicles are rated by the degree the vehicle can drive without human intervention. Level 5 is fully autonomous and may still be a number of years before they come to market. Currently, Level 3 and some level 4 vehicles are being sold by most manufacturers.

Autonomous vehicles will disrupt many industries such as automobile sales, insurance, trucking, bussing, agriculture, etc.



Level 3 automation

requires a human driver, but the human is able to put some "safety-critical functions" to the vehicle

Level 4 automation

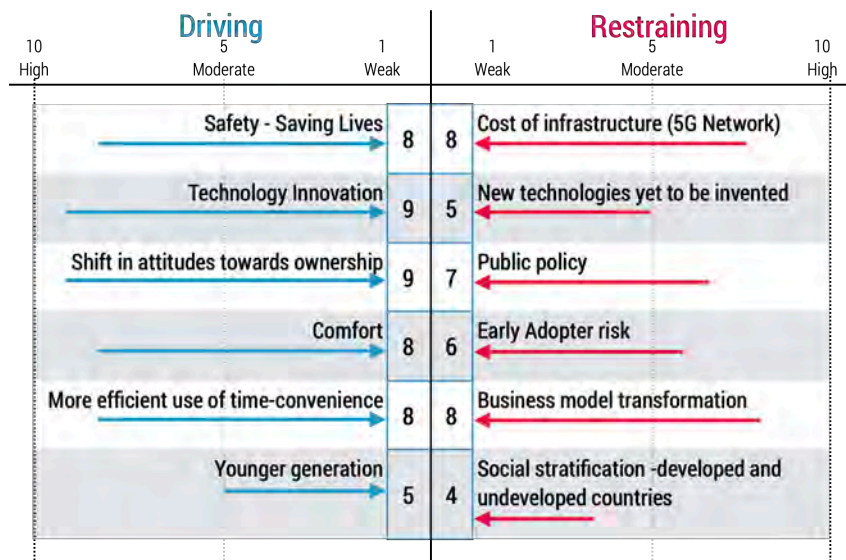
is a car that can drive itself almost all the time

Level 5 automation

means full automation in all conditions

Force Field Analysis

What are the restraining and driving forces for implementing Level 5 AV.



Autonomous Vehicle Disruption

While the long-term benefits of AV's are genuinely exciting, the route to true autonomy in transportation will likely be long and full of uncertainty.

The impact of AVs on transportation will be as significant as Karl Benz and Henry Ford at the beginning of the 20th Century

Every industry will be affected. Some will find themselves disrupted; others will find new opportunities for growth and innovation. Both outcomes create a pressing need for businesses to understand the current direction of AV travel, and to develop a plan to prepare for a future in which AV use is widespread.

S Curve Poster



Students Becoming Imaginal

During the 2017-18 academic year, students at Master's College embarked on a transformative journey where they used the Imaginal Thinking process to envision, learn from, and shape the future. This involved a comprehensive, year-long program that was not just confined to traditional classroom learning, but extended to delving deep into the dynamics of various sectors and industries of the future.

A pivotal tool in this exploratory journey was the S Curve Poster. More than just a visual aid, it was a consolidated report of the students' extensive research on future trends. Each poster highlighted a specific trend, painted an insightful narrative of its evolution, and presented an S Curve Analysis based on the students' intensive research. The S Curve Analysis acted as a visual representation of the growth, maturity, and decline phases of the trend, providing an insight into its life cycle.

But the exploration didn't stop there. Along with the S Curve Analysis, the students carried out a Force Field Analysis. This analysis identified and quantified the driving forces that propelled the trend forward and the restraining forces that hindered its progress. The results offered a balanced view of the positive and negative influences that affected the trend, allowing for a comprehensive understanding of the forces at play.

To round off their research, students provided a summary of the impact of the trend. This involved extrapolating the potential ramifications of the trend based on current data and predictions, thereby providing a glimpse into the possible future that the trend could shape.

Through this rigorous process, the students at Master's College not only gained a deep understanding of various trends but also sharpened their analytical skills, honed their foresight, and prepared themselves for a rapidly evolving future. The S Curve Poster, thus, served as both a snapshot of their academic journey and a testament to their growing capabilities as Imaginal Leaders.

Imaginal Organization and the Issachar Mandate

In the annals of biblical history, the sons of Issachar were commended for their unique understanding of the times and the discerning knowledge of what Israel ought to do (1 Chronicles 12:32). This extraordinary ability to interpret the signs of their era was not just a testament to their wisdom but also a mandate for strategic action. In the

modern context, this can be termed as the 'Issachar Mandate' - a call to perceive the signs of the times and act upon that understanding.

Imaginal Organizations, in pursuit of this Issachar Mandate, leverage tools like the S Curve Poster. This tool aids in identifying, analyzing, and visualizing trends that shape the future, making the "signs" explicit. An S Curve Poster is more than a piece of data representation - it encapsulates the life cycle of a trend, taking into account its driving and restraining forces, and postulates its potential impact.

By creating an array of S Curve Posters, an Imaginal Organization can map the diverse range of trends influencing their industry and the world at large. Each poster provides a glimpse into a possible future trajectory, derived from extensive research and informed analysis. This comprehensive mapping empowers the organization to anticipate changes, make strategic decisions, and navigate the emerging landscape of the future more effectively.

Moreover, these S Curve Posters transition from being mere representations of trends to becoming vital knowledge artifacts. They are brought into Imaginal Workshops where their insights are used for deeper impact analysis and scenario development. In this way, they serve as crucial launching pads for further explorations into the future, setting the stage for robust and creative discussions, innovative ideation, and informed decision-making processes.

Through the Issachar Mandate, Imaginal Organizations not only align themselves with the evolving dynamics of the external world but also foster a culture of foresight and innovation internally. By discerning the signs of the times and understanding the potential impacts of these signs, they position themselves as leaders in their fields, shaping the future as much as they are shaped by it.

Museum of the Future

I often suggest that organizations establish a visual repository or a 'gallery' that exhibits the knowledge artifacts they've generated. This dynamic display serves as a testament to the organization's evolving perception and understanding of the future. The gallery becomes a tangible narrative of its growth, adaptation, and maturation in anticipating the future.

Future Wheel Impact Analysis

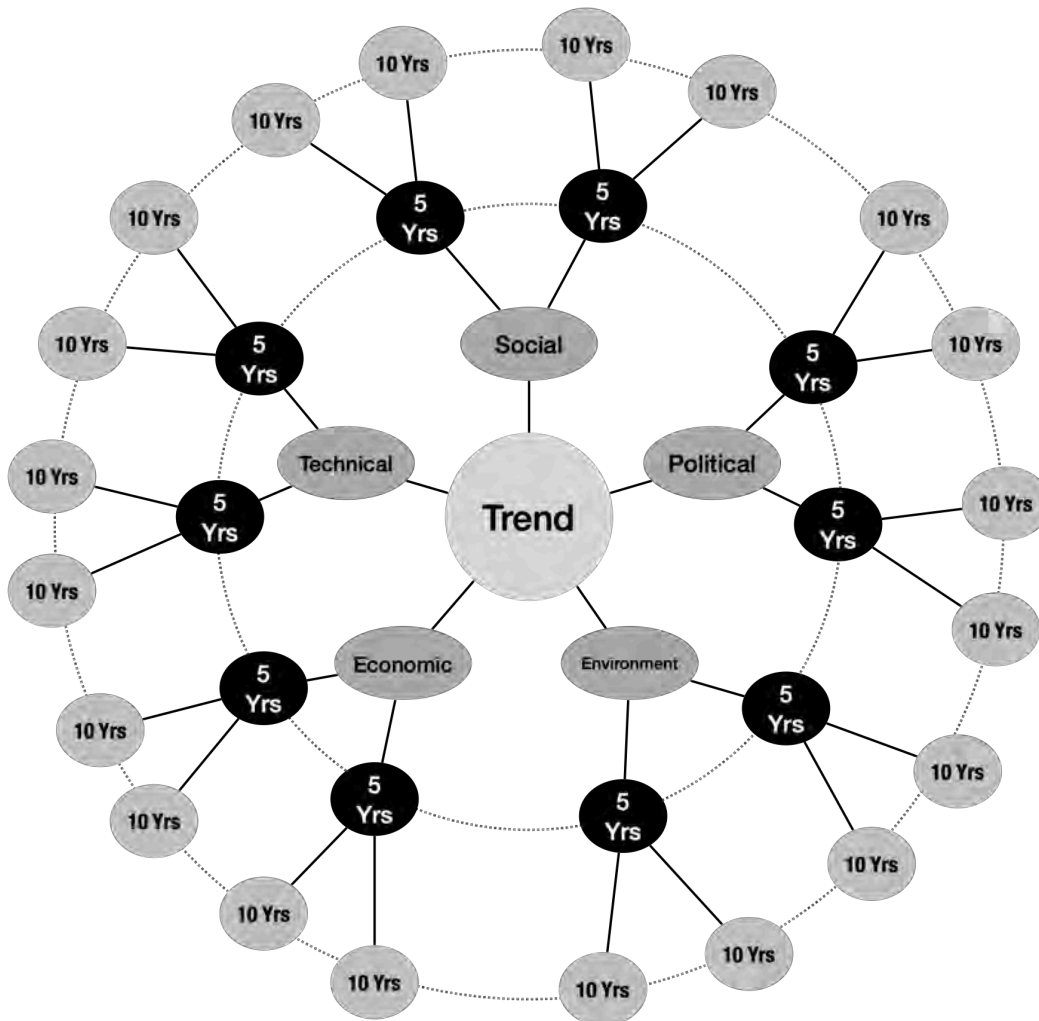


Fig. 1 Future Wheel

Example from Imaginal Workshop

Select Trends

Select the top 3 trends from your previous trends analysis step that will have the biggest impact on your sector. Your team will take each of these trends to create a future wheel impact analysis on your sector. After you have done the first Future Wheel Analysis as a group, divide into teams and finish working on the remaining 2 future wheels.

Primary and Secondary Impacts

You will brainstorm the impact of your trend in your sector by 2030, these will be your primary impacts. After completing your primary impact analysis, you

will look at secondary impacts. These impacts will be set in 2040 and are a consequence or a derivative of the primary impact. If possible try to create one secondary impact for every primary impact.

Note: Our world is facing an acceleration in the rate of change, meaning that amount and rate of change from 2030-2040 will be much higher than from 2020-2030. Try and reflect this premise as you create your primary and secondary impacts. You will need to have an active imagination if you are going to see the 2040 future.

Future Wheel



Descriptor:

The Future Wheel is a practical foresight tool that allows individuals and organizations to explore and visualize the potential impacts of a given trend, decision, or event. It's a way of mapping potential cause-and-effect relationships, providing a visual representation of possible consequences and their subsequent impacts.

To construct a Future Wheel, one begins by identifying a specific emerging trend or key issue, which is placed at the center of the diagram. This central idea acts as the seed from which all subsequent ramifications sprout, forming a ripple effect of potential outcomes that extend outward.

The process then involves systematically identifying and recording the immediate or primary impacts that could arise from the central trend or issue over a short-term horizon, typically the next twelve months. These primary impacts are the direct and immediate consequences, and they are often drawn as spokes radiating out from the hub of the wheel.

To ensure a comprehensive exploration, these impacts can be examined across various areas or dimensions, such as social, technological, economic, environmental, and political (STEEP) factors. Alternatively, one could focus on specific areas related to the central topic.

Next, the process delves deeper into the ripple effect by investigating secondary impacts. These are consequences that result from the primary impacts, often materializing within a 3 to 5-year timeframe. They represent the second ripple on the wheel, spreading outward from the primary impacts.

Finally, tertiary impacts are considered, looking 10 to 20 years into the future. These are the outcomes that arise from the secondary impacts, forming the outermost layer of the ripple effect. Naturally, there would be fewer tertiary impacts, owing to their distant timeline and the increasing complexity and uncertainty of predicting far-reaching effects.

The Future Wheel provides a visual and structured approach to futures thinking. By considering the cascading impacts of a trend, decision, or event, one can better anticipate and prepare for potential changes, challenges, and opportunities. It helps foster a deep and nuanced understanding of the multifaceted nature of change, offering valuable insights for strategic planning and decision-making.

Purpose:

The purpose of the Future Wheel mapping is to systematically dissect a trend's impacts over varying time frames, providing a comprehensive snapshot of potential future scenarios. It aids in understanding the dynamics of change and the interconnectedness of future outcomes.

This tool not only deepens our understanding of a trend but also broadens our view of the future landscape. By illuminating potential scenarios, it aids in strategic planning and decision-making, helping organizations navigate future complexities and shape their trajectory.

How to... :

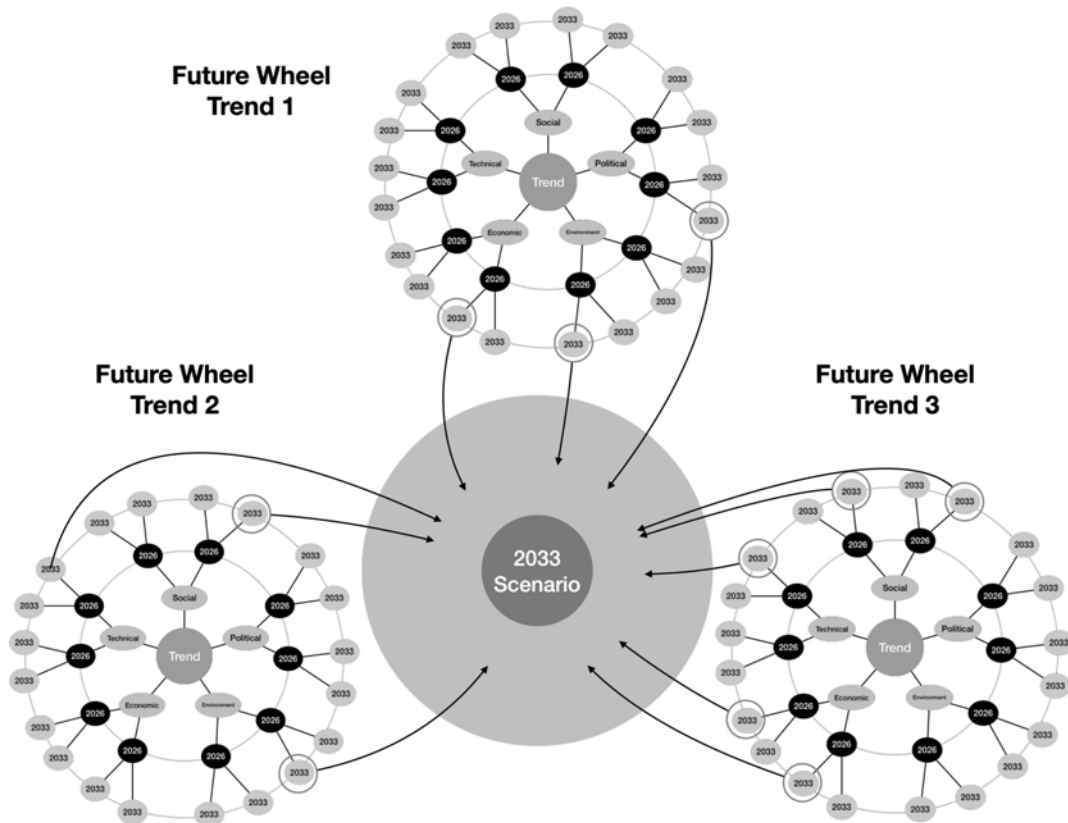
1. Write the name of a trend you want to explore in the middle circle. Describe it – for example, artificial intelligence becomes a reality across all work functions
2. Brainstorm possible impacts of the trend across a range of domains – social, technology, economic, environmental, political, values in the near future (12 months). These are primary impacts. Put them in circles and connect them to the trend. These are often impacts being felt today.

3. For each primary impact, brainstorm two or three secondary impacts (3-5 year timeframe). These could be longer term impacts. Put them in circles and connect them to the relevant primary impact.
4. You can then work on each secondary impact in the same way to identify tertiary impacts (10-20 year timeframe).
5. Look for connections between the impacts.
6. Consider the implications of the map you have created – for policy, planning, opportunities, threats – how might you need to respond

Expectations or Benchmarks:

1. For each trend you need a minimum of 5 primary impacts
2. For each primary impact you need a minimum of 2 secondary impacts
3. For each secondary impact you need a minimum of 2 tertiary impacts

Manoa Method



Manoa Method Examples

Long-Term Urban Planning:

Using the Manoa Method, city planners could create three distinct futures wheels based on the STEEP sectors to address the future of urban life. The first wheel might focus on social and technological changes, envisioning a future where remote work and virtual reality redefine the nature of urban living. The second wheel might incorporate economic and environmental factors, projecting a future where green economy initiatives and sustainable city designs are the norm. The third wheel could focus on political shifts, imagining a future where local governance is revolutionized through the use of blockchain technology and participatory democracy. Each of these future wheels would offer a significantly divergent future, challenging planners to think beyond current assumptions and paradigms.

Future of Work:

The Manoa Method could be used by a human resources consulting firm to forecast future changes in the labor market. One futures wheel could center on technological and economic shifts, projecting a future where automation and artificial intelligence dominate the workplace. Another wheel might focus on social and political changes, envisioning a future where there's greater emphasis on work-life balance and employee rights, driven by societal and policy changes. The third wheel could consider environmental and technological changes, imagining a future where most work is done remotely to reduce carbon footprint. By contrasting these divergent futures against the current reality, the consulting firm can better prepare their clients for the potential changes ahead.

Manoa Method



Descriptor:

The Manoa Method is a strategic tool hailing from the discipline of Futures Studies. It capitalizes on the interplay between three distinct Futures Wheels derived from different STEEP (Social, Technological, Economic, Environmental, and Political) sectors. This method fosters the development of comprehensive and varied scenarios that help envision the myriad potentialities of the future.

The Manoa Method is utilized to craft a multitude of alternative futures, each diverging significantly from the present and from one another. Its distinct focus lies in highlighting and intensifying the differences between potential futures and the current reality. This approach challenges entrenched assumptions and paradigms and facilitates an enhanced understanding of the lessons the future can offer.

Application:

Constructing future scenarios with the Manoa Method necessitates the creation of a suite of alternative futures. These futures, in turn, provide rich grounds for probing an array of issues or interests.

Manoa brings a unique perspective by urging you to examine the confluence of three diverse trends, each represented by a Futures Wheel from different STEEP sectors. The intersection and interaction of these trends are where the power of the Manoa Method lies.

For each trend, a Futures Wheel is constructed, extending 20-30 years into the future. This involves exploring the primary, secondary, and tertiary impacts of the trend.

The true learning emerges when you start to analyze the three wheels collectively. It's about understanding their interconnections, interactions, and the influence they might exert on the different impacts you envisaged.

These interactions will serve as the foundation for your scenario building. By challenging and scrutinizing them deeply, you can formulate narratives that truly deviate from today's reality.

After scrutinizing several emerging trends and their potential trajectories, extract the beneficial insights. Identify the lessons gleaned from each prospective future and pathway that you've explored.

Identify the key connections that underpin these futures. Recognize the new patterns, events, or dynamics that are beginning to surface. Gradually, a vision of the future will crystallize.

This process, ultimately, will enrich your understanding of your focus area. Each additional Futures Wheel will

contribute a fresh perspective, deepening your comprehension and allowing you to navigate the future with more confidence and clarity.

Manoa Method Steps

Step 1: Identify Three Diverse Trends

Start by identifying three diverse trends from three different STEEP (Social, Technological, Economic, Environmental, and Political) sectors.

Step 2: Create Three Futures Wheels

For each of the three trends, create a Futures Wheel. Extend your projections at least 30 years into the future to allow for ample scope for transformation.

Step 3: Examine the Interconnections

Begin examining the three wheels collectively. Look for areas of overlap and interconnections between the trends and their impacts. Understand how these trends might interact and influence each other, and how they could collectively shape the future.

Step 4: Map the Interactions

Map out where the multiple changes intersect. Consider how these intersections might amplify or accelerate other changes. Similarly, identify where the changes might limit or slow down other transformations.

Step 5: Develop Scenarios

Use these mapped intersections and interactions as building blocks for your scenarios. Challenge and explore these interactions deeply, and then build narratives that deviate significantly from today's reality. These narratives should offer a wide range of potential futures, each one unique and different from the present.

Step 6: Analyze the Scenarios

After you've constructed several potential futures, start analyzing them. Look for patterns, emerging events, and key connections that can offer valuable insights. Determine what you can learn from each potential future and how this could inform your decision-making in the present.

Step 7: Reflect on the Findings

Finally, reflect on your findings. What picture of the future has emerged? How have the other future wheels contributed to your understanding of your area of focus? This final step is about synthesizing your insights and understanding how these future scenarios can influence your current strategies and actions.

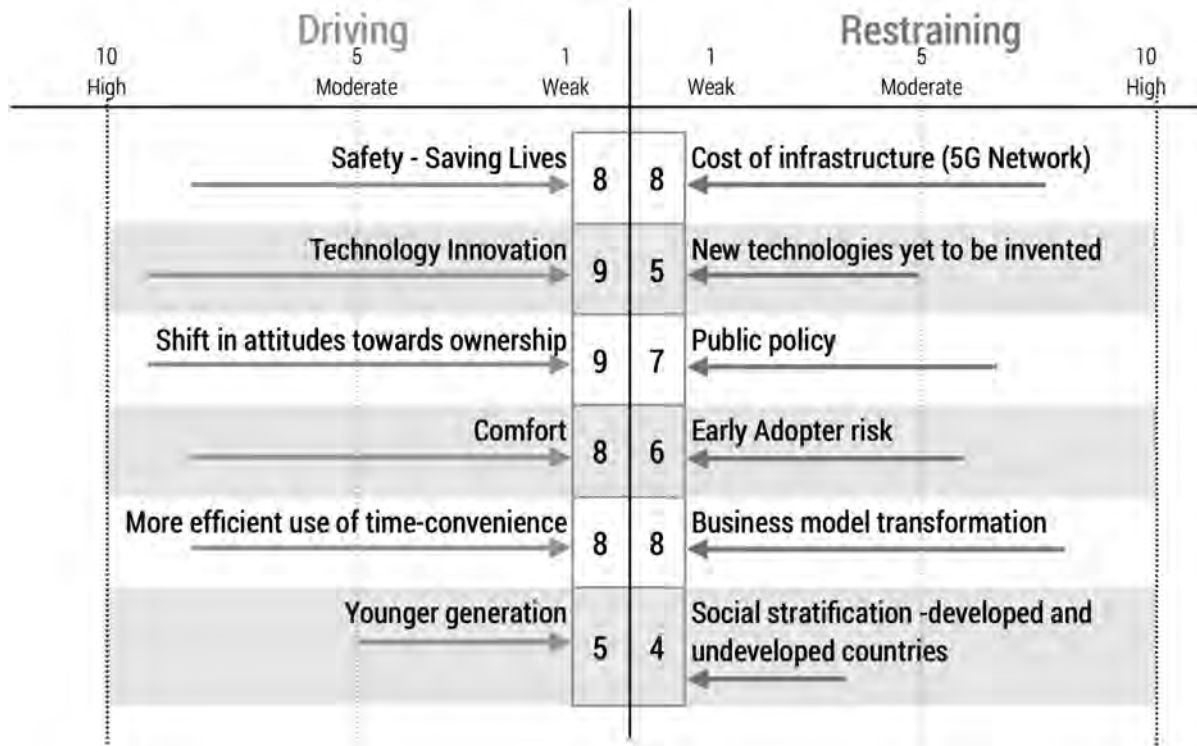
Part III

Imaginal System Tools

"The most important thing to understand is that systems determine the majority of performance, not individual performance; and that the system that people work in and the interaction with people may account for 90 or 95 percent of performance." –W. Edwards Deming

Force Field Analysis

What are the restraining and driving forces for implementing Level 5 AV.



Force Field Analysis Examples

Implementing a New Technology: When introducing new technology into an organization, driving forces might include increased efficiency, reduced manual labor, and staying competitive in the market. On the other hand, restraining forces could be employee resistance to change, high implementation cost, or a lack of necessary skills.

Introducing a New Policy: If a company plans to introduce a new environmental policy, driving forces might be enhancing company reputation, meeting regulatory requirements, and potential cost savings through energy efficiency. However, restraining forces might be the initial financial investment, potential operational disruptions, and resistance from employees or suppliers.

Mergers and Acquisitions: In the case of a proposed merger, driving forces could be access to new markets, increased resources, and business growth. Conversely, restraining forces might include culture clash, staff morale issues, and regulatory hurdles.

In each of these examples, a Force Field Analysis can provide invaluable insights, enabling teams to chart a more informed, strategic, and successful path to change. By acknowledging the forces at play, organizations can minimize resistance, leverage support, and steer their initiatives towards the desired outcome.

Force Field Analysis



Descriptor:

Force Field Analysis is a powerful tool that helps analysts delve deeper into the intricate dynamics influencing the acceptance of a particular trend within a system. Every system is subject to driving and restraining forces, also known as reinforcing and balancing loops, which dictate the behavior of the system. The Force Field Analysis aims to uncover these often obscured forces, providing valuable insights for impact analysis and scenario development.

Purpose:

Force Field Analysis serves as a graphical representation of potential driving and restraining forces impacting a specific situation. It becomes particularly useful when a team embarks on determining the best approach to implementing successful change, providing a clear depiction of challenges and opportunities that lie ahead.

Understanding System Dynamics: The Force Field Analysis brings forth the underlying dynamics of a system that might not be apparent at the surface level. These hidden dynamics can significantly influence the outcome of your change initiatives.

Planning and Decision Making: By understanding the restraining and driving forces, teams can make informed decisions, develop effective strategies, and anticipate possible resistance or support. This foresight helps in planning realistic timelines and mitigating potential risks.

Promoting Dialogue: The tool promotes open conversation within teams, fostering mutual understanding and collective problem-solving. By evaluating each force's relative strength, members can challenge assumptions, stimulate debate, and encourage diverse perspectives.

Example:

Implementing a New Technology: When introducing new technology into an organization, driving forces might include increased efficiency, reduced manual labor, and staying competitive in the market. On the other hand, restraining forces could be employee resistance to change, high implementation cost, or a lack of necessary skills.

Creating a Force Field Analysis:

Initiate the Setup:

Draw a vertical line down the center of a large flip chart or piece of paper. Label the left column as "Driving Forces" and the right column as "Restraining Forces."

Define the Issue:

Clearly articulate a question that delineates the issue under investigation. This step provides the context for the analysis.

Brainstorm Forces:

Spend 5 to 10 minutes brainstorming potential driving and restraining forces. Each force should be written on a separate sticky note, giving team members the flexibility to suggest either a restraining or driving force.

Group and Categorize:

Utilize the Affinity Diagramming technique to group the results from the brainstorming session. Make sure the category headings are specific enough to differentiate between the forces.

Position the Headers:

Place the headers for the driving and restraining forces in their respective columns, aligning them with the appropriate categorizations.

Assess the Strength:

Team members are asked to provide a subjective assessment of the force's strength. These individual assessments are then averaged to determine the collective strength of the force as perceived by the group.

Illustrate the Forces:

Draw arrows with lengths reflecting the particular strength of each force and mark it with a score. The lengths of the arrows visually represent the power of each force, adding a further dimension to the analysis.

Remember, the Force Field Analysis is not just a tool to visualize the status quo; it is a means to stimulate discussions, encourage critical thinking, and promote collective problem-solving. By understanding these forces, teams can strategize more effectively to leverage driving forces and mitigate restraining ones, ultimately navigating towards the desired future.

Consensogram

Consensogram

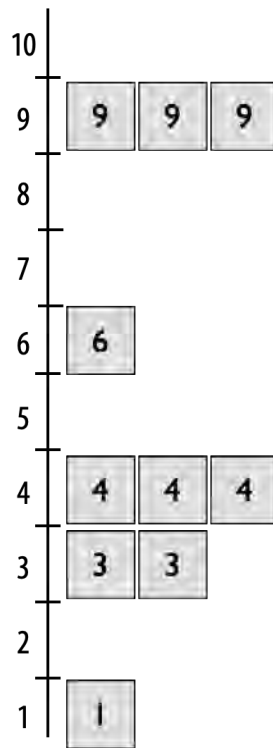
On a post-it note rate

- How well are schools in your District preparing students for the world of massive change ?
- Pick a number from 1- 10 that represents your response- (subjective judgement)

10 - Very well

5 - generally OK

1- Very poorly



Post Consensogram Dialogue

- Why is there so much variation?
- Is there a right answer?
- Do we really want to know the answer?
- Implications of knowing and not knowing.
- Is this a system problem or a people problem or both?

Consensogram Examples

Assessing Employee Engagement: A company might use a consensogram to gauge employee commitment to a new workplace initiative, such as flexible work hours or a diversity and inclusion program. This can help identify potential resistance, enthusiasm, or indifference within the team.

Evaluating Classroom Methodologies: In an educational context, teachers could use this method to assess students' comfort with a teaching style or a new curriculum. It can highlight if a significant number of students are struggling or if the majority finds the methodology effective.

Community Decision Making: Local community bodies might use a Consensogram to understand community sentiment about a proposed development project or a policy change, providing a more comprehensive picture of community opinion.

In each of these scenarios, the consensogram provides a tangible snapshot of group sentiment, ensuring every voice is considered in the decision-making process. This democratic approach to feedback can foster a more inclusive, empathetic, and effective group dynamic

Consensogram



Consensogram: A Tool for Group Feedback

Descriptor:

The Consensogram is an ingenious tool characterized by its efficiency and visual impact. It is designed to facilitate the collection and display of group sentiments, emphasizing the diversity of views within the group. Rather than being skewed by a few strong voices, the Consensogram sheds light on the myriad perspectives present, making it a powerful method for hearing and acknowledging all voices.

Purpose:

At its core, the Consensogram is a potent technique for capturing and presenting the group's collective views. Its uniqueness lies in its ability to focus on the aggregate rather than individual elements, thereby creating a platform where every voice is equally significant, not just those that are typically louder or more assertive.

By deviating from conventional group dynamics where a handful of influential voices often disproportionately direct discussions or decisions, the Consensogram enables a more balanced distribution of input. This approach ensures each group member has an equal opportunity to express their view, fostering an atmosphere of respect and participative engagement, leading to a more complete understanding of the group's collective feelings.

The Consensogram's visualization of these collective views is particularly powerful. It offers an immediate and comprehensible representation of opinion spread and intensity, making the data engaging and easy to interpret. Such visual representation aids in quickly identifying trends, areas of consensus, and outliers, making it a vital tool for informed decision-making. Additionally, it can spotlight areas of disagreement that may need further exploration, thus shaping the group's subsequent action plans.

In summary, the Consensogram is more than a tool for capturing viewpoints. It stands as a tribute to the richness of diversity in thought and opinion. It emphasizes the importance of each participant's input, crafting a vibrant, true-to-life representation of collective perspectives that capture the essence of the group's dynamics. Consequently, it is an indispensable tool for groups that value respect for diverse viewpoints and effective, inclusive decision-making.

Creating a Consensogram:

Material Preparation: Provide each participant with a sticky note of identical size. In a virtual setting, you might utilize an online polling system like Mentimeter.

Question Formulation: Formulate a clear, concise question for self-assessment. Avoid ambiguity, as unclear questions can yield unreliable results. For instance, "On a scale of 0% to 100%, how committed are you to implementing Profound Learning in our school?" is more precise than, "How committed are you to transforming our school?"

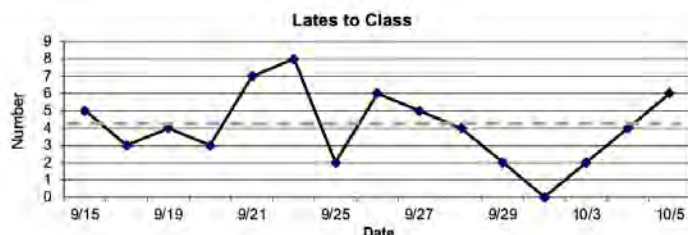
Individual Response: Ask each participant to write a number (in increments of 10%) on their sticky note that reflects their stance or feeling towards the question. Encourage honest responses, and emphasize that this is an anonymous process - no names or additional comments should be added. Ensure that all answers lie within the 0% - 100% range.

Collection and Assembly: Collect all sticky notes, face down, to maintain anonymity. Arrange them on a smooth wall to form a Bar Chart. This visual representation helps to quickly identify patterns and trends in the group's collective viewpoint.

Group Analysis: As a team, observe the distribution of results. The visualization will help guide further discussion and action on the issue, highlighting areas of consensus, contention, or concern.

Run Chart

Project: Lates to Class		
Recorder: Sam Brown		
Purpose: Record late's for Mat 7A class		
Time Sequence	Data	Comment
15-Sep	5	
18-Sep	3	
19-Sep	4	
20-Sep	3	
21-Sep	7	Special assembly
22-Sep	8	
25-Sep	2	
26-Sep	6	
27-Sep	5	2 major test this week
28-Sep	4	
29-Sep	2	Teacher lectured us on being on time
2-Oct	0	
3-Oct	2	
4-Oct	4	
5-Oct	6	
6-Oct	5	
10-Oct	3	
Average	4.06	



Check List

Class Discussion Gender Analysis

	Day 1		Day 2		Day 3		Day 4		Day 5	
	Boys	Girls	Boys	Girls	Boys	Girls	Boys	Girls	Boys	Girls
Language Arts 8A										
Responding to Questions	 1	 111	 111	 111	 1	 111	 1	 111	 11	 11
Asking Questions	11	 11	11	 1	 1111	1111	11	 1	111	
Follow-up Comments			 1	 111	 1	 1	11	11	111	 1
Total	13	20	14	22	20	15	8	14	10	18
Science 8A										
Responding to Questions	 1		 1		 111	 1			 1	 1
Asking Questions		11	1111		 1	 1			 1	
Follow-up Comments	 1	111	111	111	 1	111	 1	1111	11	1111
Total	17	10	12	14	17	16	18	14	13	15

Were the students aware that their behaviour was being monitored?

How did the observation and collection of data affect behaviour?

Run Chart

Run Chart

A Run Chart is a graphical representation of data over time, typically presented as a line graph.

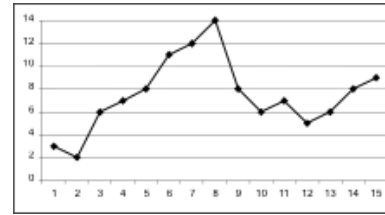
Purpose:

The key intention behind constructing a Run Chart is to evaluate the behavior of a system as time progresses. By systematically collecting and plotting data, any existing trends or patterns can be identified and analyzed.

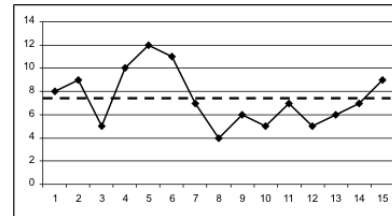
Creating a Run Chart:

1. Create a data sheet.
2. Enter time or date when the data was recorded
3. Enter value or data in the second column
4. Record any comments that may have impacted the data.
5. Plot Run Chart (Use Excel template)
6. Calculate the average and plot it on the chart.
7. Look for evidence of a special cause of variation. A special cause for variation is a source that is not inherent to the process but arises because of specific circumstances. It's an unexpected or abnormal cause. Contrasted with common causes, which are an inherent part of a process and expected to occur, special causes are unusual events or circumstances. Tests for special causes of variation:

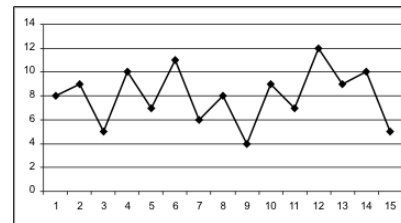
- 6 or more consecutive points all going up or all going down



- 8 or more points in a row all on one side of the average



- 14 or more consecutive points alternating up or down



Check List

Check List

The Check List is a structured, itemized list used to ensure consistency and completeness in carrying out tasks, collecting data, or meeting specific criteria. It organizes tasks or criteria into a systematic approach, allowing users to track progress and ensure that no step or detail is overlooked.

Purpose:

The primary purpose of the Check List Tool is to enhance reliability and accuracy in task execution or data collection. By providing a visual representation of what needs to be done, it minimizes the possibility of omissions and errors, ensuring that procedures, tasks, or verifications are performed thoroughly and consistently. Whether used in daily routines, professional settings, or complex projects, it serves as a roadmap to guarantee that all necessary steps are identified and completed.

Creating a Check List:

1. **Define the Subject:** What's the main topic or theme under investigation?
 1. Example: Gender differences during classroom discussions in Language Arts compared to Science.
2. **Determine Data Requirements:** What specifics are we tracking?
 1. Responding to questions

2. Asking questions
3. Making follow-up comments
3. **Design the Matrix:** Set up a table with relevant categories and columns.
4. **Gather Data:** Use the Check Sheet to consistently record observations.
5. **Evaluate the Check Sheet:**
 1. Are participants aware they're being observed, and does that alter their behavior?
 2. Does the act of observation impact results?
 3. Are additional categories necessary?
 4. Are the established categories clear and distinct enough for accurate data collection?
6. **Data Analysis:** Once collected, data can be further analyzed using tools like Pareto Charts, Scatter Diagrams, Run Charts, and more.

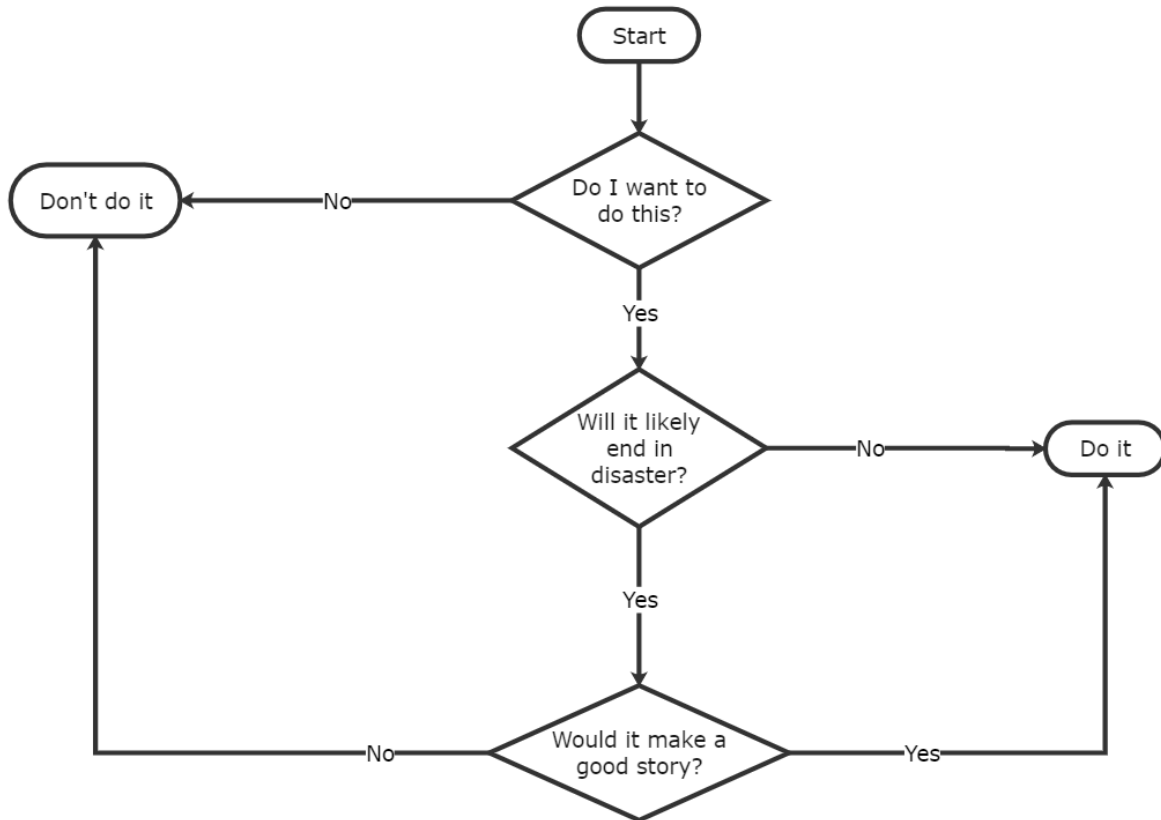
Points of Caution:

The efficacy of a Check Sheet heavily depends on its design. Clarity is crucial—every individual gathering data should have a lucid understanding of what's being captured. Remember, a Check Sheet offers data, not conclusions.

Be mindful of the "Hawthorne Effect": when individuals modify their behavior due to the realization that they're being observed. This can skew data, so it's crucial to factor this in during analysis.

Flow Chart

Decision Flowchart



<https://www.edrawsoft.com/flowchart/flowchart-for-decision-making.html>

Flow Chart Examples

Software Development: A flowchart can illustrate the sequence of processes or tasks that need to be completed before a software is fully developed. This helps in clarifying the development cycle and ensuring everyone understands the workflow.

Business Operations: Companies might use flowcharts to show the process of order fulfillment, from the moment a customer places an order to the time it's delivered. This can help in identifying bottlenecks or inefficiencies.

Human Resources: HR departments could use flowcharts for the hiring process, starting from

receiving an application, shortlisting, interviewing, and finally to onboarding.

Customer Service: Flowcharts can depict the steps a service agent should follow when handling customer complaints. This ensures consistency in how customers are treated and can speed up resolution times.

Manufacturing: In manufacturing, a flowchart might show the journey of a product from raw materials to the finished product. It can help in monitoring quality and pinpoint stages where there might be delays.

Flow Chart



Descriptor:

A flow chart is a visual representation or diagram that illustrates a process or workflow. It uses symbols, shapes, and arrows to depict the various stages, steps, or tasks within a process, showing the sequence and interrelation of these elements in a clear and concise manner.

Purpose:

The primary objective of a flow chart is to provide a clear and straightforward visualization of how a particular process unfolds, from start to finish. By mapping out each step and the connections between them, flow charts enable users to understand, communicate, and analyze the components and structure of a process. This understanding helps in identifying bottlenecks, redundancies, or inefficiencies, facilitating process optimization and improved decision-making.

Flowcharts assist in:

- Evaluating if an existing process aligns with set standards by pinpointing how, when, or where to measure.
- Illustrating or detailing a current process.
- Proposing alterations to a process or pinpointing potential issues.
- Creating a brand-new process.
- Consider Flowcharts as navigational guides outlining steps for a specific task or assignment. Distinct symbols represent specific actions.

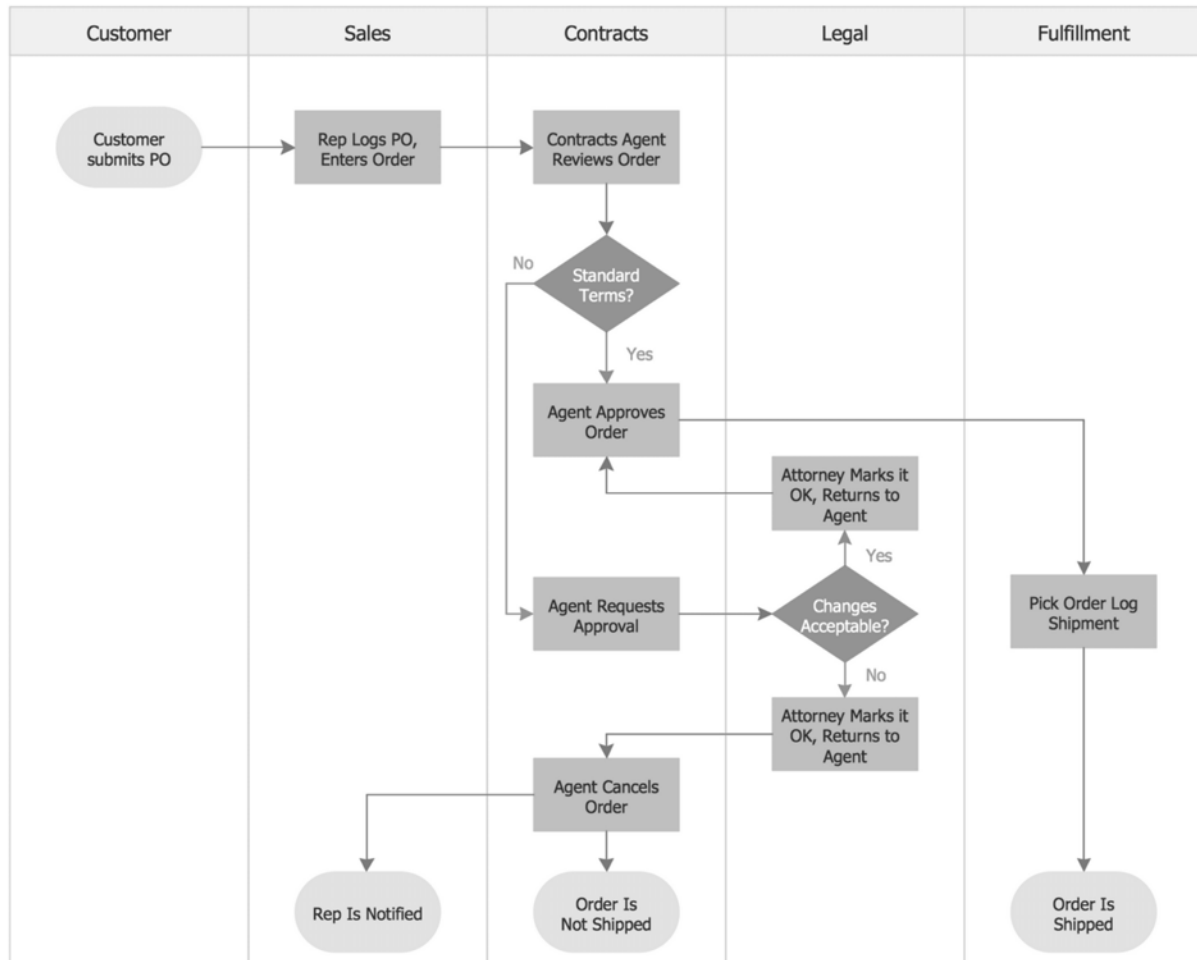
Creating a Check List:

1. Identify the department and define the process to be flowcharted.
2. Determine where the process begins and who starts the process. If others participate in the process, arrange for them to be interviewed.
3. Identify and list process steps, extending detail at this time only to the level needed for understanding.
4. Continue and complete all steps of the process.
5. Use a draft Flowchart for review and corrections, if needed. The final Flowchart may be used for improvements to the system. Draw a Flowchart of the improved process for future use.

Caution

Use a Flow Chart to document a simple process. These processes may or may not involve humans. A deployment flow chart should be used if more than one person is involved in the process.

Deployment Flow Chart



Deployment Flow Chart Examples

Product Development in a Tech Company:

Lanes: Design, Development, Testing, Marketing, and Customer Support.

Flow: Idea generation (Design) -> Wireframe creation (Design) -> Code development (Development) -> Initial testing (Testing) -> Marketing strategy creation (Marketing) -> Product release (Development) -> Customer feedback (Customer Support) -> Issue fixing (Development).

Hiring Process in a Corporation:

Lanes: Applicant, HR, Hiring Manager, Technical Team, and Onboarding Team.

Flow: Resume submission (Applicant) -> Initial screening (HR) -> First interview (HR) -> Technical interview (Technical Team) -> Final interview (Hiring Manager) -> Job offer (HR) -> Onboarding (Onboarding Team).

Deployment Flow Chart



Descriptor

A Deployment Flowchart, also known as a "cross-functional" or "swim lane" flowchart, is a type of flowchart that visualizes the flow of a process across different roles or departments within an organization. It maps out tasks and decision points, aligning them with the respective functional units responsible for their execution. Each lane in the flowchart represents a different function or department, making it easier to identify which unit is responsible for each step.

Purpose:

The primary aim of a Deployment Flowchart is to identify the interactions between different functional units throughout a process, ensuring that roles and responsibilities are clearly defined. By depicting the workflow across various departments, these flowcharts:

- Enhance inter-departmental coordination and communication.
- Identify bottlenecks, redundancies, or inefficiencies in the process.
- Improve understanding and training by clearly representing who does what and when.
- Facilitate smoother handovers between departments.
- Aid in process optimization by highlighting areas that need improvement.

Creating a Deployment Flowchart:

1. **Define the Process:** Clearly outline the process you want to represent. Ensure that you have a comprehensive understanding of its start, end, and all the steps in between.
2. **Identify Functional Units:** List out all departments, roles, or individuals that are part of the process. These will form the "lanes" or "swim lanes" in your flowchart.
3. **Determine the Flowchart's Scope:** Decide on the level of detail you wish to include. For more intricate processes, you might choose to start with a high-level flowchart before diving into more detailed ones.
4. **Draft the Flowchart:** Using flowchart software or paper, draw horizontal or vertical lanes representing each functional unit. Begin placing the process steps in the appropriate lanes.
5. **Use Standardized Symbols:** Stick to commonly recognized flowchart symbols: ovals for start/end, rectangles for processes, diamonds for decision points, and arrows for flow direction.
6. **Detail Interactions:** Highlight where the process moves between lanes, indicating interactions or handovers between departments.
7. **Review with Stakeholders:** Engage with representatives from each department to ensure accuracy and gather feedback. They might identify overlooked steps or suggest optimizations.
8. **Iterate and Refine:** Based on feedback, make necessary changes to the flowchart for better clarity or accuracy.
9. **Finalize and Distribute:** Once satisfied, finalize the flowchart and distribute it to all relevant parties. Ensure it's easily accessible and consider organizing training sessions if it's a new or revised process.
10. **Update as Needed:** Processes evolve over time. Regularly review and update the Deployment Flowchart to reflect any changes.

Note: While creating a Deployment Flowchart, always keep the audience in mind. Tailor the level of detail and complexity to the users' needs, ensuring it remains a useful and actionable tool.

Affinity Diagram

Brainstorm Ideas



Organize in Affinity Groupings



Category
Headers

Ideas

Affinity Diagram Examples

Project Management: A project team can use an Affinity Diagram to gather and categorize issues related to a project, making it easier to identify and solve problems. For example, during the testing phase of software development, multiple bugs may be discovered. An Affinity Diagram can be used to group these issues based on their characteristics, such as their source code location, type of error, or impact on the software's functionality.

Market Research: In a market research context, an Affinity Diagram could be used to analyze customer feedback. Data from surveys or interviews can be clustered into different categories, such as product features, customer

service, pricing, or brand perception, allowing the marketing team to uncover key insights and develop strategies more effectively.

Educational Setting: Teachers could use Affinity Diagrams to organize ideas from a classroom brainstorming session. For instance, while discussing the causes and effects of climate change, an Affinity Diagram could help group student contributions into areas like greenhouse gases, deforestation, rising sea levels, and changing weather patterns, facilitating a deeper understanding of the interconnectedness of these elements.

Affinity Diagram



Descriptor:

The Affinity Diagram is a visually intuitive tool utilized for organizing a multitude of ideas or information. Stemming from a brainstorming session, these ideas are grouped based on their natural relationships, allowing for a structured, coherent view of a complex issue. The tool encourages team interaction and consensus building while promoting a comprehensive understanding of the topic at hand.

Purpose:

An Affinity Diagram is a dynamic and versatile tool designed to collate and organize information, ideas, or data that emanate from brainstorming sessions dealing with complex issues. The process encourages an orderly arrangement of thoughts, allowing intricate or convoluted problems to be visualized clearly and systematically.

This tool holds the unique ability to help teams sort through vast amounts of data, breaking it down into more manageable clusters. This attribute is especially valuable when dealing with multifaceted issues that could easily become overwhelming. By enabling teams to identify shared characteristics the Affinity Diagram ultimately aids in uncovering underlying patterns, trends, or themes, facilitating a comprehensive, in-depth understanding of the subject matter.

The Affinity Diagram fosters the collaboration and active participation of all members, amplifying the collective intelligence and ensuring every voice is heard. It promotes dialogue, consensus-building, and decision-making, enhancing the overall efficacy of problem-solving and strategic planning efforts.

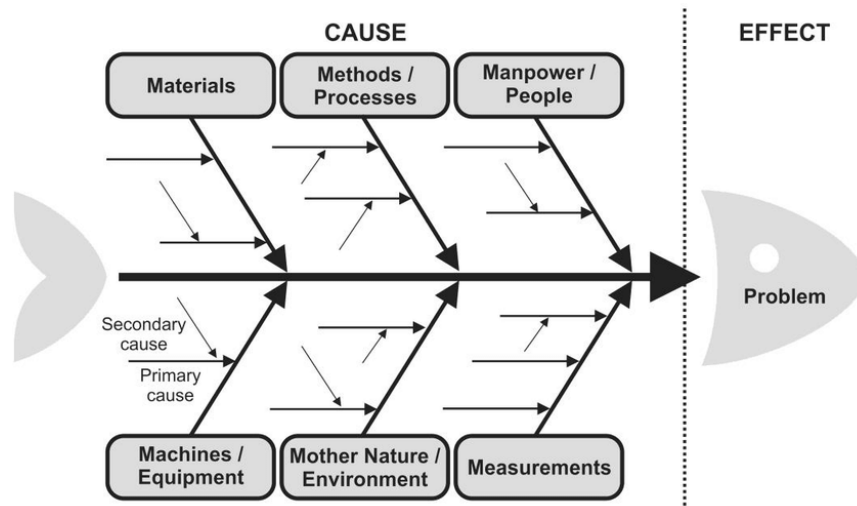
The tool is flexible and can be adapted to a wide array of scenarios, from business strategizing and project management to education and research.

Creating an Affinity Diagram:

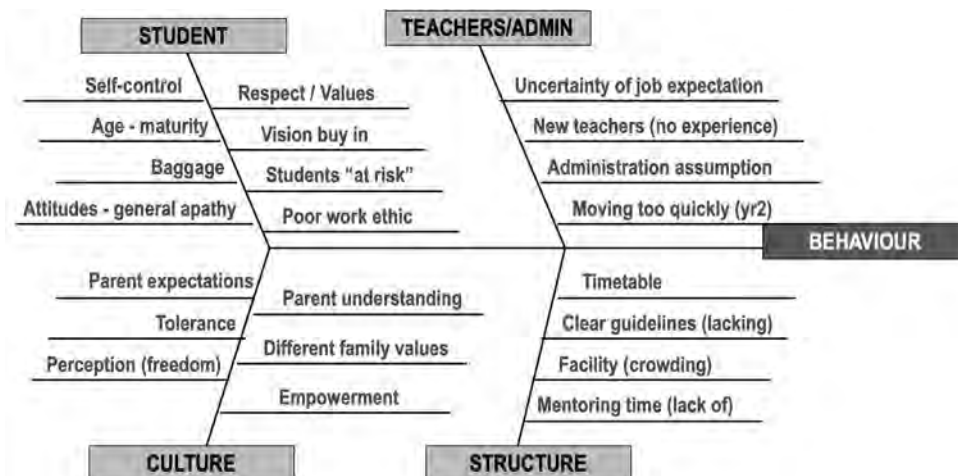
1. **Define the Issue:** Clearly state the issue to be investigated. For instance, "Why is reforming education so difficult?"
2. **Brainstorm Ideas:** Engage all team members in brainstorming responses to the question. Each participant should write their ideas on individual sticky notes. This process can be done out loud as a group or individually in silence.
3. **Display the Ideas:** Have team members randomly place their sticky notes on a large whiteboard or a smooth wall.
4. **Sort into Groups:** Team members then group similar ideas together into rows, based on the natural relationships that they observe. This should be done without discussion, and sticky notes can be moved as often as needed until the team is satisfied with the groupings. The sticky notes in each row are said to have "mutual affinity."
5. **Assign Headers:** Once the grouping is finished, assign a header, written on a different colored sticky note, to each row. At this stage, discussion on what the header should be called is allowed.

The Affinity Diagram not only promotes a collaborative and structured approach to dealing with complex issues, but it also ensures every voice is heard, facilitating more inclusive, effective, and thorough problem-solving.

Fishbone Diagram Analysis



Example used at Master's in 1998



Fishbone Diagram Examples

Manufacturing: A manufacturing company facing issues with product defects could use a Fishbone Diagram to identify potential causes. Categories could include materials, machinery, methods, and manpower, each branching out into detailed factors such as supplier quality, equipment calibration, training procedures, or employee skill levels.

Healthcare: A hospital experiencing high patient wait times could utilize a Fishbone Diagram to identify underlying causes. Categories might include scheduling, staffing, processes, and resources, exploring elements like appointment

booking procedures, nurse-to-patient ratios, triage protocols, or availability of examination rooms.

Education: A school struggling with low student engagement could use a Fishbone Diagram to uncover root causes. Categories could range from teaching methods, curriculum, environment, and student factors, diving deeper into aspects like instructional techniques, relevance of content, classroom setup, or student motivation levels.

Fishbone Diagram

Descriptor:

The Fishbone Diagram, also known as the Cause and Effect Diagram or Ishikawa Diagram, is a powerful visual tool used to systematically identify, explore, and graphically display the possible root causes of a problem or effect. It's distinguished by its fishbone-like structure, where the 'head' of the fish represents the effect or problem, and the 'bones' symbolize various categories of underlying causes, branching out into numerous potential reasons.

The Fishbone Diagram has been widely adopted across industries for its unique ability to break down complexity and stimulate thoughtful exploration of factors contributing to a particular issue. This tool facilitates the organized articulation and visualization of multiple cause-and-effect relationships, helping teams to uncover underlying problems that might not be immediately apparent.

Purpose:

The primary purpose of the Fishbone Diagram is to delve beneath the surface of a particular effect or problem, digging deeper to identify its root causes systematically. However, it's more than just a tool for organization or outlining. The Fishbone Diagram encourages structured, focused brainstorming, stimulating critical thinking, and facilitating the exploration of complex relationships between factors.

By visually mapping out the potential causes of a problem across various categories, it enables teams to better understand the intricate dynamics at play, stimulating discussion, and fostering the development of robust solutions. The Fishbone Diagram, therefore, serves as an integral instrument for problem-solving, strategic planning, quality improvement, and process optimization, helping organizations to mitigate issues, enhance performance, and achieve their objectives more efficiently.

Creating a Fishbone Diagram

Step 1: Define the Problem

Identify the problem or issue you want to analyze. This is often a result or effect that is not meeting expectations or goals. Write this problem statement at the center-right of your workspace (which can be a large whiteboard, flip chart, or even a digital workspace), then draw a horizontal arrow pointing to it from the left. This is the "spine" or "backbone" of the fish.

Step 2: Identify the Major Cause Categories

Brainstorm the major categories of causes. Common categories include Methods, Machines, Materials, Manpower, Environment, and Measurements, but these can vary depending on the nature of the problem. Write these categories along the "bones" or diagonal lines that branch out from the spine.

Step 3: Identify Potential Causes

Under each major cause category, brainstorm and identify potential underlying causes. These are the specific factors that might be contributing to the problem. Write each cause along smaller lines branching off from the major cause lines.

Step 4: Dig Deeper with Sub-Causes

If necessary, break down the causes further into sub-causes. This is particularly useful for complex problems where a single cause might have multiple underlying factors.

Step 5: Analyze and Interpret the Diagram

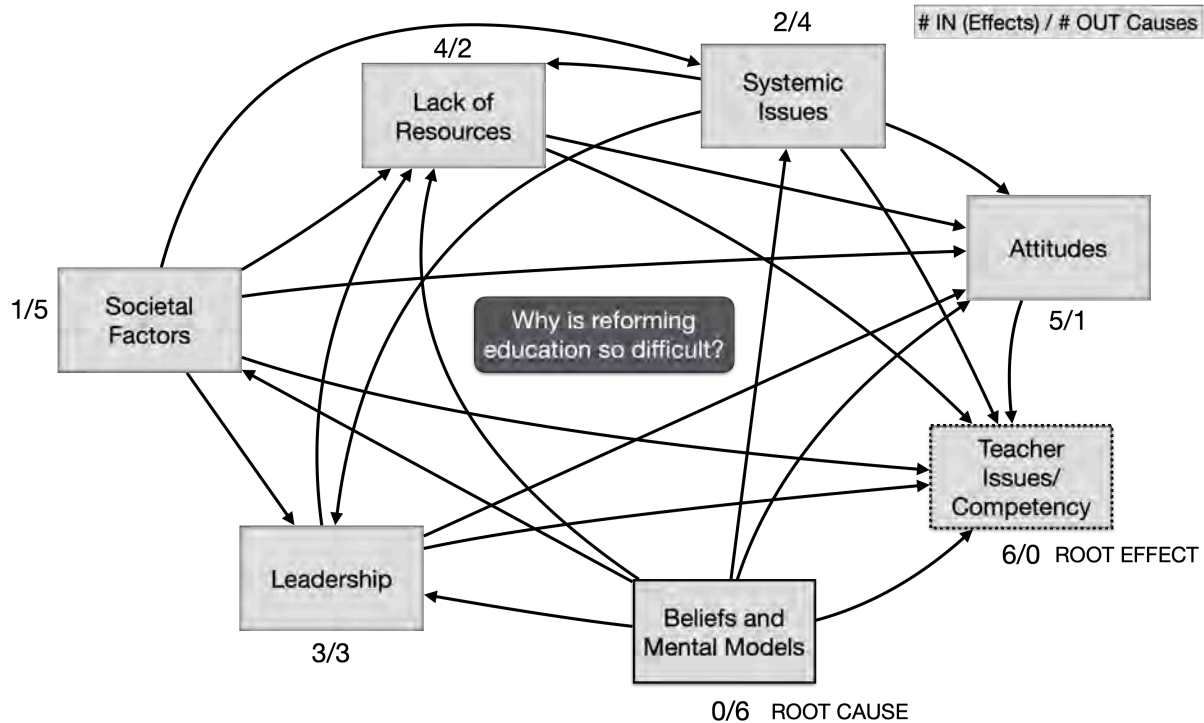
Once all potential causes and sub-causes are written on the diagram, analyze it. Look for patterns, clusters, or areas where causes might be interacting. This visualization should provide a clearer understanding of the factors contributing to the problem.

Step 6: Plan Next Steps

Use the insights gained from the diagram to plan next steps. This might involve further investigation of certain causes, implementing changes, or developing strategies to solve the problem.

Remember, the fishbone diagram is a collaborative tool. The more diverse the group of people contributing to it, the richer the diversity of perspectives, leading to a more comprehensive understanding of the problem. It's also an iterative process; you can always add to the diagram as more information or insights are gained.

Interrelationship Diagram



Interrelationship Diagram Examples

Organizational Change Management: An organization is planning to implement a new software system that will affect several departments. The management team uses an Interrelationship Diagram to understand the dependencies and impacts across different functions. The diagram reveals that staff training is the root cause that influences several aspects, like user adaptation, process efficiency, and data accuracy. Conversely, productivity is identified as the root effect, most influenced by various factors. This insight helps the management focus their efforts on effective staff training to ensure smooth software implementation and minimize disruption to productivity.

Educational Institutions: A school is experiencing issues with student engagement. The staff uses an Interrelationship Diagram to map out potential causes and effects. They identify outdated teaching methods as the root cause affecting several areas, including student interest, performance, and overall engagement. The root effect is found to be student

performance, which is impacted by various factors. Recognizing these relationships, the school implements modern, interactive teaching methods to enhance student engagement and improve performance.

Healthcare Settings: A hospital is trying to reduce patient wait times. They employ an Interrelationship Diagram to understand the various elements contributing to this issue. The diagram identifies staff scheduling as the root cause influencing several other factors, including patient wait times, satisfaction levels, and staff overtime hours. The root effect is patient satisfaction, which is impacted by multiple components. With this understanding, the hospital management focuses on optimizing staff schedules to improve patient wait times and, consequently, patient satisfaction.

Interrelationship Diagram



Descriptor:

An Interrelationship Diagram is a visual tool that illustrates how different ideas or issues are interconnected. It forms a complex web of cause-and-effect relationships, illuminating the interdependencies among various elements centered around a core problem or idea.

Purpose:

The main purpose of an Interrelationship Diagram is to reveal the intricate network of relationships between different ideas or issues. It provides an in-depth understanding of how one idea can have a multi-faceted influence on others, forming a complicated chain of cause and effect. This tool proves instrumental in a wide array of applications, including developing policies, implementing improvements, promoting group activities, and restructuring departmental processes.

By laying out these connections visually, the Interrelationship Diagram fosters a comprehensive understanding of a complex problem, and helps in identifying the most influential elements – the root causes and root effects. This, in turn, guides strategic planning and problem-solving efforts.

In a project management scenario, an Interrelationship Diagram can be used to map the relationships between different tasks, identifying critical tasks that impact many others.

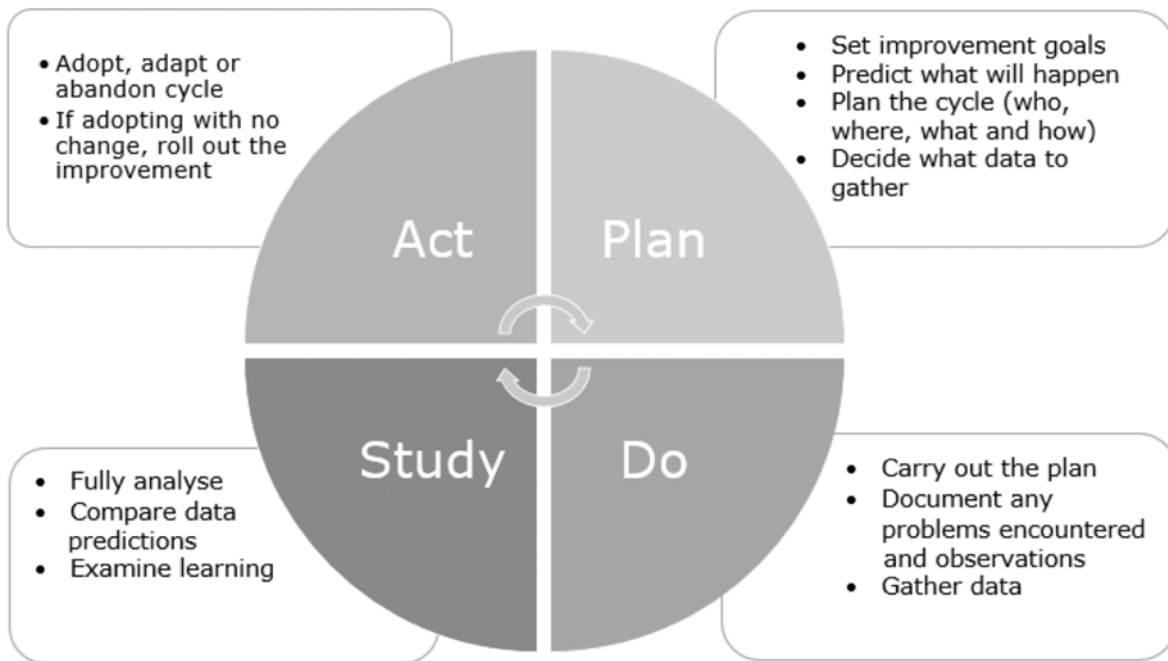
In a quality improvement initiative, it can help pinpoint the root cause of a problem and the most affected areas, guiding corrective action.

In strategic planning, the Interrelationship Diagram can elucidate how different factors like market trends, competitive actions, or internal capabilities influence each other, shaping the organization's strategic direction.

Creating an Interrelationship Diagram:

1. Start by placing the central problem or issue in the middle of a large chart or whiteboard, marking it with a double-lined circle.
2. Arrange the main categories from the Affinity Diagram (or brainstormed elements) in a circle around the central problem.
3. Identify relationships between categories by asking, "Does this category influence or is it influenced by the other?" Draw an arrow from the cause to the effect. If no relationship exists, do not draw a line.
4. Continue this process until all relevant cause-and-effect relationships have been established.
5. Count the number of arrows pointing away from and towards each category. The category with the most outgoing arrows is typically the root cause, while the one with the most incoming arrows is the root effect. Highlight these with a double box.
6. Lastly, determine the sequence of intermediate causes that link the root cause and root effect.

PDSA



PDSA Cycle Examples

Healthcare: In a hospital setting, the PDSA cycle can be used to improve patient care procedures. For example, to reduce the time taken for patient discharge, a team can plan a change in the procedure, implement it in one department, collect data, study the result, and if the result is positive, implement it in the whole hospital.

Manufacturing: The PDSA cycle can be used to improve the production process. For instance, if a manufacturing company is having issues with

production bottlenecks, they can plan a change in the production line, test the change, study the result, and act accordingly.

Education: In a school, the PDSA cycle can be used to improve student learning outcomes. For example, a new teaching methodology can be planned and implemented in one grade or class, results can be studied, and depending on the impact, it can be applied across the school.

PDSA



Descriptor:

The PDSA Cycle, standing for Plan-Do-Study-Act, is a systematic series of steps for gaining valuable learning and knowledge for the continual improvement of a product or process. Also known as the Deming Cycle, this quality process is a simple yet powerful approach for problem-solving and managing change.

Purpose

The purpose of the PDSA Cycle is to test and implement changes in the real work setting. The method allows teams to document a change to be tested or implemented, trial the change in a controlled way, observe what happens, study the results, and act on what is learned. This is a fundamental principle of scientific method and is widely applicable to diverse processes, including organizational and operational improvement.

Creating a PDSA Initiative

Plan

In the planning phase, identify a goal or purpose, formulate a theory, define success metrics and put a plan into action. Tools that can assist in this phase include:

- Brainstorming sessions: to generate ideas for improvement.
- Flowcharts or process maps: to understand the process better.
- Fishbone Diagram (also known as Ishikawa or Cause and Effect Diagram): to identify possible causes of a problem.
- Pareto Charts: to focus efforts on the problems that offer the greatest potential for improvement.

The plan should be as specific as possible about what the change will be and where it will be implemented. Also, remember to define what data needs to be collected.

Do

This is the execution phase where the plan is implemented, preferably on a small scale for initial testing. Data collection is an integral part of this stage and can be done through various methods such as observations, surveys, and inspections. Tools to assist in this phase could be:

- Check sheets: to organize data and classify it, making it easier to interpret.
- Control charts: to visualize data over time and look for trends or patterns.

Study

In the study phase, the collected data is analyzed to see whether the change has led to improvement. This stage often involves conducting a root cause analysis to understand why a particular result occurred. Tools that can help include:

- Scatter Diagrams: to identify possible relationships between different variables.
- Histograms: to visualize the distribution of your data.
- Run charts: to display process performance over time.

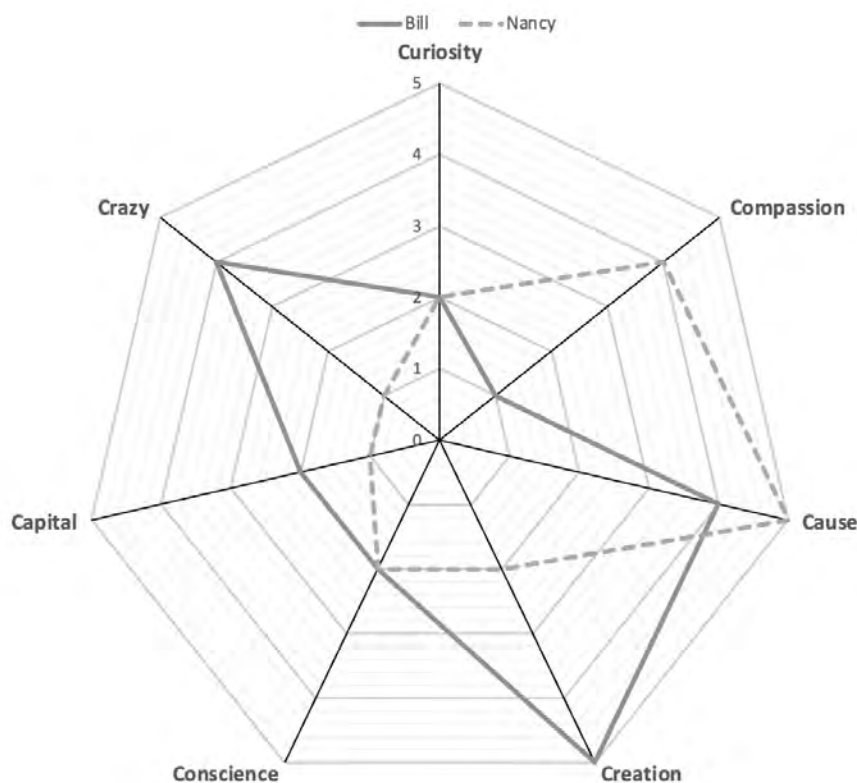
Act

In the acting phase, you will standardize the process if the change was successful, or develop a new hypothesis and repeat the cycle if it was not. Also, document your results and what you've learned. A key aspect is to communicate the findings to all stakeholders. The following tools can assist:

- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs): to document the new process.
- Gantt charts or project management software: to plan broader implementations and ensure everyone knows their role.

The PDSA cycle is iterative, meaning that it's designed to be repeated again and again for continuous improvement. Remember, the aim is not just to solve one problem but to develop a culture that embraces systematic problem solving and continuous improvement.

Radar Diagram



Radar Chart Uses

The utility of a Radar Chart is widespread across different sectors. For instance, an education institute might use it to compare student performance across multiple subjects, identify areas of improvement, and tailor strategies accordingly. Similarly, a business organization may deploy a Radar Chart to analyze its performance across various KPIs, revealing which areas require more attention to attain their envisioned goals.

In the realm of personal development, individuals may use a Radar Chart to gauge their skills or competencies in different areas, providing a clear picture of their strengths and areas needing enhancement. A non-profit organization, on the other hand, might use it to compare the impact of their initiatives across various communities or regions.

Radar Chart

Radar Chart Descriptor

The Radar Chart is a graphic representation that paints a vivid picture of performance, progress, or potentiality across a multiplicity of dimensions. Aptly named, it radiates information across an array of variables, allowing for a panoramic assessment of a given scenario. Embracing a holistic approach, the Radar Chart moves beyond a one-dimensional outlook, showcasing a comprehensive perspective.

Purpose

The *raison d'être* of a Radar Chart is to unearth disparities and trace the contours of change. It is an instrument of foresight and insight, designed to traverse the terrain of 'now' and 'future', bringing to light the chasm that separates the current reality from the desired future state. It is also a bridge between diverse perspectives, highlighting the divergence and convergence amongst different groups.

In the spirit of IMAGINAL, the Radar Chart offers a kaleidoscope of insights, fostering awareness about where to channel efforts for maximizing returns and accelerating transformation. Whether it is identifying strengths to leverage or weaknesses to mend, the Radar Chart aids in crafting a tailored strategy.

Creating a Radar Chart

1. Identify the categories or criteria for evaluation.
2. Define the scoring system for the categories, such as a range of 1 – 10.
3. Draw a sizeable circle and evenly distribute categories around its perimeter.
4. Extend a line from the circle's center to each category.
5. Scale each radial line according to the evaluation criteria.
6. Plot your data points on each line and connect them to form a polygon.

Process (Spreadsheet)

1. Launch the template.
2. Enumerate your category headings.
3. Enter the corresponding data. For a comparative analysis of multiple groups, ensure all relevant data is inputted.
4. Allow the computer to work its magic and generate the Radar Chart. This involves highlighting the labels and data, and then selecting the Radar Chart type from the chart options.

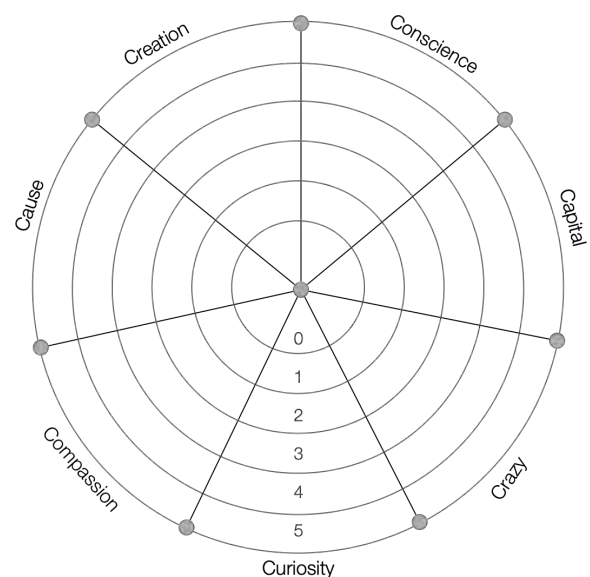
Rose Diagram

Rose Diagram Descriptor

A Rose Diagram, also known as a polar area diagram, is a graphical tool designed for circular data representation. Its sectors, often resembling the petals of a rose, present data on a two-dimensional plane to illustrate comparisons among categories. Typically, the length or area of each "petal" represents the magnitude of the variable, while the division around the circle indicates the grouping or categories of data.

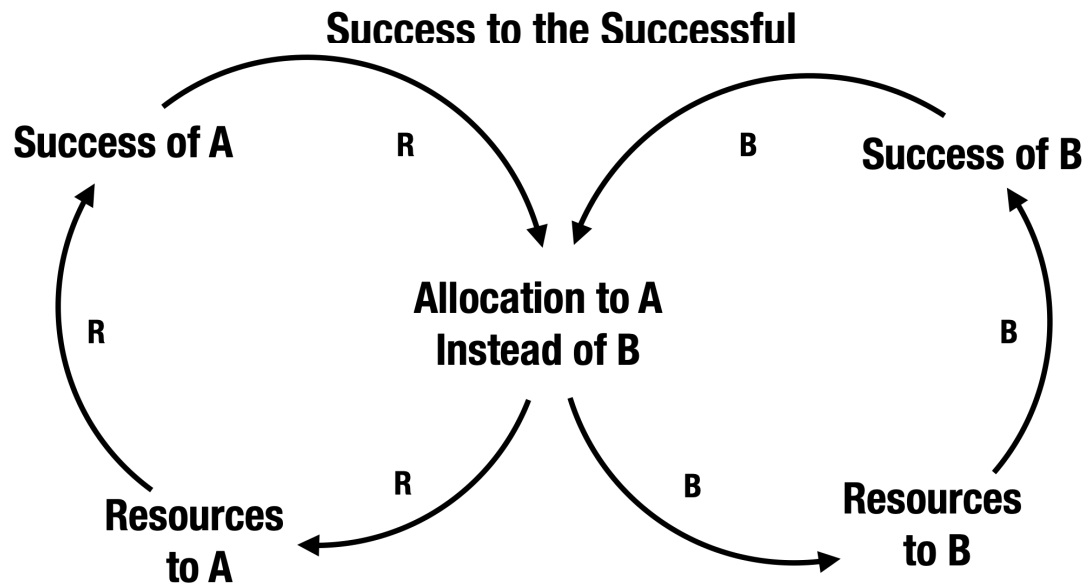
Purpose

The main purpose of a Rose Diagram is to visualize and compare cyclical or periodic data. It's particularly useful for displaying patterns of events or phenomena that occur or change over time in a circular manner, like wind directions, tidal patterns, or daily activity cycles. The diagram's circular layout makes it an excellent tool for spotting patterns and trends that might go unnoticed in other chart formats.



See Seven Breakthrough Drivers pg. 8

Systems Archetypes



System Feedback Loops

The fundamental concept behind systems thinking is the understanding that every action incites a corresponding response. In the field of system dynamics, this response is designated as feedback. There exist two categories of feedback – reinforcing feedback and balancing feedback. Occasionally, a feedback response may not be instantaneous, introducing the factor of delays into the process. A visual representation of any system can be crafted through diagrams depicting these circles of causality, encompassing actions, feedback mechanisms, and delays.

- Links / Arrows - show the relationship and the direction of influence between variables
- B - Balancing feedback loop that seeks equilibrium, it acts in the opposite direction of the feedback
- R - Reinforcing feedback loop that amplifies change, it acts to reinforce the same direction of the feedback

Success to the Successful Example

In Peter Senge's landmark work, "The Fifth Discipline", he introduced the concept of systems archetypes. One of these archetypes, "Success to the Successful", can be illustrated as follows: two individuals or activities compete for the same limited resources. When one becomes more successful, it garners a larger share of the resources, thereby thriving even more. Concurrently, the other, having fewer resources, declines in success, seeming to "justify" the decision to invest more in the

first. Issues arise if the competition is unhealthy and undermines the overall system's objectives. In such cases, the two activities or agents could be separated or allocated an equal portion of resources to promote balance. This pattern can be seen in diverse situations, such as the allocation of resources between two products of the same company, or even the delicate balancing act between work and family commitments.

There are plenty of resources on the internet about system archetypes and casual loops.

Systems Thinking 101

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"Embracing Systems Thinking: A Gateway to Imaginal Transformation"

Systems thinking illuminates the complex tapestry of interconnected elements, transcending a focus on singular entities. Such a paradigm equips Imaginal leaders with a universal language, comprehensive principles, and a versatile toolkit. These tools empower them to navigate and recalibrate even the most intricate challenges they confront in their endeavors.

Diving into System Fundamentals

Think of a system as a beautifully orchestrated ensemble of components, each influencing and being influenced by the other. This dance of interaction and dependence is evident everywhere: from the rhythmic flow of our bloodstream, the balance of predator and prey in nature, to the spark that ignites our cars.

Harnessing the Might of Systems Thinking

This cognitive approach is the key to crafting resilient, intelligent solutions to multifaceted challenges. It paints a richer picture of reality, letting us harness a system's inherent dynamics to realize enduring benefits. Embracing this mindset aids in predicting and mitigating potential pitfalls.

Evolution as an Imaginal Leader with Systems Thinking

Every day, as an Imaginal leader, you're immersed in diverse systems. The essence of systems thinking is understanding and interpreting the symbiotic relationships within these systems. Every component in a system plays a part, continually interacting with and influencing its peers.

Our world's ever-increasing complexity underscores the vital role of systems thinking. It's our beacon, helping us traverse an intricate maze of challenges. As global interconnectivity, rapid evolutions, and information surges dominate, our mental models need a revamp, favoring dynamic patterns over static views.

Systems span both natural wonders like ecosystems and human-made structures like corporations. As these systems grow complex, discerning cause and effect becomes elusive. Systems thinking aids in comprehending such intricacies and orchestrating effective solutions. This approach emphasizes the interconnected nature of components, urging collective actions and urging us to look beyond surface symptoms.

This perspective also instills a deep realization that progress might demand acknowledging vulnerabilities, past oversights, and shortfalls before improvements manifest. Systems thinking broadens horizons, prompting a shift to examine our ingrained beliefs and attitudes, thereby amplifying our capacity for lasting transformation.

System Archetypes at a Glance

Description:

System archetypes offer a lens through which complex systems can be analyzed, understood, and addressed. They act as blueprints, distilling common recurring patterns and structures that lead to particular types of behaviors in systems, regardless of the specific context or domain. By using these archetypes, one can diagnose issues, predict potential pitfalls, and identify leverage points for intervention in a system.

Application:

Whether it's an organizational challenge, an ecological concern, a societal pattern, or an economic trend, system archetypes help in drawing parallels between seemingly unrelated situations. Recognizing an archetype in play allows stakeholders to harness collective wisdom and avoid historical pitfalls, making them invaluable for strategists, policymakers, and change agents.

System archetypes embody recurring behavioral models within a system. They can be visualized as interconnected circles of causality that share a common structural framework. Recognizing these system archetypes and pinpointing the points of leverage can facilitate impactful and efficient transformations within the system. Here are some of the more common system archetypes.

Drifting Goals

Escalation

Fixes that Fail / Backfire

Growth and Underinvestment

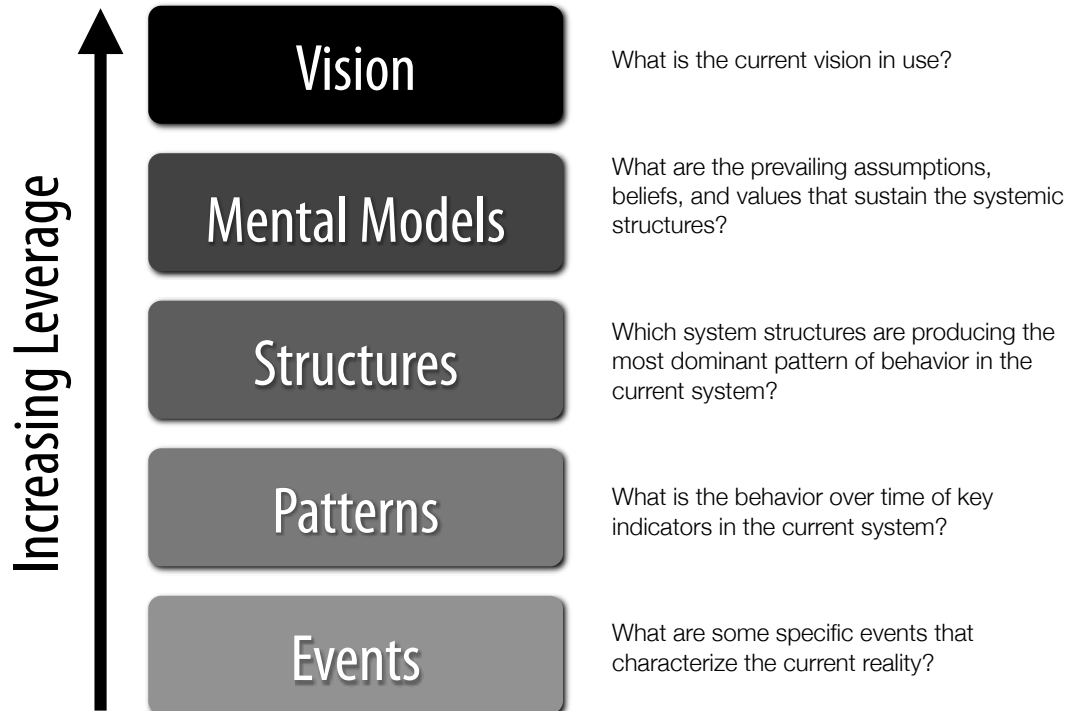
Limits to Success

Shifting the Burden / Addiction

Success to the Successful

Tragedy of the Commons

System Thinking Basics



System Levels Model Uses

Organizational Change Management:

The System Levels Model is instrumental in managing change within organizations. It can help leaders identify patterns that may be hindering productivity or progress and enable them to dissect the structures and mental models that may be causing these patterns. With these insights, leaders can make necessary adjustments or overhaul the system to create a more effective and efficient organization.

Policy Development and Implementation:

Policymakers can use the System Levels Model to better understand how a proposed policy might interact with existing structures and behaviors. The model can help identify potential areas of resistance

or conflict and guide the creation of strategies to address these challenges. It can also help policymakers to align policy actions with broader visions or goals.

Education and Curriculum Design:

In the field of education, the System Levels Model can be used to analyze and improve curriculum design. By identifying patterns of learning and teaching, educators can examine the structures and mental models that underlie these patterns. The insights gained can then guide modifications to curriculum design, teaching methodologies, and evaluation mechanisms to better serve students' needs and learning outcomes.

System Levels



System Levels Model: A Strategic Compass for Imaginal Leaders

Imaginal leaders embrace the competency of systems thinking - the capacity to comprehend how a system operates and to identify its fulcrum points. Such an understanding is vital because there will be times when one needs to execute changes to the system.

The Systems Levels Model offers a lens to discern why certain behavioral patterns exist in various contexts, whether personal or organizational. This model encompasses five levels of recursion and can help you observe how system structures steer behaviors and the thought processes that bolster these structures.

Let's initially clarify some key concepts:

System

A system represents a network of components or elements interconnected and operating as a unified entity. The human body serves as an apt analogy, with numerous subsystems working cohesively to evoke a unique property we call life.

Vision:

There are two variations of vision - the declared vision and the vision in use. The latter is extrapolated from one's actual behavior while the former is a stated goal or aspiration. The real challenge lies in aligning the in-use vision with the declared one, creating a reality that genuinely permeates throughout an organization and isn't mere corporate spiel or marketing illusion.

Mental Models:

Mental models embody the foundational thought processes and assumptions that underpin or are ingrained in a system. Every organizational structure is a result of explicit and implicit mental models. Understanding the thinking behind the existing structures enables you to better manage the transformation process.

Structures:

System structures are the tangible and intangible elements within a system that interact with one another to generate certain behaviors. These structures could be physical, such as the layout of a building or the anatomy of a human body, or non-physical, such as rules, policies, processes, or societal norms. These structures act as the scaffolding that shape how the system functions. For instance, the structure of an organization - its hierarchy, departments, and workflow processes - influences how work gets done and how decisions are made. Importantly, system structures are often shaped by underlying mental models or belief systems, and by changing these structures, we can influence patterns of behavior within the system.

Patterns of Behaviour:

Behavioral patterns are recurrent events, and when such a pattern is detected, it suggests that some system structure is at play in generating this behavior. For instance, if your newspaper consistently arrives late on Mondays, there's likely a system structure influencing this pattern.

Events:

Events are simply the experiences we encounter daily. For example, rush hour traffic, which happens every weekday morning, transcends from being an event to a pattern dictated by the city's workplace start times.

In using the System Levels Model, one typically begins at the base with 'Events' and works upwards towards 'Vision'.

Here's how it works:

- Experience specific events or issues, and over time, you may sense a pattern to these predicaments.
- Commence data gathering to ascertain if a pattern is associated with the problem.
- Upon identifying a behavioral pattern, scrutinizing the structures possibly instigating these patterns can illuminate the problem's root causes.
- Now, it's time to delve into the belief systems or the thought processes that constructed these structures initially. Understanding these mental models, or the logic behind them leading to the creation of these structures, can guide you to where changes might be necessary.
- Identify the in-use vision and juxtapose it with the declared vision or desired future. The outcome will enhance the leverage for system alterations.

This model stresses that Imaginal leaders must not merely respond to events or get trapped in pattern cycles. Instead, they should delve deeper, scrutinizing the system structures and mental models inciting these patterns and events, and ultimately harmonizing these elements with the declared vision. Consequently, the System Levels Model serves as an enlightening guide, encouraging Imaginal leaders to shift from a reactive to a proactive, systemic perspective, enabling them to craft systems in alignment with their vision.

VDM

Level of Perspective	Current Reality	Vision
Vision	What is the current vision in use?	What is the espoused vision of the future?
Mental Models	What are the prevailing assumptions, beliefs, and values that sustain the systemic structures?	What is the espoused vision of the future?
System Structures	Which system structures are producing the most dominant pattern of behavior in the current system?	What kinds of systemic structures (either invented or redesigned) are required to operationalize the new mental models and achieve the vision?
Patterns	What is the behavior over time of key indicators in the current system? Select key variables and research the patterns over time	What are some key indicators whose pattern of behavior shows that the desired vision is a reality?
Events	What are some specific events that characterize the current reality? Are they individual events or stories of a larger pattern that have been unfolding over time? Resist any temptation to sanitize it for political reasons or bias it towards a particular solution.	What are some specific events that illustrate how the vision is operating on a day-to-day basis?

Defining the Real Problem

Levels of Perspective	Current Reality	Gap or Opportunity	Strategy	Vision
Vision		Step 3	Step 4	Step 2
Mental Models				
Structures				
Patterns	Start			

A crucial component of the Imaginal Transformation methodology lies in accurately identifying the true challenge at hand, which is system transformation. Utilizing the framework provided by the Vision Deployment Matrix (VDM), we are able to discern the obstacles and strategies between each of the five perspective levels. This comprehensive understanding allows us to address the true question at the heart of the transformation: How do we navigate from our current reality (HERE) to our desired future vision (THERE)? By systematically identifying and addressing the barriers across all levels, we pave the way for effective and meaningful system transformation.

Vision Deployment Matrix



The Vision Deployment Matrix is a strategic tool that provides a detailed overview of your organization's current reality (HERE) versus its desired future vision (THERE). It does so by examining five levels of perspective: Vision, Mental Models, System Structures, Patterns of Behavior, and Events. Here is a breakdown of each perspective level:

1. Vision:

This level refers to the overarching goal or purpose of the organization.

Current Reality: This aspect identifies the existing vision or purpose guiding your organization's actions. For instance, a manufacturing company's current vision might be to be the leading producer of goods in its industry.

Future Vision: This outlines the organization's aspirational vision or purpose for the future. For example, the same manufacturing company may aspire to become a global leader in sustainable manufacturing practices.

2. Mental Models:

These are the prevailing assumptions, beliefs, and values that inform the organization's strategies and actions.

Current Reality: This involves identifying the mental models currently at play within the organization. For example, a non-profit might currently operate based on the belief that direct aid is the best method of helping its beneficiaries.

Future Vision: This defines the intended mental models that the organization aims to adopt. The same non-profit might aim to shift its belief towards a model of empowering beneficiaries through skill development and economic opportunities.

3. System Structures:

These are the mechanisms or structures within the organization that determine its operations.

Current Reality: This requires understanding the organization's existing system structures that generate its current patterns of behavior. A business might currently have a hierarchical structure leading to top-down decision-making.

Future Vision: This outlines the systemic structures required to achieve the vision and new mental models. The same business might envision a more democratic decision-making process requiring a flatter, more decentralized organizational structure.

4. Patterns of Behavior:

These are the recurring actions or practices within the organization.

Current Reality: This identifies the patterns of behavior in the current system by studying key indicators over time. A tech company might currently notice a pattern of quick product releases leading to recurring quality issues.

Future Vision: This highlights the key indicators demonstrating that the desired vision has been realized. The tech company might envision a pattern of comprehensive quality checks resulting in fewer product issues post-release.

5. Events:

These are specific occurrences that exemplify the broader trends, patterns, or structures at play within the organization.

Current Reality: This refers to specific events characterizing the current reality. A healthcare organization might currently experience frequent patient dissatisfaction due to long waiting times.

Future Vision: This refers to specific events that demonstrate the operationalization of the vision on a daily basis. The healthcare organization might envision frequent patient compliments on efficient service as a result of streamlined processes.

By carefully analyzing and documenting these five levels of perspective, an organization can gain a comprehensive understanding of its current state and the steps necessary to achieve its future vision, thereby successfully deploying its strategic plan.

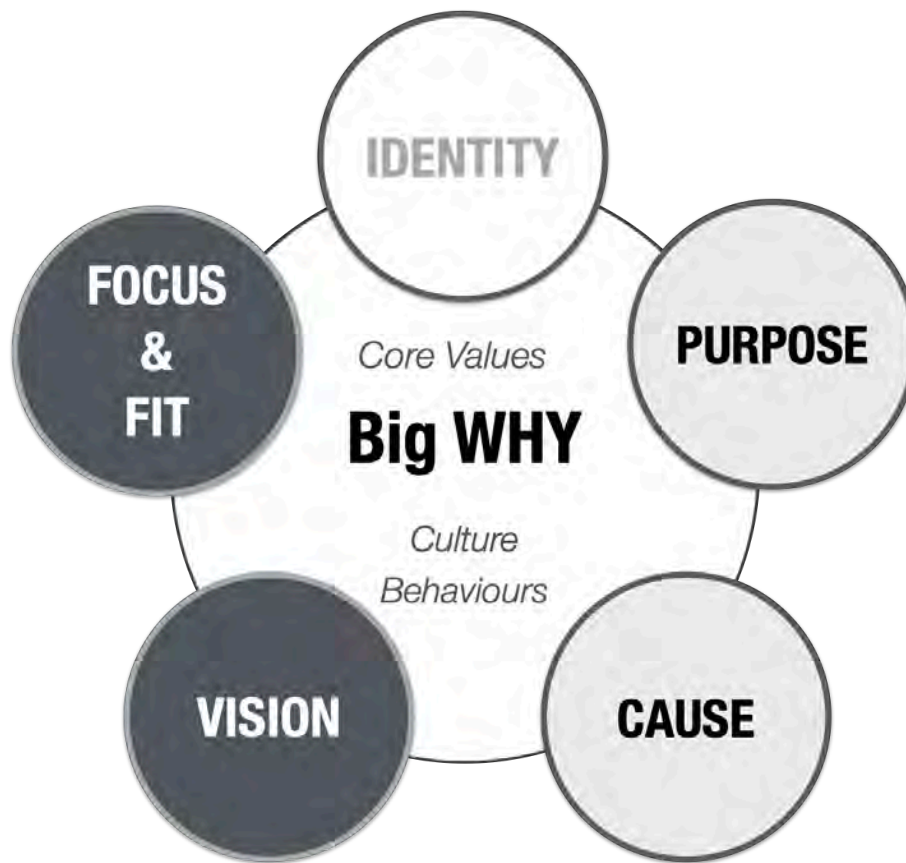
Part IV

Imaginal Organization and Innovation

"Numerous organizations base their strategic planning on historical data, overlooking the necessity to envision the future first. It's only by foreseeing what lies ahead can we develop a transformation strategy that truly secures a competitive edge."

— Thomas Rudmik, Imaginal Transformation

Imaginal Organization's Big WHY



We have all been called to make a difference—‘to make a dent in the universe’. The level at which your organizational Big WHY is internalized by your key stakeholders will determine the level of their commitment to the vision you aspire to achieve. —Tom Rudmik 2020

Imaginal Organization's Big WHY



Imaginal organizations understand the importance of a clearly defined Big WHY - a purpose that goes beyond mere financial gain. This compelling vision of making a significant difference becomes the guiding beacon that helps navigate their future. Here's how it can be broken down:

Core Values:

These are the fundamental beliefs that guide the behaviors and decision-making process of an organization. Imaginal organizations not only define their core values explicitly but also ensure they are lived out every day, regularly reporting on their adherence to these values.

Organizational Culture:

The cultural attributes of an Imaginal organization are characterized by respect, empowerment, ownership, responsibility, accountability, and integrity. The culture is an emergent property, stemming from the intricate interplay of various structures, ultimately molding the shared attitudes, customs, and values of the organization.

Behaviors:

Values manifest through the behaviors of individuals within an organization. Imaginal organizations develop a code of conduct that serves as a guiding framework, enabling individuals to self-evaluate and adjust their actions accordingly.

Organizational Identity:

What sets your organization apart? What unique competencies does it possess that ensure its sustainability and competitiveness? What historical aspects are vital to its identity? Understanding these elements is crucial for maintaining the essence of an Imaginal organization.

Purpose:

The organization's mission statement captures its primary purpose, outlining the specific value or benefit it aims to provide for its stakeholders.

Cause:

The organization's 'Reason for Being' statement places its work within a broader context. It articulates the bigger cause the organization is striving to advance and explains how this cause aligns with the organization's primary purpose. It also elaborates on why the organization has chosen to champion this particular cause and how it intends to rally stakeholder support.

Vision:

The vision statement paints a vivid picture of the organization's future, detailing its aspirations and the impact it seeks to make in line with its 'Big WHY' over a specific time frame - be it 5, 10, or 20 years.

Focus & Fit:

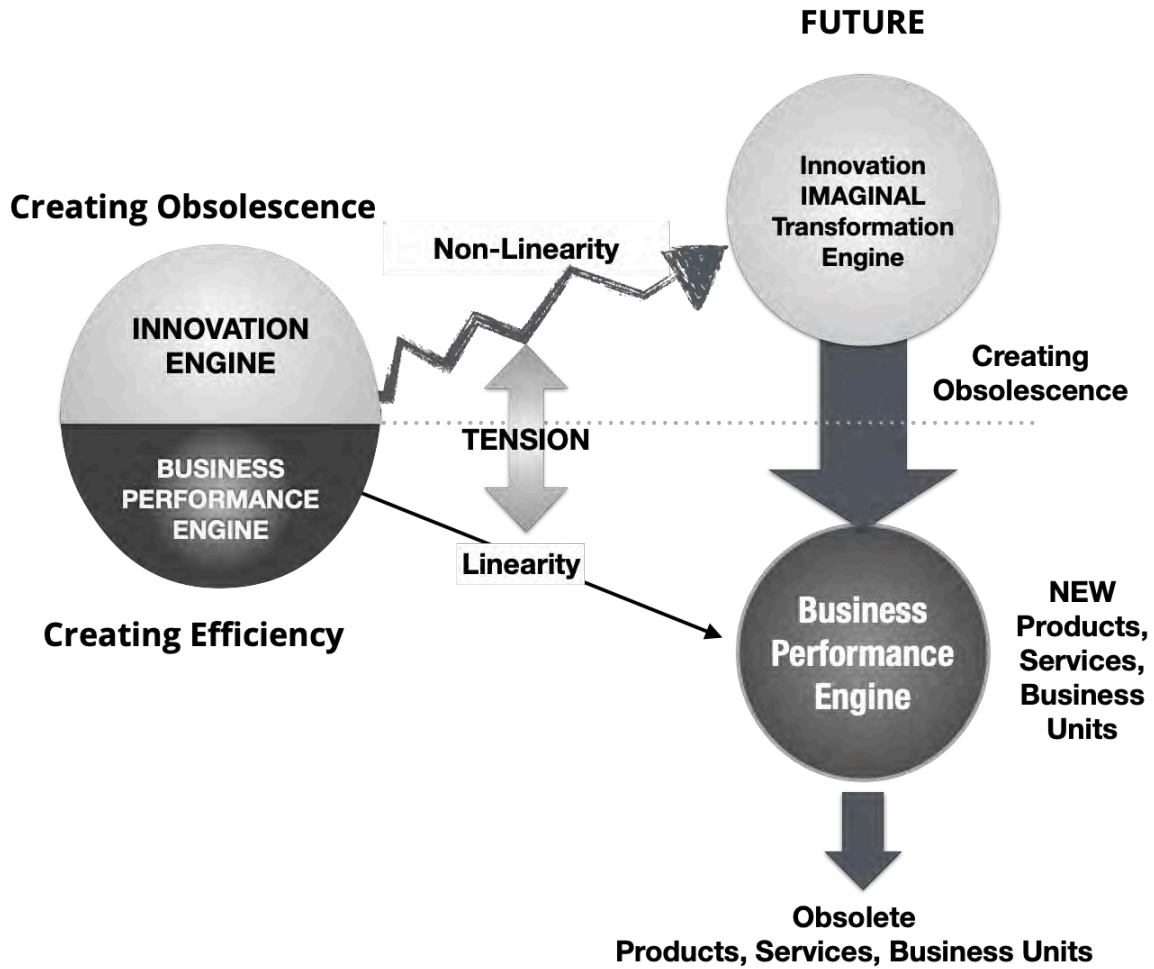
For internal stakeholders, it's crucial to deeply resonate with the organization's 'Big WHY'. This goes beyond mere compliance; it encompasses a profound sense of calling that drives them to contribute meaningfully to this overarching purpose. When hiring or reviewing an employment contract, it's vital to assess an individual's alignment with the organization's Big WHY. Those within an Imaginal Organization possess a deep sense of calling and fit with this purpose, demonstrated by their observable commitment. They go beyond meeting expectations, actively seeking ways to advance the Big WHY, often putting in effort that exceeds standard norms. This mindset transcends a traditional 'union mindset'.

Big WHY Statement:

The 'Big WHY' statement encapsulates the organization's larger purpose. Beyond providing excellent products and services within a respectful and supportive work environment, the organization aspires to make a meaningful difference. The impact could be at the community, regional, or even national level. This statement should be specific enough to inspire individuals to join and contribute to the organization's mission.

In a nutshell, Imaginal organizations embed their 'Big WHY' into every aspect of their identity - values, culture, behaviors, purpose, cause, and vision - thus motivating stakeholders to be part of their transformative journey.

Innovation vs Business Engine



Innovation vs Business Engine

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Why is Developing Innovation Capabilities so Difficult?

Developing innovation capabilities within an organization is a challenge fraught with complexities. Here are a few reasons that elucidate this dilemma:

The Pressure of Short-Term Goals:

Often, organizations get caught up in the pursuit of their short-term strategic objectives, spanning 1-3 years. Leaders tend to devote their focus on immediate business goals, which can often be achieved by extracting more value from existing product or service lines. This could be done by enhancing certain aspects of these offerings or amplifying market share via competitive pricing or incentive schemes. The incessant drive towards immediate returns can sometimes overshadow the need for groundbreaking innovation.

Meeting Present Customer Needs:

Organizations invest considerable resources in design thinking to address the current needs of their customers, often relying on today's knowledge to address today's problems, and hoping these solutions will remain relevant tomorrow. This conventional approach to innovation has served well in the past when technological advancements were gradual. However, with the rapid evolution embodied by Industry 4.0, the rules of the game are swiftly changing. The question of who will thrive and who will perish in this new competitive landscape may hinge on an organization's ability to predict and prepare for future demands.

The "Copying" Business Model:

Some companies, rather than leading the pack, prefer to follow in the footsteps of industry leaders by offering similar solutions at a more competitive price. Their

strategy is not predicated on being the pioneer, but instead on being able to quickly and economically market the innovations conceived by others. Such organizations bank on the premise that it's not always necessary to have a first-mover advantage to remain competitive in today's dynamic marketplace.

The Limited Scope of Innovation:

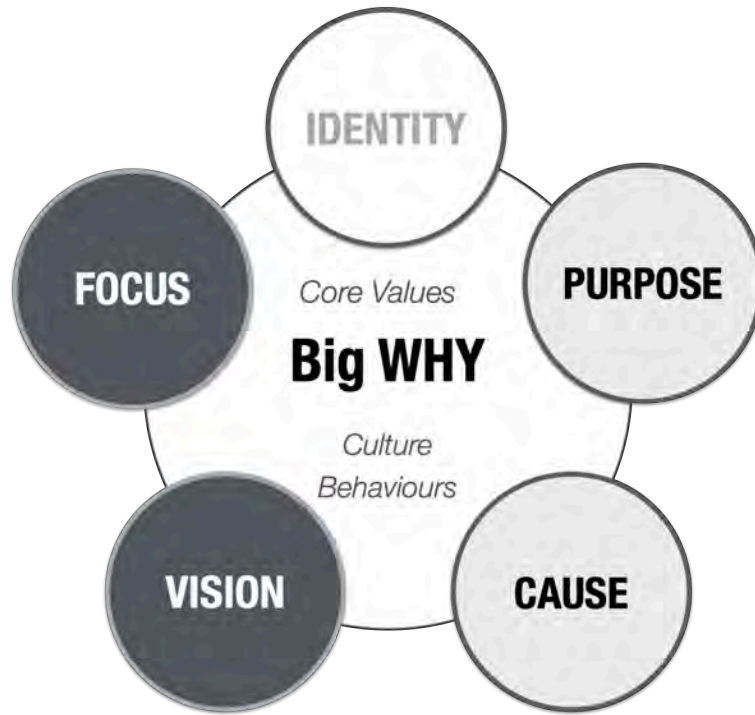
In many organizations, the responsibility of innovation lies solely within the confines of the Research and Development (R&D) department. Consequently, business unit managers aim to optimize performance through efficiencies and incentive programs, hoping that the R&D team will deliver superior products and services to maintain competitiveness. In such scenarios, managers aren't leading innovation; instead, they merely package and market what the R&D team has developed.

Balancing Innovation and Business Performance:

A delicate tension exists between the Innovation Engine, or the mechanism that drives the creation of new ideas, and the Business Performance Engine, which is responsible for delivering financial results. The pathway to innovation is seldom linear and often unpredictable. This contrasts with the more steady and predictable path of improving business performance. One of the key goals of innovation is to make your own products and services obsolete before your competitors do it for you. Striking a balance between these two seemingly opposing forces can be a herculean task.

In conclusion, while cultivating an innovative environment within an organization can be a daunting task due to these challenges, it's an essential endeavor to remain competitive and relevant in the ever-evolving business landscape.

Kingdom Company



Kingdom Company as an Imaginal Organization

"Embracing the essence of an Imaginal Organization, a Kingdom Company stands distinct. It masterfully weaves together its Imaginal prowess to perceive, learn from, and shape the future, while meeting the tangible needs of its customers, employees, and shareholders. But it goes a step further - it aligns itself firmly with Biblical principles and values, anchoring its operations in a spiritual bedrock. This steadfast commitment ensures its role in advancing God's will on Earth is never lost in its pursuit of progress. Thus, the Kingdom Company is more than just a business entity - it is a conduit for divine purpose." –Tom Rudmik, 2023

Kingdom Company



Kingdom Company Defined

A Kingdom Company is a distinct form of organization, generally privately owned, in which the majority shareholders share a common, overarching vision that extends beyond the traditional business objective of optimizing shareholder value. The core of a Kingdom Company resides in their "Big WHY," their profound purpose or *raison d'être*, which is seamlessly intertwined with the advancement of God's Kingdom on earth.

This commitment to a divine mission pervades every facet of their operations, from high-level strategic decisions to daily business activities. Every participant in the company, including shareholders, employees, and various stakeholders, becomes an integral part of this mission. Their collaborative efforts aim to build a prosperous business that not only contributes to economic growth but also makes a significant spiritual and societal impact.

Kingdom Companies embody and uphold the principles of faith, justice, compassion, stewardship, integrity, and service. They perceive their role in the business landscape as one that extends beyond the mere pursuit of economic success. Instead, they see themselves as channels for expressing God's love and grace. These companies endeavor to cultivate an environment that mirrors Kingdom values, where all stakeholders are treated with dignity and respect, and business practices are ethical, sustainable, and advantageous to all involved.

Take, for example, a Kingdom Company in the manufacturing industry. They may prioritize ethical sourcing and fair labor practices, providing fair wages, and ensuring safe working conditions. They could go beyond regulatory compliance and actively reduce their environmental impact, demonstrating stewardship for God's creation. In decision-making, the company could prioritize long-term sustainability over short-term gains, embodying the Kingdom principles of justice and stewardship.

The business strategies of Kingdom Companies are informed not only by market trends and financial metrics but also by their spiritual beliefs and convictions. These companies strive to align their organizational goals with God's will, discovering innovative means to attain their business objectives while concurrently promoting their Kingdom mission.

In essence, a Kingdom Company exemplifies the amalgamation of commerce and conviction, the harmonious integration of profitability and purpose. They embody the belief that business can serve as a potent instrument for good, propelling the advancement of God's Kingdom on earth while concurrently achieving economic success. These companies stand as living testimony to the possibility of a business ethos that combines spiritual fulfillment with worldly achievement, setting a new paradigm for organizations worldwide.

Examples of Kingdom Companies

Chick-fil-A is a well-known fast-food chain based in the United States, recognized for its signature chicken sandwiches. A Kingdom Company at its core, Chick-fil-A was founded by S. Truett Cathy, who infused his strong Christian faith into every aspect of the business. Chick-fil-A is unique in the fast-food industry for being closed on Sundays, a policy set by Cathy to ensure that employees have an opportunity to rest, spend time with family, or worship if they choose to. Beyond its operational practices, Chick-fil-A also invests in various charitable endeavors through the Chick-fil-A Foundation, focusing on youth and education programs.

Hobby Lobby is an American retail company offering arts and crafts supplies, fabrics, picture framing, party supplies, and home décor items. Founded by David Green, the company operates on a strong Christian framework, aligning its business practices with biblical principles. Hobby Lobby is renowned for its commitment to religious liberty, even taking a case to the Supreme Court to defend its right to operate according to its religious beliefs. The company also invests heavily in charitable works, including evangelism and missions work, Bible translation and distribution, and support for Christian pastors and their families. In this way, Hobby Lobby serves as a model for a Kingdom Company, prioritizing faithfulness to God's principles over simple economic gain.

The **Jacto Group** is a Brazilian company specializing in agricultural machinery and equipment. Founded by Shunji Nishimura, a Japanese immigrant, the company blends business excellence with a profound commitment to Christian values. Jacto's business operations are closely linked to its dedication to social responsibility, with a focus on environmental sustainability and supporting local communities. Through the Shunji Nishimura Foundation, the company invests in education and research, fostering innovation in agriculture and related fields. The Jacto Group demonstrates how a Kingdom Company can influence its industry and community positively, combining economic prosperity with spiritual purpose and societal impact.

Attributes of a Kingdom Company

Big WHY-Bringing Heaven's will to Earth

"But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well."— Matthew 6:33

Integrity and Honesty

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely, but whoever takes crooked paths will be found out."— Proverbs 10:9

Servant Leadership

"For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."— Mark 10:45

Generosity and Giving Back

"Remember this: Whoever sows sparingly will also reap sparingly, and whoever sows generously will also reap generously."— 2 Corinthians 9:6

Stewardship of Resources

*The Parable of the Talents emphasizes responsible stewardship.—
Matthew 25:14-30*

Commitment to Excellence

"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for human masters..."— Colossians 3:23-24,

Value for People

"For the entire law is fulfilled in keeping this one command: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'"—Galatians 5:14

Kingdom Company Attributes

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1. Big WHY - Bringing Heaven's will to Earth:

Kingdom companies are driven by a bigger purpose or 'Big WHY'. They exist not merely for profit or market share, but to implement Heaven's principles on Earth through their business activities, products, and services.

Marketplace Example: "Chick-fil-A" is a well-known fast food chain in the United States that is guided by Christian values. From being closed on Sundays to honor the Sabbath, to their mission statement: "To glorify God by being a faithful steward of all that is entrusted to us", Chick-fil-A provides a prominent example of a company operating under a 'Big WHY'. Their business model and operational decisions align with the larger aim of bringing Heaven's will to Earth.

2. Integrity and Honesty:

Kingdom companies stand firm in their commitment to truth and transparency. They prioritize honesty in every transaction, ensuring that they don't cut corners, falsify reports, or deceive stakeholders.

Marketplace Example: "Hobby Lobby", an arts and crafts company, is closed every Sunday, allowing employees a day of rest and worship. The company's commitment to Christian principles is evident in their business operations, as they prioritize honesty and integrity in all their dealings.

3. Servant Leadership:

Kingdom companies recognize the importance of leadership that serves. Instead of being top-down in their approach, these companies promote a leadership style that seeks to elevate others, fostering an environment of mutual respect and collaboration.

Marketplace Example: "ServiceMaster," a company offering a range of residential and commercial services, is an example of an organization that embraces servant leadership. The company's objectives, as formulated by founder Marion E. Wade, are "To honor God in all we do; To help people develop; To pursue excellence; and To grow profitably." Wade, a devout Christian, viewed his business as a means to serve others, and this ethos remains a pillar of ServiceMaster's corporate culture. The company not only encourages employees to grow professionally but also emphasizes character development and integrity. Their adherence to servant leadership has been recognized, with the company receiving a Better Business Bureau Torch Award for Ethics in 2021..

4. Generosity and Giving Back:

Kingdom companies understand the principle of sowing and reaping. They invest not just in their business but also in their communities, recognizing that their success is intertwined with the well-being of the people around them.

Marketplace Example: "In-N-Out Burger" prints Bible verses on its packaging and is known for its philanthropic efforts, including supporting child abuse prevention and disaster relief.

5. Stewardship of Resources:

Kingdom companies believe that they are stewards of God's resources. This drives them to be responsible, efficient, and wise in their use of finances, human resources, and other assets.

Marketplace Example: "Forever 21", a fashion retailer, had bags with "John 3:16" printed on the bottom, signifying the company's acknowledgment of God as the source of their success and their commitment to stewarding their resources wisely.

6. Commitment to Excellence:

Kingdom companies strive for excellence in all their endeavors, believing that their work is a form of worship. They continually seek ways to improve and excel, not merely to outdo competitors, but as an act of service to God.

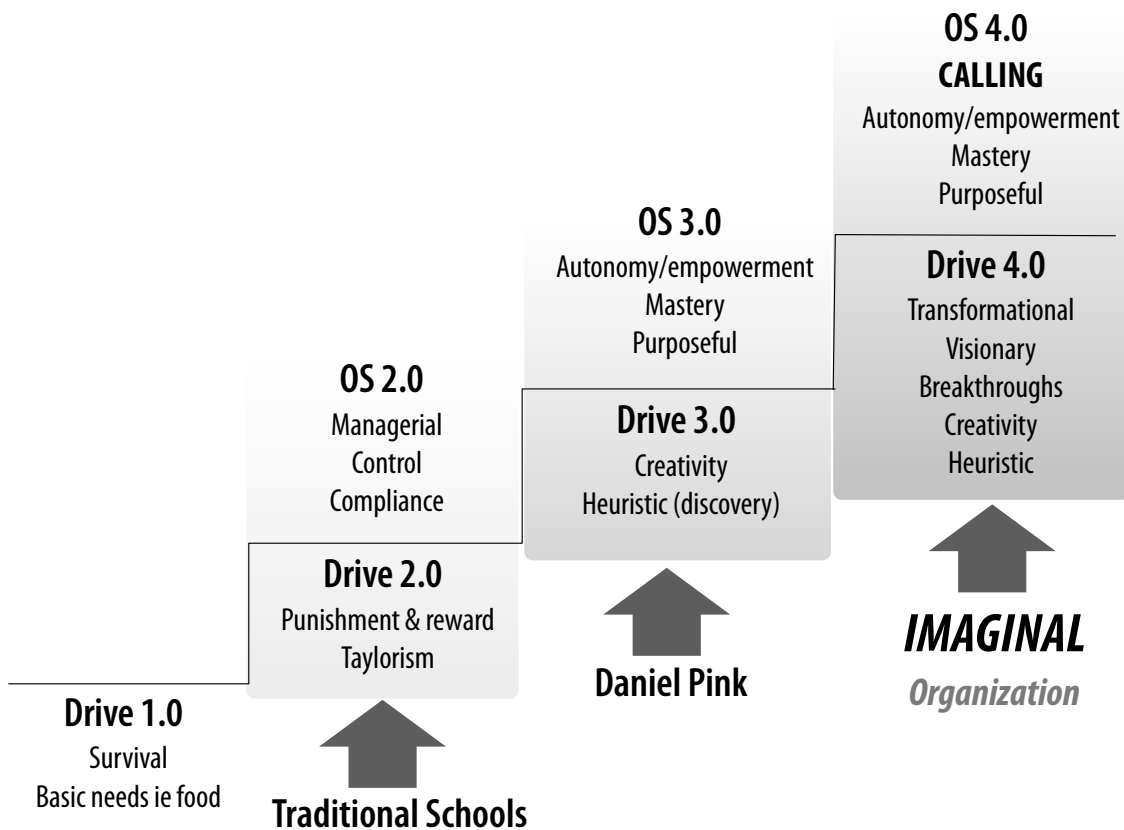
Marketplace Example: "Tyson Foods", one of the world's largest processors of chicken, beef, and pork, has a commitment to excellence that is rooted in their Christian faith. The company has chaplains available to counsel and comfort team members, ensuring they provide a supportive work environment.

7. Value for People:

Kingdom companies understand the inherent value of every individual, be it their employees, customers, or partners. They ensure fair treatment, good working conditions, and foster an environment of respect and dignity.

Marketplace Example: "Interstate Batteries", an automotive battery manufacturer, has a stated mission of "glorifying God" and is known for its emphasis on valuing its employees and treating them with respect.

Imaginal Organization OS



Big WHY

Imaginal Organizations anchor themselves to a compelling Big WHY, drawing individuals dedicated to advancing the greater good. They take the helm, shaping the future in harmony with their powerful Big WHY.

–Tom Rudmik, 2023

Imaginal Organization OS 4.0

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Primary Purpose vs. Big WHY in Education

Every organization operates with a primary purpose or *raison d'être*. In the cutthroat realm of business, it's about outshining competitors and maximizing profits. But in the world of education, where competitive forces are more muted, incremental improvements are standard practice. Such an approach wrongly assumes that the system's structure is adequate, believing that through rewards and punishments, improvements can be compelled. It misconstrues the idea that issues arise from individuals rather than the system as a whole, even though this theory has consistently shown to be flawed. Yet, it remains the linchpin of many education reform strategies.

What, then, is the fundamental aim of schools? The prevailing belief is that they prepare students for further education, leading to careers. Essentially, schools prime students for a life dominated by work. However, there's a broader spectrum: preparing students to be informed citizens and equipping them with the social skills vital for today's world. To achieve these ends, nations devise curriculums encompassing the knowledge and skills students need for the future. Educators, therefore, are tasked with delivering a curriculum in line with district expectations. Regrettably, many educators today resemble assembly line workers, each playing their part in a vast system, installing predefined outcomes into students. This isn't a critique of the educator's nobility; many still inspire a love for learning amidst this system.

Could a school or even an entire district or state have a Big WHY that revolutionizes its foundational approach and behavior? Not only is this possible, but it's also imperative. An organizational Big WHY can transition an entity from feeling victimized by a flawed system to becoming the creators of the future they envision.

What if we expanded a school's primary purpose to include researching and innovating the future educational model? What if system transformation was an intrinsic goal? Detractors might argue, "Teachers aren't system redesigners, and this wouldn't be within their collective agreement. Aren't they burdened enough without expecting them to be visionary designers?" My answer is a resounding YES. But redefining the system's primary objective and restructuring support is crucial.

Creating a Transformation Roadmap

Before any significant transformation can occur, an organization's core leadership must resonate with the envisioned future. Leaders devoted to their vision are transformation's lifeblood. Absent this vision, systems will remain stagnant, polishing an already obsolete model.

Genuine change arises from Imaginal leaders: those with the passion, courage, and foresight to envision what's not immediately evident and act upon it.

Imaginal Organization OD 4.0

To become an Imaginal Organization, you need DRIVE. Daniel Pink, in "Drive: The Surprising Truth About What Motivates Us", posits that the traditional reward-punishment approach falls short in motivating individuals to achieve exceptional feats. Writers like Alfie Kohn advocate transitioning from this archaic model to one empowering students to own their learning journey.

"Drive" delineates three true motivation facets: autonomy, mastery, and purpose. Organizations embracing these principles possess highly driven employees. However, adding a fourth element elevates an organization's motivational capacity: a calling to a vision. While vision and purpose aren't identical, a visionary organization cannot thrive without a distinct purpose.

Calling

Imaginal Organizations don't merely hire; they summon individuals. Joining such an organization transcends employment; it's a destiny, contributing to a cause larger than any one individual, deserving of time and sacrifice.

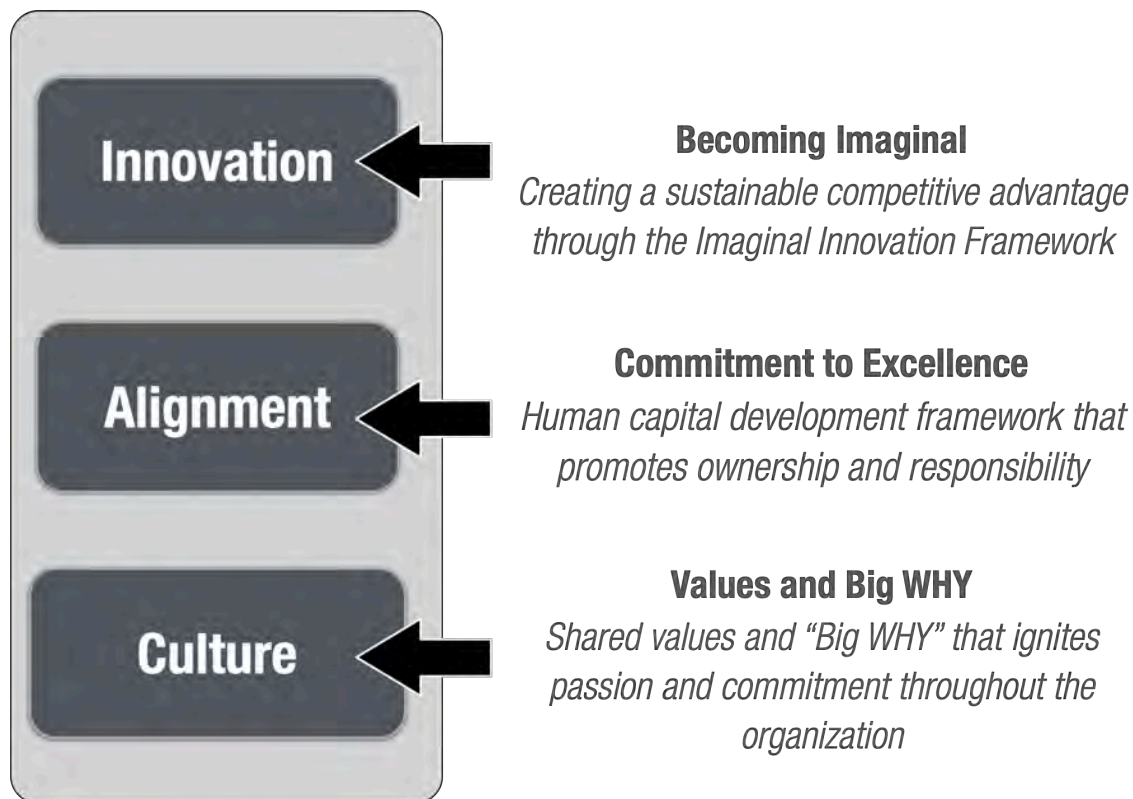
This calling is spiritual. It encapsulates one's identity, passions, life purpose, aligned cause, and vision to advance said cause, resulting in one's Big WHY. At Master's Academy and College, launched in 1997, we incorporated the "Call" process. Faculty yearly revisited their calling, aligning with our vision of cultivating Profound Learning. The commitment varies; some commit for a season, others for a lifetime. But all are viewed as more than mere employees.

Inevitably, challenges arise. But it's one's calling and unyielding dedication to the vision that propels them forward. History's game-changers are characterized by this unwavering commitment. Recognizing one's calling is pivotal, especially when facing adversity, as it's this commitment that fuels transformational endeavors.

Imaginal Organizations

*Create **OBSOLESCENCE** for themselves and their industry through **INNOVATION** and **INVENTION**. Create **BEST PRACTICES** and **DATA** that attracts early majority to follow. –Tom Rudmik, 2015*

Imaginal Organization Model



Imaginal Organization Examples

While the Imaginal Organization Model, especially with its emphasis on "Kingdom Companies" and advancing a higher purpose, isn't standard across every industry, there are several companies and organizations worldwide that seem to fit some aspects of this unique model:

1. TOMS Shoes:

Every purchase of TOMS products helps provide shoes, sight, water, and safer birth services to people in need. Their 'One for One' model highlights a deep commitment to improving lives, and they've creatively expanded this into various areas of need, showcasing the "innovation" aspect of the Imaginal Model.

2. Chick-fil-A:

Known not just for their chicken but also for their core Christian values, Chick-fil-A often emphasizes a higher purpose in their business dealings, aiming to have a positive influence on all who come into

contact with their brand. Their leadership development programs and employee-centric policies are notable examples of 'alignment' in the Imaginal Model.

3. Elevation Church:

While not a conventional company, Elevation Church (and similar religious institutions) inherently aims to advance God's Kingdom on earth. Their use of technology to reach a global audience and their leadership training and development programs can be seen as aligning with aspects of the Imaginal Model, particularly in terms of innovation and alignment.

Imaginal Organization Model

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The Imaginal Organization Model: A Framework for Future Leaders

In today's ever-evolving corporate landscape, the need for innovative and sustainable organization models is paramount. One such groundbreaking model is the "Imaginal Organization Model." Centered on a three-layered structure, this model offers a holistic approach to building robust and resilient organizations. Let's delve deep into its core components.

1. Culture: Values and Big WHY

At the base of the Imaginal Organization Model lies its culture. As the foundation for any thriving organization, culture serves as the very soil from which the organizational tree grows. For Imaginal Organizations, this isn't just about setting a list of values on paper; it's about imbibing a shared sense of "Big WHY."

But what is the "Big WHY"? In essence, it's the central purpose, the driving force behind every decision, every project, and every interaction within the organization. When employees understand and resonate with this 'WHY,' they are not just working for a paycheck; they are working towards a higher purpose. This shared understanding lights the fire of passion and commitment, transforming individual employees into a cohesive unit, all marching towards a common goal.

For Kingdom Companies, this 'Big WHY' extends even further—it's about advancing God's Kingdom on earth. Every decision, every project, and every interaction within such organizations isn't just for worldly success; it's for a higher purpose that aligns with divine intentions.

2. Alignment: Commitment to Excellence

With a strong culture in place, the next layer focuses on alignment. An organization can have the most passionate employees, but without a clear direction and sense of unity, their energy can be misdirected. The Imaginal Organization Model emphasizes the importance of aligning every team member with the company's mission and goals.

This layer promotes a commitment to excellence by nurturing a "human capital development framework." Instead of seeing employees as mere resources, the model views them as invaluable capital that can grow and appreciate over time. By investing in their continuous development, organizations not only enhance their skills but also instill a sense of ownership and responsibility. Employees feel empowered, knowing that they play a critical role in the company's success, further fueling their commitment to achieving excellence.

3. Innovation: Becoming Imaginal

Building on a solid foundation of shared values and alignment, the apex of the Imaginal Organization Model is centered on innovation. But this isn't just innovation for the sake of innovation. It's about "Becoming Imaginal."

By fostering a culture of innovation, organizations can create a sustainable competitive advantage. They continually reinvent themselves, staying ahead of the curve, and ensuring their longevity in the market. This constant evolution not only helps in staying relevant but also in attracting the best talent and clients who are always looking to align with forward-thinking entities.

The Imaginal Innovation Framework, fueled by Imaginal Thinking, provides organizations with tools and methodologies to not only keep pace with industry trends but also shape them. These insights are facilitated through Imaginal Transformation Centers, hubs of creative thinking and innovation where employees learn the art of seeing the future, drawing lessons from it, and then crafting that future.

By embracing Imaginal Thinking and leveraging Transformation Centers, organizations can pivot from being mere players in the market to pioneers, charting out paths that others will soon follow.

In Conclusion

The Imaginal Organization Model isn't just a theoretical framework; it's a call to action. It urges organizations to look beyond traditional models, to embrace a holistic approach that intertwines culture, alignment, and innovation. By fostering a culture rooted in a shared "Big WHY," aligning human capital towards a commitment to excellence, and adopting an innovative mindset, organizations can thrive in today's competitive landscape and build a legacy for the future.

For a Kingdom company it's a spiritual and strategic call to action. It urges organizations to look beyond conventional models, to embrace a holistic approach that intertwines divine purpose, leadership development, and proactive innovation.

Innovation Types

**SUSTAINING
INNOVATION**

Incremental Improvement

based on
Edward Deming's
Theories and Methods

**DISRUPTIVE
INNOVATION**

Market Changing Innovation

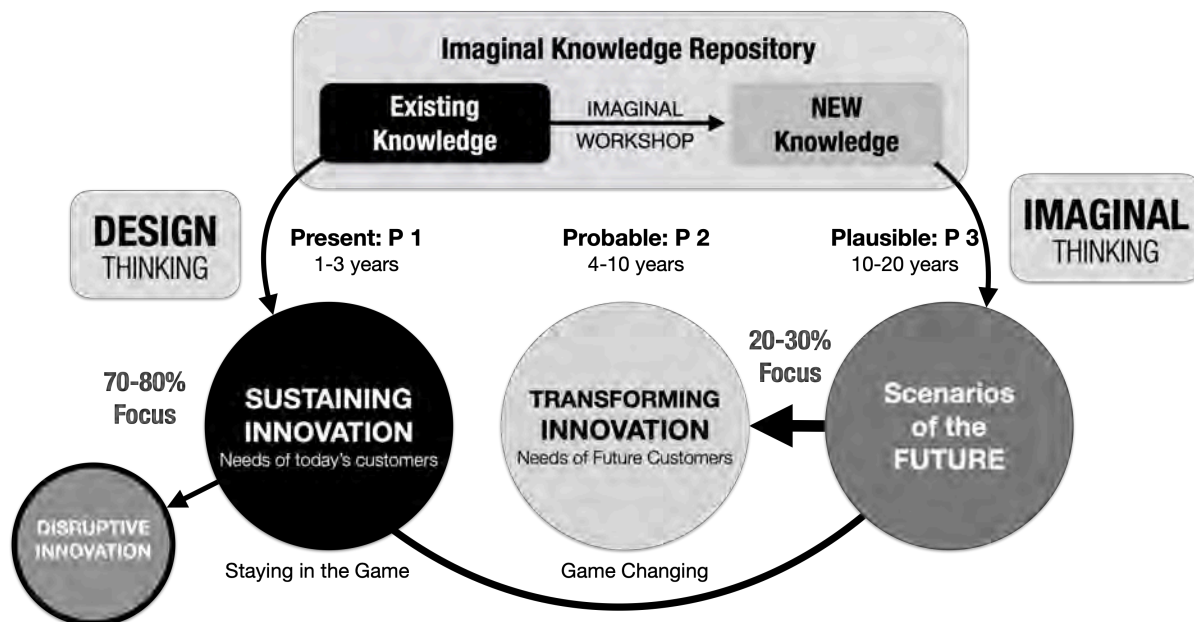
based on
Clayton's Christensen's
Theories and Methods

**TRANSFORMING
INNOVATION**

Innovation from the FUTURE

based on
Tom Rudmik's
Imaginal Theories and
Methods

Transforming Innovation



Transforming Innovation, as envisioned by Tom Rudmik, is a proactive and strategic approach to innovation, which focuses on pulling the future into the present. Instead of being reactive and trying to catch up with the evolving market trends, organizations proactively shape their future by envisioning it and creating new practices, products, or services that don't just improve upon the existing, but transform the marketplace. This innovation approach not only disrupts the current business landscape but also redefines it by reimagining what's possible, thus keeping the organization perpetually ahead in its competitive sphere.

Imaginal's Transforming Innovation



Clayton Christensen, in his seminal work, delineated two distinct forms of innovation: sustaining and disruptive. Many companies, he observed, are engaged in a continuous cycle of sustaining innovation — incremental enhancements that primarily serve to improve their existing products and services. At times, these companies manage to engineer disruptive innovations that dramatically reshape markets and consumer behavior. Both of these types of innovation hinge primarily on engineering design thinking processes that harness historical data and insights from existing customers or collaborations within their open innovation ecosystem to craft superior solutions for the future.

Imaginal's Transforming Innovation

Imaginal Transforming Innovation stands in a category of its own, representing a radical departure from conventional innovation approaches. These innovations are not merely iterations or advancements of what already exists, but are groundbreaking ideas conceived from visions of the future. These are innovations that, when manifested, have the capacity to entirely transform not just the company that birthed them, but the industry at large.

At the core of Imaginal's Transforming Innovation is a visionary perspective that is distinctly future-focused. Its methodology hinges on the principle of seeing and learning from the future, then retrospectively charting the pathways that will actualize that vision. This approach demands a certain degree of imaginative foresight, coupled with the ability to discern strong and weak signals in the present that can guide an organization in crafting potent future scenarios.

These scenarios, in turn, serve as immersive platforms for the organization. Having generated robust future scenarios, we can "futurecast"—immerse ourselves in these scenarios and extract insights by responding to questions like: What needs to change for this future to materialize? How would you align with this future? If you were an enterprise, would your present self be competitive in this future scenario, and so forth?

The responses to these questions provide invaluable insights, lessons gleaned from the future. These insights, in essence, set the stage for constructing a backcasting scenario, a reverse-engineered roadmap detailing how that particular future was brought to fruition. This process facilitates not just the envisioning of the future but also the strategic planning and actions necessary for an organization to transform itself in alignment with that future.

As such, Imaginal Transforming Innovation calls for a different kind of leadership - leaders who can intuit the future, decipher these signals, and harness them to build strategies and make decisions today that will prepare their organizations for that envisioned future. It's about learning from the future as it emerges. In the process, these innovations have the potential to catalyze widespread transformation, propelling an organization, and indeed an entire industry, into a new era of growth and relevance.

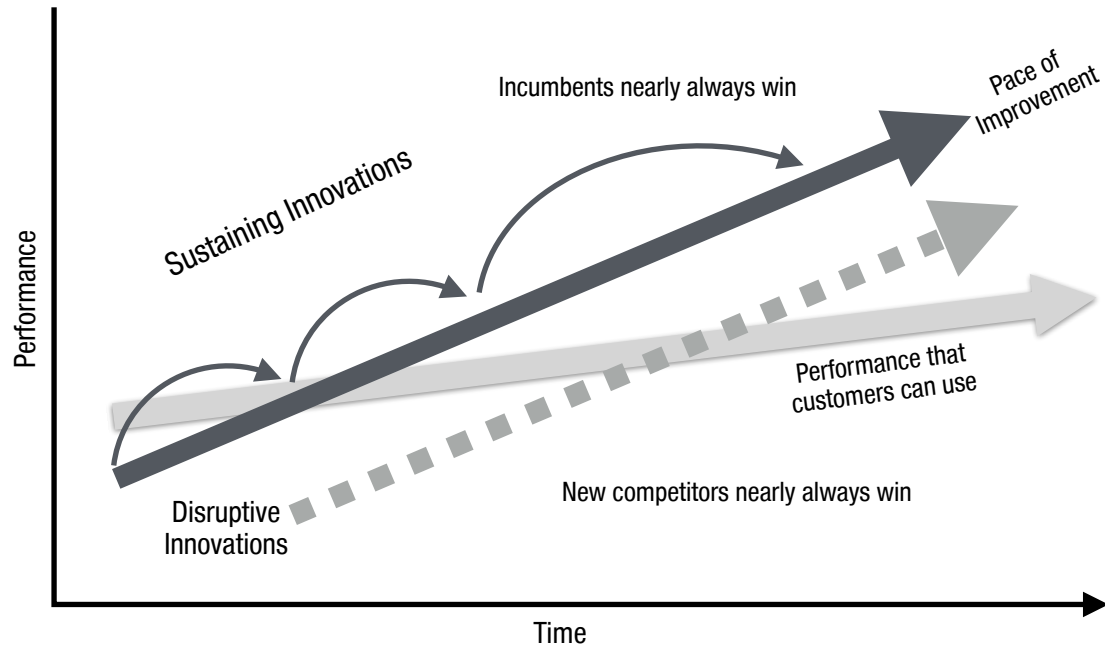
Unleashing Innovative Spirit

At the heart of Transforming Innovation lies the domain of futurism and the realm of future studies. It's a process that allows us to visualize, learn from, and shape the future. The fact that we can anticipate the future is premised on the existence of strong and weak signals present today.

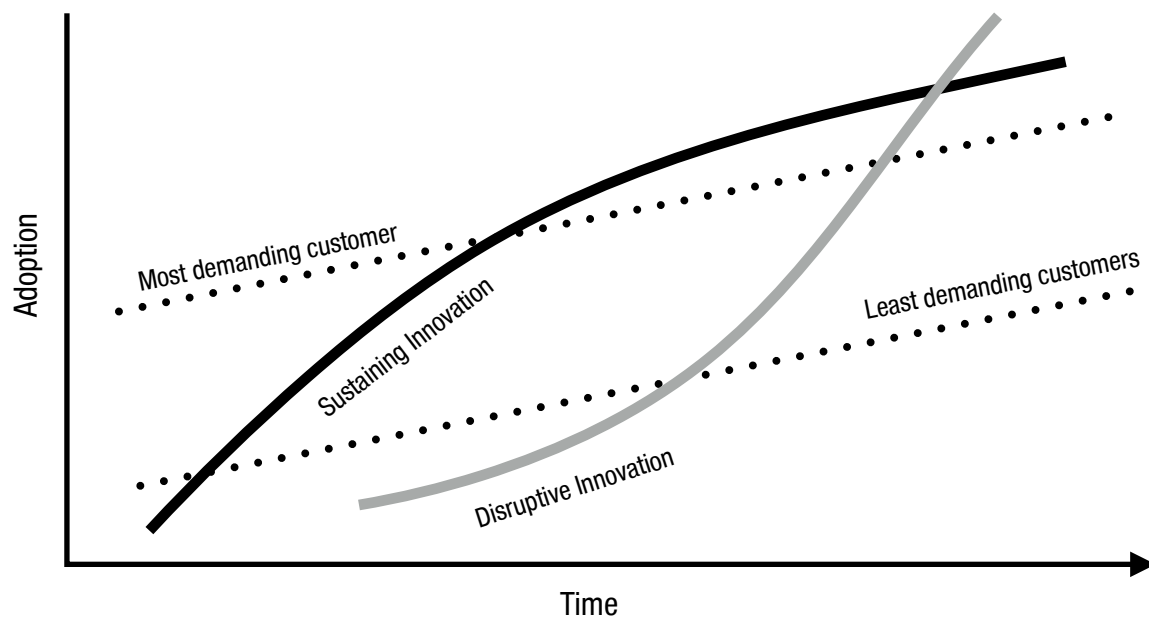
Strong signals often materialize as trends, backed by comprehensive research and data. A case in point is the growing inclination towards autonomous vehicles; it's an inevitability that self-driving cars and trucks will become the norm. We are surrounded by myriad trends across all societal sectors that will interplay and shape the future. S-curves help us map the adoption stage of each trend based on expert opinions.

Thorough future impact analysis allows Imaginal leaders to construct probable, plausible, and possible future scenarios, founded on their trend exploration. In the world of foresight or future studies, the objective isn't to foretell the future—an endeavor often laden with inaccuracies—but to craft various alternative futures, be they plausible, possible, probable, preferred, or preposterous.

Disruptive Innovation



Source: Clayton Christensen, The Innovators Solution



Source: Clayton Christensen, The Innovators Solution

Disruptive Innovation

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Christensen's Disruptive Innovation Theory

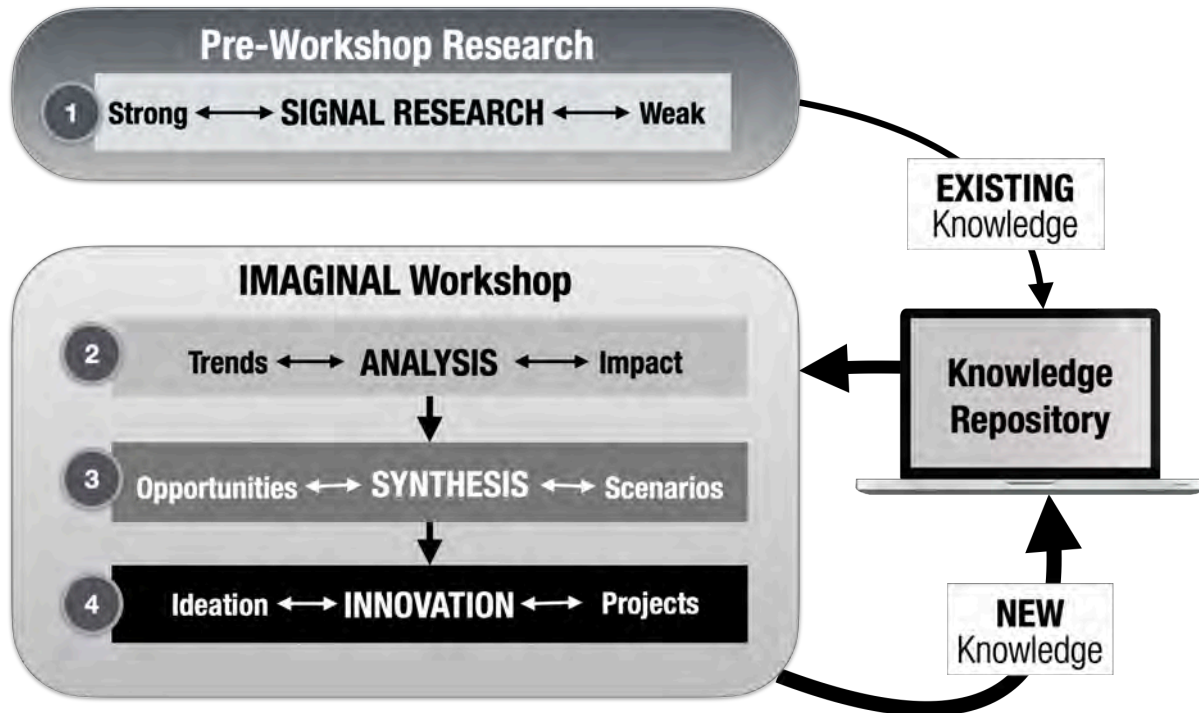
The theory of disruptive innovation was created by Harvard Business School professor Clayton Christensen. In his book *Innovator's Solution*, Christensen states that in every industry you have dominant products or solutions that are sustained by incremental improvement or innovations. Over time the functionality of the dominant solution outstrips the what the customer actually can use. Along comes a disruptive innovation and offers a solution that may be easier and less expensive begins to attract least demanding users.

Christensen's Innovators Dilemma

The context for disruptive innovation is created when a new inferior product is introduced into a marketplace that has a dominant product or solution that defines the space. At first, only those least demanding customers are willing to try the new product or solution; these customers are not the priority focus of the dominant provider, hence losing them as customers does not represent a threat. Over time, more and more of the customers at the low-end of the spectrum begin to 'jump' ship, leaving the company to focus one their higher demand more profitable customers. They do so by providing more functionalities and features to their product which they unquestionably believe will support their dominance in the marketplace. This strategy works for a period of time, meanwhile the disruptive innovation continues to grow both with usage and with features and eventually will overcome the dominant player. This phenomena was observed by Dr. Clayton Christensen which he developed into the theory of disruptive innovation.

One way for a company to combat disruptive innovation, is to create its own disrupter. A company can not afford to confuse its high-end customers with a low-end offering, however it might start a new company with a new offering targeting new customers that are not currently being served. Should some of the least demanding customers 'jump ship' to the new company offering, nothing is loss, since it still a part of its larger customer base.

Knowledge & Transforming Innovation



Pre-workshop Research:

Transforming Innovation is not an accidental or arbitrary process; instead, it unfurls as a deliberate consequence of a comprehensive, diligently planned ecosystem made up of multiple interconnected stages.

1. Signal Research: Initiating the Innovation Journey

The first step on the path to Transforming Innovation is comprehensive signal research conducted by a skilled team of investigators. This proactive exploration of the market and the wider business ecosystem is aimed at unearthing emerging trends, evolving patterns, and prospective disruptions. The information gleaned is meticulously catalogued and stored in the Imaginal Knowledge Repository, forming a treasure trove of insights that stimulate the Imaginal Thinking processes during the Imaginal Transformation Workshops. This extensive research lays the groundwork for the innovative thinking to follow; for example, a thorough analysis of trends and case studies can spark inventive thought processes among the participants, leading to the genesis of groundbreaking ideas.

New Knowledge Creation: Imaginal Workshop



Imaginal Workshops are vibrant collaborative multi-day experiences where new knowledge is generated and cultivated through a sequence of carefully planned steps.

1. PreWorkshop Research

The research phase provides the fuel that ignites the innovation process. The goal is to gather as much new information from many different perspectives as possible.

A workshop facilitator would setup research teams that would focus on domains that are relevant to the workshop. Included in the research will be articles on strong signals or trends that are currently observable and trackable. Weak signals from the fringe are also captured, these would come from various publications that are deemed to be futuristic.

With the proliferation of AI research tools this step may be integrated into the day 1 experience of the participants due to the time compression achieved using AI large language models. One still has to deal with the accuracy of the AI output.

2. Analysis: Dissecting Trends and Their Potential Impacts

At this stage, the data gathered during the research is meticulously disassembled and analyzed using various methodologies including S Curve Analysis, Future Wheel Analysis, and Force Field Analysis. Each of these tools provides a unique lens to focus on the discerned trends and their potential impacts.

- S Curve Analysis provides insight into the life cycle of products, technologies, or industries by plotting their performance over time. This helps in understanding the stages of introduction, growth, maturity, and decline, informing strategic decisions about resource allocation, innovation targets, and market positioning.
- Future Wheel Analysis, on the other hand, is a foresight method used to visually display direct and indirect future consequences of a particular trend or event. It provides a structured way to brainstorm potential future scenarios and their impacts, thereby helping to anticipate upcoming changes and strategize accordingly.
- Force Field Analysis serves to identify the forces that are either driving or resisting a particular change in the business ecosystem. By understanding these forces, the organization can plan effective strategies to reinforce the drivers and mitigate the resistors, thereby ensuring smoother execution of innovation initiatives

These methodical examinations generate new knowledge about the future, making it possible to create a pathway for informed and innovative decision-making. This deeper understanding equips the organization to better anticipate changes, grasp opportunities, and avoid potential pitfalls, thereby navigating its innovation journey more effectively.

3. Synthesis: Envisioning and Interacting with the Future:

This stage harnesses the power of techniques like the Manoa Method and Scenario Development to combine the newly acquired knowledge and to create multiple future scenarios. The Manoa Method provides a structured framework to detect emerging issues and to explore their ramifications, whereas Scenario Development helps in piecing together detailed and plausible circumstances of the future derived from the insights obtained. These methodologies empower participants to 'see' the future from various perspectives, fostering a comprehensive and farsighted understanding of the potential opportunities and challenges.

Upon establishing these future scenarios, Futurecasting and Backcasting techniques come into play, facilitating a two-way interaction with the future. Futurecasting places the organization in these prospective futures, allowing it to gauge its fit, navigate its role, and comprehend the dynamics of the environment. Meanwhile, Backcasting starts from the identified desirable future and works backward. This technique serves as a navigation tool, detailing how this future unfolds and tracing the sequence of events and decisions that led to it. With these insights, the organization can effectively strategize, adapt, and pave its path to the envisioned future."

4. Innovation: Translating Knowledge into Tangible Project Proposals

Armed with a multi-dimensional view of the future and guided by insights from the previous stages, this step delves deep into opportunity exploration and innovation ideation. Participants collaboratively brainstorm, sift through, and refine potential innovative solutions that resonate with the future scenarios crafted earlier. Emphasis is placed on identifying those innovations that not only address immediate needs but also position the organization favorably for long-term strategic advantage.

As the workshop progresses into its final modules, the focus narrows onto the concrete outcomes of all the Imaginal exploration that has transpired. Here, teams are inspired to crystallize their innovative ideas into comprehensive innovation project proposals. Each proposal serves as a project blueprint, encapsulating the core concept, objectives, anticipated impacts, resource allocation, cost estimation, and a timeline of milestones at various approval stages.

The ultimate objective of this stage is to provide a clear transition from theoretical constructs to viable projects that the organization can feasibly execute. It's about taking those leaps of innovation and grounding them into plans that can transform the organization from within. As the workshop concludes, these robust proposals become the actionable stepping stones that guide the organization on its transformative journey towards the future it has envisaged."

Four Lens of Innovation

Challenging Orthodoxies

What if the dominant conventions in your field, market, or industry are outdated, unnecessary, or just plain wrong?

Harnessing Trends

Where are the shifts and discontinuities that will, now and in the future, provide the energy you need for a major leap forward?

Leveraging Resources

How can you arrange existing skills and assets into new combinations that add up to more than the sum of their parts?

Understanding Needs

Understanding Needs
What are the unmet needs and frustrations that everyone else is simply ignoring?

<http://www.4lenses.it/en/>

Example Module from an Imaginal Transformation Workshop

Your Mission is to...

Choose one of the three innovation categories below and apply at least two of the four lenses of innovation to that category. For the sake of this exercise and time limitations do not discredit any ideas due to various constraints. . Examples of companies that disrupted their industry by creating new business models, products and services: ie. Bay, IKEA, Swatch, SouthWest Airlines, Dell, Apple, Amazon, FedEx

1. Business Model Innovation

Pick any business unit of your company and apply the four lenses of innovation to its business model. The goal is to design a new way of doing business. Questions to explore:

Who do we serve?

What do we provide?

How do we provide it?

How do we make money?

How do we differentiate and sustain advantage?

2. Disruptive Innovation

Select a business unit from company and identify the products and services that are being offered by the business unit. Apply the four lenses of innovation to these product or services and create some new possible products or services. The goal is to design a new product or service that has the potential to disrupt your industry sector.

New product or service that disrupts and industry.

3. New Venture Innovation

Leveraging some of your company's core competencies what new venture could you create that could become a major revenue source in a few short years.

Apply some Blue Ocean Strategy: shifting the focus from battling competitors, to creating "blue oceans" of uncontested market space. These strategic moves create a leap in value for the company, its buyers, and its employees while unlocking new demand and making the competition irrelevant.

Four Lens of Innovation



In his seminal work, "Four Lenses of Innovation: A Power Tool for Creative Thinking", Rowan Gibson masterfully uncovers the various pathways leading to the discovery of innovative opportunities. This book serves as a compass, guiding readers through four distinct lenses that, when employed effectively, can illuminate the roadmap towards breakthrough innovation. Gibson's thoughtful analysis and practical insights offer a unique perspective that challenges conventional thinking and inspires creative problem-solving, driving us to look beyond the status quo and envision new possibilities. With each lens, a new horizon of innovation unfolds, unlocking unprecedented opportunities for growth and transformation.

1. Challenging Orthodoxies

Within the intricate maze of our minds, we nestle rigid beliefs that usually go unchallenged, acting as the lens through which we interpret the world. These established mindsets, when applied to the organizational context, have a tendency to form 'the definitive way' of conducting business, often inhibiting our capacity to embrace innovation. Those who bring forth groundbreaking ideas, the innovators, frequently display a contrarian nature. They dare to critically analyze these unquestioned societal beliefs and norms that many blindly accept as truth. It is through this audacious act of challenging the status quo that they illuminate previously unexplored pathways to innovation.

2. Harnessing Trends

In the ever-evolving whirlwind of societal change, certain patterns or trends emerge with the potential to drastically alter the traditional industry landscapes and competitive dynamics. The real art is not just in identifying a singular trend, but rather recognizing a convergence of multiple trends, such as technology advancements, demographic shifts, lifestyle changes, regulatory reforms, and geopolitical transformations, to name a few. This holistic understanding and strategic harnessing of these converging forces can provide the launching pad for radical innovation, propelling organizations into new orbits of opportunity and growth.

3. Leveraging Resources

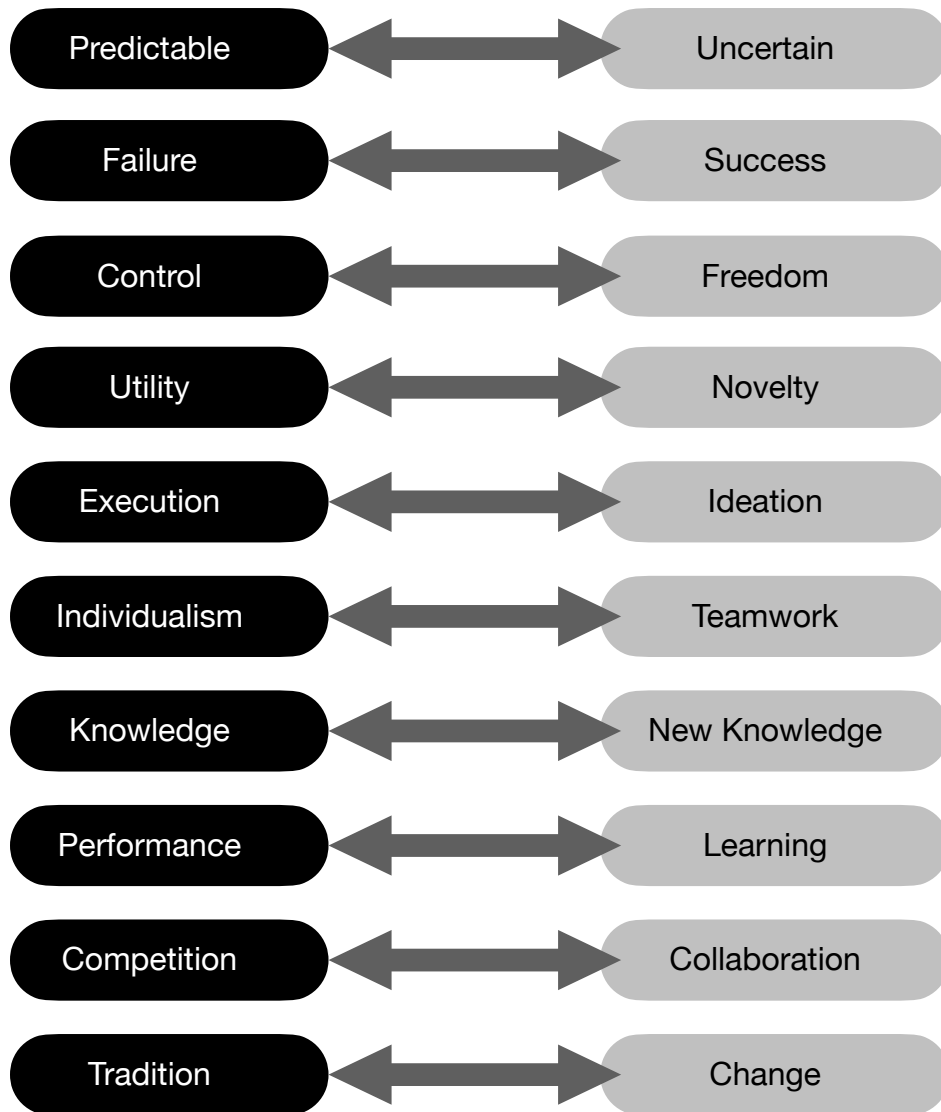
Core Competencies: Each organization is a unique tapestry woven from various strands, including specific skills, technologies, processes, and values. These distinctive elements are deeply embedded in the organization's fabric, representing its unique DNA that provides a competitive edge nearly impossible to replicate. These core competencies, more than mere strengths, form the bedrock upon which organizations can construct their innovative strategies.

Strategic Assets: These are the diverse elements ranging from supplier loyalty and financial strength (Input Assets), proprietary technology and functional expertise (Process Assets), distributor loyalty and brand recognition (Channel Assets), customer loyalty and information (Customer Assets), to a deep understanding of the market, customers, and competitors (Market Knowledge Assets). Each of these strategic assets offers an invaluable resource that can be harnessed to spur innovation.

4. Understanding Unmet Needs

Innovation often necessitates diving deep to discover those problems and needs that remain unvoiced and unaddressed. History is rife with revolutionary solutions that sprung from frustrations consumers hadn't articulated, simply because they couldn't envision an alternative. For instance, FedEx's overnight courier service, Dell's made-to-order computers, Starbucks' coffee house culture, or Amazon's global online bookstore; each of these revolutionary business models filled a void consumers were previously oblivious to. This knack to comprehend and address these silent, unmet needs forms the cornerstone of Transforming Innovation.

Paradox of Innovation



Here is a more pragmatic, structured aspect that necessitates a focused, strategic, and systemic approach to innovation. This side recognizes the importance of diligence, persistence, and a methodical approach to transforming creative ideas into reality.



Here is the dynamic, unbounded realm of exploration that encourages radical thinking and challenges orthodoxies. This dimension of innovation is about breaking new ground, pushing boundaries, and opening up novel avenues for growth and transformation.

Paradox of Innovation



Navigating the complex landscape of innovation often presents us with several paradoxes - seemingly contradictory yet interrelated elements that coexist and give shape to the overall process. Let's delve into ten central paradoxes of innovation, enriched with examples to provide a clearer perspective:

1. The Paradox of Predictability:

Innovation fundamentally thrives on uncertainty, spawning ideas and solutions that are often unforeseeable. Yet, businesses crave stability and predictability. For instance, Apple, known for its groundbreaking products, maintains a secret culture to manage the uncertainty of their innovative processes, while keeping its operational aspects highly predictable.

2. The Paradox of Failure:

In most circumstances, failure is seen as a setback. However, within the realm of innovation, failure is a valuable teacher. The numerous iterations and "failures" of Thomas Edison before successfully inventing the incandescent light bulb exemplify this paradox. Businesses must balance learning from failures while driving towards success.

3. The Paradox of Freedom and Control:

Creativity requires freedom, yet absolute liberty can lead to disorder and lack of direction. Conversely, excessive control can suffocate creativity. Google's '20% time', where employees are encouraged to spend 20% of their time on projects that interest them, is a classic example of balancing freedom and control for innovation.

4. The Paradox of Novelty and Utility:

Innovations need to be original, but also practical and market-friendly. A product too revolutionary might be tough to implement or not accepted by the market, while a trivial improvement may not provide substantial value. Tesla's electric cars, for example, balance this paradox by introducing revolutionary battery technology in the familiar form of an automobile.

5. The Paradox of Ideation and Execution:

The process of coming up with ideas (ideation) and implementing them (execution) demands distinct skills and attitudes. While ideation calls for open-minded thinking, execution necessitates focused, detail-oriented thinking. Companies like 3M, known for inventions like Post-it Notes, succeed by cultivating an environment that values both ideation and execution.

6. The Paradox of Individualism and Teamwork:

While individual ingenuity can spark brilliant ideas, innovation often stems from collaboration. Balancing respect for individual contributions with the need for effective teamwork is critical, as exemplified by the Skunk Works team at Lockheed Martin. Their small, dedicated teams worked semi-autonomously but in close collaboration to deliver pioneering aircraft designs.

These paradoxes serve as a guide to understanding and navigating the complexities inherent in innovation. Recognizing and managing these paradoxes can help foster a more dynamic, resilient, and innovative organizational culture.

7. The Paradox of Knowledge:

Innovation thrives on new knowledge, yet too much information can lead to analysis paralysis. Organizations must strike a balance between nurturing knowledge and avoiding overload, ensuring they are aware of the latest trends and technologies without getting overwhelmed.

8. Paradox of Learning versus Performance:

Organizations need to perform and deliver immediate results, often focusing on existing strategies (exploitation). However, they also need to learn, grow, and innovate for the future, which requires exploring new opportunities and taking risks (exploration). Balancing these seemingly opposing needs is crucial for sustainable innovation.

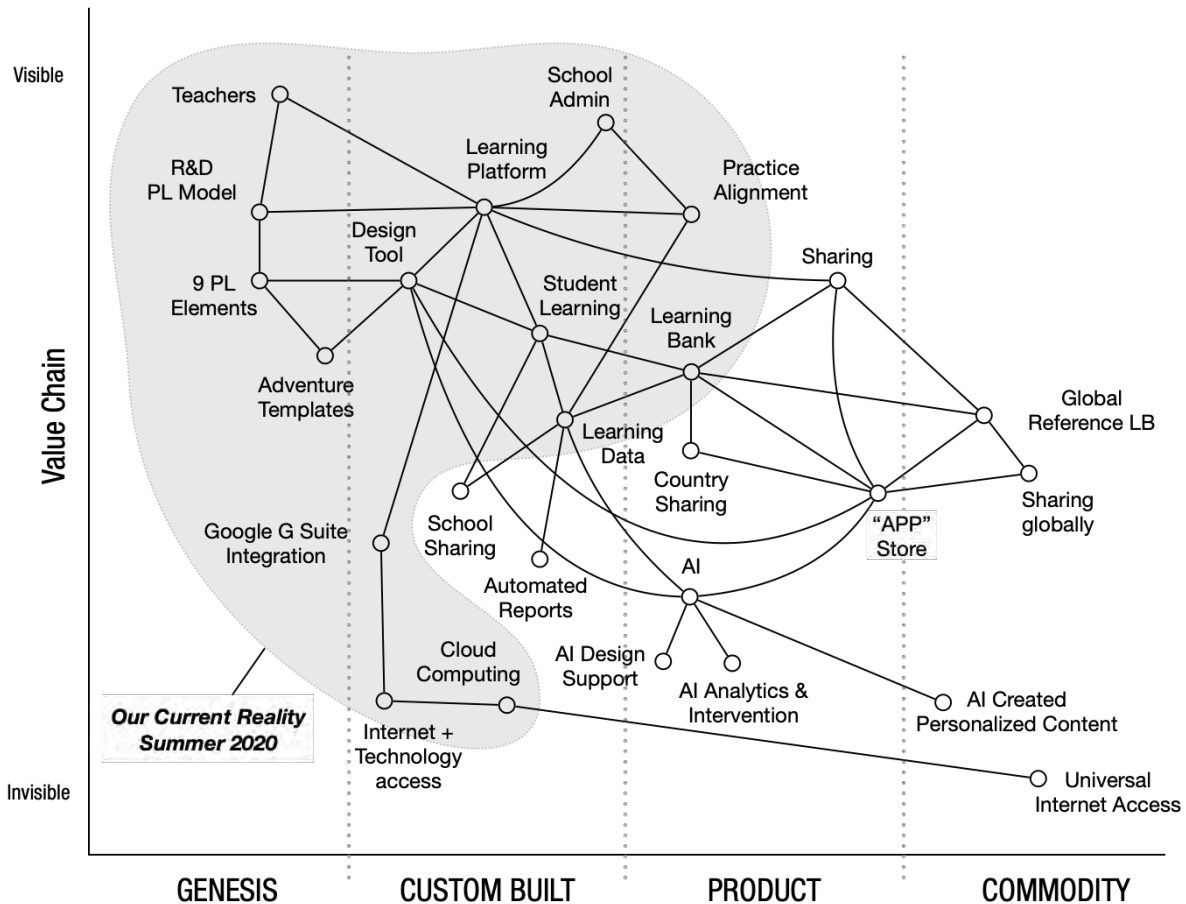
9. The Paradox of Competition and Collaboration:

In certain instances, businesses need to compete fiercely to innovate. Yet, in others, they benefit significantly from collaborating with their competitors (a concept known as "co-opetition"). For example, Apple and Google compete in the smartphone market, but Google also provides various apps and services on Apple's iOS platform.

10. The Paradox of Tradition and Change:

While innovation is about change and progress, holding onto certain traditions can provide stability and continuity. Balancing respect for tradition with the necessity of change is a delicate task, as demonstrated by companies with a long history like IBM, which has reinvented itself multiple times over the decades while maintaining its core values.

Imaginal Platform - Wardley Map



Wardley Map for Imaginal Education's digital platform.

Wardley Map



Visualizing Your Landscape

The Wardley Evolution Map, a strategic business tool conceived by Simon Wardley, was specifically designed to aid organizations in making strategic, future-oriented decisions by visually representing the landscape of their business. Inspired by Sun Tzu's "Art of War", Wardley perceived the necessity of a profound comprehension of the conditions within which businesses function, and the principles underpinning their operation. While there were existing tools – some even referred to as 'maps' – that endeavored to provide businesses with insights into various aspects of their operation, none offered a comprehensive, visual depiction of the business landscape. Using a military analogy, Wardley posited that understanding the terrain of the battleground is indispensable for devising a potent strategy.

The Wardley Map melds value chain analysis of an organization's offerings with the evolving pattern of product or service evolution, offering a visually explicit representation of the business's current position and areas that may necessitate more attention or investment. This strategic tool provides businesses with the intelligence necessary to navigate the ever-changing business landscape, and facilitates informed decision-making about the organization's direction and investment priorities.

In the context of an Imaginal Organization, while the 'Big WHY' articulates the overarching purpose or moral reason for the organization's existence, it doesn't guide the day-to-day 'why' of strategic decision-making. To answer these 'whys', a more intricate understanding of the business environment, the competition, and the forces that shape the landscape is needed.

To illustrate this, let's take the example of the digital learning platform developed by Imaginal Education. Here, Wardley's mapping approach was applied to visualize the strategic landscape of the platform, guiding its development and decision-making. The subsequent steps will elucidate how this map was constructed, offering an insightful illustration of this strategic tool in action..

Step 1: Identifying Customer or User Needs

The process begins with discerning who your customers are and understanding their needs. The Wardley map is anchored in the user and their needs. Each element's position on the map is displayed relative to this user along a value chain, depicted on the y-axis.

Step 2: Value Chain

The value chain outlines how you're addressing the needs of your customers. The value chain example provided represents a broad perspective of not just the current customers' needs but also the future ones. Each element on this chain is dependent on the one beneath it, with the elements closer to the top having a higher visibility to the user.

Step 3: Evolution Mapping

The lifecycle of a product or service typically progresses through the stages of genesis, custom build, product, and eventually becomes a commodity. As you plot your value chain, consider these evolutionary stages of your product or service. Grasping each stage and the placement of your product or service within the market will aid in formulating your strategies. This mapping technique proves most valuable in the early stage of your product development. Each stage on the map reveals potential innovation opportunities that will shape your strategic decision-making. This four-stage lens allows you a glimpse into the future from which you can extract valuable insights.

Key questions:

What foundational principles or values steer your business, and how do they influence your strategic planning?

What is your organization's Big WHY, and what are the underlying 'whys' that motivate your strategic planning process?

What "climatic" patterns are emerging that will affect your strategic decision-making? This encompasses current market dynamics and future trends based on your reading of future signals and the Imaginal Thinking process.

How can you overcome the inertia that hinders forward progress, particularly the kind that's tied to past successes? For Imaginal Organizations, we recommend initiating obsolescence in-house before taking it to the market.

Wardley Evolution Mapping

CHARACTERISTICS	GENESIS	CUSTOM BUILT	PRODUCT	COMMODITY
Ubiquity	Rare	Slowly increasing consumption	Rapidly increasing consumption	Widespread and stabilizing
Certainty	Poorly understood	Rapid increase in learning	Rapid increases in use/fit for purpose	Commonly understood in terms of use
Publication Types	Normally describe the wonder of the thing	Build, construct awareness and learning	Maintenance, operations, installation, features	Focused on use
GENERAL PROPERTIES				
Market	Undefined	Forming	Growing	Mature
Knowledge Mgmt	Uncertain	Learning on use	Learning on operation	Known, accepted
Market Perception	Chaotic (non-linear)	Domain of experts	Increasing expectation of use	Ordered (appearance of being linear), trivial
User Perception	Different, confusing, exciting, suprising	Leading edge, emerging	Increasingly common, disappointed if not used	Standard, expected
Perception in Industry	Competitive advantage, unpredictable, unknown	Competitive advantage, ROI, case examples	Advantage through implementation, features	Cost of doing business
Focus of Value	High future worth	Seeking profit, ROI?	High profitability	High volume, reducing margin
Understanding	Poorly understood, unpredictable	Increasing understanding, development of measures	Increasing education, refinement, measures	Well defined, stable, measurable
Comparison	Constantly changing, unstable	Learning from others, testing the waters	Feature difference	Essential, operational advantage
Failure	High, tolerated, assumed	Moderate, not surprising, but disappointed	Not tolerated, focus on constant improvement	Operational efficiency and surprised by failure
Market Action	Gambling, driven by gut	Exploring a 'found' value	Market analysis, listening to customers	Metric driven, build what is needed
Efficiency	Reducing the cost of change (experimentation)	Reducing the cost of waste (learning)	Reducing the cost of waste (learning)	Reducing the cost of deviation (volume)
Decision Drivers	Heritage, culture	Analysis and synthesis	Analysis and synthesis	Previous experience

<https://blog.gardeviance.org/2016/04/whats-in-wardley-map-and-need-for-cheat.html>

Wardley Evolution Mapping

Wardley Map- Visualizing Your Landscape

Simon Wardley, the creator of the Wardley Mapping technique, proposes an insightful model describing how innovations journey through a lifecycle composed of four distinct stages. This evolution starts with the birth of an original concept or 'genesis', proceeds to a stage where the concept is customized and tailored to fit specific requirements, advances further to the stage of productization where it is scaled and standardized, and finally reaches the commoditization phase where competitive offerings are almost indistinguishable from each other.

Each stage in this evolutionary progression carries its own unique competitive dynamics, innovation strategies, and process enhancements. Furthermore, recognizing the specific stage an innovation occupies on this spectrum is critical in foreseeing significant market shifts and responding in a way that safeguards the organization's competitiveness.

Genesis:

This is the stage where an idea or a concept comes into being. Here, the focus is primarily on proving the concept's feasibility. The innovation is unique and not yet commercialized. The competition is limited or non-existent as the organization is usually the pioneer in this space.

Custom-Built:

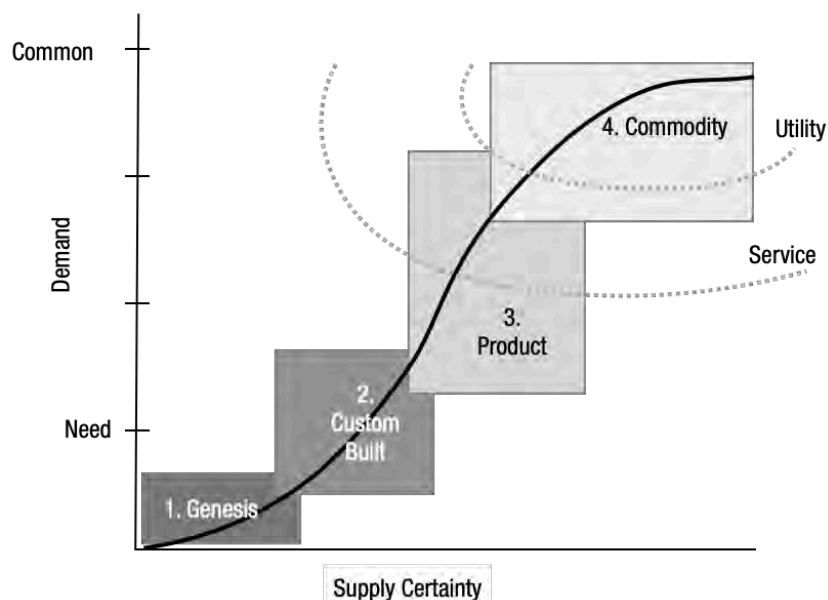
Once the genesis phase has proven successful, the innovation is now tailored and customized to meet specific requirements. It has demonstrated its value and has thus entered a more competitive landscape. The aim here is to offer something uniquely suited to customer needs, differentiating from other market players.

Product: Following the custom-built phase, the innovation becomes a standard, mass-produced product. The concept has now matured and been optimized for scalability. While there is competition, it is based on the quality, price, and features of the standardized product.

Commoditized:

The final stage is commoditization, where the competitive offerings become largely identical, and the primary differentiator becomes cost. The focus is on delivering this commodity efficiently, with process enhancement playing a key role.

Understanding these stages and where your innovation stands on this trajectory will enable an organization to navigate the landscape with clarity, optimizing processes, and formulating effective strategies for innovation. Wardley's comprehensive summary of the characteristics and properties of these stages, as shared on his blog, provides an excellent guide for any organization on this journey.



Imaginal Workshop Part I

Sample Workshop Invite

Our world today has been profoundly shaped by Imaginal Leaders who saw a different future, the likes of Steve Jobs, Bill Gates, Mahatma Gandhi, Karl Benz, Henry Ford, Johannes Gutenberg, Martin Luther King Jr., Albert Einstein, and Elon Musk to name a few, who were willing to step out of their comfort zones and create obsolescence in their world. All new innovations and advancements have been created by Imaginal Leaders

The Imaginal Transformation Workshop (ITW) is for leaders – who have the passion, courage and vision to engage in the process of seeing and creating the future for their organization. Imaginal leaders are not only dissatisfied with the current system, they have a deep desire to create something that is much better, a breakthrough model for their industry. Imaginal leaders are Innovators and Early Adopters, they are not looking for best practices, they are the ones who create them.

Imaginal leaders understand, that in today's hyper competitive world, an organization needs to out innovate its competition by "creating obsolescence". Obsolescence is created by Imaginal leaders who see a different future and have the ability to create that future and so doing create disruptive changes in their industry. Obsolescence occurs in every industry, its a given, the question is who will create obsolescence for your organization, will you create your own obsolescence or will someone create it for you.

Most successful businesses have developed a fine tuned business "Performance Engine" that drives profitability by providing consistent high value to its customers. In today's rapid changing world an organization's ability to innovate its future is the most important core competency for success, but can not be achieved by improving efficiency within the business "Performance Engine" alone. In a global CEO survey by IBM, 65% indicated that they feared a change in their competitive landscape by a competitor that would threaten their future business. To be leader in an industry sector an organization needs to Becoming an Imaginal Organization by developing its "Innovation Engine" that will continuously create obsolescence, first internally for the organization and secondly for the industry itself.

We are planning to conduct a series of Imaginal Transformation Workshops over the next few months with the focus on elevating your organization's ability to innovate. The goal is define and design the philosophy and processes that will become your organization's "Innovation Engine" that will drive its competitive advantage for years to come.

Workshop 1- Defining: Focus on your organizations core value, the Innovative Spirit, what is it, what needs to change, what will the company look like in 10-15 years from now.

Workshop 2- Designing: Designing various systems and processes that will become Jacto's "Innovative Engine",

Workshop 3-Implementing: Early Adopter Implementation of your organization's emerging "Innovative Engine".

Imaginal Workshop Overview



Imaginal Workshops

In today's fast-paced and highly competitive business environment, there's a clear mantra: adapt swiftly or risk fading into obsolescence. The Imaginal workshop is a process that increase that ability of an Imaginal Organization to thrive in the world of massive change.

1. The Challenge of Innovation

Understanding the Innovator's Dilemma: At its core, the Innovator's Dilemma presents a paradox. While there's an undeniable urge to push boundaries and innovate, there's also a parallel obligation to cater to the existing clientele, ensuring steady revenue streams. Balancing these contrasting demands requires strategic foresight.

Resource Allocation: It's not merely about investing financial resources. Time, talent, and technological assets must be deployed efficiently to drive both current operations and future-oriented innovations.

2. Knowledge Expansion and Organizational Adaptability

Knowledge Boom: The digital age has led to an explosion in accessible knowledge. For businesses, this means continually updating practices, learning from emerging data, and being open to revising long-held beliefs.

The modern business environment is characterized by an exponential growth in knowledge. This continuous expansion demands that organizations remain adaptable and receptive to new information. Failure to do so can render an organization obsolete, missing out on essential trends and insights that drive the industry forward.

AI as a Research Assistant: Prior to and during workshops or strategy meetings, AI can serve as an efficient research assistant. Its capacity to collate, analyze, and present data in real-time makes it a formidable tool. Instead of spending hours or even days in preparation, AI can compile and update necessary materials in moments, ensuring that discussions are grounded in the most current data available.

3. Human Capital: The Forefront of Change

Empowering Individuals: The emphasis is now more than ever on human potential. The most successful companies are those that invest in their people, fostering environments where employees at all levels feel empowered to innovate.

Visionary Leadership: The role of executives has evolved. Beyond management, they're now expected to be visionaries, guiding their teams toward a promising future.

4. Complexity: A Demand for Enhanced Processes

Integrated Solutions: As business operations become more intricate, there's a growing need for integrated solutions that can handle complex tasks with efficiency.

Adapting to Change: Amidst evolving market dynamics, businesses should adopt flexible processes, capable of pivoting in response to unforeseen challenges or opportunities.

5. Diversity as a Catalyst for Innovation

Harnessing Varied Perspectives: A diverse team brings together a multitude of experiences, insights, and problem-solving approaches. Such rich backgrounds can be the catalyst for breakthrough ideas.

Collaborative Innovation: By encouraging collaboration amongst diverse teams, businesses can ensure that prototypes or solutions are well-rounded, catering to a broader audience.

6. The Imperative for an Imaginal Transformation Center

A Dedicated Innovation Hub: An Imaginal Transformation Center would act as a hub for forward-thinking. It would be a space dedicated to fostering new ideas, testing novel concepts, and ensuring the organization stays at the forefront of its industry.

Promoting Imaginal Leadership: Beyond mere ideation, the center would promote Imaginal leadership principles, emphasizing vision, courage, and adaptability, guiding the business into the future.

7. AI Integration in the Imaginal Transformation Center

Power of AI to Elevate Workshop Performance: Integrating AI into the Imaginal Transformation Center (ITC) transcends traditional boundaries of productivity and innovation. Beyond its prowess in data analysis and pattern recognition, AI acts as a formidable research assistant, delving into vast reservoirs of information and extracting precise, relevant insights in a fraction of the time it would take a human. This efficiency not only saves enormous amounts of time but also ensures that the data and insights are as accurate and up-to-date as possible. As AI manages these extensive research tasks, individuals are liberated to concentrate on brainstorming, critical thinking, and innovative ideation. The result is a harmonious synergy where AI augments human capabilities, providing real-time insights, facilitating collaboration, and sharpening decision-making. In this enriched environment, human creativity and collaboration are positioned at the forefront, unfettered by the limitations of traditional research processes.

Imaginal Workshop Part II

Sample Workshop Agenda Spreadsheet

Start	End	Hr: Min	Module	Description	Logistics	Resources
8:00 AM	8:30 AM	0:30	Registration	Participants arrive and check in	Make sure everyone is logged into Geenius	
8:30 AM	9:30 AM	1:00	1A Welcome	Sponsor welcome and charge Rules of Engagement - A spiritual undertaking	TEAM A- Arrival teaming (unprescribed) Everyone sitting at tables, internet polling	AV - Projector, audio,
9:30 AM	9:40 AM	0:10	1B Who you are	Introduction: each participant, what gift I bring, my desired outcome.	Microphone will be passed from table to table- no more than 30 seconds/participant	1 wireless microphone used by participants 1 wireless microphone used by TR
9:40 AM	10:20 AM	0:40	2A Country's History	Creating a 150 year History of your Country's Timeline - segment into historical blocks (live with participants)	TEAM A- Arrival teaming Timeline is already hanging on the wall, - will need masking tape and sticky tack - group brainstorm and writes key events	Each table will have (3x5) yellow post-it notes Large scroll of paper 3ft x 12ft hanging on wall 3-fine tipped black permanent marker/table
10:20 AM	11:30 AM	1:10	2B Current Reality	Force Field Analysis (FFA) Why is Uganda still a poor country? (includes synthesis)	TEAM B- 50% move to new team 7 teams - 3 people from each table move to the adjacent table- Assign a sector to each table.	Seven flip charts (need at least 2 flipchart pads 3x7=21 for the three days Flip Chart colour markers Sticky Tack to 'hang' flip chart paper on the wall
11:30 AM	12:00 PM	0:30	2C R/O	Each team reports out their FFA - 3 min/team		
12:00 PM	12:40 PM	0:40	3A Future New Economy	Gathering Knowledge- trends impacting New Economy	TEAM C - Component Teams research- assigned component take notes of key trends impact New Economy	
12:40 PM	1:25 PM	0:45	Lunch			
1:25 PM	2:45 PM	1:20	3B Trends Map	Create a Trends Map- for your PE component using the 6 STEEP categories	Create trends map on one flip chart paper - landscape orientation	Flip chart paper and pens 3x5 Post it- one pack of 100 per table
2:45 PM	3:45 PM	1:00	4A Model Building 1	Same Teams as in Module 4, Model Building- 2 D schematic	TEAM C - Component Teams 7 Teams for each of the components of New Economy	Use flip chart to create a visual model for their PE component
3:45 PM	4:45 PM	1:00	4B Model Building 2	Create a 3D physical model- subsystem using bricolage	Same teams as 5A	7- 4'x4' base (2 from a 4'x8' foam core sheet) craft supplies, multiple size styrofoam balls, blocks, string, pipe cleaners, tooth picks, popsicle sticks, paint, etc. the more the better
4:45 PM	5:15 PM	0:30	4C Model Building 3	Join all the subsystems to create one large System	Self Organizing- observing the group behaviour is part of the discovery	Need open space in the room where we can place the 7 - 3D models and connect them using various connector objects (string) etc.
5:15 PM	5:45 PM	0:30	4D Synthesis	Debrief, complex systems	sustainability, corruption, failure points	large group debrief standing around the New Economy Model
5:45 PM	5:55 PM	0:10	5A Home Research	Trends research for their New Economy component	all participants will have access to Knowledge Banks	

Imaginal Workshop Example



Imaginal Workshops

The following is an overview of an actual workshop that was conducting in an African country in May of 2022 at the request of the Ministry of Science, Technology and Innovation. In launching the project, a collaboration was established with a national think tank through a formal agreement, setting the stage for a bespoke Imaginal workshop aimed at achieving the objectives set by the Ministry of Science, Technology and Innovation. The initial phase relied on thorough research, gathering experts from the think tank and government sectors to dive into a wide array of subjects relevant to the project. Utilizing a sophisticated digital platform and a vast knowledge repository, over 200 articles were compiled, offering diverse perspectives on the project's themes.

To enhance efficiency and understanding, the project was segmented into seven distinct areas, facilitating a structured analysis of the extensive research material. This strategic approach ensured a detailed examination of each relevant field. The culmination of this preparatory work was the Imaginal Workshop, which began by recognizing the country's spiritual roots and how these could align with the project's goals, particularly in developing a sector focused on combating both biological and societal challenges.

The workshop's structure followed a seven-step Imaginal Thinking Process, divided across three days, where participants were organized into teams to delve into current challenges, future possibilities, and strategic planning for the new industry.

The workshop followed the seven-step Imaginal Thinking Process over the course of three days, varying teams depending on the module. These modules generally followed the seven step Imaginal Thinking Process,

1. Setting Conditions
2. Learning from the Past
3. Learning from the Present
4. Seeing Futures
5. Learning from the Futures
6. Redefining Strategic Focus:
7. Creating the Future:

With a little over 50 participants we were able to have 8-10 teams that would vary depending on the module

Day 1: Learning from the Present

- Module 1 - Who are we
- Module 2 - Explore why your country still poor?

- Module 3A - Gathering of information from the research phase of the project
- Module 3B- Identify key trends - creating a trends map
- Module 4A - Research and develop model for the seven components of the New Economy
- Module 4B - Develop a physical 3D model of the specific component
- Module 4C - Merge the physical models into one large New Economy system
- Module 5A - Homework: Identify key factors leading to successful economic development from a specific book,

Day 2- Seeing the Future

- Module 5B - Sharing success factors
- Module 6 - Teams identifying top trends impacting their PE component
- Modules 7 - Conducting an impact analysis of the top trends
- Module 8 - First iteration of design for the New Economy
- Module 9 - Scenario development
- Module 10 - Identifying what is the real problem that we are trying to solve?

Day 3- Learning and Creating the Future.

- Module 11 A-C - Designing the Future
- Module 12 - Identifying strategies by which the future can be created

Critical to the workshop's success was the documentation and synthesis of new knowledge generated by participants. This effort was supported by a dedicated team from the think tank, highlighting the importance of capturing and leveraging insights to shape future strategies and innovations. Post-workshop, the think tank compiled a comprehensive report detailing the workshop's findings and recommendations for the Ministry, presenting a vision for the future that incorporates economic, social, and spiritual dimensions.

This report is positioned as a cornerstone for future strategic initiatives, offering a vision that transcends traditional economic development to encompass a broader, spiritually-integrated perspective. The transformation envisaged is one that marries material progress with cultural and spiritual growth, proposing a multi-dimensional strategy for national advancement that is rooted in the country's values and aspirations.

Current Reality Canvas

1. Your Big WHY

2. Key STEEP Trends

3. Customer Needs

4. Competition

5. Uncertainties

6. Opportunities and Threats

Current Reality Canvas

The Current Reality Canvas provides a structured approach for organizations to strategically assess their operational environment and align their missions accordingly. It encompasses six key components: articulating a Greater Purpose or Big WHY to guide every action and decision; identifying influential STEEP trends for proactive strategy adjustment; understanding current customer needs for better alignment of offerings; assessing the competition to inform strategic positioning; navigating through uncertainties to enhance resilience; and mapping potential opportunities and threats for informed decision-making. This comprehensive framework enables organizations, from educational charities to technology companies, to critically evaluate their current standing and future directions, ensuring they are equipped to adapt, innovate, and thrive in a dynamic landscape.

Current Reality Canvas



1. Greater Purpose - Your Big Why:

This element delves into your organization's core purpose or mission - the overarching reason why it exists. The Big Why is more than just a mission statement; it's the foundation upon which the entire organization is built, the driving force that guides every decision, strategy, and action.

Example 1: An organization might define its Big Why as "developing a breakthrough Christian Education model and to share it with the world" Every decision, from the core pedagogical philosophy, the design of digital learning platform, to developing students as being future ready, would be guided by this mission.

Example 2: A technology company might define its Big Why as "Making technology accessible and affordable for everyone." All its strategies, including product design, pricing, and marketing, would be designed to fulfill this purpose.

2. Identifying Key STEEP Trends:

This involves identifying major trends across Social, Technological, Economic, Environmental, and Political (STEEP) fields that can impact your organization. Recognizing these trends can help you align your strategies and adapt to change effectively.

Example 1: A rise in social media usage (a technological trend) might influence a faith-based organization to enhance its online presence and utilize these platforms for outreach and fellowship.

Example 2: An apparel company might identify a growing environmental trend of sustainable fashion and start producing clothes from recycled materials.

3. Understanding Current Customer Needs:

This component is about comprehending the present and near-future needs, demands, and expectations of your customers or stakeholders. By deeply understanding these aspects, your organization can better align its offerings and improve its communication, thereby increasing value creation and stakeholder engagement.

Example 1: A faith-based charity working on poverty alleviation might identify a current need among its stakeholders for transparency and direct impact. Recognizing this, the charity could implement a more comprehensive communication strategy, sharing stories of how donations are directly improving lives, and reinforcing the charity's commitment to integrity and accountability.

Example 2: A technology company might find that its current customers are increasingly concerned about data privacy. Understanding this shift, the company could invest in enhancing the privacy features of its existing products and emphasize these advancements in its marketing communications.

4. Assessing the Competition:

This involves identifying potential competitors and understanding their strategies, strengths, and weaknesses. While competition might seem primarily relevant to businesses, even faith-based organizations can benefit from understanding the landscape in which they operate.

Example 1: A charity focused on water sanitation might face competition from new NGOs with innovative, cost-effective water purification technologies, potentially impacting their donor appeal and project implementation.

Example 2: An electronics retailer might consider both local and online stores as competitors and work on enhancing their customer service and product range to differentiate themselves.

5. Navigating through Uncertainties:

This entails identifying uncertainties that might impact your organization, allowing you to manage risks effectively and build resilience.

Example 1: A charity that depends heavily on volunteer labor might face uncertainties related to changing labor laws or societal attitudes towards volunteerism.

Example 2: A business in the energy sector might encounter uncertainties around future regulations concerning carbon emissions or the adoption rate of renewable energy technologies

6. Mapping Opportunities and Threats:

This involves identifying potential opportunities that your organization can leverage and threats it might face, aiding in strategic planning and decision-making.

Example 1: An educational charity might identify an opportunity in partnering with ed-tech firms to scale their impact, but face the threat of reduced funding due to economic downturns.

Example 2: A car manufacturer might see an opportunity in the growing interest in electric vehicles but a threat in potential regulations on fossil fuel consumption. This would inform its product development and lobbying strategies.

Business Model Canvas

Vision - Describe your preferred future. - What are the drivers for this future? - Who are the drivers for this future?	Value Proposition: - What is your Big WHY - What value do we deliver to the customer? - Which one of our customer's problem's are we helping to solve? - Which customer needs are we satisfying?	Key Activities - Which Key Activities do our Value Proposition require - Our distribution channels? - Customer relationships? - Revenue Streams	Customer Relationships - What type of relationship does each of our customer segments expect us to establish and maintain with them? - Which ones have we established? - How are they integrated wit the rest of our business model? - How costly are they?	Customer Segments - What value do we deliver to the customer? - Who are out most important customers? - What are the types of customers or segments?
Key Partners - Who are our Key Partners? - Who are your key suppliers? - Which Key Resources are we acquiring from partners? - Which Key Activities do partners perform?	Key Resources - What Key Resources do our Value Propositions require? - Our Distribution Channels? - Customer Relationships? - Revenue streams?	Channels - Through which channels do our customer segments want to be reached? - How are we reaching them now? - How are the channels integrated - Which one are most cost efficient? - How are we integrating them with Customer routines?		
	Cost Structures - What are the most important costs inherent in our business model? - Which key resources are most expensive? - Which key activities are most expensive?	Revenue Streams - What value are our customers really willing to pay? - For what do they currently pay? - How are they currently paying? - How would they prefer to pay? - How much does each revenue stream contribute to overall revenues?		

Use Case for Business Model Canvas

Idea Validation: In an Imaginal workshop, participants might come up with multiple innovative ideas. Using a Business Model Canvas can be an effective way to systematically explore and validate these ideas. By breaking down each idea into key components like value proposition, customer segments, revenue streams, etc., participants can assess the feasibility and potential impact of each idea. It also allows them to identify potential challenges or gaps in their initial conception and refine their ideas accordingly.

Transition Strategy Development: If the workshop is focused on transformation or transition strategies for an existing organization, the Business Model Canvas can provide a clear snapshot of the current business model. Participants can then imagine and chart new components on the canvas that align with the Imaginal's vision. This can serve as a roadmap for the organization's transformation journey.

Modeling Disruptive Innovations: When exploring disruptive or radical innovations during the Imaginal workshop, the Business Model Canvas can be instrumental. Participants can sketch out how these innovations might disrupt the existing business model and imagine entirely new models that could emerge. This could reveal opportunities for the organization to be the disruptor rather than the disrupted.

Scenario Planning: The Business Model Canvas can be used in conjunction with the Manoa Method and other futures studies tools to consider how different future scenarios might impact the business model. By creating different versions of the canvas for different possible futures, participants can devise strategies that ensure the organization's resilience and adaptability.

Business Model Canvas



The Imaginal Business Model Canvas

The Imaginal Business Model Canvas is a unique adaptation of the standard Business Model Canvas, offering a more holistic, vision-based approach to organizational transformation. It integrates principles from the Imaginal Transformation methodology, creating a framework that allows businesses to envision a preferred future and strategize on how to actualize it.

Key Components of the Imaginal Business Model Canvas:

1. Vision (Future THERE):

This is your organization's envisioned future. It encapsulates the organization's mission, purpose, and the impact it wants to make in the world. It's crucial that this vision is inspiring, ambitious, and aligned with bringing Heaven's will to earth, reflecting an alignment with the highest spiritual and ethical principles.

2. Value Proposition: Big WHY

This details the unique value your organization will offer in the future. It goes beyond just product or service specifications, encapsulating the transformative impact on customers' lives or businesses, societal value, and contributions towards the greater good.

3. Customer Segments:

This refers to the specific groups your organization will serve in the future. In line with Imaginal thinking, the focus is not just on who they are in the present, but who they will become and how their needs, preferences, and behaviors might evolve.

4. Channels:

This considers how your organization will reach its future customers. It contemplates future communication channels, technological advancements, and novel ways of interacting with customers.

5. Customer Relationships:

This considers how your organization will build and maintain relationships with its current and future customers. It includes considerations of trust, authenticity, and fostering long-term relationships built on shared value and mutual growth.

6. Key Activities:

These are the main activities your organization must excel at to bring about your vision. This could involve innovating new products or services, building new capabilities, forging strategic partnerships, or spearheading societal change.

7. Key Resources:

This refers to the resources necessary to enable these activities, from human and financial resources to intellectual properties, technology, and more.

8. Key Partnerships:

This identifies the partnerships that will be essential to actualizing your future vision. This includes traditional business partnerships as well as collaborations with societal stakeholders, reflecting the interconnected nature of creating a better future.

9. Cost Structure:

This looks at the financial implications of your future business model. It encourages a broadened perspective, considering not just monetary costs, but also environmental and societal costs, reflecting a commitment to holistic sustainability.

10. Revenue Streams:

This identifies how the organization will generate revenue in the future. It encourages creative, value-based revenue models that not only ensure financial sustainability but also drive societal value.

The Imaginal Business Model Canvas is more than just a planning tool. It's a roadmap that guides an organization towards its desired future (THERE), starting from its current reality (HERE). By adopting an Imaginal approach, organizations can envision and strategize for a future that is not only successful but also transformative, ethical, and aligned with their greater purpose.

Kingdom Business Model Canvas

Vision - Describe your view of the Providential future. - How might your vision bring heaven's will to earth? - What are the drivers for this future? - Who are the drivers for this future?	Value Proposition: - What is your Big WHY - How is the business advancing God's Kingdom - What value do we deliver to the customer? - Which one of our customer's problem's are we helping to solve? - Which customer needs are we satisfying?	Key Activities - Which Key Activities do our Value Proposition require - Our distribution channels? - Customer relationships? - Revenue Streams	Customer Relationships - What type of relationship does each of our customer segments expect us to establish and maintain with them? - Which ones have we established? - How are they integrated wit the rest of our business model? - How costly are they?	Customer Segments - What value do we deliver to the customer? - Who are out most important customers? - What are the types of customers or segments?
Key Partners - Who are your key Kingdom Partners? - Who are your key suppliers? - Which Key Resources are we acquiring from partners? - Which Key Activities do partners perform?	Key Resources - What Key Resources do our Value Propositions require? - Our Distribution Channels? - Customer Relationships? - Revenue streams?	Channels - Through which channels do your customer segments want to be reached? - How are we reaching them now? - How are the channels integrated - Which one are most cost efficient? - How are we integrating them with Customer routines?		
	Cost Structures - What are the most important costs inherent in your business model? - Which key resources are most expensive? - Which key activities are most expensive?	Revenue Streams - What value are our customers really willing to pay? - For what do they currently pay? - How are they currently paying? - How would they prefer to pay? - How much does each revenue stream contribute to overall revenues?		

Value of Kingdom Business Model Canvas

The Kingdom Business Model Canvas serves as a crucial strategic tool for a Kingdom Company, allowing them to align all aspects of their business with their profound purpose or "Big WHY". This comprehensive visual overview ensures that their business operations, strategies, and relationships are in sync with their mission of advancing God's Kingdom on earth. It enables them to create a consistent and focused approach that resonates with their core purpose, ensuring all business decisions contribute to their Kingdom-oriented objectives, hence fostering sustainable success rooted in their foundational beliefs.

Business Model Canvas: Kingdom Company

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A Kingdom Company

A Kingdom Company is a unique type of organization, typically privately owned, where the majority shareholders are united by a vision that transcends the conventional business objective of maximizing shareholder value. The heart of a Kingdom Company lies in their "Big WHY," their profound purpose, that is intertwined with advancing God's Kingdom on earth.

The Kingdom Business Model Canvas

The Imaginal Kingdom Business Model Canvas is an innovative adaptation of the original Business Model Canvas. It harmonizes traditional business strategies with an unwavering dedication to actualizing God's Kingdom on earth, incorporating the transformative principles of the Imaginal methodology. This framework provides Kingdom Companies with the ability to visualize and strategize their God-aligned vision of the future. Key Elements of the Imaginal Kingdom Business Model Canvas:

1. Vision (Future THERE):

The vision for Kingdom Companies is not just any future, but a future that embodies the values and purposes of God's Kingdom. It represents a commitment to building a more compassionate, just, and sustainable world, rooted in divine principles and aligned with Heaven's will.

2. Big WHY (Value Proposition):

This encapsulates the unique spiritual and societal value your organization offers. More than just a product or service, your value proposition encompasses the transformative impact on your stakeholders' lives, the advancement of communities, and God's Kingdom.

3. Kingdom Stakeholders (Customer Segments):

Your stakeholders are the specific groups that your Kingdom Company serves. Your focus should be on who they are today and who they will become in the future. This requires anticipating their evolving needs, values, and behaviors in a world influenced by Kingdom principles.

4. Channels for Kingdom Advancement:

This component considers the means by which your Kingdom Company will reach and serve its stakeholders. It contemplates Kingdom-aligned communication channels, potential technological advancements, and innovative interaction models.

5. Covenant Relationships (Customer Relationships):

This focuses on how your Kingdom Company will build and maintain relationships with stakeholders. It stresses creating relationships based on trust, authenticity, and long-term mutual growth, reflecting the covenantal nature of Kingdom relationships.

6. Kingdom Activities (Key Activities):

These are the main activities your organization will undertake to manifest your Kingdom vision. This could involve developing new products or services, building new capabilities, creating strategic partnerships, or leading societal transformation based on Kingdom principles.

7. Resources for the Kingdom (Key Resources):

This refers to the resources required to enable these Kingdom activities. It could involve human, financial, technological resources, or spiritual gifts, deployed in a manner that aligns with God's will.

8. Kingdom Alliances (Key Partnerships):

These are the alliances and partnerships critical to actualizing your Kingdom vision. This includes partnerships with business, community, and faith-based entities, reflecting the collective effort required to bring Heaven's will to earth.

9. Kingdom Stewardship (Cost Structure):

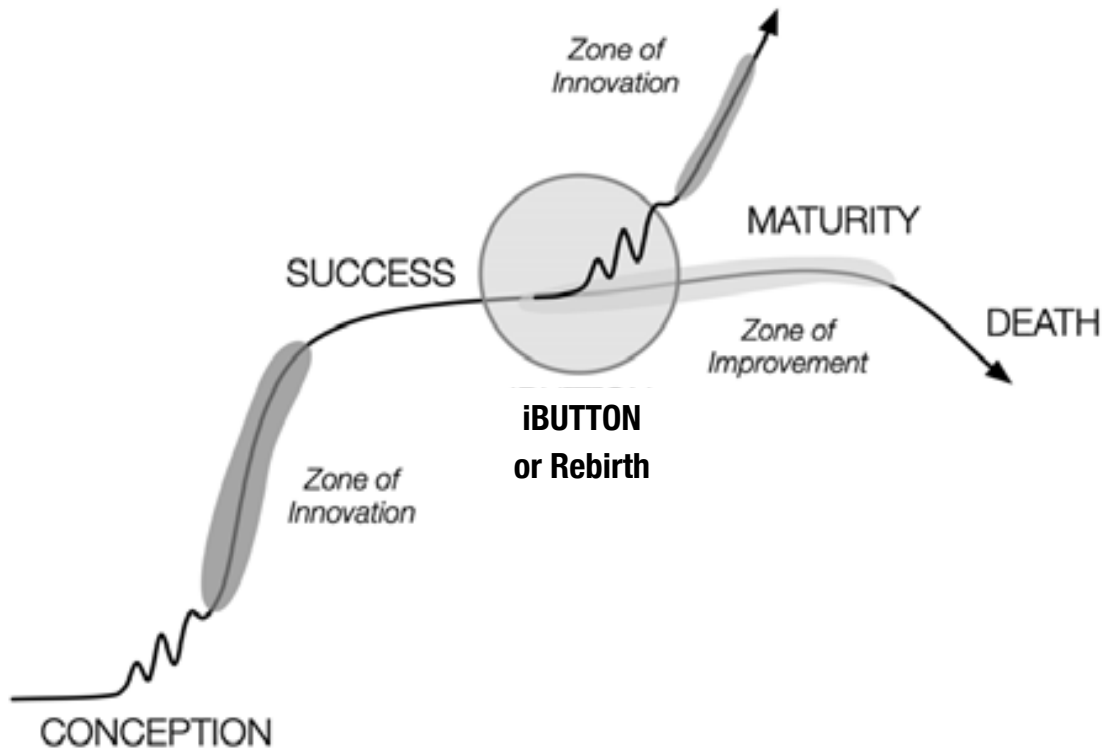
This involves considering the financial implications of your Kingdom business model, while also recognizing the environmental and societal costs. It stresses the importance of stewardship, sustainable practices, and responsible utilization of God's resources.

10. Kingdom Impact (Revenue Streams):

This identifies the revenue generation models that will sustain your Kingdom Company. It emphasizes the importance of developing value-based models that not only ensure financial sustainability but also drive societal and spiritual impact.

The Imaginal Kingdom Business Model Canvas is more than a tool. It's a strategic roadmap for Kingdom Companies, guiding them from their current reality (HERE) to their envisioned future (THERE). By embracing this Imaginal approach, Kingdom Companies can envision and strategize for a future that is prosperous, transformative, ethical, and in alignment with advancing God's Kingdom on earth

Stages of the Enterprise



Imaginal Button

The Imaginal Button is a metaphorical construct that represents a decision or a series of decisions made by an organization to consciously instigate significant transformation. It signifies the organization's commitment to innovation, change, and growth, and the willingness to redefine itself as needed.

The term "Imaginal" is derived from the process of metamorphosis, as seen in nature when a caterpillar transforms into a butterfly. In this process, imaginal cells within the caterpillar instigate a radical change, eventually leading to the emergence of a completely different organism - the butterfly. In a similar vein, pressing the Imaginal Button in an organization can spur a metamorphosis, sparking substantial changes in its identity, strategy, culture, or operational processes. Pressing the Imaginal Button is not a passive act; it calls for active engagement in disrupting the status quo. It requires leaders and members of the organization to question existing orthodoxies, challenge complacency, and embrace a vision of

the future that might be radically different from the present. This might involve redefining the organization's purpose, reimagining its value proposition, innovating its product or service offerings, or transforming its operational models and processes.

Importantly, pressing the Imaginal Button is not a one-time event; it's a process, a journey. It requires ongoing commitment to learning, innovation, and adaptability. It invites the organization to continually reassess and redefine itself in response to evolving market trends, customer needs, and technological advancements. It propels the organization to not just react to change but to proactively drive change, thereby shaping its future.

In essence, the Imaginal Button is a call to action for an organization to embrace change and innovation, and to continually reinvent itself, thus fostering resilience, growth, and long-term sustainability.

Stages of the Enterprise



The lifecycle of an enterprise can be understood as a dynamic, ever-changing journey through various stages, each offering its own unique challenges and opportunities. This journey commences with the initial conception of an idea and navigates through a turbulent looping phase before settling into success and maturity. Eventually, like all entities, an enterprise meets its end, marking a new beginning for fresh ideas to take shape.

Conception:

The birthplace of all ventures and enterprises, the conception stage is characterized by nascent ideas, seemingly impractical dreams, and a sense of urgency prompted by external or internal rates of change. Ideas can emerge from unexpected conversations, scribbles on napkins, or deep introspection. This stage represents the early inklings of a new enterprise and is often marked by a high degree of creativity, enthusiasm, and uncertainty.

Looping:

As enterprises evolve from their embryonic state, they enter the looping stage, a tumultuous period marked by soaring successes and near-catastrophic setbacks. The looping phase is akin to a roller coaster ride, with enterprises constantly facing new challenges and opportunities. It is in this stage that enterprises grapple with their viability, striving to establish an operational rhythm that ensures their existence beyond the early, unpredictable days of conception.

Success:

Upon weathering the turbulence of the looping phase, an enterprise enters a phase of success. Here, the enterprise becomes a viable entity that understands its operational cadence and can sustain its existence month to month while also fostering growth. Success is marked by stability, profitability, and a deepening understanding of the marketplace.

Maturity:

The maturity phase often represents the longest and most stable period in an enterprise's lifecycle. With viability and success established, the enterprise is well-positioned for expansion, diversification, and innovation. Maturity is the ideal time for birthing new ventures, although many enterprises miss this golden opportunity until they are on the brink of decline.

Death:

An inevitable stage in the lifecycle of any organization, death signifies the end of an enterprise's existence as it was known. This could mean the total dissolution of the enterprise, or it may represent a transformation into something entirely new. Death is not always negative; sometimes it's the most potent catalyst for letting new ideas take flight and chart their own course towards viability. It's a reminder that in the business world, endings often pave the way for new beginnings.

Imaginal Button or Rebirth:

An organization embarks on a journey of rebirth when it consciously chooses to press the Imaginal Button. This decision is born out of a recognition of organizational stagnation, where the initial vigor for innovation and progress has given way to complacency and indifference. At such a crossroads, the organization craves a renewed cycle of innovation and transformation, recognizing the need to rekindle its innovative spirit and drive.

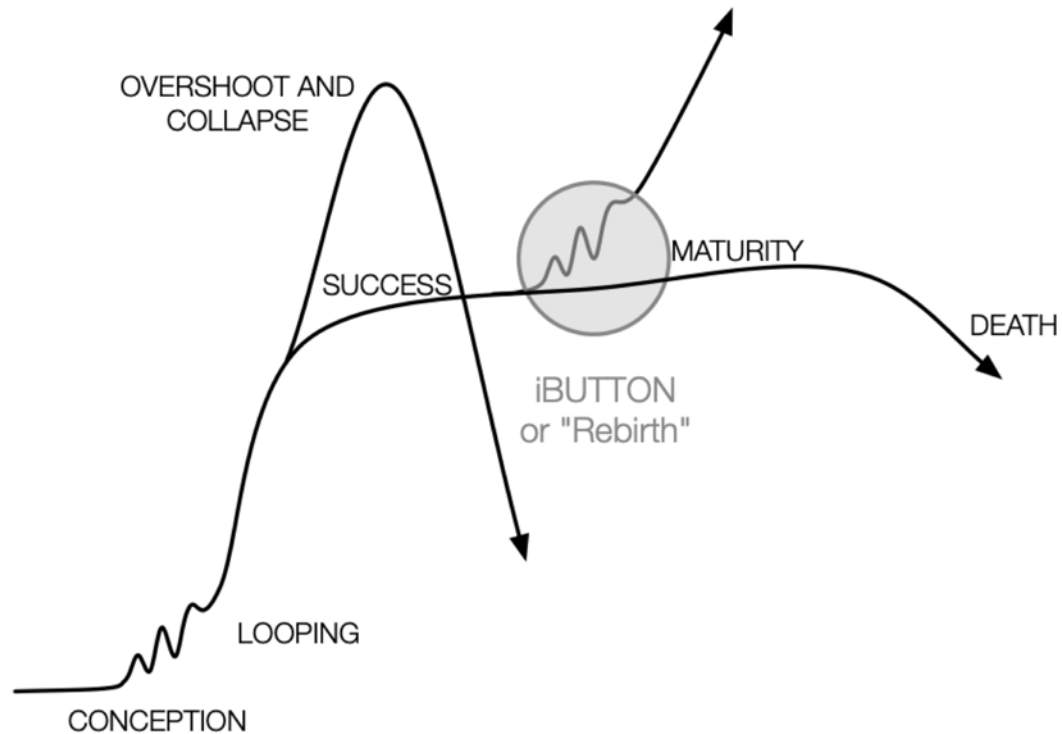
Human nature often gravitates towards the path of least resistance. The Imaginal Button moment is thus a conscious deviation from this norm, signifying the organization's permission to itself, or to a part of itself, to reach for uncharted heights again, to revisit and revive its roots of innovation. It is akin to a wake-up call, an urgent nudge to step out of comfort zones and boldly embrace change.

Imaginal's Transformative Innovation

This renewal is not an isolated event; it embodies a chain of purposeful steps taken to drive the Imaginal transformation process seeing and creating the future. An Imaginal Organization cultivates its own redundancy by continuously importing the future into the present. It deliberately decides to overturn the established order, proactively rendering its existing practices, products, or services obsolete. This anticipatory regeneration can serve as a powerful instigator for ongoing transformation, ensuring the organization maintains a lead over its competitors.

The Imaginal Button moment thus serves as a launchpad for the organization's new phase of growth, a strategic move that not only disrupts the present but also shapes the future. This process of self-orchestrated obsolescence and rejuvenation enables the organization to maintain its innovative edge, ensuring it remains dynamic, relevant, and resilient in an ever-changing business

Stages of the Enterprise Scenarios



Stages of the Enterprise Summary

The stages of the enterprise model encompass a sequential journey, beginning with "Conception," where a business idea is birthed and its feasibility assessed. Following conception, the enterprise enters the "Looping" stage, where it repeatedly fine-tunes its strategies and models, honing its product or service offering based on market feedback. With meticulous planning and execution, the enterprise eventually reaches the "Success" stage, where its offerings gain market acceptance, leading to increased revenue and reputation.

In the "Maturity" phase, the business experiences stability, having a firm foothold in the market and operating efficiently. However, this stage can also bring complacency and a lack of innovation, potentially making the enterprise vulnerable to competitive forces and changing market dynamics.

The final stage is "Death," where the enterprise, due to various factors like operational inefficiencies,

market changes, or dwindling profits, may dissolve, be acquired, or merge with another entity.

Nevertheless, at any stage, an enterprise may face an "Overshoot and Collapse," a situation arising from rapid success leading to overconfidence and reckless decisions, causing unintentional consequences that could prompt a sudden downfall.

To avoid this perilous route, an organization can choose to hit the "Imaginal Button." This proactive decision triggers a new era of innovative thinking, enabling the enterprise to reimagine and reinvent itself to stay competitive and relevant, thereby avoiding stagnation or decline.

Stages of the Enterprise Module

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Sample Module used in Brazil

In 2015, your organization embarked on a bold journey by establishing the Imaginal Transformation Center (ITC). Conceived as an innovation incubator, the ITC was meant to foster breakthroughs within your company and bolster educational initiatives.

You will be split into teams, each team analyzing a distinct scenario based on the Stages of the Enterprise model. Your dialogue should be captured on a whiteboard, and each team should be ready to present a summary of their findings in approximately an hour.

Team 1 - Scenario: Success

Fast forward to 2035, the ITC has achieved phenomenal "success," revolutionizing education and industry in Brazil. The tide began to turn dramatically in favor of Brazilian education once it was demonstrated that Profound Learning could indeed be actualized in the early pilots in your city and at other early-adopter sites.

By fall of 2015, the ITC started integrating the Imaginal Organizational model within your company. After three transformative years, a notable improvement in innovative capacity was evident. Presently, the ITC contributes significantly to the Brazilian economy by assisting businesses across the nation in adopting the IMAGINAL model.

How did this extraordinary success come about?

Construct a timeline and document the key milestones that led to this outcome.

Team 2 - Scenario: Maturity and Decline

In 2035, the once thriving ITC has started to witness a downturn, with decreasing interest from schools and businesses in its offerings. The first five years of the ITC were marked by substantial "success" in transforming education and industry. However, growth has plateaued and the ITC is now in a decline. It appears the ITC has lost its north star, its Big WHY.

What caused this scenario to develop?

Construct a timeline and document the key milestones that led to this outcome.

Team 3 - Scenario: Overshoot and Collapse

The year is 2035, and the ITC has experienced an explosive growth in its initial four years, followed by a swift and drastic decline.

What fueled this quick expansion and what precipitated the rapid decline?

Were there leadership changes or any other transitions that might have contributed to this downfall?

Create a timeline and document the key milestones that led to this outcome.

Team 4 - Scenario: Looping

Fast forward to 2035. Despite a decade of attempts, the ITC has been unable to fully "take off." Periods of immense promise and progress were frequently followed by major setbacks. While the Profound Learning and Imaginal models have proven successful in Brazil, the ITC has struggled to scale and expand its vision.

What led to this outcome? How could it have been averted?

Create a timeline and document the key milestones that led to this outcome.

Team 5 - Scenario: The iButton Effect

By 2035, the ITC has proven the effectiveness of the Imaginal incremental transformation process. Having completed its third three-year transformation cycle, the ITC has built a thriving business enterprise in both the education and industry sectors. By adopting the Imaginal Continuous Transformation methodology, it has become more agile and responsive to changing market conditions. Right from its inception, the ITC's Big WHY - making a significant impact in Brazil - continues to inspire and drive its passionate leaders.

What led to this successful transformation?

Construct a timeline and document the key milestones that contributed to this outcome.

Part V

Master's Big WHY

as an Example of an Imaginal Organization

Big WHY



Master's Big WHY

We have all been called to make a difference—‘to make a dent in the universe’. The level at which your organizational Big WHY is internalized by your key stakeholders will determine the level of their commitment to the vision you aspire to achieve.

Beyond providing excellent education in a respectful and honoring culture, our Big WHY is to advance God's Kingdom through transformative education, making a significant impact locally and beyond. All staff commit in writing to this mission.

—Tom Rudmik 2020

Master's Big WHY



Master's Big WHY

At Master's Academy and College, we believe that our Mission, Vision and Kingdom Assignment are God-inspired and that teaching here is a spiritual calling. Our Kingdom Assignment reflects our commitment to advance God's Kingdom within the realm of education, integrating Biblical principles into every aspect of our work. We are called to:

- Inculcate Christian faith, values, and worldview in our students and families.
- Act as marketplace influencers and redemptive agents within the educational system, whether public or private, secular or Christian.
- Make a transformative impact on education worldwide.

We are also called to work together as a vision community, in a manner that brings honor and glory to God. As stated in John 13:34-35, the world will know we are disciples of Christ by the love we have for one another.

Commitment Beyond Contracts

We recognize that legal agreements and union contracts cannot fully encapsulate the spiritual "Calling" to serve at Master's and the deep commitment this calling requires. The cost of being a follower of Christ is significant, and this dedication shapes every aspect of our community.

Values

Our core values shape our culture and govern the behaviors of our organization. These values are made explicit and are reported on annually to ensure they are lived out in practice.

Master's comprehensive Christian Worldview document is available at www.masters.ab.ca

Culture

The attributes of our culture include respect, empowerment, ownership, responsibility, accountability, and integrity. Our culture is an emergent property resulting from many structures working together harmoniously.

Behaviors

Values are expressed through the behaviors of our people. A behavioral code is developed to enable individuals to self-evaluate and regulate their actions, ensuring alignment with our core values.

1. Identity

Our unique core competencies as an R&D school provide the impetus for sustainability and competitiveness. We cherish the aspects of our history that are important to maintain and continue to define who we are.

2. Purpose

Our Mission Statement, to prepare students to be Future Ready, defines our primary purpose, which we fulfill daily. It articulates the value or benefit we provide to our stakeholders, driving our daily operations.

3. Cause

Our Reason for Being Statement answers the question of why we do what we do. It places our work within a larger context, advancing a cause that aligns with our primary purpose and Kingdom Assignment, see below, that builds stakeholder buy-in.

4. Vision

Our Vision Statement, to transform education locally and globally, describes our preferred future, outlining who we are becoming and the impact we aim to have on our 'Big WHY' over the next 5, 10, 20 years, or more.

5. Focus & Fit

Our internal stakeholders are deeply committed to our 'Big WHY,' functioning from a place of calling rather than mere compliance.

Big WHY Statement

Beyond providing the best education and services to our students and families within a culture that respects and honors all workers, our Kingdom Assignment at Master's is,

"to co-design and co-create with God a new model of Christian education. This prototype will align with Kingdom principles and values, and we are committed to sharing it with the world."

Our Big WHY is to make a significant difference in our community, region, country and beyond by advancing God's Kingdom through transformative education.

Ownership and Empowerment

14 Governing Principles

The 14 Governing Principles provide clarity on how Master's implements the organization's "Big WHY." These principles are not merely guidelines or suggestions; they are non-negotiable standards and expectations that define the boundaries of our behavior and actions.

Principle #1

We will intentionally integrate the vision of the school to transform education locally and globally with Profound Learning.

Principle #2

We will intentionally integrate Biblical truth into daily instruction and activities.

Principle #3

Master's Society leadership, in collaboration with school administration, will create clarity and definition.

Principle #4

We will always strive to develop a culture and climate of mutual trust and respect.

Principle #5

We will release ownership and empowerment into the organization.

Principle #6

We will develop pedagogical practices and elements of PL to be implemented in all classrooms.

Principle #7

We will intentionally develop our students to be Future Ready.

Principle #8

As an Imaginal Organization we will continuously integrate, improve, innovate and invent our future

Principle #9

Master's Society's Research and Development team, in collaboration with school administration, will deliver ongoing training and development of staff.

Principle #10

We will intentionally create a culture and environment that encourages teachers to be innovative and to take risks.

Principle #11

We will always communicate on a "real time" basis.

Principle #12

We will intentionally create opportunities for collaboration.

Principle #13

We will implement strategies to sense earlier and to respond faster to change.

Principle #14

As an Imaginal Organization we will continuously seek to create obsolescence through innovation.

Values



VALUES - BIG WHY

Bringing clarity for the organization's existence is reached when the organization has a clear understanding of its purpose and vision. Stating the Big Why helps Master's Academy and College declare:

- Its reason for being
- Its moral compass
- Its calling
- Its decision-making filter
- Its daily operational practices

Master's Academy and College's Big Why paints the big picture at both strategic and tactical levels. It ensures that those who work here know what to align to as a vision community.

In our hyper competitive world, only those organizations that can INNOVATE and create OBSOLESCENCE will thrive in the world of massive change. TRANSFORMING complex systems, such as EDUCATION, requires a comprehensive ecosystem of solutions addressing the many SYSTEMIC changes that need to take place. At Master's we have developed systems and solutions that will enable organizations to become IMAGINAL; those who can see and create the future, and those who create obsolescence through innovation.

At Master's, our Big Why includes partnerships with those early adopters who want to make a difference in their city, state, country and world through transforming their educational system by becoming IMAGINAL LEADERS. The Organization's BIG WHY is layered from general big picture to specific implementation.

At The Centre

Core Culture, Behaviours, Values and Beliefs:

14 Governing Principles

Master's fundamental beliefs guide the behaviours and decision-making process of this organization. Imaginal organizations not only define their core values explicitly, but also ensure they are lived out every day, regularly reporting on their adherence to these values. The cultural attributes of an Imaginal organization are characterized by respect, empowerment, ownership, responsibility, accountability, and integrity. The culture is an emergent property, stemming from the intricate interplay of various structures, ultimately molding the shared attitudes, customs, and values of the organization. Values manifest through the behaviours of individuals within an

organization. Imaginal organizations develop a code of conduct that serves as a guiding framework, enabling individuals to self-evaluate and adjust their actions accordingly.

Worldview

All schools teach from a worldview that shapes life's meaning and purpose. At Master's, we teach from a traditional Biblical Christian perspective. Our curriculum and instruction are rooted in this belief, guiding students' physical, social, intellectual, emotional, and spiritual development.

We see each student as a unique creation of God, aiming to instill a deep appreciation for Scriptural morals and principles. This helps students understand their responsibilities as citizens and develop a genuine love for God, playing a redeeming role in the world.

Master's integrates the Christian worldview into daily curriculum, addressing complex issues with sensitivity and wisdom. We prepare students to confidently face modern challenges, believing in their ability to shape their future by design. Our vision for Profound Learning and R&D initiatives align with our mission to improve education for all children.

Being Future Ready includes thinking through personal choices and the way these choices affect our lives and the lives of others. Each generation faces questions of integrating faith into daily living. At Master's we encourage students to ask the hard questions of life and we set a culture where this is welcomed. It is hoped that the response of the student is formed from a respectful process of open and vigorous discussion, biblical reference, and an invitation to live out a God-honouring life and redemptive response within our cultural context. As teachers, we purpose to come alongside students to support and to challenge them by displaying grace, love, wisdom and hope. In addition, Future Ready means we are ready to take on the challenge of creating a better world that is aligned to God's Kingdom Principles. We are equipped to be Imaginal Leaders who see and create a better future.

Statement of Faith



I. OUR STATEMENT OF FAITH

A. INTRODUCTION

Master's Academy and College opened its doors in 1997 as a private Christian school. In 2008, Master's was granted Alternative Program status as a faith based Christian school by Palliser Regional Schools in Alberta. (School Act section 21-RSA 2000)

Our spiritual orientation at Master's Academy & College is based on the Word of God, the Bible, which we hold in its entirety to be the infallible revelation of God. The entirety of the Bible contains an historical and theological description of God's interactions with humankind. As such, it is a consistent narrative of God's past, current and future relationship with humanity. God instructs humanity on how we ought to relate to Him, fellow humans, and every part of His creation. It therefore contains moral teachings on human behaviour, organizational culture, and identity. The Apostles' Creed and the Bible have been widely followed by Christians for almost two thousand years and have formed the basis of our Statement of Faith.

We hold the following truths to be foundational and self-evident from the Word of God. As a Christian school, we associate with the historical beliefs of the Christian faith as found in the original manuscripts of the Old and New Testaments. The Statement of Faith forms the core of Master's beliefs and values.

B. APOSTLES' CREED

I believe in God, the Father almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit
and born of the virgin Mary.

He suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried;
he descended to hell.

The third day he rose again from the dead.

He ascended to heaven

and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty.
From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting.

Amen.

II. OUR BELIEFS and VALUES

GOD AND PEOPLE

1. GOD as Father and Creator

- a) God is the holy Trinity – one in essence eternally consisting of three persons - Father, Son and Holy Spirit (*Genesis 1:26; Matthew 28:19; John 10:30; 14:16; 17:21; 2 Corinthians 13:14*).
- b) God gives meaning, purpose and identity (*Jeremiah 29:11; John 10:10; 14:6*).
- c) God is Creator and Designer of our world, both things that are seen and unseen (*Genesis 1:1; Colossians 1:15-17; Revelation 4:11*).
- d) God is everywhere, all powerful and all-knowing (*Psalms 139; Jeremiah 32:27; Matthew 19:26; Luke 1:37; 1 John 3:20*).
- e) God makes Himself known to us through the Bible, creation, special revelation and through His human incarnation, Jesus Christ (*Genesis 1:31; 31:11; Numbers 12:6; Deuteronomy 5:24,27; 1 Kings 3:5; Psalm 19:1; 119; Matthew 1:20; John 1:1,14,18; 6:46; 14:9-11; 20:30-31; Acts 2:17; 8:26-40; Romans 1:20; 15:4; Colossians 1:19; 2 Timothy 3:16; Hebrews 1:1-2; 4:12*).
- f) God is full of mercy, truth and love and is worthy of our trust and praise (*Psalms 86:15; John 1:14; 2 John 1:3*).
- g) God is good and just (*Psalms 89:14; 1 Timothy 4:4*).

2. JESUS as Son of God and Saviour

- a) God, the Son, is one with the Father and the Holy Spirit (*Genesis 1:26; John 10:30; 14:16; 17:21*).
- b) Jesus, both truly God and truly man, was conceived by the Holy Spirit and born of the virgin Mary (*Matthew 1:18-25*).
- c) Jesus, while on earth, was both God and human (*John 1:1,14; Philippians 2:5-11; Colossians 1:19; Hebrews 2:17*).
- d) Jesus taught us what the kingdom of heaven is like (*Matthew 13:1-51; 18:1-35; 19:13-15; 20:1-14; 22:1-10; 25:1-29*).
- e) Jesus Christ took the punishment for our sin through His sacrificial love for humanity, by dying on the cross (*Matthew 20:17-19; Mark 9:31; 10:45; Luke 24:7; John 3:16; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Philippians 2:8; 1 Timothy 2:5-6*).
- f) Jesus Christ was resurrected from the grave, and after appearing to many, He ascended into heaven (*Matthew 20:17-19; Mark 9:31; 16:14,19; Luke 24:5-7,51-52; 1 Corinthians 15:3-8*). His death and resurrection are climactic in history, bringing hope for our future (*Jeremiah 29:11; 1 Timothy 1:1*).

Statement of Faith



2. JESUS ...cont'd

- g) Through Jesus our Saviour, we have forgiveness, freedom, reconciliation and hope for eternity. When we accept Jesus as the Saviour, we follow a path based on the teachings in the Bible. We are created anew with a fresh start. The old life is gone and a new way of living begins in relationship with God. (*Isaiah 43:11; Luke 4:16-21; 24:45-47; Acts 10:43; Romans 6: 6-7; 10:9; 2 Corinthians 5:17-18; Ephesians 4:24; Colossians 3:9; 2 Peter 1:11; 3:18*).
- h) Jesus has promised to return to further establish His kingdom on this earth (*Daniel 12:1-2; Acts 1:10-11; Philippians 2:10-11; 1 Thessalonians 4:17; Revelation 11:17; 21:3-4*).
- i) Jesus is our advocate with God the Father (*John 14:6; Hebrews 7:25*).

3. HOLY SPIRIT as Supernatural Comforter and Helper

- a) God, the Holy Spirit, is one with the Father and the Son (*Genesis 1:26; Matthew 28:19; John 14:16-18; 17:21; Acts 2:33; 1 Corinthians 12:4-6*).
- b) The Holy Spirit lives within us to comfort and guide us (*John 14:16,26; 16:7-15; 20:22; Acts 2:32-33; 5:32; 8:14-17; 9:31; 10:44; 11:15; 2 Corinthians 13:14*).
- c) The Holy Spirit is the sustainer of faith and the giver of love, joy, peace (*Galatians 5:22-23; Romans 14:17; 15:13*).
- d) The Holy Spirit acts supernaturally in our lives (*Acts 1:8; 9:17; Romans 5:5; 8:14-16; 2 Corinthians 3:16-18; Hebrews 2:4; 10:15; 2 Peter 1:21*).

4. HUMANS as Creations in the Image of God

- a) God made humans as special members of creation because we are created as unique images of God (*Genesis 1:26-27; 2:7,19; Psalm 8:3-8; Matthew 19:4-5*). As a result of human rebellion, sin and death entered the world, distorting the image of God in us and in all of God's good creation (*Romans 5:12-19; 7:13-25; 8:20-23; Ephesians 2:1-5*). We are entrusted with the care of God's creation as faithful stewards who have a special place in His order (*Genesis 2:15*).
- b) Our identity is uniquely and purposefully formed in God's image (*Genesis 1:26-27; Psalm 139:13-18*).
- c) Both male and female are created in God's image. Maleness and femaleness are gifts of God and designed by God to play complementary and equally important roles in creation (*Genesis 1:26-27; 5:2; Matthew 19:4-5; 1 Corinthians 11:11-12; Ephesians 5:21-33*).
- d) We are created to love the Lord with all our heart, soul, mind and strength, and love our neighbours as ourselves (*Deuteronomy 6:5-9; Joshua 22:5; Luke 10:27*).

- e) We embrace God's wisdom and those practices that align to God's Word (*Psalm 14:1; Proverbs 1:2-6; Romans 12:1-2*).
- f) We believe Jesus modelled the way for us to live in harmony with God (*Luke 2:52; John 5:19; 10:30; Philippians 2:5-11; Colossians 2:19*).
- g) We live out God's grace by assisting and serving those in need (*Psalm 146:7-9; Micah 6:8; Matthew 25:40; Mark 10:45; Luke 10:30-37; 1 Corinthians 12:31-13:13*).
- h) We believe that each person has been created with unlimited worth and value in God's eyes (*Genesis 1:27,31; Jeremiah 31:3; Luke 12:7; John 10:11; 15:13*).
- i) We believe that God is personal and can be known, and therefore we can be in relationship with God, and talk with Him and listen to Him (*Psalm 139:1-17,23-24; John 3:16; 15:15; 2 Corinthians 5:18; Colossians 1:20*).
- j) We live and work to follow the ways of Jesus and we are uniquely gifted to be the light in our world (*Matthew 5:14-16; 1 Corinthians 12:4-11,27-30; Romans 12:4-21; Ephesians 4:11-12*).
- k) As followers of Christ we are called to be witnesses of Christ on this earth (*Psalm 145:4-7; Matthew 28:18-20; Acts 1:8*).
- l) We have a responsibility to serve and care for one other in alignment with God's will (*Genesis 4:9; Psalm 15; Micah 6:8; Matthew 6:9-13; Luke 4:18; Romans 12:9; Galatians 6:2; Philippians 2:3-5*).

INTEGRATION OF BIBLICALLY BASED CHRISTIAN WORLDVIEW

Biblical Worldview: We interpret life through scripture, seeking God's wisdom (*Proverbs 2:1-11*) and recognizing the spiritual conflict between good and evil (*Ephesians 6:10-13*). We encourage understanding of other worldviews while affirming students' freedom to form their own beliefs (*Joshua 24:15*).

God as Creator: We believe God is the creator with purpose revealed in the Bible (*Genesis 1*). The complexity of life suggests a theistic origin, and we see harmony between the Bible and science (*Colossians 1:15-17*).

Christian Culture: We nurture respect, love, and freedom in Christ (*Romans 12:17*), integrating our Christian worldview into teaching (*Deuteronomy 6:7*). We create experiences that help students find hope and purpose (*Jeremiah 1:5*) and believe in the Holy Spirit's guidance through faculty and peer interactions, modeling practical faith (*Hebrews 13:7*).

Two Realms

This chart highlights the distinctions between the two realms, underscoring the temporal and physical nature of the Natural Realm versus the eternal and spiritual nature of the Spiritual Realm.

Natural Realm	Spiritual Realm
Physical and material (2 Corinthians 4:18)	Spiritual and immaterial (John 4:24)
Composed of matter (Genesis 1:1)	Not composed of matter (Ephesians 6:12)
Visible to human eyes (Romans 1:20)	Invisible to human eyes (2 Corinthians 4:18)
Subordinate to the spiritual realm (Hebrews 9:11)	Dominates the natural realm (Hebrews 8:5)
Influenced by the spiritual realm (Ephesians 6:12)	Governs the natural realm (Colossians 1:16)
Temporal, will pass away (2 Peter 3:10)	Eternal, will never cease to be (2 Corinthians 4:18)
Populated by physical beings (Genesis 1:26-27)	Populated by spiritual beings (Hebrews 1:14)
Governed by natural laws and principles (Romans 8:2)	Governed by spiritual laws and principles (Romans 8:2)
Reflects the spiritual realm, a shadow of true reality (Colossians 2:17)	The reality and substance behind the natural realm (Hebrews 11:3)
Limited by time and space (Psalm 90:10)	Transcends time and space (Revelation 1:8)

Two Kingdoms

This chart highlights the distinctions between the two kingdoms, underscoring the divine legitimacy and eternal nature of God's Kingdom versus the illegitimate and temporal nature of Satan's kingdom,

The Kingdom of God and The Kingdom of Light	The Kingdom of Satan and The Kingdom of Darkness
Heavenly Kingdom (Matthew 6:10)	Earthly Kingdom (2 Corinthians 4:4)
Ruled by a legitimate King, Jesus Christ, with ordained lines of authority and government (Colossians 1:13)	Ruled by illegitimate authority, Satan, with structured lines of authority and government (Ephesians 6:12)
Populated by angelic beings and people (Hebrews 12:22-23)	Populated by fallen angels/demons and people (Revelation 12:9)
Redeemed men and women are citizens of this Kingdom (Philippians 3:20)	Unredeemed men and women are under the authority of this Kingdom (John 8:44)
Characterized by righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit (Romans 14:17)	Characterized by chaos, deceit, and destruction (John 10:10)
This Kingdom operates from the Third Heaven. Its authority is entirely undivided and absolute, it is the source of all authority in the universe (Ephesians 1:20-21)	This Kingdom operates from the second heaven, the spiritual realm of the earth. Its authority is entirely derived, having no authority of its own (Ephesians 2:2)
This Kingdom will ultimately swallow up all other Kingdoms (Revelation 11:15)	This Kingdom will ultimately fall and fail completely (Revelation 20:10)

Two Kingdoms



The Kingdom of God, also known as the Kingdom of Heaven, is a central theme in Christian theology, encompassing both a present reality and a future hope. It is described in various ways throughout the Bible, highlighting its spiritual, ethical, and eschatological dimensions.

Present Reality of the Kingdom

Luke 17:20-21 - "The kingdom of God does not come with observation; nor will they say, 'See here!' or 'See there!' For indeed, the kingdom of God is within you." This passage emphasizes the Kingdom as a spiritual reality within believers.

Romans 14:17 - "For the kingdom of God is not eating and drinking, but righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit." The Apostle Paul highlights the Kingdom's ethical and spiritual qualities, focusing on inner transformation and moral living.

Ethical Dimensions

Matthew 5:3-10 - The Beatitudes outline attitudes and behaviors characteristic of Kingdom citizens: humility, mercy, peacemaking, and righteousness. These qualities contrast with worldly values, demonstrating the Kingdom's ethical demands.

Future Hope of the Kingdom

Revelation 21:1-4 - "Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth... 'Look! God's dwelling place is now among the people, and he will dwell with them. They will be his people, and God himself will be with them...'" This vision of the New Jerusalem encapsulates the Kingdom's ultimate fulfillment, where God's reign is fully realized.

Isaiah 11:6-9 - This prophetic vision describes a future world of peace and harmony, symbolizing the comprehensive restoration that the Kingdom of God will bring.

Parables of the Kingdom

Matthew 13:31-33 - Jesus uses the parables of the mustard seed and the yeast to illustrate the Kingdom's growth, starting modestly but eventually transforming all of creation.

The King and His Kingdom

Isaiah 9:6-7 - "For to us a child is born, to us a son is given... He will reign on David's throne... establishing and upholding it with justice and righteousness..." This prophecy points to Jesus Christ, whose reign is characterized by justice and peace.

John 18:36 - "Jesus said, 'My kingdom is not of this world...'" Jesus clarifies that His Kingdom is fundamentally different from earthly kingdoms, rooted in divine authority.

Invitation to the Kingdom

Matthew 6:33 - "But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well." Jesus calls His followers to prioritize the Kingdom in their lives.

John 3:3-5 - Jesus tells Nicodemus, "No one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again... born of water and the Spirit." Entry into the Kingdom requires a spiritual rebirth.

In summary, the Kingdom of God is both a present spiritual reality and a future hope, marked by righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit. It calls for ethical living, promises ultimate restoration, and invites all to partake in its divine life through faith in Jesus Christ.

Two Realms and Two Kingdoms

The Kingdom of God operates within the context of two realms and two kingdoms, as detailed in the chart on the opposite page. The chart outlines distinctions between the natural and spiritual realms, and the Kingdom of God and the Kingdom of Satan. The natural realm is temporal and governed by physical laws, while the spiritual realm is eternal and governed by spiritual laws. The Kingdom of God, ruled by Jesus Christ, contrasts with the Kingdom of Satan, ruled by Satan. Understanding these realms and kingdoms provides a comprehensive view of the spiritual and physical dimensions that influence our reality and underscores the impact of advancing God's Kingdom on earth.

The Battle Between the Two Kingdoms

The battle between the Kingdom of God and the Kingdom of Satan is a central theme in Christian theology, symbolizing the ongoing struggle between good and evil. Ephesians 6:12 states, "For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms." This verse highlights the spiritual nature of the battle. Colossians 1:13 declares that God "has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of the Son he loves." Believers are called to stand firm in faith, using spiritual armor to resist the enemy's schemes (Ephesians 6:13-18). Ultimately, the Bible assures that the Kingdom of God will prevail, as Revelation 20:10 depicts the final defeat of Satan and his forces.

Innovator's Dilemma

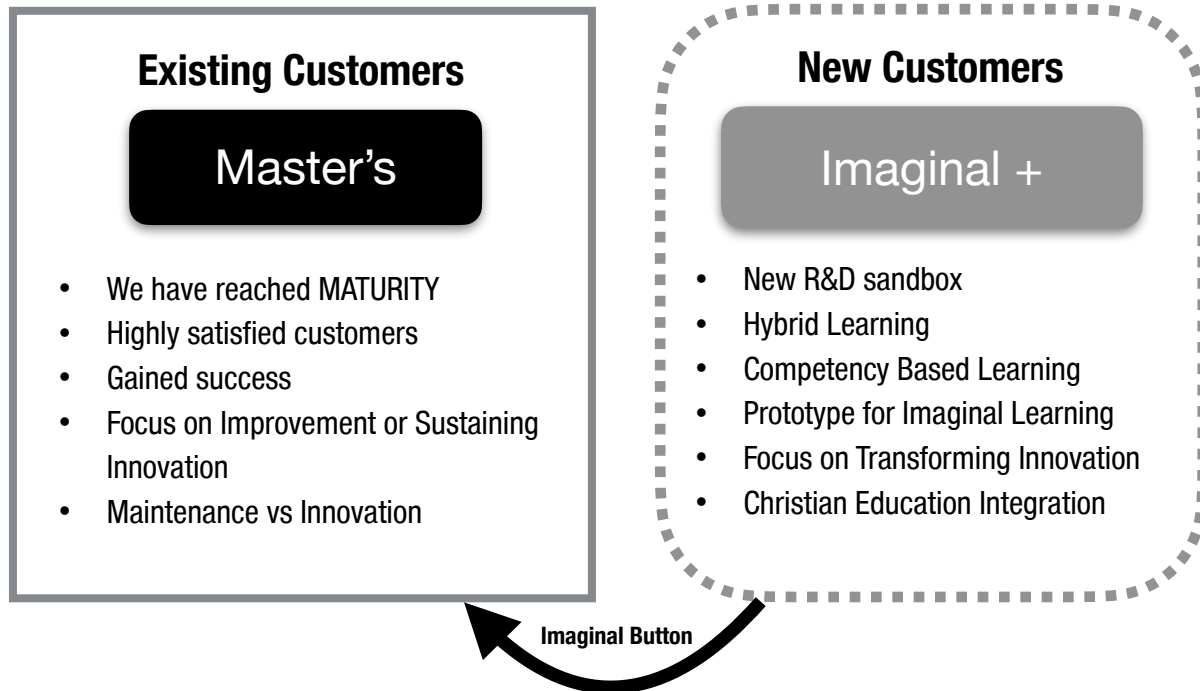


Fig. 1 Planned Obsolescence at Master's

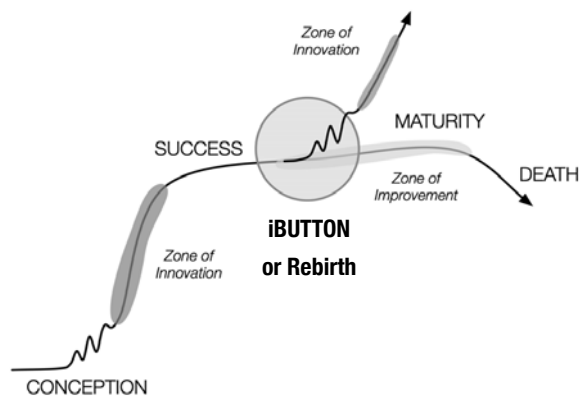


Fig. 2 Stages of the Enterprise

Imaginal Button

The Imaginal Button signifies a decision by an organization to instigate significant transformation, representing a commitment to innovation, change, and growth. It involves active engagement in disrupting the status quo, questioning existing norms, challenging complacency, and embracing a future vision that is radically different from the present.

Pressing the Imaginal Button is not a one-time event but a continuous process requiring ongoing commitment to learning, innovation, and adaptability. It encourages the organization to continually reassess and redefine itself in response to market trends, customer needs, and technological advancements. This proactive approach to change fosters resilience, growth, and long-term sustainability.

Launching Imaginal+ in 2025 is Master's Academy's moment to press the Imaginal Button. Imaginal+ is a hybrid school offering both online and site-based learning for older students, moving away from the factory model and allowing students to manage their own time and learning.

1. Identity

UNIQUE IDENTITY

Master's Academy and College has developed a unique vision with unique structures and beliefs that provide impetus and sustainability for the vision. From the initial start of the school in 1997, the school has operated with the understanding that Godly direction will influence the Big Why of the organization.

Mission, Vision, Assignment

This term “Imaginal” is derived from the biology involved in the transformation of a caterpillar to butterfly. Much like these imaginal cells, Imaginal leaders are the visionaries and architects of the future. They possess an ability to discern possibilities beyond common perceptions and have the prowess to achieve the seemingly unattainable. Imaginal orientation is part of the vision, mission and Kingdom assignment of this school.

At Master's we believe that our Mission and Vision is God inspired. We state that we will operate with the Biblical principles that relate to Godly ways – ways that Jesus called the Kingdom of God. We recognize a shift in authority from only being under human leadership, to being under God's direction for our organization. Hence we refer to our vision, mission, and purpose as a “Kingdom Assignment”. The following three statements bring clarity:

1. **Our Mission:** to develop students who are Future Ready, by becoming Master Learners, Imaginal Leaders and Christ Followers.
2. **Our Vision:** to transform education locally and globally with the practices and beliefs of Profound / Imaginal Learning, the trademark label for the model developed at this school
 - To be a market place influencer of the system of education
 - To continually grow a dynamic vision that addresses changes in our world
3. **Our Kingdom Assignment:** to co-design and co-create with God a new model of Christian education that will be a prototype that aligns to God's Kingdom's principles and values and then share the model with the world

To make a difference in education around the world as supported by spiritual statements given to the organization from different, independent spokespeople

Role of a 'R&D' School

In 1997, Master's Academy and College opened its doors with a clear vision: to transform the traditional command-and-control industrial model of teaching into a system that

prepares students to be Future Ready and Imaginal Leaders. The Master's Academy Educational Society leads various initiatives and has established an R&D team that collaborates closely with Master's teachers to develop breakthroughs in learning.

The R&D team, composed of educators, software developers, instructional designers, and engineers, spearheads numerous Profound Learning initiatives, both locally and globally. Innovation is a continuous process at Master's, with the R&D team relentlessly to render current practices obsolete by discovering and implementing more effective and suitable models for our ever-changing world.

Master's faculty are actively involved in the iterative process of developing new ideas, which evolve until they become standard practices. The R&D team welcomes feedback and input from staff during the development phase, and once a final version is accepted, it is implemented as the new standard. Proven effective structures and models are then shared with the wider educational community. Being a part of Master's faculty requires adaptability and comfort with change, as new initiatives and structures are continually developed and refined.

Innovator's Dilemma: Need a New R&D Sandbox

Clayton Christensen describes the 'Innovator's Dilemma' as the challenge that highly successful organizations face in making obsolete what is already working well and has brought them success. Christensen suggests finding customers you are not currently serving and innovating something new for them.

This is the challenge Master's Academy and College faces. As a top-ranked school with a waitlist, our Innovator's Dilemma is how to innovate while keeping our high level satisfaction with our current clientele.

To tackle this, Master's is launching Imaginal+ in 2025. Imaginal+ (imaginalplus.com) is a hybrid school offering both online and site-based learning for older students. To move away from the factory model of education, we are creating a flexible system without bells and rigid schedules. Imaginal+ students manage their own time and learning.

The site-based component includes an Imaginal Studio for collaboration and the Creative Commons, featuring a fabrication lab, robotics lab, and digital creative labs. Students engage in specialized, collaborative activities.

Imaginal+ has a different structure from Master's current school, enabling innovation without disrupting our current base. Once proven effective, we can transform the existing school to reflect the new model, following our planned obsolescence strategy.

Becoming Future Ready

MASTER LEARNER K-6



7 Habits of the Master Learner

1. Person of Character
2. Principle-Centered Leader
3. Critical and Creative Thinker
4. Collaborative Worker
5. Independent Worker
6. Quality Producer
7. Lifelong Learner

IMAGINAL LEADER GR. 7-12



Becoming an Imaginal Leader

1. IDENTITY: Finding Your Big WHY
2. DRIVE: Activating Personal Drive
3. VISION: Seeing the Future
4. CREATE: Creating the Future
5. GROW: Doing the Impossible

From "Becoming Imaginal, Seeing and Creating the Future of Education" by Thomas Rudmik

CHRIST FOLLOWER GR. K-12



Biblical Christian Integration

1. BIG WHY
2. IDENTITY
3. WISDOM
4. RELATIONSHIP
5. SERVICE
6. VALUES

2. Purpose



Our Mission Statement, to *prepare students to be Future Ready*, defines our core purpose and directs our daily actions. To achieve this mission, we have created an educational framework that prioritizes not only academic excellence but also the holistic development of each student. We place a strong emphasis on nurturing all dimensions of their identity, beginning with their spiritual foundation as individuals created in God's image, and extending to their mental and physical capabilities.

The **Future Ready Model** at Master's Academy is a comprehensive framework designed to holistically develop students into well-rounded individuals who are prepared to excel in all aspects of life. This model, which integrates Christian values deeply into the school's Profound Learning Model, ensures that students are not only academically equipped but also spiritually and ethically grounded.

The model is structured around three core pillars: Master Learner, Imaginal Leader, and Christ Follower, each of which is emphasized at different stages of a student's educational journey.

Master Learners

For students in Grades K-6, the focus is on cultivating the 7 Habits of the Master Learner. A Master Learner is one who has grown to become like their teacher, reflecting the principle found in Luke 6:40: "The student is not above the teacher, but everyone who is fully trained will be like their teacher." Students begin their journey as apprentice learners, and over the first six to seven years of schooling, they develop into Master Learners, much like Jesus who, at the age of 12, was found in the temple engaging with the teachers. The 7 Habits of the Master Learner include:

1. **Person of Character** – Developing integrity, honesty, and moral courage.
2. **Principle-Centered Leader** – Leading by example with a strong ethical foundation.
3. **Critical and Creative Thinker** – Approaching problems with innovative and analytical thinking.
4. **Collaborative Worker** – Working effectively with others to achieve common goals.
5. **Independent Worker** – Demonstrating self-reliance and the ability to manage tasks independently.
6. **Quality Producer** – Striving for excellence in all work, producing high-quality results.
7. **Lifelong Learner** – Embracing a continuous quest for knowledge and personal growth.

These early habits lay the groundwork for students to become self-motivated, resilient learners who can navigate the complexities of their educational journey and beyond.

Imaginal Leaders

As students progress into Grades 7-12, the emphasis shifts towards the 4 Imaginal Capacities and the 5 Keys to Becoming an Imaginal Leader. The 4 Imaginal Capacities are:

1. **Improvement** – Continuously seeking to enhance processes and outcomes.
2. **Innovation** – Embracing new ideas and pushing the boundaries of what already exists.
3. **Invention** – Creating novel solutions and products that address unmet needs.
4. **Integration** – Combining diverse elements to form cohesive and effective systems.

In addition to these capacities, the 5 Keys to Becoming an Imaginal Leader guide students in their leadership development:

1. **IDENTITY**: Finding Your Big WHY – Discovering personal purpose and motivation.
2. **DRIVE**: Activating Personal Drive – Harnessing inner motivation to pursue goals.
3. **VISION**: Seeing the Invisible – Using insight and foresight envisioning future possibilities and opportunities
4. **CREATE**: Making Visible the Invisible – Bringing innovative ideas to life.
5. **GROW**: Doing the Impossible – Overcoming challenges and achieving extraordinary results.

Christ Follower

Throughout Grades K-12, there is a continuous focus on Becoming a Christ Follower. This aspect of the model is central to the school's mission, ensuring that students grow in their faith, develop strong moral and ethical values, and learn to live in a way that reflects the teachings of Christ. By integrating Christian principles into every aspect of their education, students are guided to not only achieve personal success but also to contribute to the greater good in a meaningful and impactful way.

Through this integrated approach, students at Master's Academy are developed into Learners, Leaders, and Followers, each of which is crucial to being truly Future Ready. By the time they graduate, students are not only prepared for the academic and professional challenges that lie ahead but are also equipped to lead with integrity, think imaginatively, and live out their faith in all areas of life. This comprehensive development process ensures that they are well-prepared to navigate the future with confidence and purpose.

Master's Christian Integration Model

WISDOM:

God's direction through scripture,
prayer & worship

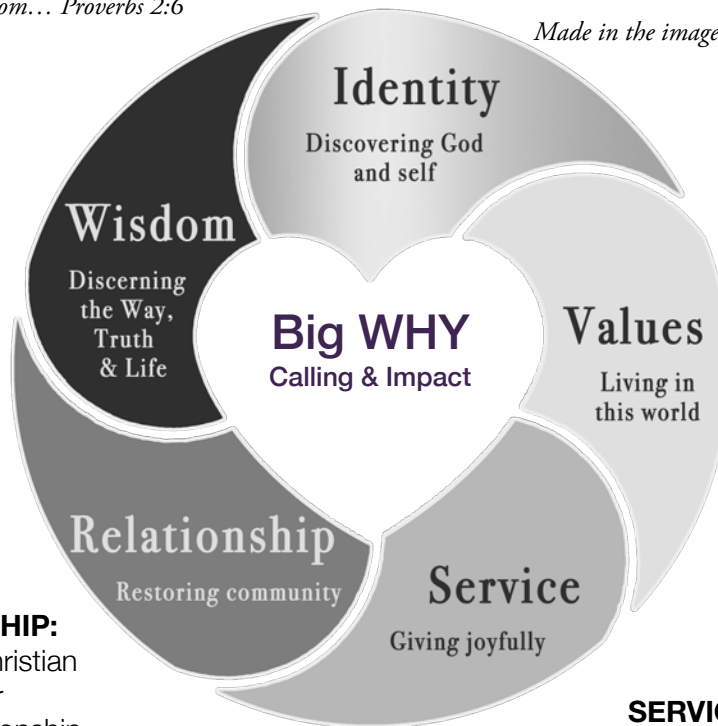
Seek first the Kingdom of God... Matthew 6:33

The Lord gives wisdom... Proverbs 2:6

IDENTITY:

God the Father & Creator
Jesus the Saviour & Lord
Holy Spirit the Helper & Guide
My Identity / Destiny

Made in the image of God... Genesis 1:26



Values,
Ethics &
Justice

*Act justly, love
mercy & walk
humbly with your
God... Micah 6:8*

RELATIONSHIP:

Celebrating Christian
Calendar
Restoring relationship
between God and
humanity
Caring for our world

*Love the Lord your God with all your heart
and with all your soul and with all your mind
and with all your strength.*

*The second is this: 'Love your neighbour as
yourself.' There is no commandment greater
than these. Mark 12:30-31*

SERVICE:

Contributing Sacrificial Service
God's hands in the community

It is better to give than receive... Acts 20:35

God loves a cheerful giver... 2 Corinthians 9:7-12

*Don't become so well adjusted to your culture that you fit into it without
even thinking. Instead, fix your attention on God and you'll be changed
from the inside out. Romans 12:2*

Master's Christian Integration Model



Here's a detailed exploration of the six fundamental principles for living a purposeful life according to Christian values, focusing on developing a transformative identity, embracing divine values, engaging in selfless service, fostering healthy relationships, and applying godly wisdom:

Big WHY:

The concept of the "Big WHY" is central to understanding your divine purpose. This foundational purpose is not just an aim but a profound calling that influences every aspect of your life. It integrates with your personal ambitions and the societal contributions you aspire to make, thereby shaping a comprehensive vision for your life. It's the motivation behind all decisions, large and small, and provides the framework through which you perceive and interact with the world. Living out your Big WHY means aligning your day-to-day actions and long-term goals with this deeper calling, which springs from and nourishes your spiritual and personal growth.

"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the Lord, plans for welfare and not for evil, to give you a future and a hope." - Jeremiah 29:11.

IDENTITY:

Your identity in Christ fundamentally alters how you view yourself and how you interact with the world. This transformation goes beyond mere reform—it's a complete rebirth that encompasses spiritual endowments and a new, holy lineage as God's child. This new identity liberates you from past bonds and misidentifications, allowing you to live freely and fully in the image God has for you. It involves a recognition of your inherent worth and capabilities, encouraging you to employ your natural and spiritual gifts in ways that fulfill God's purposes and enrich your communities.

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come." - 2 Corinthians 5:17.

VALUES:

Embracing God's values requires a deliberate pivot from secular norms to divine ordinances. These values challenge you to live counter to cultural expectations, promoting virtues like humility, generosity, and altruism. Understanding and embodying these values is a dynamic process facilitated by regular engagement with Scripture and the Holy Spirit's guidance. This process leads to a life that not only respects divine principles but also actively demonstrates them through choices that foster justice, kindness, and righteousness in every interaction and endeavor.

"But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you." - Matt. 6:33.

SERVICE:

Service in the Christian context is modeled after Jesus' example of love and sacrifice. It calls for a lifestyle where service is an expression of joy and gratitude rather than obligation. By serving others, you reflect Christ's selfless nature and his ministry of reconciliation and healing. This commitment to service isn't limited to occasional acts of kindness but is a continual lifestyle of considering others' needs as paramount and using your unique abilities to meet those needs, thereby building up the community and furthering the kingdom of God.

"For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many." - Mark 10:45.

RELATIONSHIP:

Christianity places a strong emphasis on relationships, advocating for harmony and integrity in dealings with God, self, and others. Each relationship requires attention and care, informed by biblical principles that promote reconciliation and responsible stewardship. These relationships are interconnected, reflecting the holistic nature of God's creation and commandments. The Church plays a crucial role in this, offering support and resources to navigate these relationships effectively and authentically, demonstrating God's love and grace to the broader world.

"A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another." - John 13:34.

WISDOM:

Wisdom in Christian doctrine is about discerning and living according to God's truth. It transcends mere intellectual understanding, involving a heartfelt commitment to applying God's Word in everyday situations. Wisdom involves seeing life from God's perspective and making choices that align with His will, leading to fulfillment and righteousness. The pursuit of wisdom is a lifelong endeavor, nurtured through prayer, meditation on Scripture, and practical application. It empowers believers to make decisions that are not only personally beneficial but also contribute positively to their communities and the world at large.

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom, and knowledge of the Holy One is insight." - Proverbs 9:10.

These principles are not isolated but are interconnected, each enriching and being enriched by the others. Together, they form a robust framework for a life that is not only aligned with God's will but also proactive in manifesting His kingdom on Earth through personal transformation, community service, and global influence.

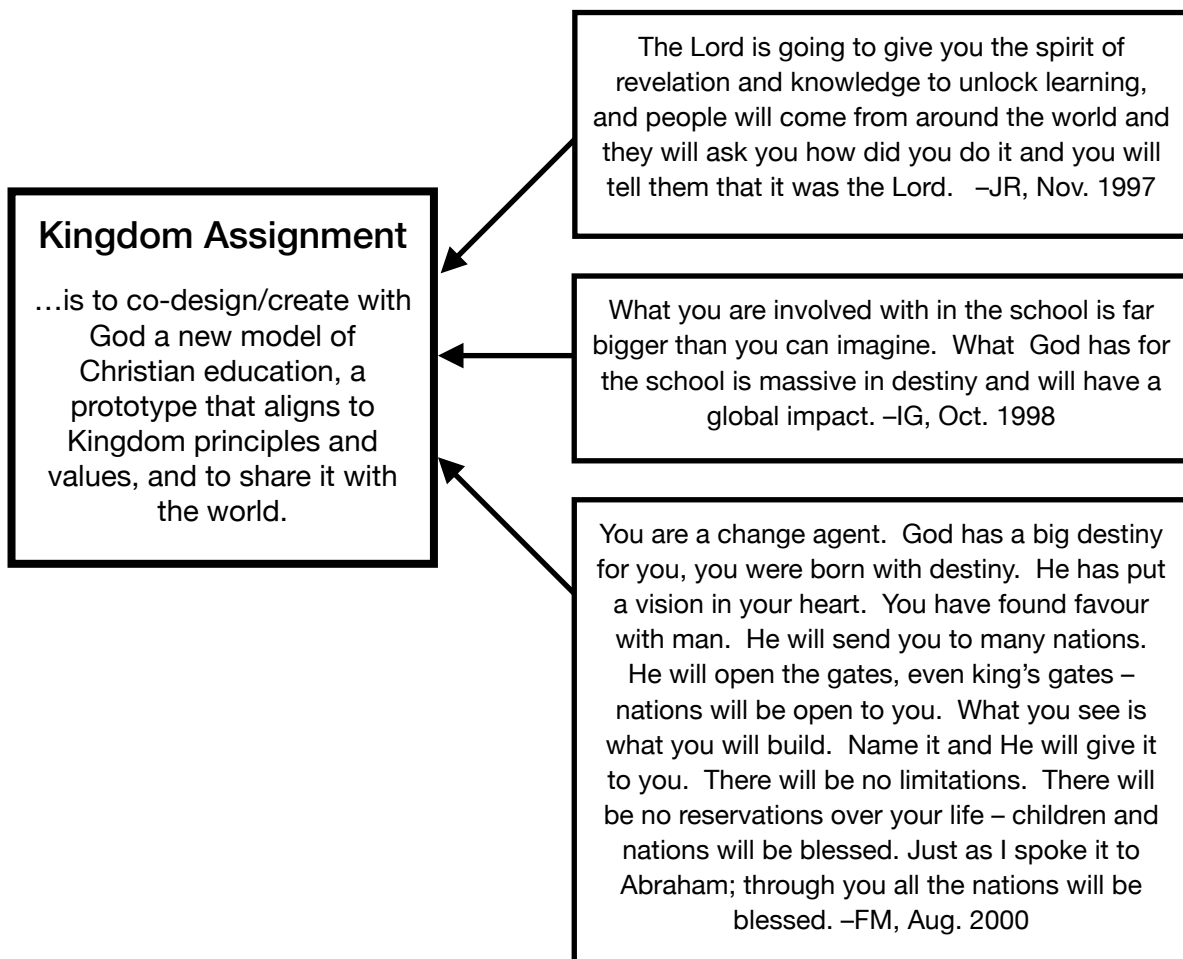
Master's Kingdom Assignment

Biblical Premise for Making a Legal Claim

Deuteronomy 19:15 "A single witness shall not prevail against a man for any crime or for any wrong in connection with any offence that he has committed; only on the evidence of **two witnesses, or of three witnesses**, shall a charge be sustained.

Three Witnesses to Master's Kingdom Assignment

The trilogy of prophetic words spoken to Tom Rudmik outlines Master's destiny and calling. The Kingdom Assignment statement emerges from the core messages of these three distinct prophetic words, each delivered by individuals with no prior relationship with Tom Rudmik or with one another.



3. Cause



Master's purpose represents a broad expression of the calling that aligns with advancing Heaven's will on earth, whether as individuals or as an organization. The cause refines this purpose by identifying the specific focus or mission that the purpose is directed toward. Just as Jesus had a distinct cause that guided all his actions, the Cause for an organization or individual is a particular area of focus that one is called to pursue. This often aligns with one of the seven spheres of influence or mountains of culture, and can also be referred to as your Kingdom Assignment.

The Seven Spheres or Mountains of Influence

The Seven Mountains of Culture, first articulated by Bill Bright and Loren Cunningham, represent key areas of society that shape cultures and values. Bringing Biblical and Kingdom values to each of these mountains involves transforming them to reflect God's principles and purposes.

Religion: The Church and faith communities are essential in imparting Biblical truth and Kingdom values. By embodying Christ-like love, teaching sound doctrine, and engaging in compassionate outreach, religious institutions can serve as beacons of hope, guiding society towards a deeper relationship with God.

Family: The family, as the foundational unit of society, must be nurtured through Biblical principles of love, respect, and responsibility. By fostering environments rooted in Kingdom values, families can provide a stable and nurturing foundation for individuals to grow in faith and character.

Education: Integrating a Biblical worldview into education shapes the minds and values of future generations. By instilling wisdom, integrity, and a sense of divine purpose, educational systems can prepare students to live out Kingdom values in every aspect of their lives.

Government: Governance should reflect God's justice and righteousness. Leaders guided by Biblical principles can enact policies that uphold the sanctity of life, protect the vulnerable, and promote accountability and the common good, reflecting the Kingdom's emphasis on justice and compassion.

Media: Media has the power to influence public perception and values. By promoting truth, integrity, and redemptive storytelling, media can advance Kingdom values, countering destructive narratives and inspiring hope and moral clarity.

Arts and Entertainment: The arts have the unique ability to inspire and reflect cultural values. Christian artists can create works that celebrate beauty, truth, and redemption, offering society a vision of hope and reflecting the transformative power of God's Kingdom.

Business: The marketplace is a powerful arena for expressing Biblical values. Businesses that operate on principles of honesty, stewardship, and generosity can foster environments of economic justice and social well-being, demonstrating the practical application of Kingdom values in the world.

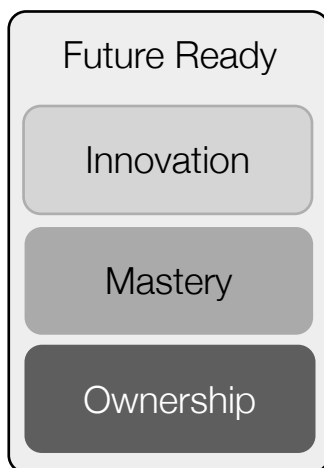
Kingdom Assignment

In John 17:1-5, Jesus prays, "Father, the hour has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may glorify you... I have brought you glory on earth **by finishing the work you gave me to do.**" Just as Jesus was purposeful and focused on His assignment to glorify God and complete His work, we too are called to fulfill our unique Kingdom assignments with intentionality and dedication, 1 John 2:6: "Whoever claims to live in him must live as Jesus did."

For example, Master's Kingdom Assignment is related to what God wants for education. This means advancing God's Kingdom by transforming educational systems to reflect Biblical principles, nurturing the spiritual and moral growth of students, and preparing them to live out Kingdom values in their lives. Specifically, Master's Assignment includes the research and development of a new model of Christian Education, which is to be prototyped at Master's and shared globally. This context-specific mission highlights the importance of aligning our efforts with God's will, ensuring that every action and decision contributes to the broader goal of expanding His Kingdom on earth.

By being purposeful as Jesus was with His assignment, we ensure that our Kingdom Assignment is fulfilled with the same focus and dedication, bringing glory to God and manifesting His will on earth.

Profound Learning



Personal Development

preparing students with mindsets, skills and habits essential for their future success

Becoming Imaginal

inspiring and developing seer and creators of the future

Learning Excellence

closing gaps in learning using brain compatible experiences

Student Responsibility

empowering students to use specific tools to own and track their learning

Fig. 1. Profound Learning Model

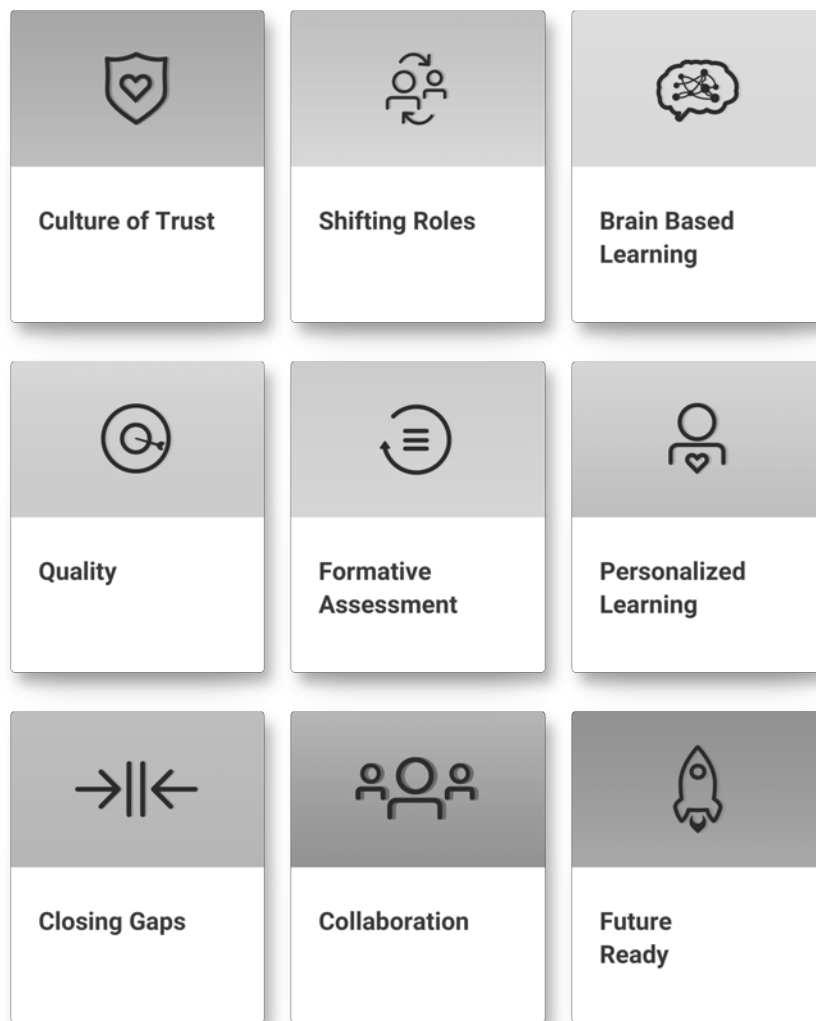


Fig. 2. Nine Essential Profound Learning Elements

4. Vision



Master's Academy and College, operating as an Imaginal Organization, is dedicated to transforming the educational landscape. By leveraging innovative tools, methods, structures, and systems, it aims to cultivate the imaginal spirit within students, thereby enabling them to achieve academic excellence and prepare for future challenges. This transformation is rooted in a dynamic vision that continuously evolves to anticipate and shape future educational models.

Imaginal Defined

The term "Imaginal" is inspired by the biological transformation from caterpillar to butterfly, symbolizing profound change and potential. At Master's, this concept is integral to nurturing visionary and innovative qualities in students, encouraging them to think beyond conventional boundaries and envision transformative possibilities for their futures.

Profound Learning

Master's has trademarked its unique educational approach as "Profound Learning," recognized globally for its effectiveness in fostering academic success and personal growth. This model ensures students are Future Ready—spiritually, mentally, and physically—by integrating joy into the learning process and encouraging students to pursue their individual visions without constraints.

The Model and Its Elements Profound Learning operates beyond traditional programs; it is a systemic approach that emerges from specific educational practices and a supportive culture. Key components include:

- **Ownership:** Students are empowered to take charge of their learning through specific tools and experiences.
- **Mastery:** Focus is on achieving academic excellence by identifying and addressing gaps in understanding.
- **Innovation:** Students are inspired to adopt innovative thinking to become Imaginal leaders.
- **Future Ready:** The model prepares students with the necessary mindsets, skills, and habits for future success.

9 Elements of Profound Learning

This approach is characterized by nine interconnected elements:

1. Culture of Trust
2. Shifting Roles
3. Brain-based Learning
4. Quality
5. Formative Assessment
6. Personalized Learning
7. Closing Gaps
8. Collaboration
9. Future Ready

These elements facilitate a learning environment where students are empowered, trust is cultivated, and mastery is prioritized.

Role of the Teacher and Student

In this model, teachers are responsible for setting the learning context, creating conducive conditions, and ensuring all necessary connections are made for understanding. Students, on the other hand, are tasked with learning, reflecting, choosing, and contributing. This structure emphasizes student ownership over their educational journey, with teachers providing support and guidance to foster a mastery-oriented learning environment.

Engaging Experiences and Learning Adventures

Master's Academy emphasizes engaging learning experiences, designed to instill joy, satisfaction, and self-motivation. These experiences are carefully crafted to clarify learning outcomes, integrate essential academic skills, and incorporate a Christian worldview, ensuring alignment with the Profound Learning model.

Geenius Learning Platform

The Geenius Platform is a proprietary software developed to support both on-site and online learning at Master's Academy. It facilitates the Profound Learning model by helping students track their progress and master the curriculum through interactive, personalized content. Geenius also features an Adaptive Knowledge Retention (AKR) system, which uses algorithms to enhance long-term memory retention by up to 90%, thereby reducing exam stress and improving educational outcomes.

The AKR system, integral to the Geenius platform, optimizes learning by spacing information and tailoring reviews to user feedback. This method breaks down information into key points for daily review, helping students build a robust knowledge base that is both contextual and significant. Regular engagement with this system minimizes the need for last-minute cramming and maximizes long-term retention, offering a more effective and efficient learning experience.

In summary, Master's Academy and College embodies an advanced educational paradigm through its Imaginal identity and Profound Learning model, equipped with modern technology and innovative pedagogical strategies to prepare students for the challenges and opportunities of the future.

Commitment to Master’s Big WHY

FOCUS & FIT

At Master’s Academy and College, we work together in a vision community where we all align our practices to the Big Why of the organization.

The Big Why of the organization provides the focus for the core values and the practices of Master’s Academy and College.

Individually, we assess our own fit within the organization.

Affirming Commitment Statement

As per the hiring statement from Palliser Regional School District, “All current and future Education staff shall demonstrate a continuing commitment to implement and carry out the Philosophy of Christian Education and the unique learning model called Profound Learning of the MACAP, and the Board may include in the contracts of employment of such persons such statements as it, in its discretion, considers desirable in that regard.”

With regard to the organization’s Big Why, I have read the article and linked documents on the following topics:

Values	_____ (initial)
Identity	_____ (initial)
Purpose	_____ (initial)
Cause	_____ (initial)
Vision	_____ (initial)

Master’s Society Leadership welcomes any conversation a staff member may wish to initiate to express their personal response to the Big Why of Master’s. The desire of the Society leadership is to ensure that all staff feel satisfactorily informed as to Master’s organizational position before signing the statement below.

I _____ in my role as _____ will support the statements regarding Master’s Academy and College Educational Society’s VALUES, IDENTITY, PURPOSE, CAUSE and VISION. I will align and continuously look for opportunities to elevate my classroom practice and my leadership with students to support and carry out the unique Big Why expressed through the worldview of Christian Education and the unique learning model called Profound Learning. By signing this document, I understand the terms to apply until the termination of my employment at Master’s Academy and College, or until an updated document is presented by the Administration of the school.

Name: _____
Signature: _____
Date Signed: _____

Each faculty member at Master’s was asked to submit the above document as a statement of their commitment to Master’s Big WHY.

5. Fit and Focus



At Master's Academy and College, each of us as staff members is deeply engaged in fulfilling a Kingdom Assignment we believe has been divinely appointed by God. Our roles are crucial to realizing the school's overarching vision—Master's Big WHY—which revolves around transforming the educational landscape in a manner that aligns with God's divine plan. This vision compels us to commit to a process of co-designing and co-creating with God, synchronizing our efforts with the Divine rhythm set for our collective journey.

Dance with Co-Design/Creation with God

This principle of co-design underscores our purpose to enact the Kingdom mission entrusted to us. Echoing the Lord's Prayer, where Jesus instructed us to seek God's will on earth as it is in heaven, we recognize our significant role in the expansive task of extending God's Kingdom on earth. The Scriptures offer numerous examples where God invites individuals to participate in His grand design, providing them with the necessary resources and guidance to effectively echo His intentions on this earth.

In our endeavor at Master's, we understand that the journey of educational innovation requires more than individual effort; it demands a collective commitment.

Acknowledging that no single person within our community possesses all the skills and resources needed to independently achieve our goals, our journey is deeply rooted in faith, trusting that God will reveal His mysteries to us at the perfect moment. This mission, akin to constructing the "ark of education," involves a dedicated community of individuals. All of us rely extensively on divine guidance while co-designing and co-creating elements such as Profound Learning, the Geenius digital platform, Imaginal Thinking, and beyond.

A particularly affirming moment came in November 1997 during an evening service, when a prophetic message was delivered:

"The Lord is going to endow you with the spirit of revelation and knowledge to demystify learning, and people from across the globe will approach you to ask how you accomplished this, and you will tell them it was the Lord's doing."

This profound affirmation served not only to endorse the vision or mission God had given us but also to pledge His active participation in our co-design efforts. Today, Master's is nationally recognized by the Fraser Institute, Canada's largest independent think tank, as one of Canada's top schools and is internationally acclaimed as an educational model capable of transforming nations.

Our Journey Co-Designing and Co-Creating with God:

Laying the Foundations (1995-1997): The initial vision for Master's School was launched with a clear divine directive, leading to providential connections and opportunities that clearly defined our path forward.

Embracing Prophetic Affirmations (1997-1999): With the establishment of Master's Academy and College, our mission was magnified by several prophetic affirmations, which deepened our resolve to revolutionize the realm of education rooted in Christian values and teachings.

Visionary Explorations (1999-2008): A pivotal revelation in 1999 urged us to push beyond traditional educational models, spurring innovations that have since become foundational to our approach.

Blueprint of Divine Co-Creation (2008-2012): This period was marked by strategic developments, such as the implementation of the Geenius Digital Platform, which epitomize our collaborative efforts with the divine and exemplify how each element was crafted with purpose.

Sowing the Seeds of Global Vision (2012-Present):

Sowing the Seeds of Global Vision (2012-Present): Since our initial outreach efforts in Nigeria in 2012, we have substantially expanded our educational impact worldwide, highlighting the extensive scope of our collaborative work with God. This global vision has deepened through significant partnerships in Uganda and South Africa, where our models and methodologies are being adopted and adapted to meet local educational needs. A particularly notable advancement has occurred in Brazil, where we have established a prototype school in partnership with the Nishimura Family Foundation and ITC Brasil. This strategic collaboration not only serves as a model for integrating our educational philosophies but also solidifies our commitment to shaping a future that honors and glorifies the Divine through international educational transformation.

Today, Master's Academy stands as more than just an educational institution; it is a vibrant testament to what is possible when human vision aligns with divine intent. Our collective dedication to nurturing holistic individuals—Master Learners, Imaginal Leaders, and devoted Followers of Christ—reflects our deep commitment to preparing students for a purposeful life on Earth and eternal communion with God. Through our shared faith and collaborative spirit, we continue to co-create with God, pioneering pathways in education that transcend conventional boundaries and expectations, aiming to shape a future that truly honors and glorifies the Divine.

Thomas Rudmik

CEO, Founder of Master's Academy & College

CEO and Co-founder of Imaginal Education and Imaginal Transformation Inc.

Thomas Rudmik is a 1978 graduate of the University of Toronto with B.Sc. and B.Ed. degrees, with more than 40 years experience as a teacher, principal, pastor, entrepreneur and visionary leader. In May 2017, Thomas Rudmik was granted an Honorary Doctorate degree, for his 40 years of advancing education in Canada and globally, by Canada Christian College.

Thomas's Big Why is to transform communities, cities, states and nations by unleashing the Imaginal and Innovative spirit. Thomas has created the Imaginal Thinking process of seeing, learning from and creating the future that has become the cornerstone for the transformation of education, business, government and all sectors of our economy.



Thomas Rudmik's passion for transforming education has brought him professional acclaim. He is committed to addressing the REAL problem in education, which is system transformation. His book, *Becoming Imaginal Seeing and Creating the Future of Education*, provides a roadmap for Imaginal leaders to transform their school, district, state or country. Thomas's vision has led to the establishment of an international network called, Imaginal Education, which currently is functioning in numerous countries.

Thomas Rudmik is the Founder of Master's Academy and College (1997), a K-12 awarding winning R&D Christian school located in Calgary, Canada. Today, Master's has gained international recognition for the development of its Future Ready Model of Education and becoming one of the top-performing K-12 schools in North America. Master's vision goes well beyond achieving academic excellence, it is preparing students to become Imaginal Leaders, those that can see, learn from and create the future of their world; those that transform their world with creativity and innovation.

More recently, Thomas Rudmik founded the Imaginal+ School in Calgary, Alberta, Canada as a prototype for a global network of Imaginal+ Schools each uniquely adopted to the each countries curriculum and culture.

www.imaginaleducation.com

www.imaginalplus.com

www.masters.ab.ca